

人类理解研究

第一章 论哲学的不同类别

道德哲学，或曰人性科学，有两种不同的研究方法，二者各有所长，均有助于人类的娱乐、教育和改革。一种方法认为，人主要为行动而生，在品位和情趣的影响之下，根据事物表现出的不同价值，以及事物的展现方式，有选择地追求和规避。既然一切事物中，唯德最为宝贵，此类哲学家便将德描绘得美妙无比，充分利用诗歌和雄辩，用浅显易懂的方式解释德，以便充分发挥人们的想象，激发其情感共鸣。他们从日常生活中挑选给人最深刻印象的现象和事例，将相反的品格加以适当的对照，用壮丽和幸福的景象诱导我们步入德行之途，再以最无懈可击

的箴言和最好的例证指引我们前行的步履。他们让我们感知善恶之别，激发并管制我们的情感。他们认为，这样一来他们就能把人心引向对诚信和至善的热爱，他们就完全达到了自己千辛万苦所追求的目标。

Section I Of the Different Species of Philosophy

Moral philosophy, or the science of human nature, may be treated after two different manners; each of which has its peculiar merit, and may contribute to the entertainment, instruction, and reformation of mankind. The one considers man chiefly as born for action; and as influenced in his measures by taste and sentiment; pursuing one object, and avoiding another, according to the value which these objects seem to possess, and according to the light in which they present themselves. As virtue, of all objects, is allowed to be the most valuable, this

species of philosophers paint her in the most amiable colours; borrowing all helps from poetry and eloquence, and treating their subject in an easy and obvious manner, and such as is best fitted to please the imagination, and engage the affections. They select the most striking observations and instances from common life; place opposite characters in a proper contrast; and alluring us into the paths of virtue by the views of glory and happiness, direct our steps in these paths by the soundest precepts and most illustrious examples. They make us feel the difference between vice and virtue; they excite and regulate our sentiments; and so they can but bend our

另一类哲学家把人视作理性而非行动的生灵，他们致力于培养人的悟性，而非规范其举止。他们把人性作为思辨的对象，对其进行仔细考察，以期发现有什么原则在塑造我们的理解，激发我们的情感，让我们对某一事物、行动、行为或褒或贬。他们认为，令古今一切文献蒙羞的是，哲学竟然迄今尚未无可争议地确立道德、理性和批评的根基；竟然还在无休止地讨论真与假、善与恶、美与丑，却无法确定这些不同之处的本源是什么。他们力图完成这一艰巨任务，不惧怕任何困难；他们从具体事例出发，设法

推导出普遍原理，再进一步探求，以找出更普遍的原理，孜孜以求，直到得出那些初始原则。在每一门学科里，这些原则限定了人类本着好奇心探求的边界。这些哲学家的思辨似乎很抽象，普通人甚至理解不了，其目标是得到博学和智慧之士的赞同。他们认为，倘若能发现什么隐秘的真理，有助于教育子孙后代，那么他们毕生的努力就如愿以偿了。

hearts to the love of probity and true honour, they think, that they have fully attained the end of all their labours.

The other species of philosophers consider man in the light of a reasonable rather than an active being, and endeavour to form his understanding more than cultivate his manners. They regard human nature as a subject of speculation; and with a narrow scrutiny examine it, in order to find those principles, which regulate our understanding, excite our sentiments, and make us approve or blame any particular object, action, or behaviour. They think it a reproach to all literature, that philosophy should not yet

have fixed, beyond controversy, the foundation of morals, reasoning, and criticism; and should for ever talk of truth and falsehood, vice and virtue, beauty and deformity, without being able to determine the source of these distinctions. While they attempt this arduous task, they are deterred by no difficulties; but proceeding from particular instances to general principles, they still push on their enquiries to principles more general, and rest not satisfied till they arrive at those original principles, by which, in every science, all human curiosity must be bounded. Though their speculations seem abstract, and even unintelligible to common readers, they aim at the approbation of the

显然，对于大众而言，明白易懂的哲理总是比精确深奥的哲理更受欢迎；而且在许多人看来，前者不仅更招人喜欢，而且比后者更实用可行。它更贴近日常生活，更能够塑造人的心灵与情感。它通过触及促使人行动的原则，改进人的行为举止，将人引领到它所描绘的完美境界。反之，那些玄奥的哲理，由于它们视作基础的思维方式不适用于日常事务与行动，因此一旦哲学家们走出阴影，进入光天化日之下，它们便会消失得无

影无踪；其原则也很难对我们的言行举止产生任何影响。在世人的真切感受、澎湃欲念、激烈情感面前，这种哲学的一切结论都会烟消云散，思想深奥的哲人也就变成了无足轻重的庸人。

必须承认，简易的哲学赢得了最恒久、最公道的声誉。而那些抽象的推理者似乎仅因其所处时代的一时潮流或愚昧无知获得了

learned and the wise; and think themselves sufficiently compensated for the labour of their whole lives, if they can discover some hidden truths, which may contribute to the instruction of posterity.

It is certain that the easy and obvious philosophy will always, with the generality of mankind, have the preference above the accurate and abstruse; and by many will be recommended, not only as more agreeable, but more useful than the other. It enters more into common life; moulds the heart and affections; and, by touching those principles which actuate men, reforms their conduct, and brings them nearer to that

model of perfection which it describes. On the contrary, the abstruse philosophy, being founded on a turn of mind, which cannot enter into business and action, vanishes when the philosopher leaves the shade, and comes into open day; nor can its principles easily retain any influence over our conduct and behaviour. The feelings of our heart, the agitation of our passions, the vehemence of our affections, dissipate all its conclusions, and reduce the profound philosopher to a mere plebeian.

This also must be confessed, that the most durable, as well as justest fame, has been acquired by the easy philosophy, and

短暂的虚名，一旦到了更加公正的后人那里，这种名声便无法维持。对于深奥的哲学家而言，在玄妙的推理中犯错误是很容易的，而且在其一环扣一环的推理过程中，一个错误必然导致另一个错误；同时，他会毫不犹豫地接受任何结论，哪怕这结论显得怪诞离奇、有悖于常理。相反，一个只想把人类的常识描绘得更加美好、更加绚丽的哲学家，即便一不小心犯了错误，也不至失之太远。只要他能重新借助常识和心灵的自然情感，便能回归正途，确保自己不陷入虚妄的险境。当今世界，西塞罗的名声如日中天，而亚里士多德则几近销声匿迹。拉布吕耶尔驰名海外，如今仍然举世皆知，而马勒伯朗士的荣耀却仅限于他的国家和他的时代。艾迪生的作品或许会被后人拜读，而洛克必定

会被彻底遗忘。

纯粹的哲学家常常不为世人接受，因为人们认为他们既无助于社会的发展，也不能让大众娱乐。他们不与人交流；他们的思想也不为大众所理解。另一方面，纯粹的无知

that abstract reasoners seem hitherto to have enjoyed only a momentary reputation, from the caprice or ignorance of their own age, but have not been able to support their renown with more equitable posterity. It is easy for a profound philosopher to commit a mistake in his subtile reasonings; and one mistake is the necessary parent of another, while he pushes on his consequences, and is not deterred from embracing any conclusion, by its unusual appearance, or its contradiction to popular opinion. But a philosopher, who purposes only to represent the common sense of mankind in more beautiful and more engaging colours, if by accident he falls into error, goes no farther; but

renewing his appeal to common sense, and the natural sentiments of the mind, returns into the right path, and secures himself from any dangerous illusions. The fame of Cicero flourishes at present; but that of Aristotle is utterly decayed. La Bruyere passes the seas, and still maintains his reputation; but the glory of Malebranche is confined to his own nation, and to his own age. And Addison, perhaps, will be read with pleasure, when Locke shall be entirely forgotten.

The mere philosopher is a character, which is commonly but little acceptable in the world, as being supposed to contribute nothing either to the advantage or pleasure

之辈仍然更让人厌恶。在科学高度发达的国家和时代，能体现出一个人不开明最明显的标志，莫过于完全对这些高尚的志趣没兴趣。最完美的人应该介于两者之间；在读书、交友和职业诸方面，有着同等的能力和志趣；谈吐之中，既有敏锐的判断，又有儒雅的风范；在职业活动中，则能时时展现出正确的哲学所养成的正直和精确。要培养这样的完美人格，使更多的人拥有这种品性，最有效的办法莫过于让人阅读风格简易、文笔晓畅的作品。这样的作品既非过多地取材于生活，也无需人们孜孜不倦，甚或隐居精修以求得理解。一个人读了这样的书，回到社会时便具备了高尚的志趣和明智的观念，足以在情急时派上用场。在这类作品的陶冶之下，美德变得与人亲近，科学让人舒心惬意，交友使人受益，独居充满乐趣。

人是理性的生灵，因此能从科学中获得合适的精神食粮和养分。可是，人的理解能

of society; while he lives remote from communication with mankind, and is wrapped up in principles and notions equally remote from their comprehension. On the other hand, the mere ignorant is still more despised; nor is any thing deemed a surer sign of an illiberal genius in an age and nation where the sciences flourish, than to be entirely destitute of all relish for those noble entertainments. The most perfect character is supposed to lie between those extremes; retaining an equal ability and taste for books, company, and business; preserving in conversation that discernment and delicacy which arise from polite letters; and in business, that probity and accuracy which are the natural result of a just philosophy. In order to diffuse and cultivate so accomplished a character, nothing can be more useful than compositions of the easy style and manner, which draw not too much from life, require no deep application or retreat to be comprehended, and send back the student among mankind full of noble sentiments and wise precepts, applicable to every exigence of human life. By means of such compositions, virtue becomes amiable, science agreeable, company instructive, and retirement entertaining.

Man is a reasonable being; and as such, receives from science his proper food and

力非常有限，对于他对科学的了解，无论是在广度还是在确切程度上，都不能期望过高。人不仅仅是理性的生灵，他同时也是社会动物。然而，人既不能和惬意开心的朋友长久相处，也无法保持结交这类朋友的志趣。人还是活跃的动物，由于这样的性情，加之生活的种种需要，人必须从事某种职业和工作。但是人的心灵需要放松，无法承受长期的操心 and 劳作之苦。所以，大自然似乎为人类指明了最适合他们的混合式的生活，暗中告诫他们，不可让任何偏好过多侵占他们的生活，使他们不能追求其他的职业和娱乐。大自然说，带着激情去拥抱科学吧，但是，要让你追求的科学成为人的科学，成为与行动和社会息息相关的科学。深奥的思想和玄妙的研究，我要禁止，违者将受到严厉

的惩罚。让它们带给你忧思冥想之苦，让你永远感到飘忽不定，让你把自己所谓的发现公诸于众时，受到世人的冷遇。你若要做哲学家，尽管做吧，但是，在你醉心于哲学的同时，务必要做一个人。

nourishment; but so narrow are the bounds of human understanding, that little satisfaction can be hoped for in this particular, either from the extent of security or his acquisitions. Man is a sociable, no less than a reasonable being; but neither can he always enjoy company agreeable and amusing, or preserve the proper relish for them. Man is also an active being; and from that disposition, as well as from the various necessities of human life, must submit to business and occupation; but the mind requires some relaxation, and cannot always support its bent to care and industry. It seems, then, that nature has pointed out a mixed kind of life as most suitable to the human race, and

secretly admonished them to allow none of these biases to draw too much, so as to incapacitate them for other occupations and entertainments. Indulge your passion for science, says she, but let your science be human, and such as may have a direct reference to action and society. Abstruse thought and profound researches I prohibit, and will severely punish, by the pensive melancholy which they introduce, by the endless uncertainty in which they involve you, and by the cold reception which your pretended discoveries shall meet with, when communicated. Be a philosopher; but, amidst all your philosophy, be still a man.

如果大众更偏爱明白易懂的哲学，但并不责难或藐视玄妙深刻的思想，我们不妨追随大众的看法，不非此即彼，让人人都有享受各自品位和情趣的自由。然而，实际的情形远非如此，人们往往对一切玄奥推理，即所谓的形而上学，持全盘否决的态度。有鉴于此，我们将在下文中对这一问题进行探讨，看看我们能为这一派哲学做出什么合理的辩护。

首先我们要指出，精确玄妙哲学的一大好处是，它补益于浅易近人的哲学。离开了

Were the generality of mankind contented to prefer the easy philosophy to the abstract and profound, without throwing any blame or contempt on the latter, it might not be improper, perhaps, to comply with this general opinion, and allow every man to enjoy, without opposition, his own taste and sentiment. But as the matter is often carried farther, even to the absolute rejecting of all profound reasonings, or what is commonly called metaphysics, we shall now proceed to consider what can reasonably be pleaded in their behalf.

We may begin with observing, that one considerable advantage, which results from

前者，浅易近人的哲学无论在其情感和观念的表述上，还是在其推理过程中，都永远达不到高度精确。一切儒雅的文章都不过是描绘人类生活的各种态度和不同情景，并根据其呈现在我们面前的事物的特质，用不同的情感启迪我们，或颂扬或谴责、或崇敬或嘲讽。一个艺术家必须能更好地担当这一任务。除了要具备高雅的品位和敏捷的头脑，他还得精确了解思维的内在机理、人类理解的方式、激情的作用过程以及区分善恶的各类情感。这是对人类内心世界的搜寻和探索，无论多么痛苦，对于任何期望成功描述人类生活和行为的明显外部特征的人而言，在某种程度上，都是必备的素质。解剖学家把人体最丑陋、最不堪入目的一面呈现在我们眼前，但是他所从事的科学有助于画家勾

the accurate and abstract philosophy, is, its subserviency to the easy and humane; which, without the former, can never attain a sufficient degree of exactness in its sentiments, precepts, or reasonings. All polite letters are nothing but pictures of human life in various attitudes and situations; and inspire us with different sentiments, of praise or blame, admiration or ridicule, according to the qualities of the object, which they set before us. An artist must be better qualified to succeed in this undertaking, who, besides a delicate taste and a quick apprehension, possesses an accurate knowledge of the internal fabric, the operations of the understanding, the workings of the

勒维纳斯或海伦的画像。画家在运用丰富的色彩，刻画出人物最优雅动人的形象时，他还必须关注人体的内部结构、肌肉的位置、骨骼的构造，以及身体各部分或各器官的作用和形状。任何情况下，精确有助于美的呈现，严密的推理有益于表达细腻的情感。我们通过贬低一种品质来抬高另一种品质，这是徒劳之举。

此外，我们还可以说，在每一种艺术或职业中，甚至在那些与生活或行动最密切相关的艺术或职业中，只要获得精确的精神，都能使这一艺术或职业更近于完美，更有益于社会。一个哲学家或许远离职业活动，但哲学的天赋之才一旦在几个人身上得到精心培养，必然会逐渐在全社会扩散开来，并为每一门艺术和职业带来类似的对准确的追求。在权力分配与制衡方面，政治家会变得更富远见，也更加敏锐；律师在其推理中会

passions, and the various species of sentiment which discriminate vice and virtue. How painful soever this inward search or enquiry may appear, it becomes, in some measure, requisite to those, who would describe with success the obvious and outward appearances of life and manners. The anatomist presents to the eye the most hideous and disagreeable objects; but his science is useful to the painter in delineating even a Venus or a Helen. While the latter employs all the richest colours of his art, and gives his figures the most graceful and engaging airs; he must still carry his attention to the inward structure of the human body, the position of the muscles, the fabric of the

bones, and the use and figure of every part or organ. Accuracy is, in every case, advantageous to beauty, and just reasoning to delicate sentiment. In vain would we exalt the one by depreciating the other.

Besides, we may observe, in every art or profession, even those which most concern life or action, that a spirit of accuracy, however acquired, carries all of them nearer their perfection, and renders them more subservient to the interests of society. And though a philosopher may live remote from business, the genius of philosophy, if carefully cultivated by several, must gradually diffuse itself throughout the whole society,

更有条理，原则更加细致；将军能掌握更适合军事训练的规律，筹划和实施军事行动时更为谨慎。现代政府相比于古代政府更稳定，现代哲学相比于古代哲学更精确，并且以此类推，它们将来很可能会继续进步。

即使这些研究除了满足人类天真的好奇心外，没有任何益处，它们也不应该因此而受到鄙视，毕竟这是自然赋予人类为数不

多、却又安全无害的消遣之一。最幸福、最平和和无害的人生之路会穿过科学和学问的大道，任何人只要能排除这一道路上的障碍，或是开拓出新的前景，都应当被视为人类的恩人。尽管从事研究可能会劳神费力，让人筋疲力尽，但是有些人的思想就像有些人的身体一样，天生地充满活力、健康茁壮，需要通过高强度的锻炼才能得到快乐，而这对普通人而言，可能是让人疲惫不堪的负荷。事实上，晦涩深奥的东西让思想和视觉都感到痛苦。但是，用尽一切方法，把晦涩深奥的东西解释清楚，便能令人欢欣鼓舞。

and bestow a similar correctness on every art and calling. The politician will acquire greater foresight and subtility, in the subdividing and balancing of power; the lawyer more method and finer principles in his reasonings; and the general more regularity in his discipline, and more caution in his plans and operations. The stability of modern governments above the ancient, and the accuracy of modern philosophy, have improved, and probably will still improve, by similar gradations.

Were there no advantage to be reaped from these studies, beyond the gratification of an innocent curiosity, yet ought not even

this to be despised; as being one accession to those few safe and harmless pleasures, which are bestowed on the human race. The sweetest and most inoffensive path of life leads through the avenues of science and learning; and whoever can either remove any obstructions in this way, or open up any new prospect, ought so far to be esteemed a benefactor to mankind. And though these researches may appear painful and fatiguing, it is with some minds as with some bodies, which being endowed with vigorous and florid health, require severe exercise, and reap a pleasure from what, to the generality of mankind, may seem burdensome and laborious. Obscurity, indeed, is painful

然而，人们对深奥抽象哲学中晦涩难懂的东西持排斥态度，不仅因为它劳神费力、让人精疲力竭，还因为人们认为它必然是一切不安和错误的根源。事实上，人们反对相当一部分形而上哲学，最正当、最合理的缘由在于，它们不是真正意义上的科学，要么发端于人类虚荣徒劳之举，渗透到人类理解力无法企及的话题，要么来源于广为流传的迷信之术，由于不能光明磊落地捍卫自己的立场，只好生发出这些纵横杂乱的荆棘，来掩盖自身的弱点以保护自身。这些盗贼之徒

to the mind as well as to the eye; but to bring light from obscurity, by whatever labour, must needs be delightful and rejoicing.

But this obscurity in the profound and abstract philosophy, is objected to, not only as painful and fatiguing, but as the inevitable source of uncertainty and error. Here indeed lies the justest and most plausible objection against a considerable part of metaphysics, that they are not properly a science; but arise either from the fruitless efforts of human vanity, which would penetrate into subjects utterly inaccessible to the understanding, or from the craft of pop-

在开阔之地上受到驱逐，只得躲进树林之中，伺机对疏于防守的思想之路发起突然袭击，并用宗教恐惧和偏见使其溃败。最强健的对手，稍有疏忽松懈，就会被打败。许多懦弱愚蠢之辈，更是为敌人打开大门，心悦诚服、卑躬屈膝地将这些盗贼之徒奉为合法之主。

ular superstitions, which, being unable to defend themselves on fair ground, raise these intangling brambles to cover and protect their weakness. Chased from the open country, these robbers fly into the forest, and lie in wait to break in upon every unguarded avenue of the mind, and overwhelm it with religious fears and prejudices. The stoutest antagonist, if he remits his watch a moment, is oppressed. And many, through cowardice and folly, open the gates to the enemies, and willingly receive them with reverence and submission, as their legal sovereigns.

但是，难道这一理由就足以让哲学家们

But is this a sufficient reason, why

放弃玄奥哲学的研究，让迷信继续占据其逍遥自在之所？难道我们不该做相反的决定，认识到我们有必要将战火烧到敌人最隐秘的藏身之地？我们枉然期盼，人们在频繁失望之后，最终会放弃这些虚幻的科学，发现人类理性的正途。因为许多人有着强烈的动机想要长久地研究这些话题，除此以外，我认为盲目的绝望绝不可能合理地存在于科学研究中。不管前人的努力多么不成功，我们仍然有理由期待，后人的勤勉、好运，以及在智慧上更胜一筹，或许会有前人闻所未闻的发现。每一个不畏艰险的天才都会奋不顾身地要夺取这份巨奖，前人的失败不仅不会使他感到泄气，反而会成为激励他前行的动力。他希望这份克服此等艰难险阻的荣誉是专门为自己预备的。让学问立即摆脱这些晦

涩难题的唯一方法，在于对人类理解力的本质进行严肃探讨，精确分析其才智和能力，证明它根本不适合涉猎如此遥远而玄妙的话题。我们必须先经受这一磨难，以求以后能安然地生活；必须精心地培育真正的形而上学，以摧毁假冒伪劣的形而上学。对有些人而言，懒惰是抵御这一欺世哲学的良方，但在另一些人身上，懒惰则被好奇心取代。同样，绝望有时候会占上风，但随着时间的推移，说不定会让位于乐观的希望和期盼。准确恰当的推理乃是唯一的普世良方，适合所有人、所有性格，而且仅凭自身就足以颠覆玄妙的哲学和形而上的胡言乱语。后两者常和世间流传的迷信混杂在一起，伪装成科学和智慧，让粗心大意的推理者无法看透。

philosophers should desist from such researches, and leave superstition still in possession of her retreat? Is it not proper to draw an opposite conclusion, and perceive the necessity of carrying the war into the most secret recesses of the enemy? In vain do we hope, that men, from frequent disappointment, will at last abandon such airy sciences, and discover the proper province of human reason. For, besides, that many persons find too sensible an interest in perpetually recalling such topics; besides this, I say, the motive of blind despair can never reasonably have place in the sciences; since, however unsuccessful former attempts may have proved, there is still room to hope, that

the industry, good fortune, or improved sagacity of succeeding generations may reach discoveries unknown to former ages. Each adventurous genius will still leap at the arduous prize, and find himself stimulated, rather than discouraged, by the failures of his predecessors; while he hopes that the glory of achieving so hard an adventure is reserved for him alone. The only method of freeing learning, at once, from these abstruse questions, is to enquire seriously into the nature of human understanding, and show, from an exact analysis of its powers and capacity, that it is by no means fitted for such remote and abstruse subjects. We must submit to this fatigue in or-

der to live at ease ever after; and must cultivate true metaphysics with some care, in order to destroy the false and adulterate. Indolence, which, to some persons, affords a safeguard against this deceitful philosophy, is, with others, overbalanced by curiosity; and despair, which, at some moments, prevails, may give place afterwards to sanguine hopes and expectations. Accurate and just reasoning is the only catholic remedy, fitted for all persons and all dispositions; and is alone able to subvert that abstruse philosophy and metaphysical jargon, which, being mixed up with popular superstition, renders it in a manner impenetrable to careless reasoners, and gives it the air of

science and wisdom.

经过慎重研究，把最不确定、最让人厌恶的学问排拒于外，这是一件好事。除此之外，对人性的能力和机能进行准确的分析和探索，也有许多益处。值得注意的是，尽管心智活动和我们息息相关，可是一旦把它们作为思考的对象，似乎就显得很难理解。同样，我们无法用眼睛观察到各种心智活动的边界。作为我们思考的对象它们太过精细，不能长时间以同样的形态呈现在我们眼前，我们只有借助超常的洞察力瞬间把握住它们。这样的洞察力是天生的，并在反复运用和思考中得到提高。因此，稍微了解思想发挥作用的各种方式，并加以区分，将其各自归入适当的类别，并改正它们作为思考和探

Besides this advantage of rejecting, after deliberate enquiry, the most uncertain and disagreeable part of learning, there are many positive advantages, which result from an accurate scrutiny into the powers and faculties of human nature. It is remarkable concerning the operations of the mind, that, though most intimately present to us, yet, whenever they become the object of reflexion, they seem involved in obscurity; nor can the eye readily find those lines and boundaries, which discriminate and distinguish them. The objects are too fine to remain long in the same aspect or situation;

索对象时造成的混乱，本身就是一份不小的科学任务。我们的感官对象对外在物体进行分类和区分本身没有什么益处，但若是针对我们的思维活动，其价值就会升高，而且与我们从事这一工作的难度和强度成正比。如果我们在完成思维的测绘之后，或者说在勾画和区分出思想的各种成分和各种能力之后，再也无法继续向前，那么至少我们应该为走到了这一步而感到满足。这一门科学越明了（现在当然丝毫也不明了），一切对其一无所知的伪学问家和伪哲学家就越应该受到鄙视。

and must be apprehended in an instant, by a superior penetration, derived from nature, and improved by habit and reflexion. It becomes, therefore, no inconsiderable part of science barely to know the different operations of the mind, to separate them from each other, to class them under their proper heads, and to correct all that seeming disorder, in which they lie involved, when made the object of reflexion and enquiry. This talk of ordering and distinguishing, which has no merit, when performed with regard to external bodies, the objects of our senses, rises in its value, when directed towards the operations of the mind, in proportion to the difficulty and labour, which

we meet with in performing it. And if we can go no farther than this mental geography, or delineation of the distinct parts and powers of the mind, it is at least a satisfaction to go so far; and the more obvious this science may appear (and it is by no means obvious) the more contemptible still must the ignorance of it be esteemed, in all pretenders to learning and philosophy.

到时候，也不再有任何人会怀疑这是一门飘渺不定、异想天开的科学，除非我们抱着一种颠覆一切思辨甚至行动的怀疑主义。毫无疑问，我们的大脑拥有多种能力和机能，这些能力各不相同，且真正可以直接观察的东西或许也能通过思考来分辨。因此，

Nor can there remain any suspicion, that this science is uncertain and chimerical; unless we should entertain such a scepticism as is entirely subversive of all speculation, and even action. It cannot be doubted, that the mind is endowed with

在这一问题上，所有的观点都有正误之别，这种正误之别并未超出人类理解的范畴。类似的明显区别有许多，比如意愿和理解力的区别、想象和激情的区别，都是每个人可以理解的。更细致、更具有哲学性的区别，虽然更难理解，但却同样是真实和确定的。在这类研究中取得的一些成功的例子，特别是最近的例子，有助于我们更好地理解这门学问的确定性和实在性。如果一位哲学家努力为我们提供正确的行星系统，调整那些遥远天体的位置和顺序，而我们认同他的工作，那么对于那些成功地绘制了与我们息息相关的心理地图的人，我们能够视而不见吗？

several powers and faculties, that these powers are distinct from each other, that what is really distinct to the immediate perception may be distinguished by reflexion; and consequently, that there is a truth and falsehood in all propositions on this subject, and a truth and falsehood, which lie not beyond the compass of human understanding. There are many obvious distinctions of this kind, such as those between the will and understanding, the imagination and passions, which fall within the comprehension of every human creature; and the finer and more philosophical distinctions are no less real and certain, though more difficult to be comprehended. Some instances, espe-

cially late ones, of success in these enquiries, may give us a juster notion of the certainty and solidity of this branch of learning. And shall we esteem it worthy the labour of a philosopher to give us a true system of the planets, and adjust the position and order of those remote bodies; while we affect to overlook those, who, with so much success, delineate the parts of the mind, in which we are so intimately concerned?

但是，难道我们不能希望，通过精心培育，并在公众关注的激励之下，哲学的各项研究能够更深入地推进，至少在某种程度上发现隐秘的驱使人类头脑运转的动因和原则吗？长期以来，天文学家满足于从各种现象

But may we not hope, that philosophy, cultivated with care, and encouraged by the attention of the public, may carry its researches still farther, and discover, at least in some degree, the secret springs and prin-

中证明了天体的运动、秩序和星等（天体的亮度），直到终于出现了一个哲学家，从最恰当巧妙的推理中确定了支配和驱使行星旋转的法则和力量。类似的成就也出现在自然界的其他领域。如果我们在人类心理和结构上投入同等的研究力度和同样的细心谨慎，我们没有理由感到绝望，认为不能获得同样的成功。一种心理活动和法则有可能依赖另一种心理活动和法则，而这另一种活动和法则有可能又引向一种更一般、更普遍的法则。这样的研究能走出多远，我们在进行细心的尝试之前，甚至之后，都很难确切阐明。不过有一点是确信无疑的，即乐于对最琐碎的事物进行哲学思考的人们每天都在进行类似的尝试。在这一方面，尤为必要的是要全神贯注地投入。如果这一目标在人类的

ciples, by which the human mind is actuated in its operations? Astronomers had long contented themselves with proving, from the phaenomena, the true motions, order, and magnitude of the heavenly bodies; till a philosopher, at last, arose, who seems, from the happiest reasoning, to have also determined the laws and forces, by which the revolutions of the planets are governed and directed. The like has been performed with regard to other parts of nature. And there is no reason to despair of equal success in our enquiries concerning the mental powers and economy, if prosecuted with equal capacity and caution. It is probable, that one operation and principle of the

理解范围之内，可能最终会实现；反之，我们也可以颇有信心地、安全地将其拒之于外。最后这个结论当然并非我们所愿，我们也不应该草率接受。因为一旦得出这样的假定，我们不就大大减损了这类哲学的美和价值吗？道德学家们在思考那些为我们认可或厌恶的各不相同的大量行动时，习惯于去寻求这些情感共同依赖的某种原则。尽管他们对某种普遍原理的热情有时候使他们走得太远，但也必须承认，他们期待找到能解释一切善恶的普遍原则的行为是情有可原的。批评家、逻辑学家，甚至政治家们也做出过类似的尝试。他们的努力也并非全然不成功，尽管要使这些科学更加完美，还需要更长的时间、更高的准确度、更多的热情和勤勉。倘若全然抛弃这样的主张，则完全可以被视

mind depends on another; which, again, may be resolved into one more general and universal; and how far these researches may possibly be carried, it will be difficult for us, before, or even after, a careful trial, exactly to determine. This is certain, that attempts of this kind are every day made even by those who philosophize the most negligently; and nothing can be more requisite than to enter upon the enterprize with thorough care and attention; that, if it lie within the compass of human understanding, it may at last be happily achieved; if not, it may, however, be rejected with some confidence and security. This last conclusion, surely, is not desirable; nor ought it to be

为鲁莽、草率、独断之举。这和试图把粗陋的教条和原理强加给人类的最冒失、最武断的哲学比起来，有过之而无不及。

embraced too rashly. For how much must we diminish from the beauty and value of this species of philosophy, upon such a supposition? Moralists have hitherto been accustomed, when they considered the vast multitude and diversity of those actions that excite our approbation or dislike, to search for some common principle, on which this variety of sentiments might depend. And though they have sometimes carried the matter too far, by their passion for some one general principle; it must, however, be confessed, that they are excusable in expecting to find some general principles, into which all the vices and virtues were justly to be resolved. The like has been the endeav-

our of critics, logicians, and even politicians; nor have their attempts been wholly unsuccessful; though perhaps longer time, greater accuracy, and more ardent application may bring these sciences still nearer their perfection. To throw up at once all pretensions of this kind may justly be deemed more rash, precipitate, and dogmatical, than even the boldest and most affirmative philosophy, that has ever attempted to impose its crude dictates and principles on mankind.

如果这些关于人性的推理显得抽象，难以理解，那又怎样呢？这并不能作为断定它们是错误哲学的理由。相反，迄今为止，许

What though these reasonings concerning human nature seem abstract, and of difficult comprehension? This affords no

多聪明博学的哲学家们尚且没能理解的东西，似乎不可能是非常简单明了的。无论这样的研究会让我们感到多么烦恼，倘若我们通过研究，能够在这些无比重要的领域增加我们的知识，我们会感到自己的努力得到了回报，不仅增进了利益，也得到了乐趣。

但是，这些哲学思辨的抽象性质毕竟不是什么优点，而是其缺点。我们可以通过细心和技巧，以及避免一切不必要的细节等方法，来克服这一困难，我们在下面的探索研

究中，尝试揭示出某些话题的真相。迄今为止，这些领域以其不确定性令智者望而却步，以其深奥晦涩令无知者畏缩不前。倘若我们能让深奥的研究变得清晰，让真相和新奇完美结合起来，将不同类别的哲学连接起来，那该是多么幸福的事！如果能通过这样简单明了的推理，我们可以削弱深奥哲学的根基，那就更令人高兴了。因为这样一种深奥的哲学迄今为止所起的作用，似乎仅仅是在庇护迷信、遮掩荒唐与谬误。

presumption of their falsehood. On the contrary, it seems impossible, that what has hitherto escaped so many wise and profound philosophers can be very obvious and easy. And whatever pains these researches may cost us, we may think ourselves sufficiently rewarded, not only in point of profit but of pleasure, if, by that means, we can make any addition to our stock of knowledge, in subjects of such unspeakable importance.

But as, after all, the abstractedness of these speculations is no recommendation, but rather a disadvantage to them, and as this difficulty may perhaps be surmounted

by care and art, and the avoiding of all unnecessary detail, we have, in the following enquiry, attempted to throw some light upon subjects, from which uncertainty has hitherto deterred the wise, and obscurity the ignorant. Happy, if we can unite the boundaries of the different species of philosophy, by reconciling profound enquiry with clearness, and truth with novelty! And still more happy, if, reasoning in this easy manner, we can undermine the foundations of an abstruse philosophy, which seems to have hitherto served only as a shelter to superstition, and a cover to absurdity and error!

第二章 论观念的起源

人人都会欣然承认，人在切身感受过被烫的痛苦或温暖的快乐时的心理感觉，和他在事后回忆时的感受，或通过想象获得的感觉是有很大区别的。回忆和想象的官能可以模仿或复制感官的感觉，但它们却永远无法完全达到切身感受所具有的强度和活力。即便是最强烈的回忆和想象，我们最多只能说，它们生动再现了原来的场景，使我们仿佛身临其境。但是，除非由于疾病或疯狂导致心理失常，回忆和想象绝不能达到让我们无法将其与亲身感受相区分的鲜活程度。诗歌描绘的五彩缤纷的世界，无论多么壮美，都不可能以假乱真，让我们把它描绘的景物当作真实的自然风光。最生动的想法都不如

最迟钝的亲身感受。

我们可以从心理的其他所有感觉中发现同样的区别。一个怒火中烧的人和一个仅仅想象自己愤怒的人，处于完全不同的状态。如果你对我说某某人在恋爱，我很容易明白你的意思，并对该人的状态有了正确的认识，但是决不会把这一认识等同于恋爱的激

Section II Of the Origin of Ideas

Every one will readily allow, that there is a considerable difference between the perceptions of the mind, when a man feels the pain of excessive heat, or the pleasure of moderate warmth, and when he afterwards recalls to his memory this sensation, or anticipates it by his imagination. These faculties may mimic or copy the perceptions of the senses; but they never can entirely reach the force and vivacity of the original sentiment. The utmost we say of them, even when they operate with greatest vigour, is, that they represent their object in so lively a manner, that we could almost say we feel or

see it; but, except the mind be disordered by disease or madness, they never can arrive at such a pitch of vivacity, as to render these perceptions altogether undistinguishable. All the colours of poetry, however splendid, can never paint natural objects in such a manner as to make the description be taken for a real landskip. The most lively thought is still inferior to the dullest sensation.

We may observe a like distinction to run through all the other perceptions of the mind. A man in a fit of anger, is actuated in a very different manner from one who only thinks of that emotion. If you tell me, that any person is in love, I easily understand

情所引起的实实在在的错乱和狂热。我们回忆过去的情感体验时，我们的思想是一面忠实的镜子，把思考的对象映射出来。但是，它所运用的色彩，与我们切身感受相比，就显得暗淡模糊。把两者区别开来，并不需要多么卓越的明辨能力或哲学头脑。

因此，我们可以根据心理感知的强度和活力把它们分为两类。强度和活力低的一类普遍称为“思想”或“观念”。另一类在我们的

语言和大多数语言中缺乏一个名称，我想可能是因为除了哲学的考虑之外，没有必要将其纳入一个一般性的术语或名称之下。因此，咱们暂且随意一点，把这一类心理感知称为“印象”，这和该词通常的意义有点区别。我所谓印象，指的是一切更生动的感知，即我们的所听、所见、所感、所爱、所恨、所欲、所愿。印象有别于观念。观念是生动程度更低的感知，是我们回想上述各种情感活动时所意识到的感知。

your meaning, and form a just conception of his situation; but never can mistake that conception for the real disorders and agitations of the passion. When we reflect on our past sentiments and affections, our thought is a faithful mirror, and copies its objects truly; but the colours which it employs are faint and dull, in comparison of those in which our original perceptions were clothed. It requires no nice discernment or metaphysical head to mark the distinction between them.

Here therefore we may divide all the perceptions of the mind into two classes or species, which are distinguished by their

different degrees of force and vivacity. The less forcible and lively are commonly denominated Thoughts or Ideas. The other species want a name in our language, and in most others; I suppose, because it was not requisite for any, but philosophical purposes, to rank them under a general term or appellation. Let us, therefore, use a little freedom, and call them Impressions; employing that word in a sense somewhat different from the usual. By the term impression, then, I mean all our more lively perceptions, when we hear, or see, or feel, or love, or hate, or desire, or will. And impressions are distinguished from ideas, which are the less lively perceptions, of which we

乍一看，世界上似乎没有任何东西比人的思想更无拘无束。思想不仅超越了人的一切能力和权力的范畴，甚至不受自然和现实的任何束缚。在头脑中想象怪物，把错乱的形状和外表结合在一起，对于思想而言，就像想象最自然、最熟悉的事物一样，毫不费力。虽然我们置身一个星球，只能在上面艰难痛苦地行走，思想却能在一瞬间把我们带到宇宙中最遥远的空间，甚至把我们带到宇宙之外无垠的混沌中去，在那里，自然处于彻底混乱状态。任何前所未见、前所未闻之物，我们都可以想象得到。除非其自身是绝

对矛盾之物，没有任何东西能超越思想的边界。

但是，尽管我们的思想似乎拥有无拘无束的自由，认真思考之后我们会发现，其实思想活动的范围非常狭窄，我们思想的全部创造力不外乎是对感官和经验提供的材料进行组合、变换、扩大或减少。我们想到一座金山，不过是把我们先熟悉的“金”和“山”这两个观念组合在一起。我们可以想象一匹品德高尚的马，因为我们从自己的情感中想

are conscious, when we reflect on any of those sensations or movements above mentioned.

Nothing, at first view, may seem more unbounded than the thought of man, which not only escapes all human power and authority, but is not even restrained within the limits of nature and reality. To form monsters, and join incongruous shapes and appearances, costs the imagination no more trouble than to conceive the most natural and familiar objects. And while the body is confined to one planet, along which it creeps with pain and difficulty; the thought can in an instant transport us into the most

distant regions of the universe; or even beyond the universe, into the unbounded chaos, where nature is supposed to lie in total confusion. What never was seen, or heard of, may yet be conceived; nor is any thing beyond the power of thought, except what implies an absolute contradiction.

But though our thought seems to possess this unbounded liberty, we shall find, upon a nearer examination, that it is really confined within very narrow limits, and that all this creative power of the mind amounts to no more than the faculty of compounding, transposing, augmenting, or diminishing the materials afforded us by the senses

到美德，然后再将其和马的外形结合起来，而马是我们熟悉的动物。简单地说，思想进行活动的一切材料都来自于我们外在的或内在的情感，对这些材料进行混合组装则仅仅是心理和意愿的功能。或者用哲学语言来说，我们所有的观念或更加微弱的感知都是我们的印象或更加生动的感知摹本。

and experience. When we think of a golden mountain, we only join two consistent ideas, gold, and mountain, with which we were formerly acquainted. A virtuous horse we can conceive; because, from our own feeling, we can conceive virtue; and this we may unite to the figure and shape of a horse, which is an animal familiar to us. In short, all the materials of thinking are derived either from our outward or inward sentiment; the mixture and composition of these belongs alone to the mind and will. Or, to express myself in philosophical language, all our ideas or more feeble perceptions are copies of our impressions or more lively ones.

我希望下面两条论据足以证明这一点。首先，我们的思想和观念无论多么复杂、多么崇高，一经分析，我们就会发现，它们都是我们先前的某种感觉或情感所引起的简单的观念。即使那些初看起来有着完全不同来源的观念，只要进行更仔细分析，也会发现它们是因此而来的。上帝的观念，指的是一种无限聪明、智慧、善良的存在，来源于我们对各种心理活动的思考，和对善良与智慧这些品质的无限扩大。对于这一问题的研究，我们可以不受时间限制，但是我们始终会发现，每一种观念均来源于一种相似的印象。那些宣称这一立场并非永远正确或者不无例外的人，只能用一种简单的方法来反驳这一立场，那就是找出一种在他们看来不源于此的观念。而我们如果要坚持自己的信

To prove this, the two following arguments will, I hope, be sufficient. First, when we analyze our thoughts or ideas, however compounded or sublime, we always find that they resolve themselves into such simple ideas as were copied from a precedent feeling or sentiment. Even those ideas, which, at first view, seem the most wide of this origin, are found, upon a nearer scrutiny, to be derived from it. The idea of God, as meaning an infinitely intelligent, wise, and good Being, arises from reflecting on the operations of our own mind, and augmenting, without limit, those qualities of goodness and wisdom. We may prosecute this enquiry to what length we please;

条，就有义务来证明，任何观念都有一种与之对应的印象或生动的感知。

其二，如果一个人由于身体器官的缺陷无法获得任何一类感知，我们就会发现，他同样不会具有相应的观念。盲人没有色彩的观念，聋子没有声音的观念。为他们打通新

的感官通道，让他们获得先前不具有的感官能力，同时也是为他们打通了认识观念的通道。他们就会发现，理解色彩和声音并不难。如果某种事物可以激发某种情感，但是这种事物却从未呈现在相应的感官面前，情况也一样。北欧的拉普兰人或非洲人就不知道葡萄酒的滋味。一个人从未感知或完全不能感知人类共有的某种情感或激情，尽管这样的心理缺陷很少，几乎没有，但我们还是发现确有这样的情形存在，只是程度较低而已。一个性情温和的人无法想象什么是深仇大恨，什么是残忍。同样，一个自私自利的人难以理解友谊和大方的高尚何在。我们愿意相信，其他生物或许具有多种我们无法想象的感官能力，因为它们有着什么样的观念，我们不得而知。它们所具有的观念从来

where we shall always find, that every idea which we examine is copied from a similar impression. Those who would assert that this position is not universally true nor without exception, have only one, and that an easy method of refuting it; by producing that idea, which, in their opinion, is not derived from this source. It will then be incumbent on us, if we would maintain our doctrine, to produce the impression, or lively perception, which corresponds to it.

Secondly, if it happens, from a defect of the organ, that a man is not susceptible of any species of sensation, we always find that he is as little susceptible of the corres-

pondent ideas. A blind man can form no notion of colours; a deaf man of sounds. Restore either of them that sense in which he is deficient; by opening this new inlet for his sensations, you also open an inlet for the ideas; and he finds no difficulty in conceiving these objects. The case is the same, if the object, proper for exciting any sensation, has never been applied to the organ. A Laplander or Negro has no notion of the relish of wine. And though there are few or no instances of a like deficiency in the mind, where a person has never felt or is wholly incapable of a sentiment or passion that belongs to his species; yet we find the same observation to take place in a less degree. A

不曾以心理认识观念的唯一方式，即通过切身体验或感知的方式，为我们所知晓。

然而，有一种矛盾的现象可以证明，观念的来源和与之相应的印象相互独立，这并非绝对不可能的事。我相信人们会欣然承认，多种由眼睛观看形成的关于色彩的观念，或由耳朵获得的关于声音的观念，虽然

很相似，其实是有区别的。如果对于不同色彩的认识的确如此，那么对同一色彩的不同色差的认知也应该一样，每一种色度产生一种独特的观念，不同于其他色度给人的感觉。如果我们不承认这一点，就有可能在不断的色差变化后，使一种颜色彻底变了样。如果你不承认色度之间的差异，你就必须荒唐地承认色差极大的两种色度属于同一种颜色。假设一个人30年来都有很好的视力，对各种各样的色彩相当熟悉，而只有某种特定色度的蓝色，他未曾有幸见过。现在，把除此之外所有不同色度的蓝色放在他面前，依据色彩的深浅度由高到低排列。很明显，他会发觉有个空缺，缺了那一种特定色度的蓝色，而且觉察到，空缺两边相邻的两种蓝色间的色差，比其他任意两种相邻蓝色间的色

man of mild manners can form no idea of inveterate revenge or cruelty; nor can a selfish heart easily conceive the heights of friendship and generosity. It is readily allowed, that other beings may possess many senses of which we can have no conception; because the ideas of them have never been introduced to us in the only manner by which an idea can have access to the mind, to wit, by the actual feeling and sensation.

There is, however, one contradictory phenomenon, which may prove that it is not absolutely impossible for ideas to arise, independent of their correspondent impressions. I believe it will readily be allowed,

that the several distinct ideas of colour, which enter by the eye, or those of sound, which are conveyed by the ear, are really different from each other; though, at the same time, resembling. Now if this be true of different colours, it must be no less so of the different shades of the same colour; and each shade produces a distinct idea, independent of the rest. For if this should be denied, it is possible, by the continual gradation of shades, to run a colour insensibly into what is most remote from it; and if you will not allow any of the means to be different, you cannot, without absurdity, deny the extremes to be the same. Suppose, therefore, a person to have enjoyed his sight for

差要大。现在我要问的是，这个人能否根据自己的想象来填补这个空缺，在大脑中形成那种特定色度的蓝色的观念，尽管此前他的感官从未接触过这种色彩？我相信大多数人会认为他办得到。这可以证明，简单的观念并非总是从某种与之相对应的印象衍生而来。不过这样的情形很少见，不值得我们去看，更不值得我们仅仅为了这个例外就改变我们的普遍原则。

thirty years, and to have become perfectly acquainted with colours of all kinds except one particular shade of blue, for instance, which it never has been his fortune to meet with. Let all the different shades of that colour, except that single one, be placed before him, descending gradually from the deepest to the lightest; it is plain that he will perceive a blank, where that shade is wanting, and will be sensible that there is a greater distance in that place between the contiguous colours than in any other. Now I ask, whether it be possible for him, from his own imagination, to supply this deficiency, and raise up to himself the idea of that particular shade, though it had never been con-

veyed to him by his senses? I believe there are few but will be of opinion that he can; and this may serve as a proof that the simple ideas are not always, in every instance, derived from the correspondent impressions; though this instance is so singular, that it is scarcely worth our observing, and does not merit that for it alone we should alter our general maxim.

这里我们就有一个命题，它不仅本身简单明了，而且只要运用得当，也能把每一种争论变得清晰易懂，能够让我们抛弃长期控制着哲学推理，并使之蒙羞的胡言乱语。一切观念，尤其是抽象的观念，自然都是飘渺模糊的。我们的头脑只能微弱地把握住它

Here, therefore, is a proposition, which not only seems, in itself, simple and intelligible; but, if a proper use were made of it, might render every dispute equally intelligible, and banish all that jargon, which has so long taken possession of metaphysical

们，并且容易和其他相似的观念混淆。我们往往在使用一个并无明确意义的术语时，想象它有着一种确定不变的意义。相反，所有的印象，即所有的切身感觉，无论是外在的还是内在的，都是强烈生动的。各种切身感觉之间的界限更加分明，我们不会轻易误判。因此，如果我们怀疑人们使用的一个哲学术语没有明确的意思或观念（这种情形时常出现），我们只需要探究一下，这个观念来源于什么印象？如果我们找不到与之对应的印象，这就证实我们的怀疑是对的。通过对观念的明确分析，我们或许有望能消除围绕观念的本质和真实状况可能出现的一切争论。[^1]

reasonings, and drawn disgrace upon them. All ideas, especially abstract ones, are naturally faint and obscure: The mind has but a slender hold of them; they are apt to be confounded with other resembling ideas; and when we have often employed any term, though without a distinct meaning, we are apt to imagine it has a determinate idea annexed to it. On the contrary, all impressions, that is, all sensations, either outward or inward, are strong and vivid: the limits between them are more exactly determined; nor is it easy to fall into any error or mistake with regard to them. When we entertain, therefore, any suspicion that a philosophical term is employed without any

meaning or idea (as is but too frequent), we need but enquire, from what impression is that supposed idea derived? And if it be impossible to assign any, this will serve to confirm our suspicion. By bringing ideas into so clear a light we may reasonably hope to remove all dispute, which may arise, concerning their nature and reality.[^1]

第三章 论观念的联系

显然，我们心中的不同思想或观念间存在一定的联系，这些思想或观念出现在记忆或想象中时，会以一定的方法和规律互相引入。在我们更加严肃的思维活动或对话中，很容易观察到这一过程，因此，如果某个想法突然闯入我们一连串连贯的观念中，便会立刻引起我们的注意，并遭到排斥。我们仔细思索就会发现，即使在我们最异想天开的遐想中，甚至在我们的梦中，想象也不是全然漫无目的的冒险之举，各种先后出现的观念间仍然存在着联系。如果把我们随意自由的谈话誊录下来，立刻就会发现有某种线索起着承前启后的作用。就算某个地方没有这

种线索，打断它的人仍然能告诉你，他的心里产生了一连串的想法，让他渐渐偏离了谈话的主题。在不同的语言里，即使在那些我们相信根本不存在丝毫联系或交流的地方，我们也发现，哪怕是用来表达最复杂观念的词语之间的确存在前后关联性。这一点明确证明，有某种普遍原则把简单的观念联系起来，形成复合观念，这样的原则对全人类有着同等的影响。

Section III Of the Association of Ideas

It is evident that there is a principle of connexion between the different thoughts or ideas of the mind, and that in their appearance to the memory or imagination, they introduce each other with a certain degree of method and regularity. In our more serious thinking or discourse this is so observable that any particular thought, which breaks in upon the regular tract or chain of ideas, is immediately remarked and rejected. And even in our wildest and most wandering reveries, nay in our very dreams, we shall find, if we reflect, that the imagination

ran not altogether at adventures, but that there was still a connexion upheld among the different ideas, which succeeded each other. Were the loosest and freest conversation to be transcribed, there would immediately be observed something which connected it in all its transitions. Or where this is wanting, the person who broke the thread of discourse might still inform you, that there had secretly revolved in his mind a succession of thought, which had gradually led him from the subject of conversation. Among different languages, even where we cannot suspect the least connexion or communication, it is found, that the words, expressive of ideas, the most compounded, do

yet nearly correspond to each other: a certain proof that the simple ideas, comprehended in the compound ones, were bound together by some universal principle, which had an equal influence on all mankind.

尽管不同观念间的相互联系一目了然，我还没有发现哪位哲学家尝试过将所有联系法列举出来并分类。然而，这似乎是值得我们去探究的课题。在我看来，观念间的联系法则似乎只有三种，即“相似性”、“时空连续性”，和“因果关系”。

Though it be too obvious to escape observation, that different ideas are connected together; I do not find that any philosopher has attempted to enumerate or class all the principles of association; a subject, however, that seems worthy of curiosity. To me, there appear to be only three principles of connexion among ideas, namely, Resemblance, Contiguity in time or place, and Cause or Effect.

我相信，说这些是联系观念的法则，不会受到多少怀疑。一幅画自然把我们的思想引向画家描摹的原型；谈到某栋楼中的一套公寓，我们自然会提到大厅或谈论该楼中其余的公寓；想到伤口时，我们很少不会想到伤口引起的疼痛。但是，要说这就是全部的法则，除此三项之外再没有别的联系观念的法则，此证明就很难使读者满意，甚至很难让自己满意。现在我们所能做的，就是通过一些例子，仔细研究将不同观念联系起来的法则，直到我们尽可能找出最普遍的法则。我们探讨的例子越多，越认真细致，就越能保证我们列举的三项法则是完整无缺的。

That these principles serve to connect ideas will not, I believe, be much doubted. A picture naturally leads our thoughts to the original; the mention of one apartment in a building naturally introduces an enquiry or discourse concerning the others; and if we think of a wound, we can scarcely forbear reflecting on the pain which follows it. But that this enumeration is complete, and that there are no other principles of association except these, may be difficult to prove to the satisfaction of the reader, or even to a man's own satisfaction. All we can do, in such cases, is to run over several instances, and examine carefully the principle which binds the different thoughts to each other,

never stopping till we render the principle as general as possible. The more instances we examine, and the more care we employ, the more assurance shall we acquire, that the enumeration, which we form from the whole, is complete and entire.

第四章 对理解活动的怀疑

Section IV Sceptical doubts
concerning the operations of the
understanding

第一节

Part I

人类推理或研究的一切对象可以自然地分为两类，即观念的联系和实际的事实。第一类指几何、代数和算术，简单说，指每一种凭直觉或通过演示证明是确定的论断。“直角三角形斜边的平方等于另外两边平方之和”是表达三角形各边之间关系的观点。“3乘5等于30的一半”表达了这几个数字间的关系。这类观点仅仅需要大脑进行思考就可以证明，不依赖宇宙中任何别的存在。即使自然界从来没有过圆形或三角形，欧几里得证明

All the objects of human reason or enquiry may naturally be divided into two kinds, to wit, Relations of Ideas, and Matters of Fact. Of the first kind are the sciences of Geometry, Algebra, and Arithmetic; and in short, every affirmation which is either intuitively or demonstratively certain. That the square of the hypotenuse is equal to the square of the two sides, is a proposition which expresses a relation

了的真理仍然永远是确信的、有据可依的。

实际的事实作为人类理性思考的第二类对象，却不能以同样的方式得到确证。我们用来证明它们的证据无论多么坚实，也不具有上述第一类对象的性质。每一种实际的事实仍然可能有其对立面，因为这并不隐含着

什么矛盾，大脑可以轻易地、清晰地想象出来，仿佛它们与现实非常相符。“明天太阳不会升起”和“明天太阳会升起”的观点一样可以理解，并未隐含什么矛盾。我们如果要证明它是错误的，只能白费力气。要是我们能证明这个观点是错的，那就意味着它本身是矛盾的，是我们的大脑绝对不能清楚地想象出来的。

因此，研究这类证据的性质可能就成为一个值得深入探索的话题。这类证据让我们确信，在我们的感官之外，在我们的记忆之

between these figures. That three times five is equal to the half of thirty, expresses a relation between these numbers. Propositions of this kind are discoverable by the mere operation of thought, without dependence on what is anywhere existent in the universe. Though there never were a circle or triangle in nature, the truths demonstrated by Euclid would for ever retain their certainty and evidence.

Matters of fact, which are the second objects of human reason, are not ascertained in the same manner; nor is our evidence of their truth, however great, of a like nature with the foregoing. The contrary of

every matter of fact is still possible; because it can never imply a contradiction, and is conceived by the mind with the same facility and distinctness, as if ever so conformable to reality. That the sun will not rise tomorrow is no less intelligible a proposition, and implies no more contradiction than the affirmation, that it will rise. We should in vain, therefore, attempt to demonstrate its falsehood. Were it demonstratively false, it would imply a contradiction, and could never be distinctly conceived by the mind.

It may, therefore, be a subject worthy of curiosity, to enquire what is the nature of that evidence which assures us of any real

外，确实有实际的事实存在。很显然，这一种哲学无论在古人还是今人身上都几乎没得到培养。所以，我们在这样一项重要的研究中，有疑虑和失误是情有可原的，毕竟我们是在一条艰难的道路上前行，没有前人引导，不知道正确的方向。说不定这些疑虑和失误最终证明是有用的，能够激励我们的好奇心，并摧毁我们心中固有的信念和安全感，这些东西是一切推理和自由探索的毒药。如果普通哲学中存在缺陷，那么我认为，发现这些缺陷不仅不会让人失望，通常情况下反而会激励我们去进行比已提出的理论更充实、更令人满意的探索。

existence and matter of fact, beyond the present testimony of our senses, or the records of our memory. This part of philosophy, it is observable, has been little cultivated, either by the ancients or moderns; and therefore our doubts and errors, in the prosecution of so important an enquiry, may be the more excusable; while we march through such difficult paths without any guide or direction. They may even prove useful, by exciting curiosity, and destroying that implicit faith and security, which is the bane of all reasoning and free enquiry. The discovery of defects in the common philosophy, if any such there be, will not, I presume, be a discouragement, but rather an

incitement, as is usual, to attempt something more full and satisfactory than has yet been proposed to the public.

针对实际事实的所有推理似乎都建立在因果关系之上。仅仅凭借因果关系，我们就能超越记忆和各种感官提供的证据。你问一个人，他为什么相信不在他眼前的事物，比如，他的朋友目前国内或在法国，他会给你提供一个理由，这个理由本身又是某个事实，如刚收到来自该朋友的信，或者朋友此前的决定和承诺，等等。一个人在荒岛上发现一块表或别的任何机器，他会得出结论，曾经有人来过这座岛。我们关于事实的所有推理都具有同样性质。这里我们可以看到，在当下的事实和从事实得出的推论之间存在

All reasonings concerning matter of fact seem to be founded on the relation of Cause and Effect. By means of that relation alone we can go beyond the evidence of our memory and senses. If you were to ask a man, why he believes any matter of fact, which is absent; for instance, that his friend is in the country, or in France; he would give you a reason; and this reason would be some other fact; as a letter received from him, or the knowledge of his former resolutions and promises. A man finding a watch

联系。要是二者间没有什么联系，那么得出的推论就是完全靠不住的。听到暗处传来清晰的声音和理性的谈话，我们就能确信那里有人。为什么？因为这些是人体构造的结果，二者间有密切联系。如果我们对同样性质的其他推理进行剖析，就会发现它们都是基于因果关系的。这种关系或近或远，或直接或间接产生。热和光就是火附带产生的两种结果，我们从其中一种结果可以合理地推断出另一种结果。

or any other machine in a desert island, would conclude that there had once been men in that island. All our reasonings concerning fact are of the same nature. And here it is constantly supposed that there is a connexion between the present fact and that which is inferred from it. Were there nothing to bind them together, the inference would be entirely precarious. The hearing of an articulate voice and rational discourse in the dark assures us of the presence of some person. Why? because these are the effects of the human make and fabric, and closely connected with it. If we anatomize all the other reasonings of this nature, we shall find that they are founded

因此，我们若要满足自己的好奇，了解让我们确信而又事实存在的那种证据有什么样的性质，就得研究我们是如何得出因果关系的。

我将大胆提出一个没有任何例外的、普遍性的命题，即因果关系的知识任何时候都不是通过由因及果的推理得出的，而是完全来自我们的经验，即我们发现某些具体的事

on the relation of cause and effect, and that this relation is either near or remote, direct or collateral. Heat and light are collateral effects of fire, and the one effect may justly be inferred from the other.

If we would satisfy ourselves, therefore, concerning the nature of that evidence, which assures us of matters of fact, we must enquire how we arrive at the knowledge of cause and effect.

I shall venture to affirm, as a general proposition, which admits of no exception, that the knowledge of this relation is not, in any instance, attained by reasonings *a pri-*

物之间有着恒常的联系。如果把一个事物放在一个有很强的逻辑推理能力和各种才能的人面前，这个事物是他从未见过，即便他对该事物进行精确的观察和研究，也不能发现与之相关的因果关系。即使我们假定亚当一开始就具有完美的理性推理能力，但他照样不能从水的流动性和透明度等属性上推断出水能把他淹死，也不能从火的发光发热中看出火能把他吞噬。没有任何东西感官上呈现的各种品质揭示出它由什么原因引起，会产生什么结果。同样，我们的理性没有经验的辅助，也不能得出关于真实存在和实际事实的任何推论。

ori; but arises entirely from experience, when we find that any particular objects are constantly conjoined with each other. Let an object be presented to a man of ever so strong natural reason and abilities; if that object be entirely new to him, he will not be able, by the most accurate examination of its sensible qualities, to discover any of its causes or effects. Adam, though his rational faculties be supposed, at the very first, entirely perfect, could not have inferred from the fluidity and transparency of water that it would suffocate him, or from the light and warmth of fire that it would consume him. No object ever discovers, by the qualities which appear to the senses, either the

causes which produced it, or the effects which will arise from it; nor can our reason, unassisted by experience, ever draw any inference concerning real existence and matter of fact.

对于我们曾经一无所知的事物，我们很容易接受因果关系不是通过理性所揭示，而是通过经验所揭示的观点，因为我们必须意识到，我们丝毫没有能力来预测会出现什么结果。把两块光滑的大理石交给一个完全不懂自然哲学的人，他永远也不会发现，两块石头会粘在一起，而且粘合得很紧密，如果从纵向施力，需要很大的力才能把石头分开；但是，如果从侧面往相反方向施力，就能很轻松地分开它们。这种事情在自然中很

This proposition, that causes and effects are discoverable, not by reason but by experience, will readily be admitted with regard to such objects, as we remember to have once been altogether unknown to us; since we must be conscious of the utter inability, which we then lay under, of foretelling what would arise from them. Present two smooth pieces of marble to a man who has no tincture of natural philosophy; he

少有类似的情形，也只有通过经验才能知晓。我们也无法想象，怎么可以通过先觉推理发现火药的爆炸威力或磁铁的吸引力。同理，如果某种结果有赖于复杂的机械构造或各部分间的隐秘结构，我们会毫不犹豫地承认我们在这一问题上的所有知识来源于经验。谁能断言说自己能够解释为什么牛奶面包能够为人提供营养，但不能为狮子老虎提供营养呢？

will never discover that they will adhere together in such a manner as to require great force to separate them in a direct line, while they make so small a resistance to a lateral pressure. Such events, as bear little analogy to the common course of nature, are also readily confessed to be known only by experience; nor does any man imagine that the explosion of gunpowder, or the attraction of a loadstone, could ever be discovered by arguments *a priori*. In like manner, when an effect is supposed to depend upon an intricate machinery or secret structure of parts, we make no difficulty in attributing all our knowledge of it to experience. Who will assert that he can give the ultimate

reason, why milk or bread is proper nourishment for a man, not for a lion or a tiger?

但是，在涉及我们从小就熟悉的事物时，这个道理似乎就没有同样的证据来支持了。这些事情与自然中的事物存在密切的相似性，仅仅依赖事物简单的品质特点，不涉及复杂的部件构造。我们倾向于认为，只需要运用理性推理就能揭示出这些结果从何而来。我们想象，即便我们是突然来到这个世界，我们也能立刻推断出，一个弹子球在碰击另一个弹子球时会把动能传递给第二个弹子球，我们无须等着亲眼所见，就能断定会发生什么事情。这便是习惯的影响。当这种影响非常强时，它不仅能掩盖我们的无知，还会掩盖它自身，因为当其强大到无所不在

But the same truth may not appear, at first sight, to have the same evidence with regard to events, which have become familiar to us from our first appearance in the world, which bear a close analogy to the whole course of nature, and which are supposed to depend on the simple qualities of objects, without any secret structure of parts. We are apt to imagine that we could discover these effects by the mere operation of our reason, without experience. We fancy, that were we brought on a sudden into this world, we could at first have in-

的时候，我们仿佛感觉不到它的存在。

但是，要证明一切自然法则、一切物体的运动规律，都毫无例外地只能通过经验来知悉，如下的思考和论证或许足以说明问题。如果把任一物体呈现在我们面前，要求我们在不借助过去经验的前提下判断它能导

致什么结果，那么，我诚恳地求教于你，我们的大脑将以何种方式展开这项任务？大脑必须发明或想象出什么东西，作为该物体引起的结果。很显然，这样想象出来的东西完全带有随意性。大脑凭借最精细的观察和研究，绝对不能从眼前的原因中推断出可能的结果，因为结果完全不同于原因，也绝不可能从原因中找到。第二个弹子球的运动和第一个弹子球的运动不同，第一个弹子球的运动没有任何东西向我们暗示第二个球会怎样运动。把一颗石头或一块金属举起来，去掉托举的力后，石头或金属会立刻掉下来。但是，如果在落下之前去考虑这个问题，我们难道会发现任何能够告诉我们石头或金属在这种情况下必然要往下落，而不是往上或往其他任何方向的事物吗？

ferred that one billiard-ball would communicate motion to another upon impulse; and that we needed not to have waited for the event, in order to pronounce with certainty concerning it. Such is the influence of custom, that, where it is strongest, it not only covers our natural ignorance, but even conceals itself, and seems not to take place, merely because it is found in the highest degree.

But to convince us that all the laws of nature, and all the operations of bodies without exception, are known only by experience, the following reflections may, perhaps, suffice. Were any object presented to

us, and were we required to pronounce concerning the effect, which will result from it, without consulting past observation; after what manner, I beseech you, must the mind proceed in this operation? It must invent or imagine some event, which it ascribes to the object as its effect; and it is plain that this invention must be entirely arbitrary. The mind can never possibly find the effect in the supposed cause, by the most accurate scrutiny and examination. For the effect is totally different from the cause, and consequently can never be discovered in it. Motion in the second billiard-ball is a quite distinct event from motion in the first; nor is there anything in the one to suggest the

正因为我们在不借助经验的情况下，想象或发明自然界中的任何结果都是随意的行为，所以我们必须尊重原因和结果之间的关系，正是这一关系将二者联系起来，使某一种具体的原因不可能得出别的任何结果。比如，我看见一个弹子球沿直线向另一个弹子球移动，甚至认为两个球相撞的方式已经向

我暗示了第二个球的运动方向。这个时候，难道我不可以想象，同一个原因会产生一百个不同的结果？两个球难道不会在碰撞后立刻保持绝对的静止不动？第一个球不会沿相反方向被弹回来，或者越过第二个球，沿任何路线或方向运动？所有这些推断都是合理的，都是可以想象的。那么我们为什么要优先选择其中一种推测呢？而这一种推测并不比其他的推测更加合理，更容易想象。所有的先觉推理永远不能揭示我们这一优先选择背后的理由。

smallest hint of the other. A stone or piece of metal raised into the air, and left without any support, immediately falls; but to consider the matter *a priori*, is there anything we discover in this situation which can beget the idea of a downward, rather than an upward, or any other motion, in the stone or metal?

And as the first imagination or invention of a particular effect, in all natural operations, is arbitrary, where we consult not experience; so must we also esteem the supposed tie or connexion between the cause and effect, which binds them together, and renders it impossible that any other effect

could result from the operation of that cause. When I see, for instance, a billiard-ball moving in a straight line towards another; even suppose motion in the second ball should by accident be suggested to me, as the result of their contact or impulse; may I not conceive, that a hundred different events might as well follow from that cause? May not both these balls remain at absolute rest? May not the first ball return in a straight line, or leap off from the second in any line or direction? All these suppositions are consistent and conceivable. Why then should we give the preference to one, which is no more consistent or conceivable than the rest? All our reasonings *a priori* will

一言以蔽之，每一个结果都是其背后原因的独特产物。我们不能从原因中直接发现该结果，任何先觉的发明和想象都完全是随意的行为。即使在有暗示的情况下，结果和原因的联系也会显得同样的随意，因为总是同时存在多种不同的结果，它们在我们的理性面前都显得完全合理和自然。因此，在不借助观察和经验的情况下，我们试图确定任何事件，或推断任何原因和结果，都是徒劳之举。

never be able to show us any foundation for this preference.

In a word, then, every effect is a distinct event from its cause. It could not, therefore, be discovered in the cause, and the first invention or conception of it, *a priori*, must be entirely arbitrary. And even after it is suggested, the conjunction of it with the cause must appear equally arbitrary; since there are always many other effects, which, to reason, must seem fully as consistent and natural. In vain, therefore, should we pretend to determine any single event, or infer any cause or effect, without the assistance of observation and

因此，我们可以发现，为什么没有一个理智谦逊的哲学家试图为任何自然现象确定终极原因，或者向我们清楚地展示这种原因的力量能引起宇宙中独一无二的结果。我们承认，人类理性的终极目的在于提炼出自然现象背后的法则，使之变得更加简单，并通过类比、经验和观察，找出众多具体的结果背后一些普遍的原因。至于要找出这些普遍原因背后的原因，我们恐怕只能白费力气，不仅如此，我们也不能对它们提出任何令人满意的解释。事物背后的这些终极机理和原则完全是人类的好奇和探究无法了解的。弹性、引力、物体各部分间的黏合性、通过接触传递动能，这些或许就是我们能从自然中

experience.

Hence we may discover the reason why no philosopher, who is rational and modest, has ever pretended to assign the ultimate cause of any natural operation, or to show distinctly the action of that power, which produces any single effect in the universe. It is confessed, that the utmost effort of human reason is to reduce the principles, productive of natural phenomena, to a greater simplicity, and to resolve the many particular effects into a few general causes, by means of reasonings from analogy, experience, and observation. But as to the causes of these general causes, we should in vain

发现的最终原因和法则。如果我们通过精确的研究和推理，能够把具体的现象中和这些普遍的原则联系或大致吻合起来，我们就应该感到心满意足了。最完美的自然类哲学只是帮助我们暂时地避开无知，而最完美的精神哲学和形而上学类哲学或许仅仅在帮助我们发现更多我们的无知。这样说来，人类的盲目和脆弱就成了一切哲学的观察结果。尽管我们努力躲闪或逃避，却总会在每一个拐角路口和这个现实不期而遇。

attempt their discovery; nor shall we ever be able to satisfy ourselves, by any particular explication of them. These ultimate springs and principles are totally shut up from human curiosity and enquiry. Elasticity, gravity, cohesion of parts, communication of motion by impulse; these are probably the ultimate causes and principles which we shall ever discover in nature; and we may esteem ourselves sufficiently happy, if, by accurate enquiry and reasoning, we can trace up the particular phenomena to, or near to, these general principles. The most perfect philosophy of the natural kind only staves off our ignorance a little longer; as perhaps the most perfect philosophy of

the moral or metaphysical kind serves only to discover larger portions of it. Thus the observation of human blindness and weakness is the result of all philosophy, and meets us at every turn, in spite of our endeavours to elude or avoid it.

几何学即使可以用来辅助自然哲学，也不能纠正这一缺陷。几何学因精确的推理而得到公认，即便如此，它也没法运用精确推理来引领我们获得终极原因的知识。应用数学的每一领域都建立在同样的假设之上，即自然在其活动中建立了某些法则，我们需要运用抽象推理，作为经验的辅助来发现这些法则，或者用以确定这些法则在具体情形中的影响——特别是对距离和数量有精确要求

Nor is geometry, when taken into the assistance of natural philosophy, ever able to remedy this defect, or lead us into the knowledge of ultimate causes, by all that accuracy of reasoning for which it is so justly celebrated. Every part of mixed mathematics proceeds upon the supposition that certain laws are established by nature in her operations; and abstract reasonings are em-

的情况下。因此，通过经验发现的一个运动法则就是，运动物体的动能与其本身的质量和速度成正比，其结果是一种小的力可以移动巨大的障碍，或举起重量极大的物体，前提就是我们通过某种机巧或设备提高这种力运动的速度，使之产生能战胜对手的动能。几何学使得我们能精确丈量这种设备中所需部件的尺寸和形状，为动能法则的应用提供了辅助作用。但是，发现该法则完全要归功于经验，所有的抽象推理都不能引领我们推导出这个法则，哪怕是靠近一步也不可能。如果我们靠先觉推理来思考任何事物或其背后的原因，不借助任何观察，我们绝不可能获得关于该事物的任何认知，比如其可能会产生什么结果，更不可能认识到前因后果之间紧密相连、不可违背的关系。一个人如果

employed, either to assist experience in the discovery of these laws, or to determine their influence in particular instances, where it depends upon any precise degree of distance and quantity. Thus, it is a law of motion, discovered by experience, that the moment or force of any body in motion is in the compound ratio or proportion of its solid contents and its velocity; and consequently, that a small force may remove the greatest obstacle or raise the greatest weight, if, by any contrivance or machinery, we can increase the velocity of that force, so as to make it an overmatch for its antagonist. Geometry assists us in the application of this law, by giving us the just dimensions of

没有亲眼见过热能使水蒸发成晶莹的水珠，冷会导致水结成冰，而能仅凭推理即可发现这些自然现象，那得具备何等敏锐的洞察力！

all the parts and figures which can enter into any species of machine; but still the discovery of the law itself is owing merely to experience, and all the abstract reasonings in the world could never lead us one step towards the knowledge of it. When we reason *a priori*, and consider merely any object or cause, as it appears to the mind, independent of all observation, it never could suggest to us the notion of any distinct object, such as its effect; much less, show us the inseparable and inviolable connexion between them. A man must be very sagacious who could discover by reasoning that crystal is the effect of heat, and ice of cold, without being previously acquainted with the opera-

第二节

但是，就最初提出的问题而言，我们尚未找到稍微让人满意的答案。每一种回答都会引出一个和前述问题同样困难的新问题，把我们引向更深入的研究。如果要问：我们针对实际的事实进行的一切推理本质何在？正确的回答似乎是，这些推理建立在因果关系之上。如果再问：所有因果关系及由此得出的结论的基础又是什么？我或许可以用一个词来回答：经验。但是，如果再接着一问到底：从经验中得出所有结论的根基何在？这就意味着一个更难回答和解释的新问题出现了。哲学家们貌似智慧超群，信心百倍，

但是一旦遇上打破砂锅问到底的人就显得束手无策。这些人不停地追问，把他们逼到墙角，最终置他们于进退两难的困境。要避免出现这样糟糕的局面，最实用的办法就是要保持谦逊的立场，甚至在遭到别人反对之前先发现自己的麻烦。这样，我们反倒可以弄拙成巧，把我们的无知化为优势。

tion of these qualities.

Part II

But we have not yet attained any tolerable satisfaction with regard to the question first proposed. Each solution still gives rise to a new question as difficult as the foregoing, and leads us on to farther enquiries. When it is asked, *What is the nature of all our reasonings concerning matter of fact?* the proper answer seems to be, that they are founded on the relation of cause and effect. When again it is asked, *What is the foundation of all our reasonings and conclusions concerning that relation?* it may be replied

in one word, Experience. But if we still carry on our sifting humour, and ask, *What is the foundation of all conclusions from experience?* This implies a new question, which may be of more difficult solution and explication. Philosophers, that give themselves airs of superior wisdom and sufficiency, have a hard task when they encounter persons of inquisitive dispositions, who push them from every corner to which they retreat, and who are sure at last to bring them to some dangerous dilemma. The best expedient to prevent this confusion, is to be modest in our pretensions; and even to discover the difficulty ourselves before it is objected to us. By this means, we may make a

在本节中，我情愿为自己设定一项简单的任务，尝试为这里提出的问题给出一个否定的答案。我想说的是，即使我们有因果关系的亲身经验，我们从这一经验中得出的结论也不是来自推理，或者任何理解的过程。这个答案，我们必须尽力解释清楚，努力为之辩护。

必须承认，自然把我们拒之于外，使我们无法获知它的奥秘。自然仅仅让我们了解事物的一些表面属性，却把这些事物的活动

所依赖的力量和原则藏了起来。我们的感官让我们知道面包的颜色、重量和软硬度，但是，无论是感官还是理性都无法让我们知道，面包的这些特性如何为人体提供营养和支持。我们的视觉和触觉让我们有了物体实际运动的概念，对于是什么神奇的力量让运动的物体不断变换位置后继续运动，为什么物体永远不会失去这种力量，而是把它传递给其他物体，我们却没有一丝一毫的概念。然而，尽管我们对于这些自然力量^{*}和原理一无所知，我们在见到相似的自然现象时，总是假定它们也具有同样隐秘的力量，并期待它们会产生我们有过亲身经验的相似结果。如果把一个物体摆在我们面前，和我们吃过的面包同样的颜色，同样的硬度，我们无须重复任何实验，便能十分肯定地预测它

kind of merit of our very ignorance.

I shall content myself, in this section, with an easy task, and shall pretend only to give a negative answer to the question here proposed. I say then, that, even after we have experience of the operations of cause and effect, our conclusions from that experience are not founded on reasoning, or any process of the understanding. This answer we must endeavour both to explain and to defend.

It must certainly be allowed, that nature has kept us at a great distance from all her secrets, and has afforded us only the

knowledge of a few superficial qualities of objects; while she conceals from us those powers and principles on which the influence of those objects entirely depends. Our senses inform us of the colour, weight, and consistence of bread; but neither sense nor reason can ever inform us of those qualities which fit it for the nourishment and support of a human body. Sight or feeling conveys an idea of the actual motion of bodies; but as to that wonderful force or power, which would carry on a moving body for ever in a continued change of place, and which bodies never lose but by communicating it to others; of this we cannot form the most distant conception. But notwithstanding this

像面包一样能给我们提供营养和支持。这是一个心理或思考的过程，我非常想知道其背后的依据是什么。我们承认，在事物可感知的属性和隐秘的力量之间没有明确显现的联系，我们的大脑也不能以它对事物本质的了解就二者之间恒常的、有规律的关系做出任何结论。至于过去的经验，它仅仅为我们提供某种特定的事物在某个特定的时间这一直接的、特定的信息。但是，为什么这种经验可以延伸到未来，或者延伸到我们知道可能只是外表相似的其他事物上，这就是我要追问的主要问题。我先前吃过的面包给了我营养，也就是说，一种具有如此品质属性的东西在彼时彼刻具有如此神秘的力量。但是这是否意味着，其他面包会在其他时间为我提供营养，具有如此感官属性的东西就一定具

有如此神秘的力量？这样的结果似乎不完全是必然的。至少我们必须承认，这里存在一种心理推断的结果，有一个必要的步骤，一个思考和推理的过程，需要我们解释。“我发现这样的事物总会有这样的结果”，和“我预测，外形和这个相似的其他东西也会有相似的结果”，这两个观点有很大区别。我承认，如果你愿意，可以从一个观点推出另一个观点。事实上，人们总是能得出这样的推断。但是，如果你坚持说，这个结论是经过一连串的推理得来的，那就请你把这个推理过程展示出来。两个观点之间的联系并不是建立在直觉之上的，需要有一种媒介的辅助，大脑才能得出这样的推断，如果真要用推理和论证得出结论的话。至于这个媒介是什么，我承认自己没法理解。如果谁觉得确实有这

ignorance of natural powers^{*} and principles, we always presume, when we see like sensible qualities, that they have like secret powers, and expect that effects, similar to those which we have experienced, will follow from them. If a body of like colour and consistence with that bread, which we have formerly eat, be presented to us, we make no scruple of repeating the experiment, and foresee, with certainty, like nourishment and support. Now this is a process of the mind or thought, of which I would willingly know the foundation. It is allowed on all hands that there is no known connexion between the sensible qualities and the secret powers; and consequently, that the

mind is not led to form such a conclusion concerning their constant and regular conjunction, by anything which it knows of their nature. As to past Experience, it can be allowed to give direct and certain information of those precise objects only, and that precise period of time, which fell under its cognizance; but why this experience should be extended to future times, and to other objects, which for aught we know, may be only in appearance similar; this is the main question on which I would insist. The bread, which I formerly eat, nourished me; that is, a body of such sensible qualities was, at that time, endued with such secret powers; but does it follow, that other bread

个媒介存在，并且是我们针对实际的事实得出的所有结论的根源，那他就有义务把这个媒介展示出来。

must also nourish me at another time, and that like sensible qualities must always be attended with like secret powers? The consequence seems nowise necessary. At least, it must be acknowledged that there is here a consequence drawn by the mind; that there is a certain step taken; a process of thought, and an inference, which wants to be explained. These two propositions are far from being the same. *I have found that such an object has always been attended with such an effect, and I foresee, that other objects, which are, in appearance, similar, will be attended with similar effects.* I shall allow, if you please, that the one proposition may justly be inferred from the other; I

know, in fact, that it always is inferred. But if you insist that the inference is made by a chain of reasoning, I desire you to produce that reasoning. The connexion between these propositions is not intuitive. There is required a medium, which may enable the mind to draw such an inference, if indeed it be drawn by reasoning and argument. What that medium is, I must confess, passes my comprehension; and it is incumbent on those to produce it, who assert that it really exists, and is the origin of all our conclusions concerning matter of fact.

如果有更多敏锐和能干的哲学家沿着这个方向进行研究，而谁也不能发现在任何观

This negative argument must certainly, in process of time, become altogether con-

点或中间步骤中可以支持这个关于理解过程的结论，那么，随着时间的推移，我提出的否定的论点会越来越有说服力。但是，目前这还是一个新问题，每个读者暂且不要过分相信自己的判断，从而得出结论说，他通过研究没有找到这个论点，说明这个论点不存在。为此，我们有必要开始一项更困难的任务，——梳理人类知识的各个分支领域，努力证明没有任何领域有这样的论点存在。

vincing, if many penetrating and able philosophers shall turn their enquiries this way and no one be ever able to discover any connecting proposition or intermediate step, which supports the understanding in this conclusion. But as the question is yet new, every reader may not trust so far to his own penetration, as to conclude, because an argument escapes his enquiry, that therefore it does not really exist. For this reason it may be requisite to venture upon a more difficult task; and enumerating all the branches of human knowledge, endeavour to show that none of them can afford such an argument.

所有推理可以分为两类，一类是演示性推理，涉及概念间的联系；另一类是事实推理，关乎实际的事实和存在。这一过程中不存在演示性推论，原因似乎是显而易见的。因为我们说自然的进程会发生改变的观点，和某个物体虽然与我们经历过的其他物体相似，却可能会产生不同甚至相反的结果的观点，并不存在什么矛盾。难道我不能清晰地想象，从云端落下的某种东西，看起来很像雪片，但是尝起来带咸味，摸起来像火一样烫手？难道所有树木将在12月和1月繁花盛开葱葱郁郁，而在5月和6月却会落叶凋零比别的想法更难理解吗？由此可见，无论什么情况都是可以理解、可以想象的，并未隐含什么矛盾，也不能通过演示性推理或抽象的先觉推理证明它是错误的。

All reasonings may be divided into two kinds, namely, demonstrative reasoning, or that concerning relations of ideas, and moral reasoning, or that concerning matter of fact and existence. That there are no demonstrative arguments in the case seems evident; since it implies no contradiction that the course of nature may change, and that an object, seemingly like those which we have experienced, may be attended with different or contrary effects. May I not clearly and distinctly conceive that a body, falling from the clouds, and which, in all other respects, resembles snow, has yet the taste of salt or feeling of fire? Is there any more intelligible proposition than to affirm,

如果我们要通过论证来确定过去的经验值得信任，并将其作为评判未来事件的标准，这种论证只能是事实推理，或者说，根据上文的分类，是关乎实际的事实与存在的推理。但是，如果我们对事实推理的解释是站得住脚的，令人满意的，那么就不会出现这种论证。我们说过，一切关于现实存在的推论都是基于因果关系的，我们关于因果关

系的知识完全来自经验，我们所有来自经验的结论都建立在未来的情形应该和过去一致的假设之上。因此，试图通过事实推理，或关于现实存在的推理来证明上述最后一个假设，显然就进入了循环推理，把问题本身视为理所当然的事。

实际上，从经验出发的所有推论都建立

that all the trees will flourish in December and January, and decay in May and June? Now whatever is intelligible, and can be distinctly conceived, implies no contradiction, and can never be proved false by any demonstrative argument or abstract reasoning *a priori*.

If we be, therefore, engaged by arguments to put trust in past experience, and make it the standard of our future judgement, these arguments must be probable only, or such as regard matter of fact and real existence according to the division above mentioned. But that there is no argument of this kind, must appear, if our ex-

plication of that species of reasoning be admitted as solid and satisfactory. We have said that all arguments concerning existence are founded on the relation of cause and effect; that our knowledge of that relation is derived entirely from experience; and that all our experimental conclusions proceed upon the supposition that the future will be conformable to the past. To endeavour, therefore, the proof of this last supposition by probable arguments, or arguments regarding existence, must be evidently going in a circle, and taking that for granted, which is the very point in question.

In reality, all arguments from experi-

在我们在自然界事物中发现的相似性之上。正是由于相似性，我们期待事物产生的结果和我们所见过的相似的事物所引起的结果也相似。尽管除了傻瓜和疯子之外，没有人会尝试去质疑经验的权威性，或者排斥这位人类生活的伟大向导，但是，显然应该允许一个哲学家至少具备强烈的好奇心，去考查赋予经验巨大权威的人性法则——使我们从自然赋予事物的相似性中受益的人性法则。我们从相似的原因中期待相似的结果。这是我们从经验中获得的全部结论。显而易见，如果这一结论是通过理性推理得出来的，那么，无论是对于最初的一次体验，还是对于长期的无数次体验而言，这个结论都是同样完美的。但实际情况截然相反。蛋与蛋之间的相似性没有别的事物可比，但是没有人会

ence are founded on the similarity which we discover among natural objects, and by which we are induced to expect effects similar to those which we have found to follow from such objects. And though none but a fool or madman will ever pretend to dispute the authority of experience, or to reject that great guide of human life, it may surely be allowed a philosopher to have so much curiosity at least as to examine the principle of human nature, which gives this mighty authority to experience, and makes us draw advantage from that similarity which nature has placed among different objects. From causes which appear similar we expect similar effects. This is the sum of all our experi-

因为这一点，认为所有的蛋都有相同的滋味。我们只有通过长期一致的实验，才能获得对具体事物的信赖感和安全感。从一种情况下得出的结论，和从一百种并无不同的情况下得出的结论大不相同，这样的推理过程在哪里去找呢？我提出这个问题既是为了获得信息，也是有意想出难题。我找不到这样的推理，也无法想象有这样的推理。但是我愿意保持开放的心态，如果有人愿意赐教，我随时洗耳恭听。

mental conclusions. Now it seems evident that, if this conclusion were formed by reason, it would be as perfect at first, and upon one instance, as after ever so long a course of experience. But the case is far otherwise. Nothing so like as eggs; yet no one, on account of this appearing similarity, expects the same taste and relish in all of them. It is only after a long course of uniform experiments in any kind, that we attain a firm reliance and security with regard to a particular event. Now where is that process of reasoning which, from one instance, draws a conclusion, so different from that which it infers from a hundred instances that are nowise different from that single

one? This question I propose as much for the sake of information, as with an intention of raising difficulties. I cannot find, I cannot imagine any such reasoning. But I keep my mind still open to instruction, if any one will vouchsafe to bestow it on me.

是否应当说，我们从一系列相同的实验中推断出事物的可感知属性和隐秘力量之间存在联系。我得承认，这不过是用不同的话表述同样的疑难问题。这个推断背后的推理过程是什么？这个问题同样存在。把两个如此无关的观点连接起来的媒介或中间思想在哪里？我们承认，面包的颜色、软硬度及其他的外在特征本身和它能为人体提供营养和支持的隐秘力量之间并无联系。否则，我们

Should it be said that, from a number of uniform experiments, we infer a connexion between the sensible qualities and the secret powers; this, I must confess, seems the same difficulty, couched in different terms. The question still recurs, on what process of argument this inference is founded? Where is the medium, the interposing ideas, which join propositions so very wide

一眼就可以从这些外在特征中推断出这些隐秘力量，无需借助经验。这与所有哲学家的情感相左，也违背客观事实。这便是我们在事物的隐秘力量和影响方面的自然无知状态。这种无知状态怎样通过经验来弥补？经验只是向我们展示，一定的事物会引起一系列相同的结果，告诉我们特定的事物在特定的时间具有这样的力量和影响。一旦一个新的、具有相似外在属性的事物出现在我们面前，我们会期待它有相似的力量和影响，能产生相似的结果。看见和面包一样颜色和软硬度的东西，我们就期待它能为人体提供同样的营养和支持。但是这肯定是心理推理的一个步骤或过程，有待解释。如果一个人说：“在所有情况下，我发现这样的外在特征总是和这样的隐秘力量相联系的”，和他说

of each other? It is confessed that the colour, consistence, and other sensible qualities of bread appear not, of themselves, to have any connexion with the secret powers of nourishment and support. For otherwise we could infer these secret powers from the first appearance of these sensible qualities, without the aid of experience; contrary to the sentiment of all philosophers, and contrary to plain matter of fact. Here, then, is our natural state of ignorance with regard to the powers and influence of all objects. How is this remedied by experience? It only shows us a number of uniform effects, resulting from certain objects, and teaches us that those particular objects, at that particu-

“相似的外在特征永远会和相似的隐秘力量相联系”，他并没有犯同义反复的错误，这两个观点完全不相同。你会说，一个观点是从另一个观点中推断出来的。但是你不得不承认，这种推理既不是靠直觉，也不是演示性推理。那么，这是什么性质的推理？说这是来自经验的推理，就是想当然了。因为一切来自经验的推断的前提和基础是，未来和过去具有相似性，相似的隐秘力量总是和相似的外在特征相联系。如果我们怀疑，自然的进程会发生变化，过去不能作为评判未来的标准，所有经验都没有用了，不能帮助我们进行推断和得出结论。在这种情况下，来自经验的任何推论都不可能证明过去和未来具有相似性，因为所有这些推论都是建立在这一相似性基础之上的。我们假设，迄今为

lar time, were endowed with such powers and forces. When a new object, endowed with similar sensible qualities, is produced, we expect similar powers and forces, and look for a like effect. From a body of like colour and consistence with bread we expect like nourishment and support. But this surely is a step or progress of the mind, which wants to be explained. When a man says, *I have found, in all past instances, such sensible qualities conjoined with such secret powers*; and when he says, *Similar sensible qualities will always be conjoined with similar secret powers*, he is not guilty of a tautology, nor are these propositions in any respect the same. You say that the one

止，自然界中的事物都是有规律的，但是，如果不借助新的论证和推断，仅凭这一点并不能证明未来的一切会保持不变。如果你声称自己从过去的经验中知悉了事物的特性，必然是徒劳的。事物隐秘的属性，及其相应的结果和影响可能会发生变化，而其外在特征可能丝毫没变。这种情况的确在某些时候出现在某些事物身上。凭什么说它不可能在所有事物中永远出现呢？你有什么样的逻辑，什么样的推理过程来驳斥这个观点呢？你可能说，我个人的实际经验告诉我，不要有这种疑虑。但是你误解了我的问题的要旨。作为一个普通人，我完全满意这个说法。可是，作为一个有好奇心的哲学家，我不会接受这种怀疑态度，我需要了解这个推论的基础何在。我的所有阅读和研究没能帮

proposition is an inference from the other. But you must confess that the inference is not intuitive; neither is it demonstrative. Of what nature is it, then? To say it is experimental, is begging the question. For all inferences from experience suppose, as their foundation, that the future will resemble the past, and that similar powers will be conjoined with similar sensible qualities. If there be any suspicion that the course of nature may change, and that the past may be no rule for the future, all experience becomes useless, and can give rise to no inference or conclusion. It is impossible, therefore, that any arguments from experience can prove this resemblance of the past to

我排除疑难，也没能给我任何值得满意的回答。我还有更好的办法吗？或者不如把问题交给公众，说不定我还有一线希望找到答案。通过这种办法，即便我们不能增长自己的知识，至少可以意识到自己的无知所在。

the future; since all these arguments are founded on the supposition of that resemblance. Let the course of things be allowed hitherto ever so regular; that alone, without some new argument or inference, proves not that, for the future, it will continue so. In vain do you pretend to have learned the nature of bodies from your past experience. Their secret nature, and consequently all their effects and influence, may change, without any change in their sensible qualities. This happens sometimes, and with regard to some objects. Why may it not happen always, and with regard to all objects? What logic, what process of argument secures you against this supposition? My

practice, you say, refutes my doubts. But you mistake the purport of my question. As an agent, I am quite satisfied in the point; but as a philosopher, who has some share of curiosity, I will not say scepticism, I want to learn the foundation of this inference. No reading, no enquiry has yet been able to remove my difficulty, or give me satisfaction in a matter of such importance. Can I do better than propose the difficulty to the public, even though, perhaps, I have small hopes of obtaining a solution? We shall at least, by this means, be sensible of our ignorance, if we do not augment our knowledge.

我必须承认，如果一个人在其调查研究中没有得出某种推论，就认为这个推论不存在，那么他的无知是不可原谅的。我还得承认，如果几百年来所有哲学家都在某一问题上探索但却没有获得任何成果，便因此断言这个领域超越了人类的理解力，这仍然可能是草率的。即使我们检查了人类知识的各个分支，认为它们都不适合用来研究该问题，仍然可以怀疑我们的梳理是不完整的，我们的检查不够准确。但是就目前的问题而言，有一些认识似乎让我们免受无知的指责或者犯错的怀疑。

I must confess that a man is guilty of unpardonable arrogance who concludes, because an argument has escaped his own investigation, that therefore it does not really exist. I must also confess that, though all the learned, for several ages, should have employed themselves in fruitless search upon any subject, it may still, perhaps, be rash to conclude positively that the subject must, therefore, pass all human comprehension. Even though we examine all the sources of our knowledge, and conclude them unfit for such a subject, there may still remain a suspicion, that the enumeration is not complete, or the examination not accurate. But with regard to the present subject,

there are some considerations which seem to remove all this accusation of arrogance or suspicion of mistake.

显然，哪怕是最无知愚钝的农夫，甚至连孩童，不，甚至是野兽，都能在经验中学习，并能通过观察自然界事物的结果了解它们的品质属性。孩子因碰到蜡烛的火焰而感到疼痛，他会小心不再用手接近燃烧的蜡烛，而且会明白，具有和蜡烛相似形状和特征的东西，会产生相似的结果。如果你认为，从孩子的理解中得出这个结论是推理的结果，我就请你演示出这个推理的过程，你没有任何理由拒绝这个合理的要求。你不能说，这个推理的过程很深奥，你没法从研究中得出来，因为你承认这是连婴儿都能明白

It is certain that the most ignorant and stupid peasants—nay infants, nay even brute beasts—improve by experience, and learn the qualities of natural objects, by observing the effects which result from them. When a child has felt the sensation of pain from touching the flame of a candle, he will be careful not to put his hand near any candle; but will expect a similar effect from a cause which is similar in its sensible qualities and appearance. If you assert, therefore, that the understanding of the child is

的道理。如果你犹豫不决，或者经过思考之后提出了复杂深奥的推理过程，那你则是在一定程度上放弃了这个问题，并不得不承认，我们不是通过推理得出过去和未来相似以及相似的原因可以得到相似的结果这样的结论的。这就是我在本章中要强调的观点。如果我这个观点正确，我不会因此宣称自己有了惊天动地的发现；如果是错的，我只得承认自己的确是个愚钝的学者，毕竟我没法证明一个我还是摇篮中的婴儿的时候就非常熟悉的推论。

led into this conclusion by any process of argument or ratiocination, I may justly require you to produce that argument; nor have you any pretence to refuse so equitable a demand. You cannot say that the argument is abstruse, and may possibly escape your enquiry; since you confess that it is obvious to the capacity of a mere infant. If you hesitate, therefore, a moment, or if, after reflection, you produce any intricate or profound argument, you, in a manner, give up the question, and confess that it is not reasoning which engages us to suppose the past resembling the future, and to expect similar effects from causes which are, to appearance, similar. This is the proposition which

I intended to enforce in the present section. If I be right, I pretend not to have made any mighty discovery. And if I be wrong, I must acknowledge myself to be indeed a very backward scholar; since I cannot now discover an argument which, it seems, was perfectly familiar to me long before I was out of my cradle.

第五章 针对这些疑虑的怀疑主义解决方案

Section V Sceptical Solution of the
Doubts

第一节

Part I

追求哲学的激情，就像宗教狂热一样，容易导致这样一种麻烦。尽管哲学期望改进我们的行为，根除罪恶，但是由于管理不当，哲学恰恰容易滋生出一种强势的倾向，驱使我们的灵魂更加固执地向着本已被天性中的偏见和癖好所扭曲的方向发展。可以确信的是，尽管我们企望达到圣哲的宽宏大量，并努力把我们的快乐完全控制在自己的心里，但是最终我们或许把自己的哲学变成了爱比克泰德和其他斯多葛派哲学家那样的思想，只不过比起他们来是一套更加精致的

The passion for philosophy, like that for religion, seems liable to this inconvenience, that, though it aims at the correction of our manners, and extirpation of our vices, it may only serve, by imprudent management, to foster a predominant inclination, and push the mind, with more determined resolution, towards that side which already draws too much, by the bias and propensity of the natural temper. It is certain that, while we aspire to the magnanim-

自私自利的学说，从而使我们完全脱离了一切美德，以及社会的快乐。我们一面认真研究人类生活的虚荣、关注荣华富贵的人生背后空虚和飘渺的本质；另一面我们可能一直在助长我们懒惰的天性。这一种情性由于讨厌世间的喧闹、生计的艰辛，在理性的掩饰之下，完全地、毫无节制地迁就自己。然而，有一类哲学似乎极少遭遇这样的麻烦，因为信奉这一类哲学无需我们的心里产生狂热的激情，也不会和我们的自然情感和倾向混在一起。这就是学院派哲学或怀疑论哲学。学院派哲学家总是谈论怀疑，谈论不要随意做出判断，谈论草率下结论的危险，要把针对理解的研究关在狭窄的范围之内，要抛弃不在日常生活和实践范围内的一切思辨。可以说，再没有什么学说比这派哲学更

ous firmness of the philosophic sage, and endeavour to confine our pleasures altogether within our own minds, we may, at last, render our philosophy like that of Epic-tetus, and other Stoics, only a more refined system of selfishness, and reason ourselves out of all virtue as well as social enjoyment. While we study with attention the vanity of human life, and turn all our thoughts towards the empty and transitory nature of riches and honours, we are, perhaps, all the while flattering our natural indolence, which, hating the bustle of the world, and drudgery of business, seeks a pretence of reason to give itself a full and uncontrolled indulgence. There is, however, one species

反对心灵的消极怠倦、盲目自大、自命不凡，及其对迷信的轻信。这派哲学要求克制除了追求真理之外的所有情感，而对真理的热爱永远高无止境，也不可能无止境。然而，令人惊讶的是，这样一种几乎在任何情况下都是天真无邪的哲学，偏偏成了无端指责和诽谤的目标。或许正是赋予这派哲学纯真特性的东西，使之遭到公众的怨恨。因为它不煽无端之情，它没有多少虔诚的追随者；因为它反对各种邪恶和愚蠢，它树敌很多，敌人反过来指责它放荡不羁、亵渎神灵、无宗教信仰。

of philosophy which seems little liable to this inconvenience, and that because it strikes in with no disorderly passion of the human mind, nor can mingle itself with any natural affection or propensity; and that is the Academic or Sceptical philosophy. The academics always talk of doubt and suspense of judgement, of danger in hasty determinations, of confining to very narrow bounds the enquiries of the understanding, and of renouncing all speculations which lie not within the limits of common life and practice. Nothing, therefore, can be more contrary than such a philosophy to the supine indolence of the mind, its rash arrogance, its lofty pretensions, and its supersti-

tious credulity. Every passion is mortified by it, except the love of truth; and that passion never is, nor can be, carried to too high a degree. It is surprising, therefore, that this philosophy, which, in almost every instance, must be harmless and innocent, should be the subject of so much groundless reproach and obloquy. But, perhaps, the very circumstance which renders it so innocent is what chiefly exposes it to the public hatred and resentment. By flattering no irregular passion, it gains few partizans; by opposing so many vices and follies, it raises to itself abundance of enemies, who stigmatize it as libertine, profane, and irreligious.

我们不必担心，这种哲学在努力将我们的研究限制在日常生活范围内的同时，会削弱关于日常生活的推理，让怀疑论得到蔓延，从而摧毁我们的一切行动和思辨。自然总会坚持自己的权利，最终会战胜一切形式的抽象推理。就像在上一章，尽管我们指出，在所有来自经验的推理中，有一个思维步骤是不能用推论或者理解的过程来证明的，但是，发现这一点也不会影响人类一切知识所赖以产生的推理。如果我们的心灵（思想）不是依靠推论来完成这一步的，它一定受到某种同样重要的原则所驱使，只要人性不变，这种原则就会永远发生作用。至于这是什么样的原则，值得我们艰辛探索一番。

Nor need we fear that this philosophy, while it endeavours to limit our enquiries to common life, should ever undermine the reasonings of common life, and carry its doubts so far as to destroy all action, as well as speculation. Nature will always maintain her rights, and prevail in the end over any abstract reasoning whatsoever. Though we should conclude, for instance, as in the foregoing section, that, in all reasonings from experience, there is a step taken by the mind which is not supported by any argument or process of the understanding; there is no danger that these reasonings, on which almost all knowledge depends, will ever be affected by such a discovery. If the

mind be not engaged by argument to make this step, it must be induced by some other principle of equal weight and authority; and that principle will preserve its influence as long as human nature remains the same. What that principle is may well be worth the pains of enquiry.

假设一个理性思考能力极强的人突然间被带到这个世界，他会立刻观察到令人眼花缭乱、目不暇接的世间万物，但他不可能有任何更深入的发现。首先，由于驱使万物运转的具体力量无法感知，他不可能通过推理获得因果关系的概念；其次，也不可能仅仅因为在一种情况下某个事件在另一个事件之前出现，就推断出一个原因是原因，另一个是结

Suppose a person, though endowed with the strongest faculties of reason and reflection, to be brought on a sudden into this world; he would, indeed, immediately observe a continual succession of objects, and one event following another; but he would not be able to discover anything farther. He would not, at first, by any reas-

果。两个事件之间的联系可能是随意无常的，没有理由从一个事件的出现推断出另一事件会发生。一句话，这样一个毫无经验的人绝不可能运用其针对事实的推理能力，也不能理解任何处于其记忆和感官之外的事物。

oning, be able to reach the idea of cause and effect; since the particular powers, by which all natural operations are performed, never appear to the senses; nor is it reasonable to conclude, merely because one event, in one instance, precedes another, that therefore the one is the cause, the other the effect. Their conjunction may be arbitrary and casual. There may be no reason to infer the existence of one from the appearance of the other. And in a word, such a person, without more experience, could never employ his conjecture or reasoning concerning any matter of fact, or be assured of anything beyond what was immediately present to his memory and senses.

再假设，这个人有了更多的经验，已经在世界上生活了足够长的时间，注意到了相似的事物和相似的结果之间的联系。那么，这种经验会产生什么影响呢？结果就是：他能从一个事件的出现立刻推断出另一事件会发生。但是，他的所有经验并没有让他获得关于使一事物得以产生另一事物的隐秘力量的任何观念或知识，他也不能通过任何推理得出这一推断。但是他发现自己决心推出这个结论。尽管他相信自己的理解并未参与其中，他仍然要继续进行同样的思考，因为有某种别的原则迫使他做出这样的结论。

Suppose, again, that he has acquired more experience, and has lived so long in the world as to have observed familiar objects or events to be constantly conjoined together; what is the consequence of this experience? He immediately infers the existence of one object from the appearance of the other. Yet he has not, by all his experience, acquired any idea or knowledge of the secret power by which the one object produces the other; nor is it by any process of reasoning, he is engaged to draw this inference. But still he finds himself determined to draw it; and though he should be convinced that his understanding has no part in the operation, he would nevertheless con-

这个原则就是“习惯”或“习性”。因为每当一种动作或行为的重复会产生一种使得这一动作或行为再次出现的倾向，我们不必受到任何推理或理解过程的驱使就会说，这一倾向就是“习惯”的结果。我们使用“习惯”这个词，并不是说我们对这一倾向做了最终解释。我们仅仅是指出了人性的一条法则，这是一条公认的、其结果为人熟知的法则。可能我们再也无法进行更深入的研究，不能给出原因背后的原因，只得满足于把它视为我们从经验中得出的所有结论的最高法则。这是迄今为止我们所能得到的最大满足，我们

无须埋怨自己的能力有限，不能再引领我们走得更远。如果在我们亲眼见证了诸如炙热与火焰、沉重与结实这样的两种事物间的紧密联系之后，宣称仅仅凭习惯我们可以从一事物的出现推断出另一事物会发生，显然我们提出了一个即便不正确，但至少非常容易理解的命题。这似乎是唯一能够解释如下疑难的假说：为什么我们能够从一千个事例中得出推断，而不能从一个单独的但却并无什么不同的事例中得出同样的推断。理性就不能进行这样的变通。理性从研究一个圆得出的结论和其研究了宇宙中所有的圆后形成的结论是相同的。但是，没有任何人仅仅见到一个物体被另一个物体碰击之后动了起来，就能推断出所有的物体在遇到相似的碰击之后都会运动起来。由此看来，一切来自经验

continue in the same course of thinking. There is some other principle which determines him to form such a conclusion.

This principle is Custom or Habit. For wherever the repetition of any particular act or operation produces a propensity to renew the same act or operation, without being impelled by any reasoning or process of the understanding, we always say, that this propensity is the effect of *Custom*. By employing that word, we pretend not to have given the ultimate reason of such a propensity. We only point out a principle of human nature, which is universally acknowledged, and which is well known by its ef-

fects. Perhaps we can push our enquiries no farther, or pretend to give the cause of this cause; but must rest contented with it as the ultimate principle, which we can assign, of all our conclusions from experience. It is sufficient satisfaction, that we can go so far, without repining at the narrowness of our faculties because they will carry us no farther. And it is certain we here advance a very intelligible proposition at least, if not a true one, when we assert that, after the constant conjunction of two objects—heat and flame, for instance, weight and solidity—we are determined by custom alone to expect the one from the appearance of the other. This hypothesis seems even the only one

的结论都是习惯的结果，而不是推理的结果。¹

1: 对于那些在人性、政治或自然领域

which explains the difficulty, why we draw, from a thousand instances, an inference which we are not able to draw from one instance, that is, in no respect, different from them. Reason is incapable of any such variation. The conclusions which it draws from considering one circle are the same which it would form upon surveying all the circles in the universe. But no man, having seen only one body move after being impelled by another, could infer that every other body will move after a like impulse. All inferences from experience, therefore, are effects of custom, not of reasoning.¹

1: Nothing is more useful than for

从事写作的作者们而言，最有用的莫过于区分理性和经验，并指出围绕各自的论证是完全不同性质的。围绕理性的论证通常被认为是我们的心智能力的结果，通过先觉地思考事物的性质，探索事物活动引起的结果，来确定科学和哲学的具体原则。围绕经验的论证则完全来源于我们的感官和观察，我们借此了解特定事物活动产生的结果，并由此出发，推断未来可能发生的事情。比如说，我们可以从理性和经验两个方面来论证政府和宪法的缺陷和不足。从理性角度看，由于人性的脆弱和败坏，不能把绝对的权力安全地托付给任何人；而从人类的经验和历史来看，随处可见滥用力量的情形，事实证明任何时代、任何国家，人类的野心正是充分利用了这

writers, even, on moral, political, or physical subjects, to distinguish between reason and experience, and to suppose, that these species of argumentation are entirely different from each other. The former are taken for the mere result of our intellectual faculties, which, by considering *a priori* the nature of things, and examining the effects, that must follow from their operation, establish particular principles of science and philosophy. The latter are supposed to be derived entirely from sense and observation, by which we learn what has actually resulted from the operation of particular objects, and are thence able to infer, what will, for the fu-

样一种草率的信任。

ture, result from them. Thus, for instance, the limitations and restraints of civil government, and a legal constitution, may be defended, either from reason, which reflecting on the great frailty and corruption of human nature, teaches, that no man can safely be trusted with unlimited authority; or from experience and history, which inform us of the enormous abuses, that ambition, in every age and country, has been found to make so imprudent a confidence.

理性和经验的这一区别同样存在于我们关于生活的审度之中。有经验的政治家、将军、医生或商人让人信赖，引人追

The same distinction between reason and experience is maintained in all our deliberations concerning the conduct of

随，而没有经验的生手，不管天资如何聪颖，总会被忽略，受人轻视。纵然我们承认，理性能够就特定情况下某种行为可能产生的后果进行推测，但是，我们依然认为，没有经验的辅助，理性是不完美的。我们从研究和思考中得出各种原则，但只有经验本身才能使它们稳固和确定下来。

life; while the experienced statesman, general, physician, or merchant is trusted and followed; and the unpractised novice, with whatever natural talents endowed, neglected and despised. Though it be allowed, that reason may form very plausible conjectures with regard to the consequences of such a particular conduct in such particular circumstances; it is still supposed imperfect, without the assistance of experience, which is alone able to give stability and certainty to the maxims, derived from study and reflection.

尽管在实际生活和思辨领域人们都普遍接受了理性和经验的这种区别，我仍然

But notwithstanding that this distinction be thus universally received, both in

会毫无顾虑地指出，这个观点本质上是错误的，或者至少说是肤浅的。

有些论证在上述任何科学中被认为仅仅是推理和思考的产物，但是，仔细检查就会发现，它们最终得出的普遍原则和结论，是我们只能用观察和经验，而不是用任何理性来解释的。和那些纯粹来自经验的原则相比，唯一的区别就在于，这些论证的确离不开思考的过程，需要对我们的观察所得进行反思，以区分其具体的情景，追踪其结果。而在后者而言，我们所经验的事情本身就是我们从具体境况中推断出的结果，或者极为相似。罗马皇帝提比略（43BC—37AD）和尼禄（37AD—

68AD）的统治让我们恐惧的是，倘若我们的君主不受法律和议会的约束，我们可能也会遭遇同样的暴政。不过，只要我们稍许思考就会发现，我们从私人生活中见到的欺骗和残忍也足以让我们产生同样的顾虑，因为我们的观察所得向我们揭示了人性中普遍存在的败坏，告诉我们如果把完全信赖托付给人类，必将导致什么样的危害。两种情况下，我们最终都是从经验中得出的推断和结论。

the active and speculative scenes of life, I shall not scruple to pronounce, that it is, at bottom, erroneous, at least, superficial.

If we examine those arguments, which, in any of the sciences above mentioned, are supposed to be mere effects of reasoning and reflection, they will be found to terminate, at last, in some general principle or, conclusion, for which we can assign no reason but observation and experience. The only difference between them and those maxims, which are vulgarly esteemed the result of pure experience, is, that the former cannot be established without some process of thought,

and some reflection on what we have observed, in order to distinguish its circumstances, and trace its consequences: Whereas in the latter, the experienced event is exactly and fully familiar to that which we infer as the result of any particular situation. The history of a TIBERIUS or a NERO makes us dread a like tyranny, were our monarchs freed from the restraints of laws and senates: But the observation of any fraud or cruelty in private life is sufficient, with the aid of a little thought, to give us the same apprehension; while it serves as an instance of the general corruption of human nature, and shows us the danger which we must incur

by reposing an entire confidence in mankind. In both cases, it is experience which is ultimately the foundation of our inference and conclusion.

任何人，无论多么年轻、多么没有经验，都能从自己的观察中形成关于人类生活的普遍的、正确的诸多原则。当然，我们必须承认，一个人若要把这些原则付诸实践，那是非常容易犯错误的，他还需要时间和更多的经验帮助他拓展这些准则，并学会如何正确地运用它们。在各种情况下，一个人哪怕天赋极高，一开始总会忽视一些具体的、看似细微的情节，而他的判断是否正确，行为是否谨慎，却往往完全取决于这些细节。更不用说，对于年轻

There is no man so young and inexperienced, as not to have formed, from observation, many general and just maxims concerning human affairs and the conduct of life; but it must be confessed, that, when a man comes to put these in practice, he will be extremely liable to error, till time and farther experience both enlarge these maxims, and teach him their proper use and application. In every situation or incident, there are many particu-

的涉世未深的人而言，并非总是能从适当的情况下提炼出普遍的观察和原则，也不能立即冷静地、谨慎地把这些原则排上用场。事实上，一个没有经验的人，若是真的毫无经验，根本就不能做任何推理。所以，我们说一个人没有经验，只是相对而言，是说他的经验较少或经验不足。

lar and seemingly minute circumstances, which the man of greatest talent is, at first, apt to overlook, though on them the justness of his conclusions, and consequently the prudence of his conduct, entirely depend. Not to mention, that, to a young beginner, the general observations and maxims occur not always on the proper occasions, nor can be immediately applied with due calmness and distinction. The truth is, an unexperienced reasoner could be no reasoner at all, were he absolutely unexperienced; and when we assign that character to any one, we mean it only in a comparative sense, and suppose him possessed of experience, in a

smaller and more imperfect degree.

所以，习惯是人类生活的伟大向导。正是由于习惯这个原则，我们过去的经验才有用处，我们才会期待，未来我们见到过去曾经见过的事物时，其也会产生相似的结果。没有习惯的影响，我们将完全无法了解一切不在我们记忆和感官范围内的事物。我们就不知道怎样调整手段以达成目的，不知道利用我们天生的能力去获得我们想要的结果。这样的话，一切行动一旦结束便会立刻终止，我们大部分思辨活动也是如此。

Custom, then, is the great guide of human life. It is that principle alone which renders our experience useful to us, and makes us expect, for the future, a similar train of events with those which have appeared in the past. Without the influence of custom, we should be entirely ignorant of every matter of fact beyond what is immediately present to the memory and senses. We should never know how to adjust means to ends, or to employ our natural powers in the production of any effect. There would be an end at once of all action, as well as of the chief part of speculation.

但是这里我们恰好可以指出，尽管来自经验的结论让我们超越了记忆和感官，能够确知发生在遥远时空的事情，但是，必须首先有什么事实呈现给我们的记忆和感官，我们才能推断出结论。一个人在荒郊野岭发现了宏伟建筑的废墟，他会推断，这个地方在古代曾是文明人生活的场所。但是如果他从没见过建筑物的废墟，也就不会得出这个结论。我们从历史中了解古代的事件，但是我们必须先翻阅记载有这些事件的史册，才能从一个证据推出另一个证据，直到我们找出远古历史事件的亲历者和旁观者。一句话，如果我们不从记忆和感官中的事实出发，我们的推论就仅仅是猜想，无论其中有什么样的具体联系，我们整个的推理链条没有任何证据支撑，更不能以这样的方式获得关于客

But here it may be proper to remark, that though our conclusions from experience carry us beyond our memory and senses, and assure us of matters of fact which happened in the most distant places and most remote ages, yet some fact must always be present to the senses or memory, from which we may first proceed in drawing these conclusions. A man, who should find in a desert country the remains of pompous buildings, would conclude that the country had, in ancient times, been cultivated by civilized inhabitants; but did nothing of this nature occur to him, he could never form such an inference. We learn the events of former ages from history; but then we must

观世界的任何知识。假如我问你，你为什么相信你提及的某个事实，你会给我举出某个理由，这个理由本身又是与之有关的别的事实。但是，你不能永无止境地用这种方式继续说下去，最终必须结束于某个记忆或感官中的事实，否则你必须承认，你的信念是毫无基础的。

peruse the volumes in which this instruction is contained, and thence carry up our inferences from one testimony to another, till we arrive at the eyewitnesses and spectators of these distant events. In a word, if we proceed not upon some fact, present to the memory or senses, our reasonings would be merely hypothetical; and however the particular links might be connected with each other, the whole chain of inferences would have nothing to support it, nor could we ever, by its means, arrive at the knowledge of any real existence. If I ask why you believe any particular matter of fact, which you relate, you must tell me some reason; and this reason will be some other fact, con-

nected with it. But as you cannot proceed after this manner, in infinitum, you must at last terminate in some fact, which is present to your memory or senses; or must allow that your belief is entirely without foundation.

那么我们的整体结论是什么呢？这个结论很简单，但是必须承认，它和常见的哲学理论相去甚远。一切关于客观事实和真实存在的信念均来自记忆和感官中的某个事物，以及该事物与其他事物之间的习惯性联系。或者换一种说法，由于我们发现在很多情况下，两种事物，比如火和热、雪和冷，总是联系在一起，如果火或者雪再次出现在感官里，心灵由于习惯的引导就会想到热或者

What, then, is the conclusion of the whole matter? A simple one; though, it must be confessed, pretty remote from the common theories of philosophy. All belief of matter of fact or real existence is derived merely from some object, present to the memory or senses, and a customary conjunction between that and some other object. Or in other words; having found, in

冷，并且由于相信这些特征确实存在，大脑会选择更加捷径的方法来揭示出这一点。这种信念是把心灵放入具体情境的必然结果。这是心灵在特定情况下的反应，就像我们在得到恩惠时不可避免地感受到爱心，而受到伤害时则会感到仇恨一样。所有这些心灵的反应都是一种自然的本能，不是任何推理或思维和理解过程能够引起的，或能够阻碍其发生的。

many instances, that any two kinds of objects—flame and heat, snow and cold—have always been conjoined together; if flame or snow be presented anew to the senses, the mind is carried by custom to expect heat or cold, and to believe that such a quality does exist, and will discover itself upon a nearer approach. This belief is the necessary result of placing the mind in such circumstances. It is an operation of the soul, when we are so situated, as unavoidable as to feel the passion of love, when we receive benefits; or hatred, when we meet with injuries. All these operations are a species of natural instincts, which no reasoning or process of the thought and understanding is able

either to produce or to prevent.

到了这一步，如果我们停止我们的哲学研究，应该是完全可以的。在大多数问题上，我们无法再向前推进一步；在所有的问题上，我们在无休止的、充满好奇的探索之后，最终也得停下脚步。但是，如果我们的好奇心引领我们继续向前，去探索这种信念的本质，并对产生这一信念的习惯性联系做更加精确的研究，不仅情有可原，或许还值得赞赏。通过这种方法，我们或许能找到一些解释和类比，至少可以让我们对抽象科学的热爱得到满足，并且能够接纳无论多么准确也依然带有某种程度的怀疑和不确定的哲学思辨。对于品位不同的读者而言，本章余下的部分不是为他们写的。就算忽略下面这

At this point, it would be very allowable for us to stop our philosophical researches. In most questions we can never make a single step farther; and in all questions we must terminate here at last, after our most restless and curious enquiries. But still our curiosity will be pardonable, perhaps commendable, if it carry us on to still farther researches, and make us examine more accurately the nature of this belief, and of the customary conjunction, whence it is derived. By this means we may meet with some explications and analogies that will give satisfaction; at least to such as love the

一节，后面的研究也完全可以理解。

第二节

没有什么比人的想象更自由。尽管想象不能超出我们内部和外部感官提供的思想库藏，但是，它可以不受限制地对这些想法进行混合、组装、拆分和切割，而且可以按其尽情虚构和幻想的各种方式进行。想象可以

虚构一连串逼真的事件，就像真实的一样，为它们确定具体的时间地点，把它们构想成真实的存在，绘声绘色地为其描绘各种情节，各种我们坚信是真实的历史事件所具备的情节。那么，这样的虚构和信念的差异何在？二者之别并不在于某个特定的观念，它只和得到我们认同的某种概念相关，而在任何虚构的思想中都没有踪影。因为既然我们的心灵对其所有的想法有着控制权，它可以自发地把这个想法和任何虚构结合起来，并相信它愿意相信的任何东西，完全和我们日常生活中的实际情形相反。我们可以在想象中把人的头加在马的身上，虽然我们不相信真有过这样的动物存在。

abstract sciences, and can be entertained with speculations, which, however accurate, may still retain a degree of doubt and uncertainty. As to readers of a different taste; the remaining part of this section is not calculated for them, and the following enquiries may well be understood, though it be neglected.

Part II

Nothing is more free than the imagination of man; and though it cannot exceed that original stock of ideas furnished by the internal and external senses, it has unlimited power of mixing, compounding, separ-

ating, and dividing these ideas, in all the varieties of fiction and vision. It can feign a train of events, with all the appearance of reality, ascribe to them a particular time and place, conceive them as existent, and paint them out to itself with every circumstance, that belongs to any historical fact, which it believes with the greatest certainty. Wherein, therefore, consists the difference between such a fiction and belief? It lies not merely in any peculiar idea, which is annexed to such a conception as commands our assent, and which is wanting to every known fiction. For as the mind has authority over all its ideas, it could voluntarily annex this particular idea to any fiction, and

consequently be able to believe whatever it pleases; contrary to what we find by daily experience. We can, in our conception, join the head of a man to the body of a horse; but it is not in our power to believe that such an animal has ever really existed.

It follows, therefore, that the difference between fiction and belief lies in some sentiment or feeling, which is annexed to the latter, not to the former, and which depends not on the will, nor can be commanded at pleasure. It must be excited by nature, like all other sentiments; and must arise from the particular situation, in which the mind is placed at any particular juncture.

由此看来，虚构与信念间的区别在于某种情感或感觉，这种情感与信念结合在一起，而与虚构无关，它依赖我们的意愿，不是我们随心所欲能掌控的。像其他一切情感一样，它必须由自然中的事物所激发，必须从我们的心灵所处的具体情景中产生出来。一旦某种事物出现在我们的记忆和感官里，由于习惯的作用，它会立刻引领我们想到与之相关的事物，而这个构想的过程总是伴随

着某种特定的感觉或情感，和漫无目的的遐想是不同的。这里包含了信念的全部本质。既然不存在我们确信无疑，以至不能想象其反面的事物，那么，要不是因为我们心灵中对不同事物带有不同的情感，我们就无法区分我们赞成的概念和我们反对的概念。我看见一颗弹子球在平滑的桌面上向另一颗移动，能轻易地想象它在触碰到第二颗球时会立刻停止下来。这个想法并无矛盾，但是，这与我的另一种想法却有很大区别，即它在触碰到第二颗球后会把动能传递给第二颗球。

Whenever any object is presented to the memory or senses, it immediately, by the force of custom, carries the imagination to conceive that object, which is usually conjoined to it; and this conception is attended with a feeling or sentiment, different from the loose reveries of the fancy. In this consists the whole nature of belief. For as there is no matter of fact which we believe so firmly that we cannot conceive the contrary, there would be no difference between the conception assented to and that which is rejected, were it not for some sentiment which distinguishes the one from the other. If I see a billiard-ball moving towards another, on a smooth table, I can easily con-

如果我们尝试给这种情感下定义，就会发现这即便不是不可能，却也非常困难，这就像我们要向一个从未经历过寒冷和愤怒的人解释寒冷和愤怒是什么感觉一样。信念是这一情感恰如其分的名称，谁都能明白这个术语表示的意思，因为每个人随时都在体验它所传达的情感。当然，我们对这一情感做一番描述并无不妥之处，或许通过这种方式我们可以找到一些参照，帮助我们对其作更

精确的解释。所以我说，信念，与仅凭想象所能得到的结果相比，只不过是关于某一事物的更为生动、活泼、有力、坚定、稳固的概念。用这么多的词来解释似乎显得有失哲学性，但目的不外乎想表示那种能够把客观事实，或我们认为的客观事实，更直接呈现给我们的心理活动，使之与幻想相比，在我们的思想中占更大的分量，并对我们的情感和想象产生极大的影响。如果我们认可某一事物，就没有必要争论用什么术语的问题。想象对其所有的想法有着控制权，可以用任意可能的方式拼接、混合和变换各种想法。它可以想象具体时空条件下虚构的事物，可以让事物以适当的色彩呈现在我们眼前，仿佛它们真正存在过。但是，由于想象力不可能靠自身产生信念，显然信念不在于

ceive it to stop upon contact. This conception implies no contradiction; but still it feels very differently from that conception by which I represent to myself the impulse and the communication of motion from one ball to another.

Were we to attempt a definition of this sentiment, we should, perhaps, find it a very difficult, if not an impossible task; in the same manner as if we should endeavour to define the feeling of cold or passion of anger, to a creature who never had any experience of these sentiments. Belief is the true and proper name of this feeling; and no one is ever at a loss to know the meaning of

that term; because every man is every moment conscious of the sentiment represented by it. It may not, however, be improper to attempt a description of this sentiment; in hopes we may, by that means, arrive at some analogies, which may afford a more perfect explication of it. I say, then, that belief is nothing but a more vivid, lively, forcible, firm, steady conception of an object, than what the imagination alone is ever able to attain. This variety of terms, which may seem so unphilosophical, is intended only to express that act of the mind, which renders realities, or what is taken for such, more present to us than fictions, causes them to weigh more in the thought, and

思想和观念的特有品质或类型，而在于我们的心灵构想这些观念的方式，以及这些观念在心灵中留下的感觉。我承认，我们不可能对这种感觉或构想观念的方式作出理想的解释。我们可以使用一些可以词语表达与之接近的概念，但是正如上文所说，它的恰如其分的名称就是“信念”，这是日常生活中人人都能充分理解的术语。在哲学上，我们除了说，信念就是区分明确判断的观念和想象的虚构之物的一种心灵感受，此外别无他法。信念让这些观念在我们心中占有更大的分量，显得更加重要，把它们内化于我们心中，使之成为引领我们生活的准则。比如现在听见一个熟人的声音从隔壁房间传过来，我感官中获得的具体印象立刻让我想到这个人，连同他周围具体的事物。我想象中

gives them a superior influence on the passions and imagination. Provided we agree about the thing, it is needless to dispute about the terms. The imagination has the command over all its ideas, and can join and mix and vary them, in all the ways possible. It may conceive fictitious objects with all the circumstances of place and time. It may set them, in a manner, before our eyes, in their true colours, just as they might have existed. But as it is impossible that this faculty of imagination can ever, of itself, reach belief, it is evident that belief consists not in the peculiar nature or order of ideas, but in the manner of their conception, and in their feeling to the mind. I confess, that it is im-

这些事物就在我眼前，各自的特点以及相互间的关系就像我从前见过的一样。这些观念在我心中比一座被施以魔法的城堡留下的印象还要深刻。它们会引起非常不同的感觉，并对心灵产生更大的影响，无论是高兴与痛苦，或是欢乐和忧伤。

possible perfectly to explain this feeling or manner of conception. We may make use of words which express something near it. But its true and proper name, as we observed before, is *belief*; which is a term that every one sufficiently understands in common life. And in philosophy, we can go no farther than assert, that belief is something felt by the mind, which distinguishes the ideas of the judgement from the fictions of the imagination. It gives them more weight and influence; makes them appear of greater importance; enforces them in the mind; and renders them the governing principle of our actions. I hear at present, for instance, a person's voice, with whom I am acquainted;

and the sound comes as from the next room. This impression of my senses immediately conveys my thought to the person, together with all the surrounding objects. I paint them out to myself as existing at present, with the same qualities and relations, of which I formerly knew them possessed. These ideas take faster hold of my mind than ideas of an enchanted castle. They are very different to the feeling, and have a much greater influence of every kind, either to give pleasure or pain, joy or sorrow.

现在，我们暂且接受这个学说的全部内容，承认信念这一情感只不过是比想象的虚

Let us, then, take in the whole compass of this doctrine, and allow, that the senti-

构更加强烈、更加稳固的一种构想，形成这一构想的方式来自于外界某一事物与我们记忆或感官中的另一事物间习惯性的联系。在这些观点的基础上，我相信我们不难发现与信念类似的其他心理活动，并从所有这些现象中推断出更具有普遍性的原则。

上文中我们谈到，自然在各种具体观念间建立了联系，一旦一个观念进入我们的思想，就会立刻令我们想到与之相关的事物，以微妙的方式让我们不知不觉地注意到它

ment of belief is nothing but a conception more intense and steady than what attends the mere fictions of the imagination, and that this manner of conception arises from a customary conjunction of the object with something present to the memory or senses. I believe that it will not be difficult, upon these suppositions, to find other operations of the mind analogous to it, and to trace up these phenomena to principles still more general.

We have already observed that nature has established connexions among particular ideas, and that no sooner one idea occurs to our thoughts than it introduces its

们。我们已经把观念间的联系精简到三种，即相似性、连续性和因果关系。唯有这些纽带能把我们的想法联系起来，使我们的思考或对话显得前后连贯，这一点或多或少是全人类共有的。现在出现了一个问题，解决目前的疑难就取决于这一问题。在所有这些关系中，会不会出现如下的情形呢？当某物出现在感官或记忆中，不仅吸引我们的心灵注意到与之相关的事物，而且在我们心中形成一个更加稳固、更加深刻的构想，是该事物没有出现在我们的感官或记忆的情形无法相比的。这似乎就是从因果关系中衍生出来的信念。如果其他的关系中也存在这样的情形，就可以把它作为一条普遍的法则，适用于一切心理活动。

correlative, and carries our attention towards it, by a gentle and insensible movement. These principles of connexion or association we have reduced to three, namely, Resemblance, Contiguity and Causation; which are the only bonds that unite our thoughts together, and beget that regular train of reflection or discourse, which, in a greater or less degree, takes place among all mankind. Now here arises a question, on which the solution of the present difficulty will depend. Does it happen, in all these relations, that, when one of the objects is presented to the senses or memory, the mind is not only carried to the conception of the correlative, but reaches a steadier and

stronger conception of it than what otherwise it would have been able to attain? This seems to be the case with that belief which arises from the relation of cause and effect. And if the case be the same with the other relations or principles of associations, this may be established as a general law, which takes place in all the operations of the mind.

因此，作为当前研究目标的第一个实验，我们可以注意到，一旦我们看见一位不在身边的朋友的画像，我们心中有关他的观念就被相似性所激活，由此引起的每一种情感，无论是欢乐还有忧伤，都变得强烈而鲜活。一种联系和眼前的印象同时出现，产生了这一结果。如果这幅画像不像我的朋友，

We may, therefore, observe, as the first experiment to our present purpose, that, upon the appearance of the picture of an absent friend, our idea of him is evidently enlivened by the resemblance, and that every passion, which that idea occasions, whether of joy or sorrow, acquires new force and

或者至少不是为他而画的，就绝不会让我们想到他。如果没有画像，人也不在身边，尽管我们心中的思绪会从一个想法过渡到另一个想法，但是这样形成的想法和由具体事物激活的想法相比，就暗淡多了。如果朋友的画像在眼前，我们看着会高兴；但如果把画像拿走，我们会直接想到朋友，而不是想到他的像，因为这时那画像和人一样遥远模糊。

vigour. In producing this effect, there concur both a relation and a present impression. Where the picture bears him no resemblance, at least was not intended for him, it never so much as conveys our thought to him; and where it is absent, as well as the person, though the mind may pass from the thought of the one to that of the other, it feels its idea to be rather weakened than enlivened by that transition. We take a pleasure in viewing the picture of a friend, when it is set before us; but when it is removed, rather choose to consider him directly than by reflection in an image, which is equally distant and obscure.

照此看来，罗马天主教的各种仪式具有相同的性质。这一宗教的信徒们因其愚蠢虚伪的仪式遭到世人谴责，而他们则寻求各种托词辩护说，他们感到那些外在的动作、姿势和行为能够激活他们的宗教虔诚、增强他们的宗教激情。相反，如果借助遥远的、非物质的事物，这样的宗教情感就会衰减。他们说，我们把我们的信仰化成可以感知的类型和形象，让它们更直接呈现在我们眼前，这是仅仅靠想象和思考不能实现的。与其他任何事物相比，可以感知的事物能对头脑和心灵产生更大的影响，这种影响会很快和与事物相关、与之具有相似性的观念联系起来。我从这类行为以及这一推理过程中得出的结论仅仅是，相似性激活观念的情形非常普遍。而且，由于每一种情况下都必然是相

The ceremonies of the Roman Catholic religion may be considered as instances of the same nature. The devotees of that superstition usually plead in excuse for the mummeries, with which they are upbraided, that they feel the good effect of those external motions, and postures, and actions, in enlivening their devotion and quickening their fervour, which otherwise would decay, if directed entirely to distant and immaterial objects. We shadow out the objects of our faith, say they, in sensible types and images, and render them more present to us by the immediate presence of these types, than it is possible for us to do merely by an intellectual view and contem-

似性和事物的直接印象同时出现，我们就有大量的实验可以证明上述原则的真实性。

我们可以用不同类型的实验来增强这些实验的说服力，来考察连续性以及相似性的效果。显然，距离会削弱任何观念的强度，

我们在应对事物的时候，尽管该事物没有直接出现在我们的感官里，但它会在我们心中产生影响，这一影响和直接接触形成的印象相似。我们想到某一事物时，心里很快就会想到与之相关的一切，但是只有事物真实地出现，才能留下鲜明的印象。当我在离家几英里远的地方时候，周围的环境显然比我在200里格（约合600英里）外时更能给我留下亲近的感觉，尽管当我们置身如此遥远的距离之外时，想到朋友或自家附近的任何东西仍然会让我们想到朋友或家人。但是在后面这种情况下，心里出现的不过是两种观念。虽然二者可以轻易转换，但是由于缺乏直接的印象，仅凭转换不能让这些想法变得鲜明起来。*

plation. Sensible objects have always a greater influence on the fancy than any other; and this influence they readily convey to those ideas to which they are related, and which they resemble. I shall only infer from these practices, and this reasoning, that the effect of resemblance in enlivening the ideas is very common; and as in every case a resemblance and a present impression must concur, we are abundantly supplied with experiments to prove the reality of the foregoing principle.

We may add force to these experiments by others of a different kind, in considering the effects of contiguity as well as of re-

semblance. It is certain that distance diminishes the force of every idea, and that, upon our approach to any object; though it does not discover itself to our senses; it operates upon the mind with an influence, which imitates an immediate impression. The thinking on any object readily transports the mind to what is contiguous; but it is only the actual presence of an object, that transports it with a superior vivacity. When I am a few miles from home, whatever relates to it touches me more nearly than when I am two hundred leagues distant; though even at that distance the reflecting on any thing in the neighbourhood of my friends or family naturally produces an idea of them. But

没有人会怀疑因果关系也像相似性和连续性一样具有同样的影响。迷信的人喜爱圣人们的遗物，同样是因为他们希望通过这些实物和形象激活他们的宗教热情，让他们对于自己渴望效仿的那些圣人的生活有更加密切、更加深刻的概念。显然，一个追随者所能获得的最好的遗物之一就是圣人亲手制作的東西。如果说圣人留下的衣物和家具也可以当作他的遗物的话，那是因为这些东西

曾经为其所用，带有他活动和情感的气息。从这个角度看，这些物品只能被当作不完美的遗物，和那些我们可以由之了解圣人真实生活的物品相比，它们与圣人生活的联系就要更浅一些。

假如一位友人早已逝去，或早已不在身边，可突然有一天他的儿子出现在我们面前，那很显然，朋友儿子的出现会立刻激起与之相联系的观念，让我们想起过去和朋友

as in this latter case, both the objects of the mind are ideas; notwithstanding there is an easy transition between them; that transition alone is not able to give a superior vivacity to any of the ideas, for want of some immediate impression.*

No one can doubt but causation has the same influence as the other two relations of resemblance and contiguity. Superstitious people are fond of the reliques of saints and holy men, for the same reason, that they seek after types or images, in order to enliven their devotion, and give them a more intimate and strong conception of those exemplary lives, which they desire to imitate.

Now it is evident, that one of the best reliques, which a devotee could procure, would be the handywork of a saint; and if his cloaths and furniture are ever to be considered in this light, it is because they were once at his disposal, and were moved and affected by him; in which respect they are to be considered as imperfect effects, and as connected with him by a shorter chain of consequences than any of those, by which we learn the reality of his existence.

Suppose, that the son of a friend, who had been long dead or absent, were presented to us; it is evident, that this object would instantly revive its correlative idea, and re-

亲密相处的时光和彼此间的熟悉感，一切都显得格外真实，历历在目。这似乎是可以证明上述原则的另一种现象。

我们可以说，在这些现象中，相信相关事物的存在总是一个先决条件，离开了它就没有二者间关系产生的影响。朋友的画像之所以能产生影响，是因为我们相信的确有过这样一位朋友。离家很近的地方绝不会引起我们想到家，除非我们相信家确实存在。我肯定地说，这种超越记忆和感官的信念，正如上文解释过的思想的转换以及概念的鲜明程度一样，二者具有相似的性质和相似的来源。我把一块干柴扔进火里，心里立刻就会

想到，干柴会助长火势，而不是让火熄灭。这个从原因到结果的思想转换并不是从推理中得来的，而是整个来源于习惯和经验。因为这一转换过程始于呈现在我们感官面前的具体事物，就使得我们对于火势的观念或概念比其他随意的、漂浮不定的遐想显得更加强烈生动。这个观念是瞬间出现的，我们的思想立刻趋向它，并把感官里的印象鲜活地传递到它上面。尽管葡萄酒的出现或许碰巧会引起伤痛的感觉，但是，一把剑放在胸前难道不比一杯酒摆在面前更能激起我强烈的伤害和疼痛的感觉？在整个过程中，除了某种在场的事物和由其向另一相关事物的观念的习惯性转移之外，还有什么能让我们产生如此强烈鲜明的观念？这是我们针对事实和存在的全部结论中整个的心理活动过程。令

call to our thoughts all past intimacies and familiarities, in more lively colours than they would otherwise have appeared to us. This is another phaenomenon, which seems to prove the principle above mentioned.

We may observe, that, in these phaenomena, the belief of the correlative object is always presupposed; without which the relation could have no effect. The influence of the picture supposes, that we believe our friend to have once existed. Contiguity to home can never excite our ideas of home, unless we believe that it really exists. Now I assert, that this belief, where it reaches beyond the memory or

senses, is of a similar nature, and arises from similar causes, with the transition of thought and vivacity of conception here explained. When I throw a piece of dry wood into a fire, my mind is immediately carried to conceive, that it augments, not extinguishes the flame. This transition of thought from the cause to the effect proceeds not from reason. It derives its origin altogether from custom and experience. And as it first begins from an object, present to the senses, it renders the idea or conception of flame more strong and lively than any loose, floating reverie of the imagination. That idea arises immediately. The thought moves instantly towards it, and

人满意的是，我们找到了一些可以对其进行解释的参照。在一切情况下，从在场的事物转换到相关的观念总是能让该观念变得鲜明有力。

conveys to it all that force of conception, which is derived from the impression present to the senses. When a sword is levelled at my breast, does not the idea of wound and pain strike me more strongly, than when a glass of wine is presented to me, even though by accident this idea should occur after the appearance of the latter object? But what is there in this whole matter to cause such a strong conception, except only a present object and a customary transition of the idea of another object, which we have been accustomed to conjoin with the former? This is the whole operation of the mind, in all our conclusions concerning matter of fact and existence; and it

is a satisfaction to find some analogies, by which it may be explained. The transition from a present object does in all cases give strength and solidity to the related idea.

在自然进程和我们的思想观念的发展之间有一种预先建立的和谐关系。尽管我们不知道支配自然的力量为何物，但是我们发现我们的思想观念和自然的其他作品是同向而行的。习惯就是这一联系得以实现的原则，它对于人类的生存非常必要，能在人类生活的各种情况下调整我们的行为。如果不是由于一事物的出现立刻促使我们产生了与之相关的其他事物的观念，我们所有的知识将被限制在记忆和感官的狭窄范围内，我们绝不可能采用适当的手段实现我们的目的，也不

Here, then, is a kind of pre-established harmony between the course of nature and the succession of our ideas; and though the powers and forces, by which the former is governed, be wholly unknown to us; yet our thoughts and conceptions have still, we find, gone on in the same train with the other works of nature. Custom is that principle, by which this correspondence has been effected; so necessary to the subsistence of our species, and the regulation of

可能发挥我们的智力来造福于人，或消灾避邪。那些乐于揭示和思考事物的终极原因的人，在这个话题上有充分的空间尽情发挥他们的奇思妙想。

为了进一步证实上述理论，我要补充的是，我们可以依据心理活动从相似的原因推

断出相似的结果，或者相反，由于这一心理活动对人类的生存至关重要，不可能把它交付给不可靠的演绎推理来完成。这种推理是一个缓慢的心理过程；没有任何迹象表明，人在婴幼儿早期可以进行演绎推理；而在人生的每一个阶段，即便得到最好的发挥，这推理也是极易犯错误的。更符合自然智慧的是，应该由某种本能或心理机制来进行这一必要的心理活动，因为本能或心理机制不会出现错误，这可能是生命和思想一开始就有的，而且或许和繁琐的演绎推理无关。正如自然教会我们如何使用四肢，却没有赋予我们有关肌肉和神经的任何知识一样，它也在我们身上植入了某种本能，引领我们的思想按照相应的进程抵达她在外部事物中建立的规律，尽管我们对于这一进程以及相关事物

our conduct, in every circumstance and occurrence of human life. Had not the presence of an object, instantly excited the idea of those objects, commonly conjoined with it, all our knowledge must have been limited to the narrow sphere of our memory and senses; and we should never have been able to adjust means to ends, or employ our natural powers, either to the producing of good, or avoiding of evil. Those, who delight in the discovery and contemplation of final causes, have here ample subject to employ their wonder and admiration.

I shall add, for a further confirmation of the foregoing theory, that, as this opera-

tion of the mind, by which we infer like effects from like causes, and vice versa, is so essential to the subsistence of all human creatures, it is not probable, that it could be trusted to the fallacious deductions of our reason, which is slow in its operations; appears not, in any degree, during the first years of infancy; and at best is, in every age and period of human life, extremely liable to error and mistake. It is more conformable to the ordinary wisdom of nature to secure so necessary an act of the mind, by some instinct or mechanical tendency, which may be infallible in its operations, may discover itself at the first appearance of life and thought, and may be independent

所依赖的的各种力量一无所知。

of all the laboured deductions of the understanding. As nature has taught us the use of our limbs, without giving us the knowledge of the muscles and nerves, by which they are actuated; so has she implanted in us an instinct, which carries forward the thought in a correspondent course to that which she has established among external objects; though we are ignorant of those powers and forces, on which this regular course and succession of objects totally depends.

第六章 论可能性

虽然世界上没有“概率”这样的东西存在，但是我们对于事件背后真实原因的无知也会对理解过程产生同样的影响，并得出一种与“概率”类似的信念或意见。^{*}

任何一方如果有更多的概率，肯定会产生一种可能性，而且随着这一优势增加，超过对方的概率，可能性也会按比例相应提高，使得具有优势的一方得到更大程度的信念或认同。如果一个骰子的四面都标着相同的数字或同样数量的点子，其余两面标着另一数字或另一数量的点子，那么，我们在掷骰子时，前一个数字或相同数量的点子朝上

Section VI Of Probability

Though there be no such thing as Chance in the world; our ignorance of the real cause of any event has the same influence on the understanding, and begets a like species of belief or opinion.^{*}

There is certainly a probability, which arises from a superiority of chances on any side; and according as this superiority increases, and surpasses the opposite chances, the probability receives a proportionable increase, and begets still a higher degree of belief or assent to that side, in which we discover the superiority. If a die

面的可能性就更大。但是，如果骰子有一千个面标有同一数字或相同数量的点子，只有一个面不同，前者出现面朝上的可能性就高得多，而我们相信和期待其出现的程度也更稳固、更安全。这个思考和推理过程也许显得微不足道，不言自明，然而对于那些想要做更细致研究的人们而言，这或许是一个值得他们深入探索的话题。

显而易见，我们的心灵在企图揭示像掷

骰子这样的事件之谜时，会认为骰子的每一面朝上的概率是一样的，这便是概率的本质，就是让一事件中所包含的各个具体情形具有完全平等的机会。但是，当我们发现骰子大量的面同时出现在一种情形的概率大于同时出现在另一种情形的概率时，我们的思想就会更频繁地关注这一情形，和它相遇也更频繁，以求了解最终结果所依赖的各种可能性和概率。多次出现的同样情形，在自然不可解释的机缘作用下，立刻在我们心中生出信念的情感，并给予这一情形较其对立的一方更大的优势，因为与其对立的一方出现次数要少，在人心灵中呈现的频率也更低。如果我们承认，信念与想象的虚构相比，只不过是关于某事物的更坚定、更深刻的观念，也许在某种程度上可以解释这一活动。

were marked with one figure or number of spots on four sides, and with another figure or number of spots on the two remaining sides, it would be more probable, that the former would turn up than the latter; though, if it had a thousand sides marked in the same manner, and only one side different, the probability would be much higher, and our belief or expectation of the event more steady and secure. This process of the thought or reasoning may seem trivial and obvious; but to those who consider it more narrowly, it may, perhaps, afford matter for curious speculation.

It seems evident, that, when the mind

looks forward to discover the event, which may result from the throw of such a die, it considers the turning up of each particular side as alike probable; and this is the very nature of chance, to render all the particular events, comprehended in it, entirely equal. But finding a greater number of sides concur in the one event than in the other, the mind is carried more frequently to that event, and meets it oftener, in revolving the various possibilities or chances, on which the ultimate result depends. This concurrence of several views in one particular event begets immediately, by an inexplicable contrivance of nature, the sentiment of belief, and gives that event the advantage

多次见到或瞥见同一情形，这情形便在我们的想象中印下更深刻的观念，变得生动有力，对我们的情感产生更强烈的影响；一句话，使我们产生一种信赖感和安全感，这便是信念或意见的本质。

over its antagonist, which is supported by a smaller number of views, and recurs less frequently to the mind. If we allow, that belief is nothing but a firmer and stronger conception of an object than what attends the mere fictions of the imagination, this operation may, perhaps, in some measure, be accounted for. The concurrence of these several views or glimpses imprints the idea more strongly on the imagination; gives it superior force and vigour; renders its influence on the passions and affections more sensible; and in a word, begets that reliance or security, which constitutes the nature of belief and opinion.

原因的可然性和概率的可然性是同样的情形。某些原因无论何时何地都会导致某一特定的结果，从未有过没有出现这样的结果或出现其他异常的时候。火总会燃烧，水总是淹死人。物体受到撞击或受引力作用而动起来，这是一项普遍法则，从未有过例外。但是另一些原因出现异常或不确定结果的情形就更多。大黄不是对每个人都能起到催泻通便的作用，鸦片也不是对所有人都有安眠的功效。的确，当某种原因没能产生其通常的结果时，哲学家们并不将其归咎于自然界中的任何异常情形，而是认为在事物具体结构中有某种神秘因素阻碍了结果的出现。然而，我们关于事件的推论和结论却并不受这个例外的影响，就仿佛不存在这样的例外似的。在我们所有推理中，由于习惯决定了我

The case is the same with the probability of causes, as with that of chance. There are some causes, which are entirely uniform and constant in producing a particular effect; and no instance has ever yet been found of any failure or irregularity in their operation. Fire has always burned, and water suffocated every human creature; the production of motion by impulse and gravity is a universal law, which has hitherto admitted of no exception. But there are other causes, which have been found more irregular and uncertain; nor has rhubarb always proved a purge, or opium a soporific to every one, who has taken these medicines. It is true, when any cause fails of producing

们把过去的经历转移到未来的情形，当过去的情况完全一致地合符规律时，我们会满怀信心地期待结果也会一样，不会留下任何余地去做出相反的假设。但是，一旦发现非常相似的原因导致了不同的结果，所有这些不同的结果在我们把过去的经验转移到未来时就会进入我们心中，成为我们判断某一结果的可然性时需要考虑的因素。尽管我们会优先考虑最通常的情形，相信这样的结果会继续出现，但是我们不能忽略其他可能的结果，而且必须根据我们观察到这些结果出现的实际情形按比例确定每一种结果的可然性比重。几乎在欧洲的每一个国家，每年一月份下霜的可然性就比这个月里天气持续晴朗的可然性更大。当然，各国气候条件有差异，这种可然性也有程度变化，但是，越靠

近北边，可然性就越加变得确信无疑。似乎显而易见的是，我们把过去的经验转移到未来以确定某一原因导致某一结果的可然性时，我们是把各种不同的情况按其过去出现的实际频度同时转移，比如会考虑到某一结果已经出现过100次，另一结果出现过10次，另一结果只出现过1次，等等。同一结果出现的次数很多，就会在我们的想象中得到强化和加深，形成我们所谓信念的情感，使之与其对立的情形相比更占优势，因为与之相反的情况没有得到同等数量的出现次数的支持，当我们把过去转移到未来时，它在我们的思想中出现的频度更低。请任何人用现有的各种哲学理论来解释这一心理活动，他都会立刻感到棘手。对我而言，如果目前提出的一些看法能够激起哲学家们的好奇心，

its usual effect, philosophers ascribe not this to any irregularity in nature; but suppose, that some secret causes, in the particular structure of parts, have prevented the operation. Our reasonings, however, and conclusions concerning the event are the same as if this principle had no place. Being determined by custom to transfer the past to the future, in all our inferences; where the past has been entirely regular and uniform, we expect the event with the greatest assurance, and leave no room for any contrary supposition. But where different effects have been found to follow from causes, which are to appearance exactly similar, all these various effects must occur to the mind

in transferring the past to the future, and enter into our consideration, when we determine the probability of the event. Though we give the preference to that which has been found most usual, and believe that this effect will exist, we must not overlook the other effects, but must assign to each of them a particular weight and authority, in proportion as we have found it to be more or less frequent. It is more probable, in almost every country of Europe, that there will be frost sometime in January, than that the weather will continue open throughout that whole month; though this probability varies according to the different climates, and approaches to a cer-

让他们感觉到，现有的哲学理论在应对这些值得探索的崇高话题时存在多大的缺陷，我想就足够了。

tainty in the more northern kingdoms. Here then it seems evident, that, when we transfer the past to the future, in order to determine the effect, which will result from any cause, we transfer all the different events, in the same proportion as they have appeared in the past, and conceive one to have existed a hundred times, for instance, another ten times, and another once. As a great number of views do here concur in one event, they fortify and confirm it to the imagination, beget that sentiment which we call belief, and give its object the preference above the contrary event, which is not supported by an equal number of experiments, and recurs not so frequently to the thought

in transferring the past to the future. Let any one try to account for this operation of the mind upon any of the received systems of philosophy, and he will be sensible of the difficulty. For my part, I shall think it sufficient, if the present hints excite the curiosity of philosophers, and make them sensible how defective all common theories are in treating of such curious and such sublime subjects.

第七章 论必然联系的观念

第一节

数学相对于人性科学的巨大优势在于，前者涉及的观点可以感知，都是清晰明确的，观念之间的细微区别可以立刻分辨出来，而且同样的术语总是表达同样的观念，没有模糊不清，不会发生变化。椭圆就是椭圆，绝不会被当作圆来看；双曲线不会被当作省略号。等腰三角形和不规则三角形的区别比是非善恶间的区别明确得多。如果几何学中的术语得到定义，我们的大脑在各种情况下都会轻松地用定义取代被定义的术语；即使在没有定义可用的时候，只要具体的事

物出现在感官面前，我们也能获得清楚的理解。但是，就心灵中更细腻的情感、理解的具体活动、各种躁动的激情而言，尽管各自都是清晰明白的，但当我们去反省这些事物时，却很不容易理解。我们也不能轻易回想起原先的事物，尽管我们常常可以看到它。这样，我们的推理就会逐渐产生模糊不清的东西，往往把仅仅相似的事物当作相同的事物，结果导致我们得出的结论和推理所依据的前提相去甚远。

Section VII Of the Idea of Necessary Connexion

Part I

The great advantage of the mathematical sciences above the moral consists in this, that the ideas of the former, being sensible, are always clear and determinate, the smallest distinction between them is immediately perceptible, and the same terms are still expressive of the same ideas, without ambiguity or variation. An oval is never mistaken for a circle, nor a hyperbola for an ellipsis. The isosceles and scalenum are distinguished by boundaries more exact

than vice and virtue, right and wrong. If any term be defined in geometry, the mind readily, of itself, substitutes, on all occasions, the definition for the term defined; or even when no definition is employed, the object itself may be presented to the senses, and by that means be steadily and clearly apprehended. But the finer sentiments of the mind, the operations of the understanding, the various agitations of the passions, though really in themselves distinct, easily escape us, when surveyed by reflection; nor is it in our power to recall the original object, as often as we have occasion to contemplate it. Ambiguity, by this means, is gradually introduced into our reasonings;

similar objects are readily taken to be the same, and the conclusion becomes at last very wide of the premises.

然而，我们可以确定地说，如果我们正确地看待这两种科学，各自的优劣几乎可以互补，最终使得两者具有平等的地位。如果我们的大脑能更加娴熟地掌握几何学中那些清楚明确的观念，它也一定能够进行更持久、更精密的推理，把差异很大的观念作对比，以得出几何学中更加深奥的真理。至于人性科学的观念，人们如果稍有粗心，就会觉得晦涩而模糊，但是，相对于和数量数字打交道的科学，人性科学研究的推论过程要短得多，帮助我们得出结论的中间步骤要少得多。事实上，欧几里得的数学里，极少有

One may safely, however, affirm, that, if we consider these sciences in a proper light, their advantages and disadvantages nearly compensate each other, and reduce both of them to a state of equality. If the mind, with greater facility, retains the ideas of geometry clear and determinate, it must carry on a much longer and more intricate chain of reasoning, and compare ideas much wider of each other, in order to reach the abstruser truths of that science. And if moral ideas are apt, without extreme care,

非常简单的命题，它们哪一个都比那些陷入妄想自大的人性推理所包含的结构要复杂。考虑到我们探索事物原因的过程很快就会受到自然的阻挡，让我们承认自己的无知，那么，如果我们在寻求人心的普遍原理时需要的步骤更少，我们就大可为取得的进步感到满意。由此看来，我们在发展人性科学或形而上学时，面对首要的障碍就是那些晦涩难懂的观念和模糊不清的术语。而在数学领域中，主要的困难是我们推理的长度和思想的广度不够，而这两者的充分发展对于我们形成结论是必不可少的。或许可以说，自然哲学的进步主要受制于缺乏适当的实验和现象，这些东西常常是偶然发现的，无论研究者多么勤勉谨慎，在需要这些实验和现象时，也并非总能得到。而对于人性科学而

to fall into obscurity and confusion, the inferences are always much shorter in these disquisitions, and the intermediate steps, which lead to the conclusion, much fewer than in the sciences which treat of quantity and number. In reality, there is scarcely a proposition in Euclid so simple, as not to consist of more parts, than are to be found in any moral reasoning which runs not into chimera and conceit. Where we trace the principles of the human mind through a few steps, we may be very well satisfied with our progress; considering how soon nature throws a bar to all our enquiries concerning causes, and reduces us to an acknowledgment of our ignorance. The chief obstacle,

言，迄今取得的进步既不如几何学，也比不上物理学，我们可以说，如果这些科学中存在什么差异的话，就是那些阻碍前者（人性科学）取得进展的困难需要我们付诸更大的耐心和能力加以克服。

therefore, to our improvement in the moral or metaphysical sciences is the obscurity of the ideas, and ambiguity of the terms. The principal difficulty in the mathematics is the length of inferences and compass of thought, requisite to the forming of any conclusion. And, perhaps, our progress in natural philosophy is chiefly retarded by the want of proper experiments and phaenomena, which are often discovered by chance, and cannot always be found, when requisite, even by the most diligent and prudent enquiry. As moral philosophy seems hitherto to have received less improvement than either geometry or physics, we may conclude, that, if there be any difference in

this respect among these sciences, the difficulties, which obstruct the progress of the former, require superior care and capacity to be surmounted.

形而上学中出现的观念，最晦涩不清者莫过于动力、力量、能量或必要联系之类，而在我们的研究中时刻都得与之打交道。因此，我们将在本章中尽可能明确这些术语的意思，消除我们在形而上学研究中经常抱怨的晦涩难懂之处。

There are no ideas, which occur in metaphysics, more obscure and uncertain, than those of power, force, energy or necessary connexion, of which it is every moment necessary for us to treat in all our disquisitions. We shall, therefore, endeavour, in this section, to fix, if possible, the precise meaning of these terms, and thereby remove some part of that obscurity, which is so much complained of in this species of philosophy.

有一个观点似乎很少有争议，即我们所有的观念不过是我们的印象的摹本，换言之，我们不可能对没有事先被我们的内外感官所感知的任何事物进行思考。上文中^{*}我已经尝试解释和证明这一立场，并希望通过恰当的应用，人们能在哲学推理中达到比先前努力达到的更清晰、更准确的程度。复杂的观念或许可以通过定义让人们了解，定义不过是把构成复杂观念的各个成分或简单观念——列举清楚。但是，如果我们通过定义推进到最简单的观念，仍然发现还有模棱两可晦涩难懂的东西存在，还有什么办法可以采用？还有什么奇思妙想可以帮助我们阐明这些观念，使之在我们的知觉中变得精准明确呢？答案就是再现这些观念得以衍生的印象或最初的情感。这些印象是强烈的、可以

觉察到的，毫不模糊。这些印象不仅自身清楚明确，也有助于理解那些由之而来的晦涩难懂的观念。这样，我们或许能获得一种新的显微镜或类似的光学仪器，用来把人性科学中最细微、最简单的观念放大，便于我们理解，并使之像那些最醒目、最明显的观念一样明白易懂，从而可成为我们的研究对象。

It seems a proposition, which will not admit of much dispute, that all our ideas are nothing but copies of our impressions, or, in other words, that it is impossible for us to think of anything, which we have not antecedently felt, either by our external or internal senses. I have endeavoured^{*} to explain and prove this proposition, and have expressed my hopes, that, by a proper application of it, men may reach a greater clearness and precision in philosophical reasonings, than what they have hitherto been able to attain. Complex ideas, may, perhaps, be well known by definition, which is nothing but an enumeration of those parts or simple ideas, that compose them.

But when we have pushed up definitions to the most simple ideas, and find still some ambiguity and obscurity; what resource are we then possessed of? By what invention can we throw light upon these ideas, and render them altogether precise and determinate to our intellectual view? Produce the impressions or original sentiments, from which the ideas are copied. These impressions are all strong and sensible. They admit not of ambiguity. They are not only placed in a full light themselves, but may throw light on their correspondent ideas, which lie in obscurity. And by this means, we may, perhaps, attain a new microscope or species of optics, by which, in the moral

sciences, the most minute, and most simple ideas may be so enlarged as to fall readily under our apprehension, and be equally known with the grossest and most sensible ideas, that can be the object of our enquiry.

因此，要完全熟悉动力或必然联系的观念，就得检查它们的印象，而要确切地找到印象，我们就得从印象可能产生的各种来源去寻找。

To be fully acquainted, therefore, with the idea of power or necessary connexion, let us examine its impression; and in order to find the impression with greater certainty, let us search for it in all the sources, from which it may possibly be derived.

我们从外界事物中寻求原因的时候，绝不可能从单一的事件中发现任何动力或必然联系，或是任何特性，能将结果和原因联系

When we look about us towards external objects, and consider the operation of causes, we are never able, in a single in-

起来，使得一个成为另一个的必然结果。我们见到的不过是一件事在另一件事之后出现。第一个弹子球撞击了第二个弹子球，然后第二个弹子球动了起来。这就是呈现在我们外部感官中的一切，我们的心灵并未从这一连串事件中获得任何情感或形成任何内在印象。因此，任何单一的因果事件并不能暗示动力或必然联系的观念。

stance, to discover any power or necessary connexion; any quality, which binds the effect to the cause, and renders the one an infallible consequence of the other. We only find, that the one does actually, in fact, follow the other. The impulse of one billiard-ball is attended with motion in the second. This is the whole that appears to the outward senses. The mind feels no sentiment or inward impression from this succession of objects; consequently, there is not, in any single, particular instance of cause and effect, any thing which can suggest the idea of power or necessary connexion.

我们绝不能从某一事物的第一次出现推

From the first appearance of an object,

测其可能产生的结果。但是，如果我们知道原因中包含的动力或能量，我们甚至无需任何经验也能预测到会有什么结果出现，或许只需事先动脑筋想一想就能准确地判断出结果来。

事实上，没有任何事物会明显地向我们揭示其动力或能量，或给我们任何依据去想象它能产生什么事物，或产生任何我们可以称之为它的结果的事物。固态、广延、运动，这些都是自身完整的属性，但是从不会揭示它们能引起的结果。宇宙中的事物时刻都在变化，一事物之后接着另一事物，永不停息，但是，驱动万物运转的动力或能量却

彻底隐藏起来了，从不以事物明显的属性向我们揭示自身。我们知道，有火就会产生热，但是二者间有什么必然联系，我们却无从猜测和想象。因此，动力的观念不可能来源于对事物单一活动的思考，因为没有任何事物会向我们揭示其背后的动力，从而向我们揭示动力这一观念的本源。^{*}

we never can conjecture what effect will result from it. But were the power or energy of any cause discoverable by the mind, we could foresee the effect, even without experience; and might, at first, pronounce with certainty concerning it, by mere dint of thought and reasoning.

In reality, there is no part of matter, that does ever, by its sensible qualities, discover any power or energy, or give us ground to imagine, that it could produce any thing, or be followed by any other object, which we could denominate its effect. Solidity, extension, motion; these qualities are all complete in themselves, and never

point out any other event which may result from them. The scenes of the universe are continually shifting, and one object follows another in an uninterrupted succession; but the power of force, which actuates the whole machine, is entirely concealed from us, and never discovers itself in any of the sensible qualities of body. We know, that, in fact, heat is a constant attendant of flame; but what is the connexion between them, we have no room so much as to conjecture or imagine. It is impossible, therefore, that the idea of power can be derived from the contemplation of bodies, in single instances of their operation; because no bodies ever discover any power, which can be the ori-

既然外界事物呈现到我们感官时，不会以其具体的活动方式向我们揭示其背后的动力或必然联系，那就让我们来检查一下，动力的观念是否来自我们对自身心理活动的思考，是我们内心印象的摹本。我们感觉到，单纯靠意志的指令，就能让身体的器官动起来，就能行使我们的心智功能，这可以说我们时时刻刻都意识到了有某种内在动力存在。仅凭意志力我们能让我们的四肢动起来，或者在头脑中产生一个新的想法。我们靠意识了解到意志的这种影响。因此，我们获得了动力或能量的观念，而且确信我们和所有其他高等生物都具有这种动力。这个观念就是思考得来的观念，因为它来自于我们

对自身心理活动以及我们的意志对身体器官和心智能力的控制的思考。

我们将继续探讨这一主张，先从意志对身体器官的影响开始。我们注意到，这种影响力是客观事实，像自然界所有其他事物一样，我们只能靠经验来认识，绝不能指望从原因所蕴含的能量或动力中预测出来，这能

ginal of this idea.*

Since, therefore, external objects as they appear to the senses, give us no idea of power or necessary connexion, by their operation in particular instances, let us see, whether this idea be derived from reflection on the operations of our own minds, and be copied from any internal impression. It may be said, that we are every moment conscious of internal power; while we feel, that, by the simple command of our will, we can move the organs of our body, or direct the faculties of our mind. An act of volition produces motion in our limbs, or raises a new idea in our imagination. This influence of

the will we know by consciousness. Hence we acquire the idea of power or energy; and are certain, that we ourselves and all other intelligent beings are possessed of power. This idea, then, is an idea of reflection, since it arises from reflecting on the operations of our own mind, and on the command which is exercised by will, both over the organs of the body and faculties of the soul.

We shall proceed to examine this pretension; and first with regard to the influence of volition over the organs of the body. This influence, we may observe, is a fact, which, like all other natural events, can be

量或动力将原因和结果联结在一起，并使得一事物成为另一事物必然结果。我们的身体会随我们意志的指令而动，这是我们时刻都能意识到的。但是，引起身体活动的途径，意志得以行使这一非凡活动的能量，我们根本意识不到，或许无论我们进行多么勤勉的研究也永远发现不了。

首先我们要问，整个自然界中还有任何比心灵和身体的结合更神秘的原理吗？心灵

和身体的结合使得精神的东西能对物质的东西产生极大的影响，哪怕是最细微的思想也足以驱动最庞大的物体。倘若我们受一神秘的意愿指使，要移动大山，或把行星控制在其轨道上，这一宏大的意愿并不会显得非凡异常，也不会让我们无法理解。但是如果我们通过意识感觉到意志中的任何动力或能量，我们就能知道这种动力，就会知道它与结果之间的必然联系，也就会了解心灵和身体的神秘结合，以及这两种事物的本质何在。正是这一本质决定了一事物在很多情况下能否对另一事物产生作用和影响。

known only by experience, and can never be foreseen from any apparent energy or power in the cause, which connects it with the effect, and renders the one an infallible consequence of the other. The motion of our body follows upon the command of our will. Of this we are every moment conscious. But the means, by which this is effected; the energy, by which the will performs so extraordinary an operation; of this we are so far from being immediately conscious, that it must for ever escape our most diligent enquiry.

For first: Is there any principle in all nature more mysterious than the union of

soul with body; by which a supposed spiritual substance acquires such an influence over a material one, that the most refined thought is able to actuate the grossest matter? Were we empowered, by a secret wish, to remove mountains, or control the planets in their orbit; this extensive authority would not be more extraordinary, nor more beyond our comprehension. But if by consciousness we perceived any power or energy in the will, we must know this power; we must know its connexion with the effect; we must know the secret union of soul and body, and the nature of both these substances; by which the one is able to operate, in so many instances, upon the other.

其次，我们不能以同样的意志力来指挥身体的各个器官动起来，尽管除了经验之外，我们找不到其他解释，毕竟身体各部分差异很大。为什么我们的意志能控制舌头和手指，却无法控制我们的心和肝？倘若我们能意识到在前一种而不是后一种情况下有什么动力在起作用，这个问题就绝不会让我们感到难堪了。那样我们无须借助任何经验就能感知到，为什么意志对于身体器官的影响会受到这样的限制。完全熟悉了驱使意志的动力或力量之后，我们也就会明白，为什么意志的影响力只能达到这个边界，不能再有超越。

Secondly, we are not able to move all the organs of the body with a like authority; though we cannot assign any reason besides experience, for so remarkable a difference between one and the other. Why has the will an influence over the tongue and fingers, not over the heart or liver? This question would never embarrass us, were we conscious of a power in the former case, not in the latter. We should then perceive, independent of experience, why the authority of will over the organs of the body is circumscribed within such particular limits. Being in that case fully acquainted with the power or force, by which it operates, we should also know, why its influence reaches pre-

cisely to such boundaries, and no farther.

一个人突然间手脚麻痹，或刚刚失去了这些肢体，一开始他会频繁地尝试活动他的手和脚，行使其日常的功能。此时的他对控制肢体的动力有清醒的意识，就像一个健康的人能清醒地意识到某种能够驱使健在完好的肢体进行活动的动力一样。但是意识从不会欺骗我们，所以无论是第一种情况还是第二种情况，我们都不会意识到任何动力的存在。我们只能从经验中了解我们意志的影响。而经验仅仅向我们显示，一事物总是频繁出现在另一事物之后，没有为我们揭示出将两者联系起来、使之密不可分的神秘联系。

A man, suddenly struck with palsy in the leg or arm, or who had newly lost those members, frequently endeavours, at first to move them, and employ them, in their usual offices. Here he is as much conscious of power to command such limbs, as a man in perfect health is conscious of power to actuate any member which remains in its natural state and condition. But consciousness never deceives. Consequently, neither in the one case nor in the other, are we ever conscious of any power. We learn the influence of our will from experience alone. And experience only teaches us, how one event

constantly follows another; without instructing us in the secret connexion, which binds them together, and renders them inseparable.

第三，我们从解剖学中得知，在肢体的自发运动中，动力作用的直接对象并非被启动的肢体本身，而是一些肌肉、神经和精气，或者说是一些更细微、更不为人知的东西。通过这些东西运动得到不断传递，最后才到达肢体本身，因为肢体的运动才是意志的直接目标。隐藏在这一系列活动背后的是我们的内部情感和意识完全无法感知的动力，难道还有什么比这更确切的证据，证明事物背后的动力是完全神秘、不可知晓的吗？我们的心中一旦生出实现某一事件的愿

Thirdly, we learn from anatomy, that the immediate object of power in voluntary motion, is not the member itself which is moved, but certain muscles, and nerves, and animal spirits, and, perhaps, something still more minute and more unknown, through which the motion is successively propagated, ere it reach the member itself whose motion is the immediate object of volition. Can there be a more certain proof, that the power, by which this whole opera-

望，立刻就有某个我们全然不知的、与我们的意图完全不一样的动作发生，接着一个动作导致另一个我们同样全然不知的动作，直到最后，经过一连串的动作之后，我们意愿中的动作发生了。但是假如我们能感觉到最初的动力，我们就能知晓它；如果我们知晓这一动力，我们就会知道它的结果，因为一切动力都与其结果相关。反之亦然，如果我们不知道结果，也就不可能知晓或感知其背后的动力。我们没有让肢体动起来的动力，怎么能意识到这种动力的存在呢？我们只不过动用了一点精气，尽管这最终引起了我们的肢体动作，但是其作用的方式却是我们完全无法理解的。

tion is performed, so far from being directly and fully known by an inward sentiment or consciousness is, to the last degree, mysterious and unintelligible? Here the mind wills a certain event. Immediately another event, unknown to ourselves, and totally different from the one intended, is produced. This event produces another, equally unknown; till at last, through a long succession, the desired event is produced. But if the original power were felt, it must be known; were it known, its effect also must be known; since all power is relative to its effect. And vice versa, if the effect be not known, the power cannot be known nor felt. How indeed can we be conscious of a power

因此，我们可以从整个分析中得出结论，我希望这不是冒失的结论，而是有把握的结论，即我们的动力观念并不是在我们产生动作或发挥肢体作用时，由我们心中关于动力的情感或意识衍生而来的。肢体的动作是意志指令的结果，和自然界其他事物一样，是个日常经验问题。但是让这一活动得以发生的动力或能量，也像其他情形中的一样，是我们不可理解、不可感知的。^{*}

那么，我们是否可以说，我们通过意志的指令产生一个新的想法，让我们集中心思来思考，从各方面加以权衡，在我们认为已经对其进行充分的探索之后，把它抛弃，再换上另一个想法，而在此过程中我们意识到了心中的某种动力或能量呢？我认为，我们的论证同样会证明，即使这样一种意志的指令也没有为我们提供真实的动力或能量的观念。

to move our limbs, when we have no such power; but only that to move certain animal spirits, which, though they produce at last the motion of our limbs, yet operate in such a manner as is wholly beyond our comprehension?

We may, therefore, conclude from the whole, I hope, without any temerity, though with assurance; that our idea of power is not copied from any sentiment or consciousness of power within ourselves, when we give rise to animal motion, or apply our limbs to their proper use and office. That their motion follows the command of the will is a matter of common experience, like

other natural events. But the power or energy by which this is effected, like that in other natural events, is unknown and inconceivable.^{*}

Shall we then assert, that we are conscious of a power or energy in our own minds, when, by an act or command of our will, we raise up a new idea, fix the mind to the contemplation of it, turn it on all sides, and at last dismiss it for some other idea, when we think that we have surveyed it with sufficient accuracy? I believe the same arguments will prove, that even this command of the will gives us no real idea of force or energy.

首先，必须承认的是，如果我们知晓一种动力，我们就知晓原因中导致其产生结果的具体情境，因为二者实际上具有相同性质。这样我们就不仅知道原因和结果，而且知道两者间的关系。但是，我们能否声称我们知晓人心的本性和某个观念的本质，或者其中一个有能力产生另一个呢？这就真正属于创造，是从无中生出的创造；这其中隐含着有一种巨大的动力，乍一看似乎超越了一切非永恒生命的掌控范围。至少必须承认，这样的动力不能被我们的心灵所察觉、所知晓、所想象。我们仅仅能感觉到这一事物（即观念的存在）出现于我们的意志的指令之后，但是，它以何种方式呈现，背后的动力是什么，完全超出了我们的理解范围。

First, it must be allowed, that, when we know a power, we know that very circumstance in the cause, by which it is enabled to produce the effect; for these are supposed to be synonymous. We must, therefore, know both the cause and effect, and the relation between them. But do we pretend to be acquainted with the nature of the human soul and the nature of an idea, or the aptitude of the one to produce the other? This is a real creation; a production of something out of nothing, which implies a power so great, that it may seem, at first sight, beyond the reach of any being, less than infinite. At least it must be owned, that such a power is not felt, nor known, nor even conceivable by

the mind. We only feel the event, namely, the existence of an idea, consequent to a command of the will; but the manner, in which this operation is performed, the power by which it is produced, is entirely beyond our comprehension.

第二，意志对自身的控制有限，对身体的控制也有限。这些限制我们既不能通过理性获得认知，也不能因为我们熟悉因果关系的本质而能有所了解，就像对于自然界中其他事物和外界物体的活动一样，我们只能通过观察和经验来认识它们。我们对自身情感和感情的主宰远远比我们对自己思想的主宰要脆弱；而且即使是我们对自身思想的掌控，也是严格限制在狭窄边界内的。难道有

Secondly, the command of the mind over itself is limited, as well as its command over the body; and these limits are not known by reason, or any acquaintance with the nature of cause and effect, but only by experience and observation, as in all other natural events and in the operation of external objects. Our authority over our sentiments and passions is much weaker than

人能尝试对这些边界做出最终的解释，或者阐明为什么动力在一种情况下不起作用，而在另一种情况下又能发挥作用吗？

第三，意志的自我控制因时而异。身体健康的人比疾病缠身的人有更大的意志控制力，早晨我们对自己思想的控制比傍晚更强，斋戒之时比饱食之后更强。除了经验，我们还能用什么理由来解释这些变化？我们声称知晓的动力在何处呢？在精神或物质的实体，或同时在两者中，难道不是有某种神秘机制或复杂结构，成为了结果的依托吗？这样的机制决定了结果是什么，并在我们全

that over our ideas; and even the latter authority is circumscribed within very narrow boundaries. Will any one pretend to assign the ultimate reason of these boundaries, or show why the power is deficient in one case, not in another.

Thirdly, this self-command is very different at different times. A man in health possesses more of it than one languishing with sickness. We are more master of our thoughts in the morning than in the evening; fasting, than after a full meal. Can we give any reason for these variations, except experience? Where then is the power, of which we pretend to be conscious? Is there

然不觉中把动力和能量变得同样不可知晓、不可理解。

意志力显然是一种心理活动，对此我们都非常熟悉。认真思考，并从各个方面仔细检查一下。你能从中发现任何类似创造性动力的东西，使意志能从虚无中生出新的想法，从而借着一道命令，模仿从虚无中创造世间万物的全能的主吗（假如我可以这样比方的话）？由于我们远远不能意识到意志中有这种能量，这就需要用一定的经验，就像

not here, either in a spiritual or material substance, or both, some secret mechanism or structure of parts, upon which the effect depends, and which, being entirely unknown to us, renders the power or energy of the will equally unknown and incomprehensible?

Volition is surely an act of the mind, with which we are sufficiently acquainted. Reflect upon it. Consider it on all sides. Do you find anything in it like this creative power, by which it raises from nothing a new idea, and with a kind of Fiat, imitates the omnipotence of its Maker, if I may be allowed so to speak, who called forth into

我们有的经验一样，来证明如此非凡的结果的确来自一个简单的意志行为。

一般人并不觉得很难解释自然界中常见的、熟悉的现象，比如重物下落、植物生长、动物繁殖，或者身体需要食物提供养分，等等。但是，假设在所有这些情况下，他们感知到了原因中的动力或能量，即与其结果相关、永远不会出错的动力或能量。他们因为长期的习惯获得了这样一种心智习性，即一见到原因出现，立刻就确信通常与之伴随的结果，却极少会想到有可能出现意

外的情况。只有在他们见到一些异常的现象，诸如地震、瘟疫，以及各种奇迹的时候，他们才发现找不到原因，无法解释为什么会出现这样的结果。在遭遇这些难题的时候，人们通常会认为是某种看不见的智慧的干预^{*}直接导致了让他们感到诧异的事件，而这是不能从常见的自然活动中寻求解释的。但是，进行深入追究的哲学家就不同了，他们立刻就会认识到，即使在最熟悉的事件里，原因背后的能量和在最异常事件的情形中一样难以理解，我们只能通过经验获悉某些事物经常伴随出现，并不能理解它们之间所谓的联系。

existence all the various scenes of nature? So far from being conscious of this energy in the will, it requires as certain experience as that of which we are possessed, to convince us that such extraordinary effects do ever result from a simple act of volition.

The generality of mankind never find any difficulty in accounting for the more common and familiar operations of nature—such as the descent of heavy bodies, the growth of plants, the generation of animals, or the nourishment of bodies by food; but suppose that, in all these cases, they perceive the very force or energy of the cause, by which it is connected with its effect, and

is for ever infallible in its operation. They acquire, by long habit, such a turn of mind, that, upon the appearance of the cause, they immediately expect with assurance its usual attendant, and hardly conceive it possible that any other event could result from it. It is only on the discovery of extraordinary phaenomena, such as earthquakes, pestilence, and prodigies of any kind, that they find themselves at a loss to assign a proper cause, and to explain the manner in which the effect is produced by it. It is usual for men, in such difficulties, to have recourse to some invisible intelligent principle^{*} as the immediate cause of that event which surprises them, and which, they think, cannot

然而，一般人只用来解释奇迹和超自然现象的原理，许多哲学家却认为它们有必要用来解释所有现象。他们承认，心灵和智力不仅是一切事物的终极根源，也是自然界中一切现象的直接和唯一的诱因。他们声称通

常被称之为原因的事物实际上不过是一些“起因”，产生每一结果的真实的直接的原理不是自然界中的任何动力或力量，而是上帝的意志，上帝愿意把某些具体事物永远安排在一起出现。他们说，不是一个弹子球借助自然力推动另一个弹子球运动起来，而是上帝自己以具体的意愿推动第二个弹子球在动，第二个弹子球受到第一个球的撞击动起来，符合上帝为自己制定的统领宇宙的普遍法则。哲学家们更进一步发现，正如我们对事物相互活动所依赖的动力一无所知，我们同样不了解心灵之于身体，或身体之于心灵的影响活动背后的动力，更不可能从我们的感官或意识中找到能更好地解释一种情形而不是另一种情形的终极原理。同样的无知让他们得出同样的结论。他们断言，上帝才是心灵与

be accounted for from the common powers of nature. But philosophers, who carry their scrutiny a little farther, immediately perceive that, even in the most familiar events, the energy of the cause is as unintelligible as in the most unusual, and that we only learn by experience the frequent Conjunction of objects, without being ever able to comprehend anything like Connexion between them.

Here, then, many philosophers think themselves obliged by reason to have recourse, on all occasions, to the same principle, which the vulgar never appeal to but in cases that appear miraculous and super-

natural. They acknowledge mind and intelligence to be, not only the ultimate and original cause of all things, but the immediate and sole cause of every event which appears in nature. They pretend that those objects which are commonly denominated causes, are in reality nothing but *occasions*; and that the true and direct principle of every effect is not any power or force in nature, but a volition of the Supreme Being, who wills that such particular objects should for ever be conjoined with each other. Instead of saying that one billiard-ball moves another by a force which it has derived from the author of nature, it is the Deity himself, they say, who, by a particular volition,

身体得以结合的直接原因；心灵和身体不是感觉器官，它们的感知不是在外界事物的刺激之下在思想中产生的，而是由我们万能的造物主的一个意愿，通过器官的活动促成的。同样，不是我们意志中的能量引发了肢体的动作，而是上帝本身乐于支持我们那本来无能的意志，引起了肢体的动作，而我们却错误地认为是我们自己身上的动力和能量引起的。哲学家们并未就此止步，他们有时候把同样的推理加以扩展，用来解释心灵本身的内在活动。我们头脑中关于种种观念的认识或概念只不过是造物主给我们的启示。我们自发地想到一个事物，在心中产生一种形象，这都不是意志产生的观念，而是万能的造物主为我们揭示，为我们呈现的。

moves the second ball, being determined to this operation by the impulse of the first ball, in consequence of those general laws which he has laid down to himself in the government of the universe. But philosophers advancing still in their inquiries, discover that, as we are totally ignorant of the power on which depends the mutual operation of bodies, we are no less ignorant of that power on which depends the operation of mind on body, or of body on mind, nor are we able, either from our senses or consciousness, to assign the ultimate principle in one case more than in the other. The same ignorance, therefore, reduces them to the same conclusion. They assert that the

Deity is the immediate cause of the union between soul and body; and that they are not the organs of sense, which, being agitated by external objects, produce sensations in the mind; but that it is a particular volition of our omnipotent Maker, which excites such a sensation, in consequence of such a motion in the organ. In like manner, it is not any energy in the will that produces local motion in our members; it is God himself, who is pleased to second our will, in itself impotent, and to command that motion which we erroneously attribute to our own power and efficacy. Nor do philosophers stop at this conclusion. They sometimes extend the same inference to the mind itself,

因此，在这些哲学家看来，上帝存在于万物之中。万物皆因上帝的意志而存在，万物皆因上帝的许可而具有能力，他们不仅没有因此感到满足，还更进一步剥夺了自然和一切造物的一切能力，把它们对上帝的依存变得更明显，更直接。他们并未考虑到，通过这样的理论，他们实际上削减而不是增加

了他们努力称颂的事物的光辉品质。因为这个观点强调的是上帝可以向低等生灵分发一定程度的能力，而不是上帝按照自身的意志创造了万物。同样，它认为，上帝极具远见地设计世界的结构，使其靠自身的活动实现神的旨意，而不是说，伟大的造物主需要时刻为其调整结构，需要用自己的气息激活这架庞大机器并使其运转起来。

in its internal operations. Our mental vision or conception of ideas is nothing but a revelation made to us by our Maker. When we voluntarily turn our thoughts to any object, and raise up its image in the fancy, it is not the will which creates that idea; it is the universal Creator, who discovers it to the mind, and renders it present to us.

Thus, according to these philosophers, every thing is full of God. Not content with the principle, that nothing exists but by his will, that nothing possesses any power but by his concession; they rob nature, and all created beings, of every power, in order to render their dependence on the Deity still

more sensible and immediate. They consider not that, by this theory, they diminish, instead of magnifying, the grandeur of those attributes, which they affect so much to celebrate. It argues surely more power in the Deity to delegate a certain degree of power to inferior creatures than to produce every thing by his own immediate volition. It argues more wisdom to contrive at first the fabric of the world with such perfect foresight that, of itself, and by its proper operation, it may serve all the purposes of providence, than if the great Creator were obliged every moment to adjust its parts, and animate by his breath all the wheels of that stupendous machine.

但是，如果我们要对这个理论提出更具哲理的批判，或许下面两点理由就够了。

第一，在我看来，上帝掌握一切能量和活动的理论，对于任何充分了解人类理性的缺陷以及思维活动的狭窄限制的人，都显得过于冒失，没有说服力。尽管这个理论中一连串的推理似乎符合逻辑，然而，即使我们不敢确信，也会产生强烈的怀疑，因为它让我们远远超越了我们的能力范围，得出了非凡异常、远离日常生活和经验的结论。我们还没有得出最后的理论，就早早地被引入了一片神奇的仙境，在这块仙境中我们没有理由信任我们常用的论证方法，更不会认为我们常见的类比和可能性会发挥作用。我们的

But if we would have a more philosophical confutation of this theory, perhaps the two following reflections may suffice:

First, it seems to me that this theory of the universal energy and operation of the Supreme Being is too bold ever to carry conviction with it to a man, sufficiently apprized of the weakness of human reason, and the narrow limits to which it is confined in all its operations. Though the chain of arguments which conduct to it were ever so logical, there must arise a strong suspicion, if not an absolute assurance, that it has carried us quite beyond the reach of our faculties, when it leads to conclusions so ex-

思想之线太短，无法丈量这个无边无际的深渊。无论我们多么庆幸自己每走一步都受到某种异常真实的事物和经验的指引，可以肯定的是，这种假想的经验对于完全处在我们经验之外的事物没有任何指导作用。这个问题下文中我们还会再讨论。*

traordinary, and so remote from common life and experience. We are got into fairy land, long ere we have reached the last steps of our theory; and there we have no reason to trust our common methods of argument, or to think that our usual analogies and probabilities have any authority. Our line is too short to fathom such immense abysses. And however we may flatter ourselves that we are guided, in every step which we take, by a kind of verisimilitude and experience, we may be assured that this fancied experience has no authority when we thus apply it to subjects that lie entirely out of the sphere of experience. But on this we shall have occasion to touch afterwards.*

第二，我无法从得出这个理论的论证中发现任何动力。诚然，我们不知道事物间相互作用的方式，其中的动力和能量我们完全不能理解。但是，难道我们不是同样不知道心灵，甚至上帝之灵，以何种方式或动力对自身或对身体发挥作用？我问你，我们又是从哪里获得关于动力的观念的呢？我们对自己身上的这种动力没有任何感觉和意识；，我们也没有上帝的观念，只有我们对自己能力的反思所得。如果我们的无知可以作为拒绝一切的理由，我们就会得出，就像一切明显的事物一样，上帝不具有任何能量的观点。显然我们对两种情形同样知之甚少。想象运动源于推力难道比想象运动源于意志力更难吗？我们所知道的就是，对于两种情形我们都一无所知。^{*}

Secondly, I cannot perceive any force in the arguments on which this theory is founded. We are ignorant, it is true, of the manner in which bodies operate on each other; their force or energy is entirely incomprehensible. But are we not equally ignorant of the manner or force by which a mind, even the supreme mind, operates either on itself or on body? Whence, I beseech you, do we acquire any idea of it? We have no sentiment or consciousness of this power in ourselves. We have no idea of the Supreme Being but what we learn from reflection on our own faculties. Were our ignorance, therefore, a good reason for rejecting any thing, we should be led into that principle of

denying all energy in the Supreme Being as much as in the grossest matter. We surely comprehend as little the operations of one as of the other. Is it more difficult to conceive that motion may arise from impulse than that it may arise from volition? All we know is our profound ignorance in both cases.^{*}

第二节

但是，为了从这个已经拉得太长的议论中匆忙得出结论，我们已经从各个可能的源头徒劳地寻求动力或必然联系的观念。显然，就算再仔细审视，我们也不能从事物活动的单一例证中发现除了事物先后出现这一

Part II

But to hasten to a conclusion of this argument, which is already drawn out to too great a length, we have sought in vain for an idea of power or necessary connexion in all the sources from which we could suppose it

现象之外的任何东西，无法理解原因背后的任何动力或力量，或者原因与其结果之间的任何联系。我们在思索心灵对身体的作用时也会遇到同样的困难。我们看得见身体的动作随意志而出现，但是既不能看见也不能想象连接身体动作和意志的纽带，或者心灵藉以产生这个结果的能量。而意志对自身能力和对观念的影响，对我们而言，丝毫不显得更容易理解。所以，总的来说，整个自然界中，没有任何一种我们可以知晓的联系存在。各种事物之间关系疏散，各不相干。虽然一事物之后出现另一事物，但我们绝不可能发现二者间有任何关联。它们在时空上有连接，但绝没有内在联系。既然我们对于从未在我们外部感官和内部情感中出现过的事物没有任何观念，似乎可以得出一个必然的

to be derived. It appears that, in single instances of the operation of bodies, we never can, by our utmost scrutiny, discover any thing but one event following another, without being able to comprehend any force or power by which the cause operates, or any connexion between it and its supposed effect. The same difficulty occurs in contemplating the operations of mind on body—where we observe the motion of the latter to follow upon the volition of the former, but are not able to observe or conceive the tie which binds together the motion and volition, or the energy by which the mind produces this effect. The authority of the will over its own faculties and ideas is not a whit

结论：我们完全没有关于联系或动力的任何观念，这些词语无论用于哲学推理，还是用于日常生活，都是毫无意义的。

more comprehensible; so that, upon the whole, there appears not, throughout all nature, any one instance of connexion which is conceivable by us. All events seem entirely loose and separate. One event follows another; but we never can observe any tie between them. They seem conjoined, but never connected. And as we can have no idea of any thing which never appeared to our outward sense or inward sentiment, the necessary conclusion seems to be that we have no idea of connexion or power at all, and that these words are absolutely, without any meaning, when employed either in philosophical reasonings or common life.

但是，还有一种方法可以避免得出这个结论，还有一个源头我们尚未认真检查过。当自然界的事物或事件出现时，我们不可能靠聪明或悟性，而不靠经验，来发现甚至来想象其结果，或者让我们的见识超越直接呈现在感官和记忆中的事物。即使我们注意到一事物随另一事物出现的单个例子，我们也不能就此得出普遍法则，或者预言在相似情况下会发生什么结果。单个事例无论多么精确，多么确定，也不能因此就得出整个自然进程的规律，这样做是不可原谅的冒失之举。但是，若一连串的事物在各种情况下总是伴随在一起出现，我们可以毫无顾虑地预测一事物的出现会引起另一事物的出现，并将这种自身足以让我们对实际的事实和存在感到确信的推理方法加以运用。我们因此把

一事物称为原因，把另一种事物称为结果，并认定二者间有某种联系，其中一种事物包含某种动力，肯定会产生另一种事物，而且这个过程确信无疑，必然发生。

由此看来，必然联系的这个观念来自于

But there still remains one method of avoiding this conclusion, and one source which we have not yet examined. When any natural object or event is presented, it is impossible for us, by any sagacity or penetration, to discover, or even conjecture, without experience, what event will result from it, or to carry our foresight beyond that object which is immediately present to the memory and senses. Even after one instance or experiment where we have observed a particular event to follow upon another, we are not entitled to form a general rule, or foretell what will happen in like cases; it being justly esteemed an unpardonable temerity to judge of the whole

course of nature from one single experiment, however accurate or certain. But when one particular species of event has always, in all instances, been conjoined with another, we make no longer any scruple of foretelling one upon the appearance of the other, and of employing that reasoning, which can alone assure us of any matter of fact or existence. We then call the one object, Cause; the other, Effect. We suppose that there is some connexion between them; some power in the one, by which it infallibly produces the other, and operates with the greatest certainty and strongest necessity.

It appears, then, that this idea of a ne-

事物恒常相伴发生的多种类似情形，而不能从任何单一的情形中获得暗示，无论我们从哪个方面对其精心研究。但是，一系列反复发生的情形，和与之其实完全相似的单一的情形相比，并无什么不同。唯有在相似的事物不断重复发生之后，心灵才会受习惯的影响，能够从一事物的出现期待其常见的结果，并相信这一结果会出现。因此，我们心中感觉到的这种联系，即思想从一事物到其通常结果的习惯性过渡，正是我们形成动力或必然联系观念所依据的情感或印象。除此之外别无他物。从各方面思考这个问题，你永远不可能找到这个观念还有其他来源。这便是一个事例和多个相似事例之间的唯一区别，从前者中我们得不出联系的观念，从后者中却能得出来。一个人第一次见到因推力

引起的运动，比如两个弹子球相撞，他不能宣称两者间有联系，他只是见到一种现象出现在另一种之后。只有在他见到多种类似的现象之后，才能断言二者间存在联系。是什么发生了改变，使之产生了联系的新观念？唯一的变化是，现在他感觉事物在他的想象中存在联系，他根据一现象的出现轻松地预测另一现象会发生。因此，我们说一事物与另一事物有联系，实际上是说它们在我们的思想中建立了联系，使我们产生了这个推断，把二者变为各自相互依存的证据。这个结论显得有些异常，但似乎有充分的证据可以支持。支持这个结论的证据不会因为对理解过程的一般性怀疑而被削弱，也不会经不起人们对所有新奇异常结论所持的怀疑态度的考验。

cessary connexion among events arises from a number of similar instances which occur of the constant conjunction of these events; nor can that idea ever be suggested by any one of these instances, surveyed in all possible lights and positions. But there is nothing in a number of instances, different from every single instance, which is supposed to be exactly similar; except only, that after a repetition of similar instances, the mind is carried by habit, upon the appearance of one event, to expect its usual attendant, and to believe that it will exist. This connexion, therefore, which we feel in the mind, this customary transition of the imagination from one object to its usual attend-

ant, is the sentiment or impression from which we form the idea of power or necessary connexion. Nothing farther is in the case. Contemplate the subject on all sides; you will never find any other origin of that idea. This is the sole difference between one instance, from which we can never receive the idea of connexion, and a number of similar instances, by which it is suggested. The first time a man saw the communication of motion by impulse, as by the shock of two billiard balls, he could not pronounce that the one event was connected; but only that it was conjoined with the other. After he has observed several instances of this nature, he then pronounces them to be connected.

What alteration has happened to give rise to this new idea of connexion? Nothing but that he now feels these events to be connected in his imagination, and can readily foretell the existence of one from the appearance of the other. When we say, therefore, that one object is connected with another, we mean only that they have acquired a connexion in our thought, and give rise to this inference, by which they become proofs of each other's existence: a conclusion which is somewhat extraordinary, but which seems founded on sufficient evidence. Nor will its evidence be weakened by any general diffidence of the understanding, or sceptical suspicion concerning every con-

clusion which is new and extraordinary. No conclusions can be more agreeable to scepticism than such as make discoveries concerning the weakness and narrow limits of human reason and capacity.

除了目前的观点，对于理解过程的惊人的无知和缺陷，我们还能得出更有说服力的结论吗？可以肯定的是，如果事物之间有什么需要我们彻底理解的关系，那必定是因果关系。我们关于实际的事实和存在的一切推理都建立在这种关系之上。仅凭因果关系的存在，我们就能对不在我们感官和记忆中的事物获得确切的认识。一切科学唯一直接的用途，在于教会我们如何利用事物的原因对未来的事物进行控制和管理。所以我们所有

And what stronger instance can be produced of the surprising ignorance and weakness of the understanding than the present? For surely, if there be any relation among objects which it imports to us to know perfectly, it is that of cause and effect. On this are founded all our reasonings concerning matter of fact or existence. By means of it alone we attain any assurance concerning objects which are removed from

的思想和研究在任何时候都用在这一关系之上。但是，我们在这个问题上形成的观念还十分浅陋，除了从一些无关的外在事物中得出一些推论之外，不可能对原因作出恰当的定义。相似的事物总是伴随出现，对此我们有经验。按照这个经验，我们或许把原因定义为引起另一事物之事物，与第一种事物相似的所有事物必然引起和第二种事物相似的事物。或者换句话说，没有第一种事物，第二种就根本不会出现。原因的出现总是通过习惯性过渡把思想引向结果的观念。对此我们也有经验。根据这个经验，我们或许就会为原因下另一个定义，将其称之为引起另一事物之事物，它的出现总是把思想引向另一事物的观念。虽然这两种定义都是从与原因无关的事物中得出来的，但是我们也无法弥

the present testimony of our memory and senses. The only immediate utility of all sciences, is to teach us, how to control and regulate future events by their causes. Our thoughts and enquiries are, therefore, every moment, employed about this relation; yet so imperfect are the ideas which we form concerning it, that it is impossible to give any just definition of cause, except what is drawn from something extraneous and foreign to it. Similar objects are always conjoined with similar. Of this we have experience. Suitably to this experience, therefore, we may define a cause to be an object, followed by another, and where all the objects similar to the first are followed by objects

补这个不足，或者给出更完美的定义，以真正呈现与原因相关的情形，揭示出它与结果之间的联系。然而，当我们尝试解释这一联系的时候，我们不知道这个联系是什么，甚至对我们想知道什么都没有一个清晰的观念。比如，我们说，这根琴弦的颤动产生了某个具体声音。但是这样说是什么意思？我们要么指的是，琴弦颤动之后出现了这个声音，所有类似的颤动都出现了类似的声音，要么是说，琴弦颤动之后出现了这个声音，看见类似的琴弦颤动，我们的思想就会调动我们的感官，使之立刻产生类似声音的观念。我们可以从两个角度中任意一个角度考虑原因与结果的关系，除此之外，我们一无所知。[^7]

similar to the second. Or in other words where, if the first object had not been, the second never had existed. The appearance of a cause always conveys the mind, by a customary transition, to the idea of the effect. Of this also we have experience. We may, therefore, suitably to this experience, form another definition of cause, and call it, an object followed by another, and whose appearance always conveys the thought to that other. But though both these definitions be drawn from circumstances foreign to the cause, we cannot remedy this inconvenience, or attain any more perfect definition, which may point out that circumstance in the cause, which gives it a connexion with

its effect. We have no idea of this connexion, nor even any distant notion what it is we desire to know, when we endeavour at a conception of it. We say, for instance, that the vibration of this string is the cause of this particular sound. But what do we mean by that affirmation? We either mean that this vibration is followed by this sound, and that all similar vibrations have been followed by similar sounds; or, that this vibration is followed by this sound, and that upon the appearance of one the mind anticipates the senses, and forms immediately an idea of the other. We may consider the relation of cause and effect in either of these two lights; but beyond these, we have no

idea of it.^[7]

现将本章的推理概括如下：每一个观念都是现有的印象或情感的摹本；只要我们无法找到任何印象，就敢确证不会有相应的观念。身体或心理活动的任何单独的事例都不会留下印象，因而也不会产生动力或必然联系的观念。但是，假如许多相同的事例出现，而且相同的事物之后总会出现相同的事件，我们就开始有了原因和联系的观念。我们会感觉到一种新的情感或印象，即在我们的思想和想象中存在着一事物和与其通常伴随的事物之间的习惯性联系，这一情感正是我们追寻的观念的原型。因为既然这一观念来源于众多相似的事例，而不是任何单一的事例，说明它必然来源于众多事例与单独事

To recapitulate, therefore, the reasonings of this section: Every idea is copied from some preceding impression or sentiment; and where we cannot find any impression, we may be certain that there is no idea. In all single instances of the operation of bodies or minds, there is nothing that produces any impression, nor consequently can suggest any idea of power or necessary connexion. But when many uniform instances appear, and the same object is always followed by the same event; we then begin to entertain the notion of cause and connexion. We then feel a new sentiment or

例有所差异的情形中。但是这一习惯性联系或想象中发生的转移正是这两种情形的不同之处。从每个单个具体的事例来看，它们都相似。我们见到的两个弹子球相撞引起运动的第一个事例（再次借用这个典型例子）和现在我们可能见到的任何事例完全相似；唯一区别在于，我们当时不能从一事件推断出另一事件，而在我们有了长期的相同经验之后，如今就可以了。我不知道读者是否可以轻松理解这个推理过程。我担心的是，假如我再多费口舌，或者再做更详细的探讨，恐怕只能把这个问题弄得更加晦涩，更加玄妙。所有抽象推理中都有一个视角，一旦我们能荣幸地找到，它将引领我们在阐明主题的道路上走得更远，胜于滔滔不绝的文采和一切华丽丰富的辞藻。我们期望努力找到这

impression, to wit, a customary connexion in the thought or imagination between one object and its usual attendant; and this sentiment is the original of that idea which we seek for. For as this idea arises from a number of similar instances, and not from any single instance, it must arise from that circumstance, in which the number of instances differ from every individual instance. But this customary connexion or transition of the imagination is the only circumstance in which they differ. In every other particular they are alike. The first instance which we saw of motion communicated by the shock of two billiard balls (to return to this obvious illustration) is exactly

一视角，把修辞之花留给更适合用它们来装饰的话题。

similar to any instance that may, at present, occur to us; except only, that we could not, at first, infer one event from the other; which we are enabled to do at present, after so long a course of uniform experience. I know not whether the reader will readily apprehend this reasoning. I am afraid that, should I multiply words about it, or throw it into a greater variety of lights, it would only become more obscure and intricate. In all abstract reasonings there is one point of view which, if we can happily hit, we shall go farther towards illustrating the subject than by all the eloquence and copious expression in the world. This point of view we should endeavour to reach, and reserve the

flowers of rhetoric for subjects which are more adapted to them.

第八章 论自由与必然

Section VIII Of Liberty and Necessity

第一节

Part I

自从科学和哲学诞生以来，有些问题一直是人们热切探究和争论的对象。或许我们可以合理地期待，在这些问题中，争论各方至少本该在所有术语的意义上达成一致；而我们的研究，历经两千年之后，也本应能够从文字落到所争论的真实话题之上。对推理中采用的术语进行准确定义，使这些定义，而不是文字的声音，成为将来进一步研究和探索的对象，这岂不是非常容易的事情？但是，只要我们更仔细地思考一下这个问题，我们就会得出截然相反的结论。一个话题长

It might reasonably be expected in questions which have been canvassed and disputed with great eagerness, since the first origin of science, and philosophy, that the meaning of all the terms, at least, should have been agreed upon among the disputants; and our enquiries, in the course of two thousand years, been able to pass from words to the true and real subject of the controversy. For how easy may it seem to give exact definitions of the terms em-

期以来争论不休，但却一直悬而未决，仅凭这一点，我们就可以认定其中一定有模糊不清的地方，各方对争论涉及的术语各说不一。每个人的心智能力应该大体相当，否则大家在一起研讨和争论问题必定是最徒劳无功的事情。如果人们在术语上达成共识，就不可能在许久的争论之后还在同样的问题上众说纷纭，因为他们可以交流各自的观点，每一方可以对这些观点进行全方位的思考和权衡，以寻求能够战胜对手的论证。说真的，如果人们想要讨论人类才能远不能及的一些问题，例如世界的起源，智力体系或精神领域的组织方式等，那么他们在那些毫无意义的争辩中只能徒费力气，永远无法达成确切结论。但是如果所讨论的问题只是涉及日常生活和经验的任一方面，那我们可以想

ployed in reasoning, and make these definitions, not the mere sound of words, the object of future scrutiny and examination? But if we consider the matter more narrowly, we shall be apt to draw a quite opposite conclusion. From this circumstance alone, that a controversy has been long kept on foot, and remains still undecided, we may presume that there is some ambiguity in the expression, and that the disputants affix different ideas to the terms employed in the controversy. For as the faculties of the mind are supposed to be naturally alike in every individual; otherwise nothing could be more fruitless than to reason or dispute together; it were impossible, if men affix the same

见，只有含糊不清的表述才会使人们的争论悬置多年而未决。这些含糊的词句直至今在仍使论辩对手们保持距离，并且阻止他们相互了解。

ideas to their terms, that they could so long form different opinions of the same subject; especially when they communicate their views, and each party turn themselves on all sides, in search of arguments which may give them the victory over their antagonists. It is true, if men attempt the discussion of questions which lie entirely beyond the reach of human capacity, such as those concerning the origin of worlds, or the economy of the intellectual system or region of spirits, they may long beat the air in their fruitless contests, and never arrive at any determinate conclusion. But if the question regard any subject of common life and experience, nothing, one would think, could

长期围绕“自由和必然”的争议正是这样的情形。在很大程度上，如果我没有弄错的话，我们会发现，所有人，无论博学之才还是无知之辈，在这个问题上一直都坚守着同样的意见，而实际上只要对一些术语作出清楚明白的定义就会立刻平息整个争论。我承认这个争论已经在各方面讨论得太多，而且已经把哲学家们引入了一个模糊诡辩的迷宫。一个明智的读者若是只管自享安宁，在我们谈到这个问题时不闻不问，一点也不足

为怪，因为从中他既不可能获得教益，也不可能得到乐趣。但是，我们这里提出的论证或许能重新引起他的注意，因为我们的论证有足够的新意，至少可以保证解决部分争议，也不会用玄妙晦涩的推理打扰他的安宁。

因此，我希望证明，根据这些术语所具有的合理意义，所有人都认同必然原则和自

preserve the dispute so long undecided but some ambiguous expressions, which keep the antagonists still at a distance, and hinder them from grappling with each other.

This has been the case in the long disputed question concerning liberty and necessity; and to so remarkable a degree that, if I be not much mistaken, we shall find, that all mankind, both learned and ignorant, have always been of the same opinion with regard to this subject, and that a few intelligible definitions would immediately have put an end to the whole controversy. I own that this dispute has been so much

canvassed on all hands, and has led philosophers into such a labyrinth of obscure sophistry, that it is no wonder, if a sensible reader indulge his ease so far as to turn a deaf ear to the proposal of such a question, from which he can expect neither instruction or entertainment. But the state of the argument here proposed may, perhaps, serve to renew his attention; as it has more novelty, promises at least some decision of the controversy, and will not much disturb his ease by any intricate or obscure reasoning.

I hope, therefore, to make it appear that all men have ever agreed in the doc-

由原则，并证明迄今为止的整个争论仅仅是文字上的争论。下面我们首先讨论必然原则。

人们普遍认为，事物的所有活动皆由一种必然的动力所引起，每一种自然的结果都是由其原因中的能量精确地决定，而在每一种具体的情况下，不可能得出别的任何结果。每一运动的程度和方向都是由自然法则准确规定的，两个运动的物体相撞产生的运动就如实际的那样，不可能产生别的程度和方向的运动，就像不可能导致一种生物由此产生一样。因此，我们若要形成恰当准确的

必然的观念，必须考虑我们用这一观念描述事物的活动时它究竟从何而来。

显然，假如自然界的一切现象一直沿着下述方式发展，没有任何两种事物间存在相似之处，每一种事物都是崭新的，与此前的一切都不一样，这样的话，我们绝对不会产生一丁点儿必然的观念，或事物之间存在联系的观念。在这样一种假设的情况下，我们可以说一种事物在另一种之后出现，而不是一种事物引起了另一种事物。人类完全不会

trine both of necessity and of liberty, according to any reasonable sense, which can be put on these terms; and that the whole controversy, has hitherto turned merely upon words. We shall begin with examining the doctrine of necessity.

It is universally allowed that matter, in all its operations, is actuated by a necessary force, and that every natural effect is so precisely determined by the energy of its cause that no other effect, in such particular circumstances, could possibly have resulted from it. The degree and direction of every motion is, by the laws of nature, prescribed with such exactness that a living creature

may as soon arise from the shock of two bodies as motion in any other degree or direction than what is actually produced by it. Would we, therefore, form a just and precise idea of necessity, we must consider whence that idea arises when we apply it to the operation of bodies.

It seems evident that, if all the scenes of nature were continually shifted in such a manner that no two events bore any resemblance to each other, but every object was entirely new, without any similitude to whatever had been seen before, we should never, in that case, have attained the least idea of necessity, or of a connexion among

知道有因果关系存在。关于自然的推论和推理从此彻底终结，而我们的记忆和感官仅仅是一种把现实世界的知识引向我们思想的渠道。因此，我们的必然和因果关系的观念完全来源于从自然中观察到的统一性，相似的事物恒常地伴随出现，心灵由于习惯的影响从一事物的出现推断出另一事物。这两种情形构成了我们所谓的事物的必然观念的全部。事物恒常伴随出现，从一种事物推断出另一种事物，除此而外，我们没有必然和联系的任何观念。

these objects. We might say, upon such a supposition, that one object or event has followed another; not that one was produced by the other. The relation of cause and effect must be utterly unknown to mankind. Inference and reasoning concerning the operations of nature would, from that moment, be at an end; and the memory and senses remain the only canals, by which the knowledge of any real existence could possibly have access to the mind. Our idea, therefore, of necessity and causation arises entirely from the uniformity observable in the operations of nature, where similar objects are constantly conjoined together, and the mind is determined by custom to infer

the one from the appearance of the other. These two circumstances form the whole of that necessity, which we ascribe to matter. Beyond the constant conjunction of similar objects, and the consequent inference from one to the other, we have no notion of any necessity or connexion.

如果所有人都毫不犹豫地承认，上述两种情形确实出现在人们的自发活动和心理活动中，这就说明，所有人都认同必然原则，而迄今为止的一切争论，都是因为各自间互不理解。

If it appear, therefore, that all mankind have ever allowed, without any doubt or hesitation, that these two circumstances take place in the voluntary actions of men, and in the operations of mind; it must follow, that all mankind have ever agreed in the doctrine of necessity, and that they have hitherto disputed, merely for not under-

针对第一种情形，即相似事物恒常而有规律地伴随出现，我们或许可以从下面的论述中找到满意的解释。人们普遍承认，生活在不同国家和不同时代的人们，其活动都有巨大的统一性，人性的基本原则和行为方式并未发生改变。同样的动机总会产生同样的行动，同样的结果总会出现在同样的原因之后。野心、贪婪、自恋、虚荣、友谊、大方、公益心，这些或多或少相互混合、全社会普遍存在的感情，从人类文明之初直到今天，一直是人类社会一切活动和事业的源泉。你期望了解古希腊人和罗马人的情感生活、性情嗜好和人生轨迹吗？如果是的话，那就分别认真地考察法国人和英国人的性情

和活动吧，再把从后者那里获得的大部分观察发现转移到前者身上，这样做不会有多少差错。不同时空的人类有很大共性，历史在这方面并未向我们揭示任何新奇的东西。历史的首要功用是揭示普遍恒定的人性原则，通过展示各种境遇中人的活动，为我们提供可以进行观察研究的材料，我们藉此熟悉人类行为活动的源泉。关于战争、阴谋、分裂和革命的记载把大量的实验材料集合起来，政治家和人性哲学家从中提出各自科学领域的原理，就像自然哲学家通过相关实验熟悉植物、矿物和其他事物一样。亚里士多德和希波克拉底研究过的土、水和其他自然要素和我们今天所见到的自然要素之间的相似性，并不比波利比奥斯和塔西佗笔下的人和今天统治世界的人们之间的相似性更大。

standing each other.

As to the first circumstance, the constant and regular conjunction of similar events, we may possibly satisfy ourselves by the following considerations: It is universally acknowledged that there is a great uniformity among the actions of men, in all nations and ages, and that human nature remains still the same, in its principles and operations. The same motives always produce the same actions; the same events follow from the same causes. Ambition, avarice, self-love, vanity, friendship, generosity, public spirit; these passions, mixed in various degrees, and distributed through

society, have been, from the beginning of the world, and still are, the source of all the actions and enterprises, which have ever been observed among mankind. Would you know the sentiments, inclinations, and course of life of the Greeks and Romans? Study well the temper and actions of the French and English. You cannot be much mistaken in transferring to the former most of the observations which you have made with regard to the latter. Mankind are so much the same, in all times and places, that history informs us of nothing new or strange in this particular. Its chief use is only to discover the constant and universal principles of human nature, by showing

men in all varieties of circumstances and situations, and furnishing us with materials from which we may form our observations and become acquainted with the regular springs of human action and behaviour. These records of wars, intrigues, factions, and revolutions, are so many collections of experiments, by which the politician or moral philosopher fixes the principles of his science, in the same manner as the physician or natural philosopher becomes acquainted with the nature of plants, minerals, and other external objects, by the experiments which he forms concerning them. Nor are the earth, water, and other elements, examined by Aristotle, and Hippo-

crates, more like to those which at present lie under our observation than the men described by Polybius and Tacitus are to those who now govern the world.

倘若一个从遥远的国度归来的旅人，向我们讲述的人的故事完全和我们所熟悉的不同，比如说，那里的人们根本不懂什么叫贪婪、野心、复仇，除了友谊、大度、公益精神之外再没有别的乐子可寻。我们立刻就会发现这一切都是假的，他不过是个大骗子，就像我们听他吹嘘说见到过什么半人半马的怪物，什么龙啊，什么奇迹和怪事等等，就敢确信他在胡编乱造一样。如果我们要揭露历史上无中生有的杜撰，最有力的证据莫过于证明其中记载的某人的事迹完全违背自然

Should a traveller, returning from a far country, bring us an account of men, wholly different from any with whom we were ever acquainted; men, who were entirely divested of avarice, ambition, or revenge; who knew no pleasure but friendship, generosity, and public spirit; we should immediately, from these circumstances, detect the falsehood, and prove him a liar, with the same certainty as if he had stuffed his narration with stories of centaurs and dragons,

规律，在其具体的处境下，没有任何合理的动机会促使他做出那样的事情。库尔提乌斯在描写亚历山大时，说他有超人的勇气，敢于冲锋陷阵，单枪匹马向庞大的敌军发起攻击，又说他法力无边，抵挡得了千军万马的进攻，两项描写涉及的可信性都值得怀疑。对于人类动机和行为的统一性，就像身体活动中存在的统一性一样，我们是欣然和普遍接受的。

miracles and prodigies. And if we would explode any forgery in history, we cannot make use of a more convincing argument, than to prove, that the actions ascribed to any person are directly contrary to the course of nature, and that no human motives, in such circumstances, could ever induce him to such a conduct. The veracity of Quintus Curtius is as much to be suspected, when he describes the supernatural courage of Alexander, by which he was hurried on singly to attack multitudes, as when he describes his supernatural force and activity, by which he was able to resist them. So readily and universally do we acknowledge a uniformity in human motives

and actions as well as in the operations of body.

从长期的生活、大量的事务处理和社交活动中积累起来的经验对我们的益处也是同样的道理。它使我们了解人性的原则，帮助我们调整未来的行为和思想活动。在经验的指引下，我们从人们的行为、表情，甚至姿态中识得他们的习性和动机，再从他们的习性和动机中进一步分析和解释他们的活动。从长期的经验中得来的观察和发现为我们提供了认识人性的线索，帮助我们解开其中的难解之谜。我们不再被借口和表象所欺骗，明白人们的公开宣言不过是对某件事情做虚假的粉饰。尽管美德和荣誉被予以相当的分量和权威，但是人们常常自命拥有的公正无

Hence likewise the benefit of that experience, acquired by long life and a variety of business and company, in order to instruct us in the principles of human nature, and regulate our future conduct, as well as speculation. By means of this guide, we mount up to the knowledge of men's inclinations and motives, from their actions, expressions, and even gestures; and again descend to the interpretation of their actions from our knowledge of their motives and inclinations. The general observations treasured up by a course of experience, give

私，在公众和各种党派中绝对找不到，在他们的领袖人物身上很少见到，在不同阶层不同地位的个人身上则更罕见。但是，如果人类活动中没有统一性存在，如果我们进行的每一项实验都是不规则的、反常的，那我们就不能得出任何关于人类的普遍认知。我们在实践中悟出的经验无论多么精确，都无法派上任何用场。老农之所以比年轻的农夫更懂得农事，就是因为阳光、雨水和土壤在农业生产中存在统一性，而且老农从经验中获得了支配和指导农业生产的原则。

us the clue of human nature, and teach us to unravel all its intricacies. Pretexts and appearances no longer deceive us. Public declarations pass for the specious colouring of a cause. And though virtue and honour be allowed their proper weight and authority, that perfect disinterestedness, so often pretended to, is never expected in multitudes and parties; seldom in their leaders; and scarcely even in individuals of any rank or station. But were there no uniformity in human actions, and were every experiment which we could form of this kind irregular and anomalous, it were impossible to collect any general observations concerning mankind; and no experience, however accu-

ately digested by reflection, would ever serve to any purpose. Why is the aged husbandman more skilful in his calling than the young beginner but because there is a certain uniformity in the operation of the sun, rain, and earth towards the production of vegetables; and experience teaches the old practitioner the rules by which this operation is governed and directed.

但是，我们不能期望人类活动的统一性会达到所有人在相同情况下都会按照完全一样的方式行动的程度，不容许他们在性格、偏见和意见方面有任何差异和变化存在。无论在自然界的哪一个领域，这样的统一性都不存在。相反，通过观察各种人身上不同的

We must not, however, expect that this uniformity of human actions should be carried to such a length as that all men, in the same circumstances, will always act precisely in the same manner, without making any allowance for the diversity of charac-

行为，我们可以归纳出大量的人性原则，不过它们仍然在一定程度上以统一性和规律性为前提。

生活在不同时代不同国家的人们行为方式有区别吗？从这里我们可以认识到习惯和教育的巨大力量，从一个人的孩童时代起就对其心灵产生影响，逐渐将其塑造成某一特定的品格。男人和女人的行为举止有很大差别吗？可我们不正是从中了解到自然赋予性别不同的人以不同的性格，并将其稳定性和一致性传承下来吗？同一个人从婴儿期到老

年期，在人生的不同阶段，行为方式有很大差异吗？这为我们提供了空间，让我们可以对人类情感习性的逐渐变化进行观察总结，并归纳和提炼出不同时代通行的人性原则。即使在个体身上因人而异的性格特征，其影响也具有统一性，否则，即使我们熟悉他人，观察他人言行，也无法借此了解他们的性情，也无法指导我们更好地和这些人打交道。

ters, prejudices, and opinions. Such a uniformity in every particular, is found in no part of nature. On the contrary, from observing the variety of conduct in different men, we are enabled to form a greater variety of maxims, which still suppose a degree of uniformity and regularity.

Are the manners of men different in different ages and countries? We learn thence the great force of custom and education, which mould the human mind from its infancy and form it into a fixed and established character. Is the behaviour and conduct of the one sex very unlike that of the other? Is it thence we become acquainted

with the different characters which nature has impressed upon the sexes, and which she preserves with constancy and regularity? Are the actions of the same person much diversified in the different periods of his life, from infancy to old age? This affords room for many general observations concerning the gradual change of our sentiments and inclinations, and the different maxims which prevail in the different ages of human creatures. Even the characters, which are peculiar to each individual, have a uniformity in their influence; otherwise our acquaintance with the persons and our observation of their conduct could never teach us their dispositions, or serve to direct

我认为我们有可能发现一些行为，似乎与任何已知的动机之间都没有规则的联系，也不合乎那些早已被确认为支配人类活动的行为准则。但是，如果我们想知道如何判断这些不合规律的异常行为，我们或许可以参考人们在自然界或外部事物出现怪异现象时通常怀有怎样的情绪。不是所有的原因都会以同样的统一性引发通常的结果。一个技工，虽然只跟无生命的物体打交道，也可能实现不了自己的目标，正如一个政治家指导具有理性和智慧的人们行为时一样。

普通人按照第一次见到事物的情况来判断事物，他们把事物的变化不定性归咎于原因的不确定性，认为这种不确定性导致原因未能产生其常见的后果，尽管原因在发挥作用的过程中并未遇到什么障碍。然而哲学家们注意到，在自然的各个领域都存在大量的机理和原则，由于太细微、太隐秘不为我们所见。因而他们发现，异常或相反的结果至少有可能不是由于原因中偶然出现的意外引起的，而是由相反的原因的隐秘活动产生的。进一步的观察使得这一可能性变成了确

our behaviour with regard to them.

I grant it possible to find some actions, which seem to have no regular connexion with any known motives, and are exceptions to all the measures of conduct which have ever been established for the government of men. But if we would willingly know what judgement should be formed of such irregular and extraordinary actions, we may consider the sentiments commonly entertained with regard to those irregular events which appear in the course of nature, and the operations of external objects. All causes are not conjoined to their usual effects with like uniformity. An artificer, who handles only

dead matter, may be disappointed of his aim, as well as the politician, who directs the conduct of sensible and intelligent agents.

The vulgar, who take things according to their first appearance, attribute the uncertainty of events to such an uncertainty in the causes as makes the latter often fail of their usual influence; though they meet with no impediment in their operation. But philosophers, observing that, almost in every part of nature, there is contained a vast variety of springs and principles, which are hid, by reason of their minuteness or remoteness, find, that it is at least possible the

定性，他们指出，仔细检查后发现，相反的结果总是暗示其背后有相反的原因，总是从相互对立的原因中产生的。钟表停下不走了，一个农民能给出的最好的解释莫过于说钟表常常要出问题。但是，一个机械师很容易看到，弹簧和摆锤同样的力总是会对齿轮产生同样的影响；如果它没有产生同样的结果，可能是因为一粒尘埃让使其停止了运动。在观察多个相似的事例后，哲学家们会得出因果关系必然存在的结论，而某些情况下的不确定性是由相反原因的隐秘作用造成的。

比如，拿我们的身体来说，如果健康或疾病的征兆与预期不符，或是药物没有起到其惯常的功效，或者某个原因产生了异常的结果等等，哲学家和医学家对此并不感到惊讶，也不会因此受到影响，从而一概否定那些支配身体活动的原则具有必然性和统一性。他们知道人的身体是一架庞大而复杂的机器，隐藏着多种神秘的力量，这完全是我

contrariety of events may not proceed from any contingency in the cause, but from the secret operation of contrary causes. This possibility is converted into certainty by farther observation, when they remark that, upon an exact scrutiny, a contrariety of effects always betrays a contrariety of causes, and proceeds from their mutual opposition. A peasant can give no better reason for the stopping of any clock or watch than to say that it does not commonly go right. But an artist easily perceives that the same force in the spring or pendulum has always the same influence on the wheels; but fails of its usual effects, perhaps by reason of a grain of dust, which puts a stop to the whole

movement. From the observation of several parallel instances, philosophers form a maxim that the connexion between all causes and effects is equally necessary, and that its seeming uncertainty in some instances proceeds from the secret opposition of contrary causes.

Thus, for instance, in the human body, when the usual symptoms of health or sickness disappoint our expectation; when medicines operate not with their wonted powers; when irregular events follow from any particular cause; the philosopher and physician are not surprised at the matter, nor are ever tempted to deny, in general,

们不能理解的。在我们看来，身体活动常常显得很不确定，因此，一些表面的异常现象并不能证明，自然法则在身体内部活动和组织中没有得到最大程度的遵守。

一位哲学家如果注重观点的一致性，那么他一定会把同样的推理用到具有智慧的人

的活动和意志之上。如果对他人的性格和处境的特有之处非常熟悉，常常可以解释他们为什么会做出最反常、最出人意料的决定。一个通常对他人很体贴的人突然给你一个乖戾的回答，是因为他牙疼得厉害，或是饿了还没吃饭。一个愚笨的人显得出奇的敏捷，那是因为他突然撞上了好运气。即便有些时候，个人的某种行为自己和他人都无法解释清楚，我们知道人们的性格通常会有一定程度的不稳定性和反常情况。从某种形式上说，这正是人性恒常的特点，但是在那些没有一贯的行事原则、言行变化无常的人身上会显出一些更为特别的情形。尽管有这些表面的反常，人性的内在原则和动机依然具有统一性，正如风、雨、云和其他天气变化也受到恒常的规律所支配，只是靠人类的才智

the necessity and uniformity of those principles by which the animal economy is conducted. They know that a human body is a mighty complicated machine; that many secret powers lurk in it, which are altogether beyond our comprehension; that to us it must often appear very uncertain in its operations; and that therefore the irregular events, which outwardly discover themselves, can be no proof that the laws of nature are not observed with the greatest regularity in its internal operations and government.

The philosopher, if he be consistent, must apply the same reasoning to the ac-

tions and volitions of intelligent agents. The most irregular and unexpected resolutions of men may frequently be accounted for by those who know every particular circumstance of their character and situation. A person of an obliging disposition gives a peevish answer; but he has the toothache, or has not dined. A stupid fellow discovers an uncommon alacrity in his carriage; but he has met with a sudden piece of good fortune. Or even when an action, as sometimes happens, cannot be particularly accounted for, either by the person himself or by others; we know, in general, that the characters of men are, to a certain degree, inconstant and irregular. This is, in a manner, the con-

和探究不易发现罢了。

可见，不仅动机和自发行为之间的结合和自然界中的因果关系的结合一样具有规律

性和统一性，而且这一惯常的结合是得到人们普遍认同的，无论在哲学还是日常生活中，从来都不是争论的话题。我们正是从过去的经验中对未来做出推断，当我们指出发现过去总是一起出现的事物将来也会一起发生时，似乎没有必要再去证明我们从经验中得来的人类行为的统一性是我们对人类行为进行推断的根据。但是，为了更清楚地阐明这一观点，我们将简要地论证后一个问题。

stant character of human nature; though it be applicable, in a more particular manner, to some persons who have no fixed rule for their conduct, but proceed in a continued course of caprice and inconstancy. The internal principles and motives may operate in a uniform manner, notwithstanding these seeming irregularities; in the same manner as the winds, rain, cloud, and other variations of the weather are supposed to be governed by steady principles; though not easily discoverable by human sagacity and enquiry.

Thus it appears, not only that the conjunction between motives and voluntary ac-

tions is as regular and uniform as that between the cause and effect in any part of nature; but also that this regular conjunction has been universally acknowledged among mankind, and has never been the subject of dispute, either in philosophy or common life. Now, as it is from past experience that we draw all inferences concerning the future, and as we conclude that objects will always be conjoined together which we find to have always been conjoined; it may seem superfluous to prove that this experienced uniformity in human actions is a source whence we draw inferences concerning them. But in order to throw the argument into a greater variety of lights we shall

在一切社会中，人们之间都非常需要相互依赖，极少有人类行为是完全独立的，或无需考虑他人的行为，必须有别人的行动才能使个体的意图得以充分实现。一个独自劳作的最为贫穷的工匠至少也希望受到地方长官的保护，确保自己能享受自己的劳动成果。他当然还希望，把自己的产品拿到市场上，以合理的价格卖给别人，再用换来的钱从他人手里买回自己生活所必需的产品。随着人们的经济活动日渐广泛，人与人之间的交往越来越复杂，他们就会从生活中认识和了解别人各种有意识的活动，出于适当的动机，他们期待这些有意识的活动和自己的活

动是一致的。在得出所有这些结论时他们都以过去的经验为尺度，正如他们对外界事物做出推断时一样。他们坚信，人和自然界的一切事物一样，会继续按照他们已经发现的方式存在和活动。工厂老板从员工的劳动以及他采用的工具来判断某项任务的完成情况，如果他所依据的两方面的情况没有达到他的预期，他会感到同样惊讶。总之，人类生活中处处都是这种对别人的行为进行实验性的推测和推断的情形，任何清醒的人无时无刻不在这样做。由此看来，根据上述定义和解释，难道我们不能断言所有人从来都是认同必然学说的吗？

also insist, though briefly, on this latter topic.

The mutual dependence of men is so great in all societies that scarce any human action is entirely complete in itself, or is performed without some reference to the actions of others, which are requisite to make it answer fully the intention of the agent. The poorest artificer, who labours alone, expects at least the protection of the magistrate, to ensure him the enjoyment of the fruits of his labour. He also expects that, when he carries his goods to market, and offers them at a reasonable price, he shall find purchasers, and shall be able, by the money

he acquires, to engage others to supply him with those commodities which are requisite for his subsistence. In proportion as men extend their dealings, and render their intercourse with others more complicated, they always comprehend, in their schemes of life, a greater variety of voluntary actions, which they expect, from the proper motives, to cooperate with their own. In all these conclusions they take their measures from past experience, in the same manner as in their reasonings concerning external objects; and firmly believe that men, as well as all the elements, are to continue, in their operations, the same that they have ever found them. A manufacturer reckons upon

the labour of his servants for the execution of any work as much as upon the tools which he employs, and would be equally surprised were his expectations disappointed. In short, this experimental inference and reasoning concerning the actions of others enters so much into human life that no man, while awake, is ever a moment without employing it. Have we not reason, therefore, to affirm that all mankind have always agreed in the doctrine of necessity according to the foregoing definition and explication of it?

在这个具体问题上，哲学家们所抱的立场和普通人并无不同。不必说他们日常生活

Nor have philosophers even entertained a different opinion from the people

的方方面面都揭示了这一观点，就是在他们的思辨活动中，也极少有这一观点不显得至关重要的地方。倘若我们不能依赖史学家建立在过往人类经验之上的诚信，历史会成为什么样的呢？如果法律和政府形式不能对社会产生一致的影响，政治何以成为一门科学？如果特定的人格不能产生特定的情感，或者这些情感对于人们的活动没有恒常的影响，道德学的根基何在？对于诗人和作家，如果我们不知道他们笔下人物的行为和情感在角色扮演和具体情境中显得自然还是不自然，我们又有何理由对他们进行批判？因此，如果我们不承认必然法则，不承认从动机到意志活动、从个人品格到行为的推论，似乎将无法进行任何形式的科学研究和活动。

in this particular. For, not to mention that almost every action of their life supposes that opinion, there are even few of the speculative parts of learning to which it is not essential. What would become of history, had we not a dependence on the veracity of the historian according to the experience which we have had of mankind? How could politics be a science, if laws and forms of government had not a uniform influence upon society? Where would be the foundation of morals, if particular characters had no certain or determinate power to produce particular sentiments, and if these sentiments had no constant operation on actions? And with what pretence could we

事实上，我们看到自然和人性领域的证据是多么易于互相联系，共同组成一条连贯的论证思路，我们就可以坦然承认，它们本质上是相同的，来源于同样的原理。一个无钱无势的囚犯，想到监狱看守不近人情，再

employ our criticism upon any poet or polite author, if we could not pronounce the conduct and sentiments of his actors either natural or unnatural to such characters, and in such circumstances? It seems almost impossible, therefore, to engage either in science or action of any kind without acknowledging the doctrine of necessity, and this inference from motive to voluntary actions, from characters to conduct.

And indeed, when we consider how aptly natural and moral evidence link together, and form only one chain of argument, we shall make no scruple to allow that they are of the same nature, and de-

看看四面的高墙和铁栏，发现逃跑无门。为了获得自由，他宁愿在钢铁牢房上做文章，而不是去化解狱吏的铁石心肠。同一个囚犯在被押赴刑场之时，看见肃立的卫兵满脸的坚定忠诚，看见刀斧或绞架，就知道自己必死无疑。他的心头浮现出一连串的想法：狱吏不容他逃跑，刽子手手起刀落，他的身首分离，流血、抽搐以及死亡。这里呈现的是一连串的自然原因和意志行为，不过我们的心灵在从一个观念过度到另一个观念时并没有感到有什么区别，也不会对将要发生的事件感到不够确信，就像这一事件是由一连串原因和我们感官或记忆中的事物相联系，由我们乐意称为物理必然性的东西紧密结合在一起似的。我们体验到的相同的结合会对心灵产生相同的影响，不管结合在一起的事物

rived from the same principles. A prisoner who has neither money nor interest, discovers the impossibility of his escape, as well when he considers the obstinacy of the gaoler, as the walls and bars with which he is surrounded; and, in all attempts for his freedom, chooses rather to work upon the stone and iron of the one, than upon the inflexible nature of the other. The same prisoner, when conducted to the scaffold, foresees his death as certainly from the constancy and fidelity of his guards, as from the operation of the axe or wheel. His mind runs along a certain train of ideas: the refusal of the soldiers to consent to his escape; the action of the executioner; the sep-

是动机、意志或行动，甚或是某种形象、某种运动。我们可以改变事物的名称，但是事物本身的性质和其在理解过程中的作用绝不会改变。

aration of the head and body; bleeding, convulsive motions, and death. Here is a connected chain of natural causes and voluntary actions; but the mind feels no difference between them in passing from one link to another. Nor is it less certain of the future event than if it were connected with the objects present to the memory or senses, by a train of causes, cemented together by what we are pleased to call a physical necessity. The same experienced union has the same effect on the mind, whether the united objects be motives, volition, and actions; or figure and motion. We may change the name of things; but their nature and their operation on the understanding never

change.

一个我知道很诚实富裕的人，和我有深厚的友谊，如果他来到我家，周围都是我的仆人，我敢肯定的是他在出门之前不会拿刀捅我，抢走我的银质墨水台。我相信这样的事情不会发生，就像我相信我的新房子地基稳固、墙体坚实，不会垮塌。但是他或许会突然间莫名地发起狂来，就像会突然发生地震，把我的房子给摇垮一样。所以我改变一下假设，我会说我敢肯定这人不会把手伸进火里，放着不动，直到被火烧焦。我对这个预测信心十足，就像我同样敢肯定，如果他从窗口跳出去，在没有遇到任何东西阻挡的情况下，他不会停留在空中，哪怕是短暂的一刻。我们能猜想到的任何莫名的狂躁，都

Were a man, whom I know to be honest and opulent, and with whom I live in intimate friendship, to come into my house, where I am surrounded with my servants, I rest assured that he is not to stab me before he leaves it in order to rob me of my silver standish; and I no more suspect this event than the falling of the house itself, which is new, and solidly built and founded.—But he may have been seized with a sudden and unknown frenzy.—So may a sudden earthquake arise, and shake and tumble my house about my ears. I shall therefore change the suppositions. I shall say that I

不能证明第一种情况的可能性，因为这彻底违背了我们所知道的一切人性原则。一个人中午把装满黄金的钱袋遗失在伦敦市中心查宁十字街的步行道上，如果他设想一个时辰后钱袋还在那里，没有人动它，还不如设想钱袋会像一片羽毛一样飞走。半数以上的人类推理中有类似的推论，只是确信的程度或多或少，和我们对人们在此等情况下的通常行为的经验感受相对应。

know with certainty that he is not to put his hand into the fire and hold it there till it be consumed. And this event, I think I can foretell with the same assurance, as that, if he throw himself out at the window, and meet with no obstruction, he will not remain a moment suspended in the air. No suspicion of an unknown frenzy can give the least possibility to the former event, which is so contrary to all the known principles of human nature. A man who at noon leaves his purse full of gold on the pavement at Charing-Cross, may as well expect that it will fly away like a feather, as that he will find it untouched an hour after. Above one half of human reasonings contain infer-

ences of a similar nature, attended with more or less degrees of certainty proportioned to our experience of the usual conduct of mankind in such particular situations.

我常常想，既然所有人都毫不犹豫地承认必然原则在他们整个实践和推理中的作用，为什么他们不仅不愿意把这个观点诉诸于文，反而在不同时代都更倾向于表达恰恰相反的立场呢。我认为对这个问题可以按照以下的方式进行解释。如果我们考察物体的活动，以及从原因产生结果的过程，我们发现我们的智力对这一关系的最深远的知识，不过就是注意到某些特定的事物恒常地伴随在一起，而由于习惯的影响，我们的心灵会

I have frequently considered, what could possibly be the reason why all mankind, though they have ever, without hesitation, acknowledged the doctrine of necessity in their whole practice and reasoning, have yet discovered such a reluctance to acknowledge it in words, and have rather shown a propensity, in all ages, to profess the contrary opinion. The matter, I think, may be accounted for after the following manner. If

从一事物的出现过渡到对另一事物的信念。尽管关于人类无知的这个结论是在对这一问题进行最严肃地探索的基础上得来的，人们仍然强烈相信他们能够探索到自然界中更深刻的认识，发现因果之间存在的类似必然联系的东西。而他们再次反思自己的内心活动时，却又找不到动机和行为之间的类似联系，他们便容易假设，源自物质力量的结果和源自思想智慧的结果是有差别的。但是，一旦我们相信我们对因果关系的了解仅限于事物恒常会伴随出现以及心灵从一事物推断出另一事物，并且发现人们承认这两种情形普遍存在于意志活动中，我们或许更容易接受一切原因都有同样的必然性。虽然这个将必然归于意志决定的推理和许多哲学家所持的学说想矛盾，仔细思考后我们就会发现，

we examine the operations of body, and the production of effects from their causes, we shall find that all our faculties can never carry us farther in our knowledge of this relation than barely to observe that particular objects are constantly conjoined together, and that the mind is carried, by a customary transition, from the appearance of one to the belief of the other. But though this conclusion concerning human ignorance be the result of the strictest scrutiny of this subject, men still entertain a strong propensity to believe that they penetrate farther into the powers of nature, and perceive something like a necessary connexion between the cause and the effect. When again they

分歧不过停留在言语之上，并不是真情实感。在我们眼下讨论的意义上，必然性从未遭到任何哲学家的否定，我相信，它也永远不能被否定。人们或许可以声称，心灵从物质世界的事物活动中可以洞察更深刻的因果关系，一种不存在于有智慧的生物的意志活动中的因果关系。至于这个观点正不正确，只有经过检验才能确定，而提出这个观点的哲学家要让人信服，就有义务定义和描述这种必然性，为我们指明它在事物原因运动中的作用。

turn their reflections towards the operations of their own minds, and feel no such connexion of the motive and the action; they are thence apt to suppose, that there is a difference between the effects which result from material force, and those which arise from thought and intelligence. But being once convinced that we know nothing farther of causation of any kind than merely the constant conjunction of objects, and the consequent inference of the mind from one to another, and finding that these two circumstances are universally allowed to have place in voluntary actions; we may be more easily led to own the same necessity common to all causes. And though this reason-

ing may contradict the systems of many philosophers, in ascribing necessity to the determinations of the will, we shall find, upon reflection, that they dissent from it in words only, not in their real sentiment. Necessity, according to the sense in which it is here taken, has never yet been rejected, nor can ever, I think, be rejected by any philosopher. It may only, perhaps, be pretended that the mind can perceive, in the operations of matter, some farther connexion between the cause and effect; and connexion that has not place in voluntary actions of intelligent beings. Now whether it be so or not, can only appear upon examination; and it is incumbent on these philosophers

to make good their assertion, by defining or describing that necessity, and pointing it out to us in the operations of material causes.

事实上，人们从探索心灵的官能、理解的影响和意志的作用着手研究自由与必然这个问题，似乎本末倒置了。让他们先讨论一个更简单的问题，即物体的活动和无智慧物质的活动，看看除了事物恒常伴随出现以及心灵从一事物推断出另一事物这个发现之外，他们是否还能找到关于因果关系和必然性的任何观念。如果这些情形事实上构成了我们在事物中获得的必然性的全部内容，而且是人们普遍认为存在于心灵活动之中的，那争论就可以结束了，或者至少要承认这个

It would seem, indeed, that men begin at the wrong end of this question concerning liberty and necessity, when they enter upon it by examining the faculties of the soul, the influence of the understanding, and the operations of the will. Let them first discuss a more simple question, namely, the operations of body and of brute unintelligent matter; and try whether they can there form any idea of causation and necessity, except that of a constant conjunction of ob-

争论此后只是口头上的。但是，只要我们仍然冒失地以为，我们对于外界事物活动中的必然性和因果关系有更深刻的观念，而与此同时我们在心灵的意志活动中没有更深入的发现，这个争论就不可能有个了结，因为我们的出发点本身就建立在如此错误的认识上。摆脱自欺欺人的唯一办法就是要站得更高，考察涉及物质原因时科学的狭窄范围，让我们确信我们所知道的不过是上文提到的事物恒常伴随出现以及随之而来的推断。我们或许会发现，我们为人类的理解设定如此狭窄的限制是有困难的，但是，我们把这个原则用到意志活动上时却没有任何困难。很明显，这些活动和动机、情景以及性格之间存在有规律的关联，并且我们总是从一者中推断出另一者，我们就必须承认，我们已经

认同的那种必然性存在于我们生活的方方面面，以及我们行为举止的每一个步骤中。*

jects, and subsequent inference of the mind from one to another. If these circumstances form, in reality, the whole of that necessity, which we conceive in matter, and if these circumstances be also universally acknowledged to take place in the operations of the mind, the dispute is at an end; at least, must be owned to be thenceforth merely verbal. But as long as we will rashly suppose, that we have some farther idea of necessity and causation in the operations of external objects; at the same time, that we can find nothing farther in the voluntary actions of the mind; there is no possibility of bringing the question to any determinate issue, while we proceed upon so erroneous a supposi-

tion. The only method of undeceiving us is to mount up higher, to examine the narrow extent of science when applied to material causes, and to convince ourselves that all we know of them is the constant conjunction and inference above mentioned. We may, perhaps, find that it is with difficulty we are induced to fix such narrow limits to human understanding; but we can afterwards find no difficulty when we come to apply this doctrine to the actions of the will. For as it is evident that these have a regular conjunction with motives and circumstances and characters, and as we always draw inferences from one to the other, we must be obliged to acknowledge in words

自由与必然的问题是形而上学这一最具争议的学科中最具争议的问题，要调和二者之间的矛盾，我们无须多费口舌就能证明，全人类都认同自由原则，就像认同必然原则一样，而且迄今为止围绕这一争论都只是口头上的。在用于意志活动时，自由是什么意思呢？我们显然不是指行为和个人的动机、意愿和境遇之间没有什么联系，不是指一者与另一者之间没有一定程度的统一性，不是指我们不能从一者中推断出另一者的存在。这些都是明确且广为接受的事实。我们所谓

自由，只能是意志的决断之下作为或不作为的能力，换言之，我们想静就可以静，想动就可以动的能力。我们普遍认为，一个人只要没有身陷囹圄，没有被戴上枷锁，都拥有这一理论上的自由，这是没有争议的。

that necessity, which we have already avowed, in every deliberation of our lives, and in every step of our conduct and behaviour.*

But to proceed in this reconciling project with regard to the question of liberty and necessity; the most contentious question of metaphysics, the most contentious science; it will not require many words to prove, that all mankind have ever agreed in the doctrine of liberty as well as in that of necessity, and that the whole dispute, in this respect also, has been hitherto merely verbal. For what is meant by liberty, when applied to voluntary actions? We cannot

surely mean that actions have so little connexion with motives, inclinations, and circumstances, that one does not follow with a certain degree of uniformity from the other, and that one affords no inference by which we can conclude the existence of the other. For these are plain and acknowledged matters of fact. By liberty, then, we can only mean a power of acting or not acting, according to the determinations of the will; this is, if we choose to remain at rest, we may; if we choose to move, we also may. Now this hypothetical liberty is universally allowed to belong to every one who is not a prisoner and in chains. Here, then, is no subject of dispute.

不管我们怎样定义自由，我们都要小心谨慎地考虑两个必要的因素。一是我们的定义要合乎实际的事实，二是要和自身相符合。如果我们考虑到这些因素，把自由定义得清楚易懂，我相信所有人都不会有任何意见。

我们都承认，任何事物的存在都有原因，而所谓机会，一经详细检查就会发现，只是个消极意义的词，它不指自然界中存在的任何真实的能量。然而人们却声称有些原因是必然的，有些不是必然的。这便是定义的优势所在。让一个人来给原因下定义，而

定义中不包含原因和结果之间的必然联系这个成分，他若能在定义中把原因这个观念的来龙去脉讲清楚，我会立即抛弃整个争论。但是只要接受了上文的阐述，他们就完全不可能这样做。假如事物之间没有有规则地伴随出现，我们绝不会有因果关系的任何观念，正是由于事物的这种恒常伴随出现，才产生了理解中的推断，形成了我们能够理解的唯一联系。任何人在给原因下定义时如果不考虑这些因素，只能采用含混不清的术语或者套用与被定义的术语语义相近的词汇。^{*}而如果接受我们上文中的定义，自由，在与必然相对而不是限制必然的意义上，就等同于机会这一公认的子虚乌有之物。

Whatever definition we may give of liberty, we should be careful to observe two requisite circumstances: First, that it be consistent with plain matter of fact; secondly, that it be consistent with itself. If we observe these circumstances, and render our definition intelligible, I am persuaded that all mankind will be found of one opinion with regard to it.

It is universally allowed that nothing exists without a cause of its existence, and that chance, when strictly examined, is a mere negative word, and means not any real power which has anywhere a being in nature. But it is pretended that some causes

are necessary, some not necessary. Here then is the advantage of definitions. Let any one define a cause, without comprehending, as a part of the definition, a necessary connexion with its effect; and let him show distinctly the origin of the idea, expressed by the definition; and I shall readily give up the whole controversy. But if the foregoing explication of the matter be received, this must be absolutely impracticable. Had not objects a regular conjunction with each other, we should never have entertained any notion of cause and effect; and this regular conjunction produces that inference of the understanding, which is the only connexion, that we can have any comprehen-

sion of. Whoever attempts a definition of cause, exclusive of these circumstances, will be obliged either to employ unintelligible terms or such as are synonymous to the term which he endeavours to define. * And if the definition above mentioned be admitted; liberty, when opposed to necessity, not to constraint, is the same thing with chance; which is universally allowed to have no existence.

第二节

哲学争论中，最常见但也最受诟病的方法就是尝试用“一个假说对宗教或道德有危害”这种说法来批判这个学说。如果一个观点

造成荒唐的后果，这个观念一定是错误的。但是，如果一个观点会导致危险的后果，我们却不能因此肯定这个观点必然是错误的。我们应该完全避免这样的话题，因为它们不仅无助于发现真理，反而只能使争论的对手变得令人厌恶。针对这一点，我只是泛泛而谈，并不是宣称从中得到什么好处。我坦率地接受这方面的检查，并大胆断言，如上所述的必然原则和自由原则不仅合乎道德，而且绝对是维系道德的必要成分。

Part II

There is no method of reasoning more common, and yet none more blameable, than, in philosophical disputes, to endeav-

our the refutation of any hypothesis, by a pretence of its dangerous consequences to religion and morality. When any opinion leads to absurdities, it is certainly false; but it is not certain that an opinion is false, because it is of dangerous consequence. Such topics, therefore, ought entirely to be forborne; as serving nothing to the discovery of truth, but only to make the person of an antagonist odious. This I observe in general, without pretending to draw any advantage from it. I frankly submit to an examination of this kind, and shall venture to affirm that the doctrines, both of necessity and of liberty, as above explained, are not only consistent with morality, but are absolutely

必然性可以用两种方式定义，分别对应原因的两种定义，因为必然性是原因的关键部分。必然性要么指相似事物恒常伴随出现，要么指从一事物到另一事物的理解推断。现在，在学校、教堂和日常生活中，人们虽然没有明言，但普遍接受必然性在这两层意义上（本质上是同一种意义）属于人的意志的范畴，没有人会否认我们能对人类行为进行推断，或否认这些推断建立在我们对相似行为总是伴随相似动机、意愿和境遇的经验感受之上。可能出现分歧的地方只在于：一是可能有人拒绝把人类行为的这一特征称为必然性。但是只要意思得到正确理解，我认为用词的问题不会带来什么危害；

二是有人或许会坚持我们可能在事物作用中获得更深刻的认识。但是，我们必须承认，无论这一点对自然哲学或形而上学会产生什么后果，都不会影响到道德或宗教。我们若是断言在物体的活动中再没有任何别的必然和联系的观念，或许有错。但是我们归于心灵活动的只有人人都接受且欣然认可的东西。我们没有对正统理论体系中关于意志的看法做任何改变，只是对外界事物和原因的观点有所改变。因此，恐怕再也没有比这个学说更纯真无害的东西了。

essential to its support.

Necessity may be defined two ways, conformably to the two definitions of cause, of which it makes an essential part. It consists either in the constant conjunction of like objects, or in the inference of the understanding from one object to another. Now necessity, in both these senses, (which, indeed, are at bottom the same) has universally, though tacitly, in the schools, in the pulpit, and in common life, been allowed to belong to the will of man; and no one has ever pretended to deny that we can draw inferences concerning human actions, and that those inferences are founded on the ex-

perienced union of like actions, with like motives, inclinations, and circumstances. The only particular in which any one can differ, is, that either, perhaps, he will refuse to give the name of necessity to this property of human actions; but as long as the meaning is understood, I hope the word can do no harm; or that he will maintain it possible to discover something farther in the operations of matter. But this, it must be acknowledged, can be of no consequence to morality or religion, whatever it may be to natural philosophy or metaphysics. We may here be mistaken in asserting that there is no idea of any other necessity or connexion in the actions of body. But surely we ascribe

一切法则都建立在奖惩之上，这被假设为一个基本的原则，即这些动机会对心灵产生一致的、统一的影响，起到扬善抑恶的作用。对于这样的影响，我们想怎么称谓都可以；但是，由于它常常会导致相应的行为，它必定是一种原因，应该被视作我们这里论证的必然性的具体事例。

憎恶和报复的对象只能是一个具有思想和意识的人或生物。如果有什么罪恶或是有害的行为激起了这种情感，必定是因为这类行为和这个人相关，使他脱不了干系。人的行为本身是转瞬即逝的，如果行为不是出于行事人品性和性情的某种原因，那么即使好的行为也不会让他感到光荣，坏的行为也不会让他背上恶名。行为本身可能受到谴责，因为它违背了一切道德和宗教的原则，但是行事人无需对此负责。既然这些行为既不是源自这个人内心某种一贯的、恒常的品质，过后也不会存留类似的东西，人们就不可能

nothing to the actions of the mind, but what everyone does, and must readily allow of. We change no circumstance in the received orthodox system with regard to the will, but only in that with regard to material objects and causes. Nothing, therefore, can be more innocent, at least, than this doctrine.

All laws being founded on rewards and punishments, it is supposed as a fundamental principle, that these motives have a regular and uniform influence on the mind, and both produce the good and prevent the evil actions. We may give to this influence what name we please; but, as it is usually conjoined with the action, it must be es-

teemed a cause, and be looked upon as an instance of that necessity, which we would here establish.

The only proper object of hatred or vengeance is a person or creature, endowed with thought and consciousness; and when any criminal or injurious actions excite that passion, it is only by their relation to the person, or connexion with him. Actions are, by their very nature, temporary and perishing; and where they proceed not from some cause in the character and disposition of the person who performed them, they can neither redound to his honour, if good; nor infamy, if evil. The actions themselves may

把他当作惩罚和报复的对象。因此，按照这种否认必然性和事物原因的逻辑，一个犯下滔天大罪的人和新生儿一样纯洁无暇，其品行全然不会因其行为而受影响，因为行为和品行无关，无论他的行为多么恶劣，都不能用来证明他品行败坏。

be blameable; they may be contrary to all the rules of morality and religion, but the person is not answerable for them; and as they proceeded from nothing in him that is durable and constant, and leave nothing of that nature behind them, it is impossible he can, upon their account, become the object of punishment or vengeance. According to the principle, therefore, which denies necessity, and consequently causes, a man is as pure and untainted, after having committed the most horrid crime, as at the first moment of his birth, nor is his character anywise concerned in his actions, since they are not derived from it, and the wickedness of the one can never be used as a proof of the

depravity of the other.

无论人们的行为造成什么后果，如果他们不知道自己在做什么，他们的所作所为漫无目的，他们就不该为这些行为受到谴责。为什么呢？因为这些行为背后的逻辑是暂时的、只限于自身的。此类行为如果是人们在急躁中未经预想就实施的，他们受到的责备应该比那些出于故意的人轻一些。理由何在？因为脾气急躁虽然常常是人民心中一种恒常的原因或是原理，但是这种情况是间断性的，不至祸及整个品格。再如，人们悔过之后若能把生活和举止都改善一番，他的一切罪孽都可以洗尽。这又作何解释？我们只能说，行为之所以把人变为罪人，就在于它证明了心灵中罪恶的理念，而一旦理念改变

Men are not blamed for such actions as they perform ignorantly and casually, whatever may be the consequences. Why? but because the principles of these actions are only momentary, and terminate in them alone. Men are less blamed for such actions as they perform hastily and unpremeditatedly than for such as proceed from deliberation. For what reason? but because a hasty temper, though a constant cause or principle in the mind, operates only by intervals, and infects not the whole character. Again, repentance wipes off every crime, if attended with a reformation of life and

了，行为也就不再构成合理的证据，同样也就不能被视为有罪的了。但是，除非我们用必然原则来衡量，否则那些行为不可能构成合理的证据，因而也绝不可能构成罪恶。

按照同样的论证我们也可以轻易证明，依据上述我们都认同的定义，自由是道德中不可或缺的成分，离开了自由，任何人类活动都不再有道德的品质，也不能成为我们赞同或厌恶的对象。因为行动只有作为我们内

心的品格、激情和感情的外在流露，才是我们的道德情感的对象。如果我们的行为不是源于这些动因，而是由外在力量引起的，就不可能对其进行赞扬或批评。

我并不敢说我已经把关于必然和自由理论的所有反对观点都清除干净了。我能预见到，可能有人会从这里没有涉及的话题上生出其他的反对意见。比如，如果意志行为同样受客观事物活动中必然原则的支配，就可

manners. How is this to be accounted for? but by asserting that actions render a person criminal merely as they are proofs of criminal principles in the mind; and when, by an alteration of these principles, they cease to be just proofs, they likewise cease to be criminal. But, except upon the doctrine of necessity, they never were just proofs, and consequently never were criminal.

It will be equally easy to prove, and from the same arguments, that liberty, according to that definition above mentioned, in which all men agree, is also essential to morality, and that no human actions, where

it is wanting, are susceptible of any moral qualities, or can be the objects either of approbation or dislike. For as actions are objects of our moral sentiment, so far only as they are indications of the internal character, passions, and affections; it is impossible that they can give rise either to praise or blame, where they proceed not from these principles, but are derived altogether from external violence.

I pretend not to have obviated or removed all objections to this theory, with regard to necessity and liberty. I can foresee other objections, derived from topics which have not here been treated of. It may be

以说存在着一连串的必然原因，预先注定和决定了万物的原始动因直到每一个人的每一个意志决定。宇宙中哪里都不存在偶然，没有无缘无故的事物，没有自由。在行动的同时，我们也是行动的对象。我们所有意志的终极动力便是创世者，是他首先让这台巨大的机器运转起来，把一切存在安排在各自特定的位置，随后的每一事件都按照不可避免的必然性而发生。照此看来，人类行为就没有任何道德沦丧的情形，因为都源于如此美好的动因；而如果存在道德沦丧的情形，那么我们的造物主就脱不了干系，因为我们承认他是一切人类行为的终极动因和发动者。引爆地雷的人，无论他用的导火线是长是短，都应该对一切后果负责；同理，如果能够确定一连串必然原因，那么作为原始动

因，无论是人还是神，自然也是其他所有原因的作者，也应该为其后果担责，有过要遭到谴责，有功要得到赞赏。这一原则建立在我们明确的、不可更改的道德观念之上，背后有着我们观察人类行为的后果后得出的无可质疑的理由。这些理由同样应该对全知全能的神明的意志和企图产生更大的影响。人类可以推说受制于无知无能，但是造物主身上没有这些瑕疵。他预知、预定而且谋划了我们暂且称之为罪孽的一切人类行为。因此，我们要么宣布这些行为并非罪孽，要么把罪责归于上帝，而非人类。两种立场都同样荒唐，同样亵渎神灵，说明其背后的原则不可能是正确的，都会遭到同样的反驳。荒唐的结果若是必然产生的，证明其背后的原则同样荒唐，就如邪恶的行为证明其动机本

said, for instance, that, if voluntary actions be subjected to the same laws of necessity with the operations of matter, there is a continued chain of necessary causes, preordained and predetermined, reaching from the original cause of all to every single volition of every human creature. No contingency anywhere in the universe; no indifference; no liberty. While we act, we are, at the same time, acted upon. The ultimate Author of all our volitions is the Creator of the world, who first bestowed motion on this immense machine, and placed all beings in that particular position, whence every subsequent event, by an inevitable necessity, must result. Human actions, therefore,

either can have no moral turpitude at all, as proceeding from so good a cause; or if they have any turpitude, they must involve our Creator in the same guilt, while he is acknowledged to be their ultimate cause and author. For as a man, who fired a mine, is answerable for all the consequences whether the train he employed be long or short; so wherever a continued chain of necessary causes is fixed, that Being, either finite or infinite, who produces the first, is likewise the author of all the rest, and must both bear the blame and acquire the praise which belong to them. Our clear and unalterable ideas of morality establish this rule, upon unquestionable reasons, when we ex-

身是罪恶的一样，如果它们之间存在必然的、不可避免的联系。

amine the consequences of any human action; and these reasons must still have greater force when applied to the volitions and intentions of a Being infinitely wise and powerful. Ignorance or impotence may be pleaded for so limited a creature as man; but those imperfections have no place in our Creator. He foresaw, he ordained, he intended all those actions of men, which we so rashly pronounce criminal. And we must therefore conclude, either that they are not criminal, or that the Deity, not man, is accountable for them. But as either of these positions is absurd and impious, it follows, that the doctrine from which they are deduced cannot possibly be true, as being li-

able to all the same objections. An absurd consequence, if necessary, proves the original doctrine to be absurd; in the same manner as criminal actions render criminal the original cause, if the connexion between them be necessary and inevitable.

这个反对意见包含两个方面，我们分开讨论。第一，如果可以经由一串必然的线索把人类行为的动机追溯到上帝，那么其中就绝不会有罪恶存在，因为作为行为之源的上帝尽善尽美，上帝意旨中的一切都是好的、值得称颂的。第二，如果人类行为存在罪恶，我们就必须收回上帝尽善尽美的观点，并且承认上帝是其创造的一切生命的罪恶和道德沦丧的根源。

This objection consists of two parts, which we shall examine separately. First, that, if human actions can be traced up, by a necessary chain, to the Deity, they can never be criminal; on account of the infinite perfection of that Being from whom they are derived, and who can intend nothing but what is altogether good and laudable. Or, Secondly, if they be criminal, we must

retract the attribute of perfection, which we ascribe to the Deity, and must acknowledge him to be the ultimate author of guilt and moral turpitude in all his creatures.

对第一种反对意见的回答似乎很明确而且具有说服力。许多哲学家在仔细研究各种自然现象后认为，宇宙整体，作为一个完整的系统，在其各个存在阶段都具备完美的仁德；一切造物最终会享有最大限度的幸福，其中不会掺杂任何积极的或绝对的罪孽和苦难。他们说，每一种罪孽都是这个仁慈系统不可或缺的部分，即使被视为具有无上智慧的上帝本身也不可能清除这些罪孽，不然可能会导致更大的罪孽，或把由此产生的更大的良善排除出去。正是从这种理论中，一些

The answer to the first objection seems obvious and convincing. There are many philosophers who, after an exact scrutiny of all the phenomena of nature, conclude, that the WHOLE, considered as one system, is, in every period of its existence, ordered with perfect benevolence; and that the utmost possible happiness will, in the end, result to all created beings, without any mixture of positive or absolute ill or misery. Every physical ill, say they, makes an essen-

哲学家和其他斯多葛派学者提出了从一切苦难中得到慰藉的观点。他们教导弟子说，他们忍受的各种罪孽其实都是宇宙中的善，从一种囊括整个自然体系的广阔角度来看，每一种事物都成为我们欢欣和愉悦的对象。尽管这个论调听起来冠冕堂皇，但很快就被证实是脆弱且不中用的。如果你向一位受痛风折磨的病人宣称说，他体内的毒素通过适当的渠道排出来，到达肌腱和神经，引起了剧烈疼痛，但这都是合理的法则在起作用，恐怕不仅不能让他感到平静，反而会让他恼怒不已。这些夸张的观点可以在短时间内取悦一个安定自在的思辨者的想象。但是，就算他不受痛苦和激情的干扰，这些东西也不会在他心中长久存留，更不用说，在受到这些强敌攻击的时候就更不能守得住阵脚了。我

tial part of this benevolent system, and could not possibly be removed, even by the Deity himself, considered as a wise agent, without giving entrance to greater ill, or excluding greater good, which will result from it. From this theory, some philosophers, and the ancient Stoics among the rest, derived a topic of consolation under all afflictions, while they taught their pupils that those ills under which they laboured were, in reality, goods to the universe; and that to an enlarged view, which could comprehend the whole system of nature, every event became an object of joy and exultation. But though this topic be specious and sublime, it was soon found in practice weak and inef-

们的情感通常是以更自然的方式看到事物更狭窄的一面。再者，由于人类心灵的脆弱，我们的情感也只能关注自身周围的事物，受到那些对于我们自身而言或好或坏的事情的影响。

fectual. You would surely more irritate than appease a man lying under the racking pains of the gout by preaching up to him the rectitude of those general laws, which produced the malignant humours in his body, and led them through the proper canals, to the sinews and nerves, where they now excite such acute torments. These enlarged views may, for a moment, please the imagination of a speculative man, who is placed in ease and security; but neither can they dwell with constancy on his mind, even though undisturbed by the emotions of pain or passion; much less can they maintain their ground when attacked by such powerful antagonists. The affections take a nar-

rower and more natural survey of their object; and by an economy, more suitable to the infirmity of human minds, regard alone the beings around us, and are actuated by such events as appear good or ill to the private system.

道德方面的问题和身体疾病是同样的道理。我们并不认为，那些远离主题的考究对一个方面影响很小，却能在另一方面产生大得多的影响。人类心灵的天性是，只要遇见特定的品格、性情和行为，立刻就会流露出认同感或责备感。对于心灵的结构和成分来说，再没有比这些情感更重要的了。引起我们认同感的品格通常是有利于社会的和睦安宁的，而激起我们反感的则是扰乱和危害公

The case is the same with moral as with physical ill. It cannot reasonably be supposed, that those remote considerations, which are found of so little efficacy with regard to one, will have a more powerful influence with regard to the other. The mind of man is so formed by nature that, upon the appearance of certain characters, dispositions, and actions, it immediately feels

共利益的。因此我们可以合理地推论，道德情操直接或间接地来源于对上述两种相反利益的反思。但是，如果哲学思考提出了不同的意见和推测，认为世间一切对于整体而言都是合理的存在，扰乱社会的事物基本都是有益的，和直接促进社会福祉安宁的事物同样符合自然的意愿，那又怎么办呢？这些遥远而不确定的思想能够与我们自然、直接观察事物获得的情感相抗衡吗？一个被抢走了大笔金钱的人会因为这些崇高的反思而减少这一损失给他带来的痛苦吗？为什么说他对犯罪的反感和这些反思不相容？或者，为什么说承认善恶之间真正存在区别，就和一切思辨哲学的理念不相容，我们不是也承认身体有美丑之分吗？这两种区别都建立在人的心灵的自然情感之上，不受任何哲学理论和

思辨的控制，也不因其而改变。

the sentiment of approbation or blame; nor are there any emotions more essential to its frame and constitution. The characters which engage our approbation are chiefly such as contribute to the peace and security of human society; as the characters which excite blame are chiefly such as tend to public detriment and disturbance; whence it may reasonably be presumed, that the moral sentiments arise, either mediately or immediately, from a reflection of these opposite interests. What though philosophical meditations establish a different opinion or conjecture; that everything is right with regard to the WHOLE, and that the qualities, which disturb society, are, in the main, as

beneficial, and are as suitable to the primary intention of nature as those which more directly promote its happiness and welfare? Are such remote and uncertain speculations able to counterbalance the sentiments which arise from the natural and immediate view of the objects? A man who is robbed of a considerable sum; does he find his vexation for the loss anywise diminished by these sublime reflections? Why then should his moral resentment against the crime be supposed incompatible with them? Or why should not the acknowledgment of a real distinction between vice and virtue be reconcileable to all speculative systems of philosophy, as well as that of a

real distinction between personal beauty and deformity? Both these distinctions are founded in the natural sentiments of the human mind, and these sentiments are not to be controuled or altered by any philosophical theory or speculation whatsoever.

对于第二个反对意见，不容易提出满意的回答，也不可能清楚地解释，为什么上帝既然是人的一切行为的间接原因，却又不是人类罪孽和道德沦丧的根源。这些神秘的话题不适合用自然的、无助的理性来探讨。无论理性选择什么系统，都会发现在这些话题上每前行一步，自身就会陷入难言的困境甚至是矛盾中。要调和人类行为的随意性、偶然性和先知先觉性，或者既要捍卫上帝的绝

The second objection admits not of so easy and satisfactory an answer; nor is it possible to explain distinctly, how the Deity can be the mediate cause of all the actions of men, without being the author of sin and moral turpitude. These are mysteries, which mere natural and unassisted reason is very unfit to handle; and whatever system she embraces, she must find herself involved in

对旨意，又要免去上帝的一切罪责，迄今为止的所有哲学都不能办到。因此，如果理性意识到在探索这些崇高的神秘话题中自身的冒失，离开这个充满了晦涩而迷惑的领地，谦逊地回到真正属于自身的领地，回到对日常生活的探索之中，也不失为值得庆幸的事。在这块领地上，理性能够找到足以让她探究的难题，而不至于陷入一片充满疑虑、不安和矛盾的汪洋大海。

inextricable difficulties, and even contradictions, at every step which she takes with regard to such subjects. To reconcile the indifference and contingency of human actions with prescience; or to defend absolute decrees, and yet free the Deity from being the author of sin, has been found hitherto to exceed all the power of philosophy. Happy, if she be thence sensible of her temerity, when she pries into these sublime mysteries; and leaving a scene so full of obscurities and perplexities, return, with suitable modesty, to her true and proper province, the examination of common life; where she will find difficulties enough to employ her enquiries, without launching into so boundless an

ocean of doubt, uncertainty, and contradiction!

第九章 论动物的理性

我们关于实际的事实的所有推理都建立在一种类比推理之上。正是因为类比，我们才期待某一原因产生的结果和我们先前从相似原因中见到的结果一样。如果原因完全相似，类比性就是完全正确的，由此得出的结论也就确定无疑。任何人见到一块铁，都不会怀疑铁块是有重量的，也不会怀疑其各个成分是坚固粘合的，因为他曾经见过的所有铁块都是这样。但是，如果事物之间的相似性不是如此精确，二者之间的类比性就不高，得出的结论也就不确定，尽管这样的结论也会因二者的相似性程度而具有相当的有效性。按照这种推论，我们从一种动物身上观察到的解剖学知识同样适用于其他所有动

Section IX Of the Reason of Animals

All our reasonings concerning matter of fact are founded on a species of Analogy, which leads us to expect from any cause the same events, which we have observed to result from similar causes. Where the causes are entirely similar, the analogy is perfect, and the inference, drawn from it, is regarded as certain and conclusive. Nor does any man ever entertain a doubt, where he sees a piece of iron, that it will have weight and cohesion of parts; as in all other instances, which have ever fallen under his observation. But where the objects have not so exact a similarity, the analogy is less per-

物。如果在蛙类或鱼类动物体内发现血液循环，显然我们可以据此做出有力的假设，即所有动物体内都在进行血液循环。我们可以把从解剖学中的发现推延开来，甚至应用到我们正在研究的领域中来。如果我们发现，我们用来解释理解活动或者人的情感来源和联系的任何理论，在解释其他所有动物中同样的现象时照样适用，而且必不可少，那么这个理论就会更具有权威性。我们不妨拿上文中用于解释经验推理的假设来做尝试，希望这个新的观点能够证明我们先前所有的论述。

fect, and the inference is less conclusive; though still it has some force, in proportion to the degree of similarity and resemblance. The anatomical observations, formed upon one animal, are, by this species of reasoning, extended to all animals; and it is certain, that when the circulation of the blood, for instance, is clearly proved to have place in one creature, as a frog, or fish, it forms a strong presumption, that the same principle has place in all. These analogical observations may be carried farther, even to this science, of which we are now treating; and any theory, by which we explain the operations of the understanding, or the origin and connexion of the passions in man, will

acquire additional authority, if we find, that the same theory is requisite to explain the same phenomena in all other animals. We shall make trial of this, with regard to the hypothesis, by which we have, in the foregoing discourse, endeavoured to account for all experimental reasonings; and it is hoped, that this new point of view will serve to confirm all our former observations.

首先，动物和人一样显然都从经验中学会很多东西，并推断出同样的结果源于同样的原因。用这样的方式，他们逐渐熟悉外界事物更为明显的特点，从生命之初开始，慢慢积累关于火、水、土、石头、高度以及深度的知识，以及它们的作用所能引起的结

First, it seems evident, that animals as well as men learn many things from experience, and infer, that the same events will always follow from the same causes. By this principle they become acquainted with the more obvious properties of external objects,

果。任何没有知识、缺乏经验的幼者和老练世故、经验丰富的长者显然不一样。通过长期的观察，长者已经懂得了如何趋利避害，并且追求让他们轻松愉快的东西。对田野熟悉之后，一匹马明白自己能跃过的高度，绝不会贸然尝试超出其体能的高度。一只老猎犬会把让它疲乏的任务交给年轻的猎犬去做，自己就呆在适当的位置，等兔子调头转弯的时候伺机扑上去。老猎犬在这种场合下的判断并不能依靠别的，只能来自它的观察和经验。

and gradually, from their birth, treasure up a knowledge of the nature of fire, water, earth, stones, heights, depths, &c., and of the effects which result from their operation. The ignorance and inexperience of the young are here plainly distinguishable from the cunning and sagacity of the old, who have learned, by long observation, to avoid what hurt them, and to pursue what gave ease or pleasure. A horse, that has been accustomed to the field, becomes acquainted with the proper height which he can leap, and will never attempt what exceeds his force and ability. An old greyhound will trust the more fatiguing part of the chase to the younger, and will place himself so as to

meet the hare in her doubles; nor are the conjectures, which he forms on this occasion, founded in any thing but his observation and experience.

从动物的驯养中得到的证据更明显。用适当的奖惩办法可以教会动物做各种事情，包括完全违背动物本能和性情的行为。你威吓一只狗，或者朝它举起皮鞭，难道它不是由于经验知道挨打会痛吗？狗对自己的名字有反应，一听到这个随意的声音，就知道你用这个名称指的是它而不是别的同伴，当你用某种方式、某种声调说出这个名字时，就知道你是在叫它。这难道不也是由于经验的缘故？

This is still more evident from the effects of discipline and education on animals, who, by the proper application of rewards and punishments, may be taught any course of action, and most contrary to their natural instincts and propensities. Is it not experience, which renders a dog apprehensive of pain, when you menace him, or lift up the whip to beat him? Is it not even experience, which makes him answer to his name, and infer, from such an arbitrary sound,

从所有这些情况来看，我们可以说，动物能够推断出直接刺激它的感官之外的一些事实。动物从眼前的事物推断出和先前的观察相符的结果，这一过程完全依赖于过去的经验。

其次，动物从相似事物中推测相似结果，知道自然界活动永远是有规律的，这个

推断过程不可能来自论证或是推理过程。如果真有一个这样的推理过程存在，那一定很深奥，超出了动物有限的认知理解能力，只有极具哲学思辨能力的人通过认真细致的研究才能发现这样的推理。因此，动物的结论不是靠推理指导而来的，孩子们也一样，普通人的日常活动和结论也一样。即便是哲学家们，他们的大部分行为活动也和常人无异，也受同样的行为原则的支配。大自然一定为我们提供了某种更便捷、更广泛实用的原则，毕竟从原因得出结果这样极为重要的活动，不可能交付给不确定的推理和论证过程来完成。如果对于人而言，这一点还值得怀疑，那么对于低等动物来说则是完全没有问题的。而这一结论一旦在动物方面得以确立，我们根据类比法则可以非常有力地断

that you mean him rather than any of his fellows, and intend to call him, when you pronounce it in a certain manner, and with a certain tone and accent?

In all these cases, we may observe, that the animal infers some fact beyond what immediately strikes his senses; and that this inference is altogether founded on past experience, while the creature expects from the present object the same consequences, which it has always found in its observation to result from similar objects.

Secondly, it is impossible, that this inference of the animal can be founded on any

process of argument or reasoning, by which he concludes, that like events must follow like objects, and that the course of nature will always be regular in its operations. For if there be in reality any arguments of this nature, they surely lie too abstruse for the observation of such imperfect understandings; since it may well employ the utmost care and attention of a philosophic genius to discover and observe them. Animals, therefore are not guided in these inferences by reasoning; neither are children; neither are the generality of mankind, in their ordinary actions and conclusions; neither are philosophers themselves, who, in all the active parts of life, are, in the main, the

言，同样的结论应该得到更普遍的认可，没有任何例外，没有任何保留。唯有习惯才让动物从刺激其感官的事物中推出其通常的结果，习惯在我们所谓信念的引领下，让想象得以发挥，从一事物的出现推断出另一事物。我们注意和观察到的一切高等和低等动物都有这种活动，而我们对此找不到任何别的解释。*

same with the vulgar, and are governed by the same maxims. Nature must have provided some other principle, of more ready, and more general use and application; nor can an operation of such immense consequence in life, as that of inferring effects from causes, be trusted to the uncertain process of reasoning and argumentation. Were this doubtful with regard to men, it seems to admit of no question with regard to the brute creation; and the conclusion being once firmly established in the one, we have a strong presumption, from all the rules of analogy, that it ought to be universally admitted, without any exception or reserve. It is custom alone, which engages an-

imals, from every object, that strikes their senses, to infer its usual attendant, and carries their imagination, from the appearance of the one, to conceive the other, in that particular manner, which we denominate belief. No other explication can be given of this operation, in all the higher, as well as lower classes of sensitive beings, which fall under our notice and observation.*

但是，尽管动物从观察中学到许多知识，却也有很多知识是自然赋予它们的。这些知识大大超过了动物在平常情况下具备的能力，而且它们在这一方面靠长期的实践和经验几乎得不到任何提高。我们把这些称为本能，羡慕其非凡的本领，是一切人类现已

But though animals learn many parts of their knowledge from observation, there are also many parts of it, which they derive from the original hand of nature; which much exceed the share of capacity they possess on ordinary occasions; and in which

理解的探讨都无法解释的。然而，如果我们考虑到我们和动物都具备的、所有行为所依赖的经验推理不过是一种本能或机械的能力，它在我们内在作用而我们意识不到，其主要活动不借助于观念之间的任何关系和对比，不像我们思考的对象一样。如果我们考虑到这一点，或许我们就不再对本能感到惊异，至少这种惊异感会减弱。尽管本能有不同形式，但都是本能，让人懂得躲避火的本能和让鸟儿准确地掌握孵卵、养育雏鸟的本能是一样的。

they improve, little or nothing, by the longest practice and experience. These we denominate Instincts, and are so apt to admire as something very extraordinary, and inexplicable by all the disquisitions of human understanding. But our wonder will, perhaps, cease or diminish, when we consider, that the experimental reasoning itself, which we possess in common with beasts, and on which the whole conduct of life depends, is nothing but a species of instinct or mechanical power, that acts in us unknown to ourselves; and in its chief operations, is not directed by any such relations or comparisons of ideas, as are the proper objects of our intellectual faculties. Though the in-

stinct be different, yet still it is an instinct, which teaches a man to avoid the fire; as much as that, which teaches a bird, with such exactness, the art of incubation, and the whole economy and order of its nursery.

第十章 论奇迹

第一节

提罗特森博士的著作里有一段反对“圣体实在说”的论述，对这样一个不值得严肃批驳的学说，算得上是简洁优美而又有说服力的论述。这位博学的主教说，人们普遍承认，经文和传说的权威仅仅建立在使徒们的证言之上，因为他们亲眼见证了我们的救世主用来证明其神圣使命的各种奇迹。这样看来，我们对于基督教真理的证据就不如我们用来证明感官的真实性的证据，因为即使在我们宗教的最初建立者那里，支持基督教真实性的证据也不会比支持感官真实性的证据更充分，而在他们向信徒们传递的过程中，证据

的真实性还会削弱。任何人都不至于相信信徒们的证言胜过相信自己直接感知的事物。但是，弱小的证据绝不能战胜强有力的证据。假如“圣体实在说”的确在圣经里有清晰的揭示，那就直接违背了合理推理的所有原则，我们无法认同。这也和我们的感官相矛盾。“圣体实在说”赖以传承的经文和传说所提供的证据并不像感官那样具备有力的证据，它们提供的仅仅被视作外在的证据，并不由圣灵的直接活动抵达每个人的心中。

Section X Of Miracles

Part I

There is, in Dr. Tillotson's writings, an argument against the *real presence*, which is as concise, and elegant, and strong as any argument can possibly be supposed against a doctrine, so little worthy of a serious refutation. It is acknowledged on all hands, says that learned prelate, that the authority, either of the scripture or of tradition, is founded merely in the testimony of the Apostles, who were eye-witnesses to those miracles of our Saviour, by which he proved his divine mission. Our evidence, then, for,

the truth of the Christian religion is less than the evidence for the truth of our senses; because, even in the first authors of our religion, it was no greater; and it is evident it must diminish in passing from them to their disciples; nor can any one rest such confidence in their testimony, as in the immediate object of his senses. But a weaker evidence can never destroy a stronger; and therefore, were the doctrine of the real presence ever so clearly revealed in scripture, it were directly contrary to the rules of just reasoning to give our assent to it. It contradicts sense, though both the scripture and tradition, on which it is supposed to be built, carry not such evidence

这种果断的论证是最方便的，至少足以平息最傲慢的偏执和迷信，把我们从其荒谬的蛊惑中解救出来。我庆幸自己找到了一种性质类似的论证。这个论证如果正确，将成为智慧和博学之士手里遏制各种迷信的永久利器，而且，只要世界存在，就会有用。因为我认为，只要世界存在，关于神迹和怪事的描述就会出现在各种宗教性和世俗的史书里。

虽然经验是我们针对实际的事实进行推理的唯一向导，但我们不得不承认，这一向导并非永远完美无缺，有时候会把我们引入歧途。在我国的气候条件下生活的人会期待六月任何一周的天气比十二月任何一周的天气好，这样的推理是合理的，也是符合经验的，不过他可能会发现自己弄错了。然而，我们可以说，在这个问题上他没有理由抱怨经验，因为经验常常事先用相反的情况向我们显示了天气的不确定性，只要我们悉心观察就会注意到。一切结果并非同样确定地由我们假设的原因所引起。有些事物不分地域

with them as sense; when they are considered merely as external evidences, and are not brought home to every one's breast, by the immediate operation of the Holy Spirit.

Nothing is so convenient as a decisive argument of this kind, which must at least silence the most arrogant bigotry and superstition, and free us from their impertinent solicitations. I flatter myself, that I have discovered an argument of a like nature, which, if just, will, with the wise and learned, be an everlasting check to all kinds of superstitious delusion, and consequently, will be useful as long as the world endures.

For so long, I presume, will the accounts of miracles and prodigies be found in all history, sacred and profane.

Though experience be our only guide in reasoning concerning matters of fact; it must be acknowledged, that this guide is not altogether infallible, but in some cases is apt to lead us into errors. One, who in our climate, should expect better weather in any week of June than in one of December, would reason justly, and conformably to experience; but it is certain, that he may happen, in the event, to find himself mistaken. However, we may observe, that, in such a case, he would have no cause to complain of

和时代，总是伴随出现。而有些则会发生
变化，有时甚至会出乎我们预料之外。因此，
我们关于实际事实的推理过程存在各种程度
的确定性，从最高程度的完全确定到最低程
度的经验证据，都是有可能的。

聪明的人总是根据证据来确定自己对事

物的信念程度。在依据无误的经验得出的结
论中，他对事件的发生抱有高度确信，把过
去的经验作为推断未来事物出现的绝对证
据。其他情况下，他会更加谨慎。他会认真
权衡各种相反的实验，看看哪一方由更多的
实验证实，再迟疑地选择这一方。即使到最
后他确定了自己的判断，他所拥有的证据不
过是我们所谓的可能性罢了。一切可能性都
意味着背后存在矛盾的情形和见解，其中一
方会压倒另一方，并根据其所占优势的大小
提供相应程度的证据。一方有一百次例证或
实验支持，另一方有五十次，就会让我们很
难预判事物的结果，但是，一方有一百次的
统一的实验支持，另一方只有一次，就让我
们可以合理地做出判断。任何时候我们都要
权衡对立的双方，矛盾之处在哪里，从大数

experience; because it commonly informs
us beforehand of the uncertainty, by that
contrariety of events, which we may learn
from a diligent observation. All effects fol-
low not with like certainty from their sup-
posed causes. Some events are found, in all
countries and all ages, to have been con-
stantly conjoined together. Others are
found to have been more variable, and
sometimes to disappoint our expectations;
so that, in our reasonings concerning mat-
ter of fact, there are all imaginable degrees
of assurance, from the highest certainty to
the lowest species of moral evidence.

A wise man, therefore, proportions his

belief to the evidence. In such conclusions
as are founded on an infallible experience,
he expects the event with the last degree of
assurance, and regards his past experience
as a full proof of the future existence of that
event. In other cases, he proceeds with
more caution. He weighs the opposite ex-
periments; he considers which side is sup-
ported by the greater number of experi-
ments; to that side he inclines, with doubt
and hesitation; and when at last he fixes his
judgement, the evidence exceeds not what
we properly call probability. All probability,
then, supposes an opposition of experi-
ments and observations, where the one side
is found to overbalance the other, and to

排除小数，以确定占优势的证据究竟有多大的精确度。

把这些原理运用到具体的事例中，我们可以说，最常见、最有用，甚而对于人类生活必不可少的推理莫过于从人们的证言、事

件的亲历者和见证者的报告中得来的推理了。有人可能会否认这类推理建立在因果关系之上。对此我不提出任何争议，只需要这样表述就够了：我们对于这类论证的确信程度不是来源于别的什么原则，而是来源于我们对人类证言真实性的观察，来源于我们对事实和证人言辞通常是相符的观察。一个基本的原理是，没有任何事物之间存在可以被发现的联系，我们从一事物到另一事物的所有推断完全建立在我们对它们之间恒常的、规律的伴随出现的体验之上。显然，我们不能把人们的证言当作例外，认为它不受这个原理之约束，毕竟人们的证言与某一事物之间，就像和任何另一事物之间一样，都没有必然的联系。如果不是因为记忆有某种韧性，如果不是因为人们普遍具有倾向真理和

produce a degree of evidence, proportioned to the superiority. A hundred instances or experiments on one side, and fifty on another, afford a doubtful expectation of any event; though a hundred uniform experiments, with only one that is contradictory, reasonably beget a pretty strong degree of assurance. In all cases, we must balance the opposite experiments, where they are opposite, and deduct the smaller number from the greater, in order to know the exact force of the superior evidence.

To apply these principles to a particular instance; we may observe, that there is no species of reasoning more common, more

useful, and even necessary to human life, than that which is derived from the testimony of men, and the reports of eye-witnesses and spectators. This species of reasoning, perhaps, one may deny to be founded on the relation of cause and effect. I shall not dispute about a word. It will be sufficient to observe that our assurance in any argument of this kind is derived from no other principle than our observation of the veracity of human testimony, and of the usual conformity of facts to the reports of witnesses. It being a general maxim, that no objects have any discoverable connexion together, and that all the inferences, which we can draw from one to another, are founded

诚信的天性，如果不是因为人们在谎言被揭穿后会有羞耻感，如果不是因为经验为我们揭示所有这些品质是深植于人性中的，我们就不会对人类的证言寄予丝毫信任。一个胡言乱语的人，或者一个以虚伪和凶恶而臭名昭著的人，丝毫不值得我们的信任。

merely on our experience of their constant and regular conjunction; it is evident, that we ought not to make an exception to this maxim in favour of human testimony, whose connexion with any event seems, in itself, as little necessary as any other. Were not the memory tenacious to a certain degree; had not men commonly an inclination to truth and a principle of probity; were they not sensible to shame, when detected in a falsehood; were not these, I say, discovered by experience to be qualities, inherent in human nature, we should never repose the least confidence in human testimony. A man delirious, or noted for falsehood and villainy, has no manner of authority with us.

来自证人和人类证言的证据，由于建立在过去的经验之上，其确定性也随经验而变化。依据某一报告和其报告的事物是恒常的伴随出现还是存在一定的变化，证人证言可能被当作一种确证或者一种可能性。在这类论证中，有许多情形需要考虑，而我们用来裁决一切由此引起的争议的最终标准永远来自经验和观察。任何一方只要出现经验并不完全一致的情况，显然会导致我们判断中出现不可避免的矛盾，并且像任何其他矛盾的证据一样，正反双方相互对立、相互抵消。我们常常在听到别人的报告时犹豫不决，我们会权衡造成疑虑和不确定的对立双方的情形。如果发现某一方占有优势，我们会选择

And as the evidence, derived from witnesses and human testimony, is founded on past experience, so it varies with the experience, and is regarded either as a proof or a probability, according as the conjunction between any particular kind of report and any kind of object has been found to be constant or variable. There are a number of circumstances to be taken into consideration in all judgements of this kind; and the ultimate standard, by which we determine all disputes, that may arise concerning them, is always derived from experience and observation. Where this experience is not entirely

这一方，当然，我们的确定性程度会根据另一方的力量大小相应降低。

就目前的情形来看，矛盾的证据有几方面的原因，可能是因为相互矛盾的证言，因为证人的品格或人数，因为他们陈述证据的

方式，或者由上述各种因素共同引起等等。如果对于任何事实，当证人的言辞相互矛盾，或者只有为数极少的证人，或者证人的品格值得怀疑，或者证人通过作证有私利可图，或者作证时显得犹豫不决，或刚好相反，他们表现得异常肯定等等，那么我们应该对他们提供的证据持有怀疑的态度。还有许多类似的具体问题，都能削弱或摧毁证人证言的说服力。

uniform on any side, it is attended with an unavoidable contrariety in our judgements, and with the same opposition and mutual destruction of argument as in every other kind of evidence. We frequently hesitate concerning the reports of others. We balance the opposite circumstances, which cause any doubt or uncertainty; and when we discover a superiority on any side, we incline to it; but still with a diminution of assurance, in proportion to the force of its antagonist.

This contrariety of evidence, in the present case, may be derived from several different causes; from the opposition of

contrary testimony; from the character or number of the witnesses; from the manner of their delivering their testimony; or from the union of all these circumstances. We entertain a suspicion concerning any matter of fact, when the witnesses contradict each other; when they are but few, or of a doubtful character; when they have an interest in what they affirm; when they deliver their testimony with hesitation, or on the contrary, with too violent asseverations. There are many other particulars of the same kind, which may diminish or destroy the force of any argument, derived from human testimony.

举例说，假设证人证言试图证明的事实带有非凡的奇迹般的色彩，那么，从证人证言得来的证据就要打折扣，其可信度或多或少与其试图证明的事实的异常程度成反比。我们之所以信任证人和史学家们，不是因为我们先觉地意识到在其证言和事实之间存在联系，而是因为我们通常发现二者是相符的。但是，如果要证明的事实是我们极少观察到的，就会出现两种矛盾的经验，二者相互竞争，强者战胜弱者，最后占优势的一方以其所剩的效力影响我们的心灵。这种经验原则，让我们对证人的言辞产生一定程度的信任，同样让我们对其试图证明的事实产生一定程度的怀疑。在这样的矛盾中，对立的双方必然相互抵消，各自的信念和威信相互毁损。

Suppose, for instance, that the fact, which the testimony endeavours to establish, partakes of the extraordinary and the marvellous; in that case, the evidence, resulting from the testimony, admits of a diminution, greater or less, in proportion as the fact is more or less unusual. The reason why we place any credit in witnesses and historians, is not derived from any connexion, which we perceive *a priori*, between testimony and reality, but because we are accustomed to find a conformity between them. But when the fact attested is such a one as has seldom fallen under our observation, here is a contest of two opposite experiences; of which the one destroys the other,

as far as its force goes, and the superior can only operate on the mind by the force, which remains. The very same principle of experience, which gives us a certain degree of assurance in the testimony of witnesses, gives us also, in this case, another degree of assurance against the fact, which they endeavour to establish; from which contradiction there necessarily arises a counterpoize, and mutual destruction of belief and authority.

“这件事哪怕是加图讲的，我也不信”，这句话在加图这位爱国哲学家^{*}还在世的时候就成了罗马的一句谚语。可见，难以置信的事实甚至能使伟大的权威失效。

I should not believe such a story were it told me by Cato, was a proverbial saying in Rome, even during the lifetime of that philosophical patriot.^{*} The incredibility of a

印度王子第一次听人说起霜的作用时，他并不相信，他的推理是合理的。这就需要
有坚实的证据才能让他相信霜是自然现象。
因为这是他不熟悉的，和他恒常体验到的事物之间存在很小的类比性。尽管那些现象和他的经验并不矛盾，但却是和他的经验不相符的。^{*}

为了增加相反一面的可能性，以驳倒证

人的证据，咱们假设证人断言的事实不仅令人惊奇，简直就是神迹，再假设这些证人证言自身就是完全令人信服的，这种情况下，就会产生证据之间相互对立的局面，其中最有力的一方会胜出，当然，其有力程度也会因对方证据的效力大小而相应减弱。

奇迹即是对自然法则的违背。由于这些自然法则建立在坚定而始终不变的经验之上，所以，反对奇迹的证据本质上和由经验得到的论证同样充分。人人都会死；铅不能靠自身悬浮在空中；火会燃烧木材，会被水

fact, it was allowed, might invalidate so great an authority.

The Indian prince, who refused to believe the first relations concerning the effects of frost, reasoned justly; and it naturally required very strong testimony to engage his assent to facts, that arose from a state of nature, with which he was unacquainted, and which bore so little analogy to those events, of which he had had constant and uniform experience. Though they were not contrary to his experience, they were not conformable to it.^{*}

But in order to encrease the probability

against the testimony of witnesses, let us suppose, that the fact, which they affirm, instead of being only marvellous, is really miraculous; and suppose also, that the testimony considered apart and in itself, amounts to an entire proof; in that case, there is proof against proof, of which the strongest must prevail, but still with a diminution of its force, in proportion to that of its antagonist.

A miracle is a violation of the laws of nature; and as a firm and unalterable experience has established these laws, the proof against a miracle, from the very nature of the fact, is as entire as any argument from

熄灭，为什么这些不仅仅是一种可能性？因为这些现象符合自然法则，要阻止这些现象，就得有打破这些法则的事物出现，换言之，就得有奇迹发生。任何自然而然发生的事物都称不上奇迹。一个身体健康的人突然死去，算不上奇迹，因为这种死亡的现象虽然比起其他死亡现象不太寻常，但也是常常会发生的。但是，如果死人复活了那就是奇迹，因为这在任何时代任何国家都没有出现过。所以，每一项奇迹必然是和我们恒常的经验背道而驰的，不然它就不值得被称为奇迹。因此，根据事实的本质来说，随着恒常的经验构成确凿的证据，就会对奇迹构成直接而完全的反驳。若是要摧毁这样的证据，从而把奇迹变得真实可信，就必须要有更具优势的反面证据。*

experience can possibly be imagined. Why is it more than probable, that all men must die; that lead cannot, of itself, remain suspended in the air; that fire consumes wood, and is extinguished by water; unless it be, that these events are found agreeable to the laws of nature, and there is required a violation of these laws, or in other words, a miracle to prevent them? Nothing is esteemed a miracle, if it ever happen in the common course of nature. It is no miracle that a man, seemingly in good health, should die on a sudden: because such a kind of death, though more unusual than any other, has yet been frequently observed to happen. But it is a miracle, that a dead man should come

to life; because that has never been observed in any age or country. There must, therefore, be a uniform experience against every miraculous event, otherwise the event would not merit that appellation. And as a uniform experience amounts to a proof, there is here a direct and full proof, from the nature of the fact, against the existence of any miracle; nor can such a proof be destroyed, or the miracle rendered credible, but by an opposite proof, which is superior.*

因此，明确的结论（也是值得我们注意的一个普遍原理）就是：“没有任何证据足以证明某个奇迹确实存在，除非这一证据足够

The plain consequence is (and it is a general maxim worthy of our attention), "that no testimony is sufficient to establish

强大，使得其错误比其试图证明的事实更加神奇；即便如此，正反论证会相互抵消，占优势的一方也只能在抵消弱势一方的效力之后带给我们相应程度的信任感。”要是有人告诉我，他见到死人复活了，我立刻会想，究竟是他在骗人或者被人骗了，还是他说的事真的发生了，哪一种可能性更大呢？我权衡这两种怪事，根据我对各自优势的观察来确定哪一件事更有可能，然后总是把更为荒诞离奇的一方排除掉。如果他的证据的错误性比他要证明的事实更加荒诞神奇，只有到了这个时候，他才能说得到了我的信任或支持。

a miracle, unless the testimony be of such a kind, that its falsehood would be more miraculous, than the fact, which it endeavors to establish; and even in that case there is a mutual destruction of arguments, and the superior only gives us an assurance suitable to that degree of force, which remains, after deducting the inferior." When anyone tells me, that he saw a dead man restored to life, I immediately consider with myself, whether it be more probable, that this person should either deceive or be deceived, or that the fact, which he relates, should really have happened. I weigh the one miracle against the other; and according to the superiority, which I discover, I pronounce my

decision, and always reject the greater miracle. If the falsehood of his testimony would be more miraculous, than the event which he relates; then, and not till then, can he pretend to command my belief or opinion.

第二节

在之前的论证中我们曾假设，某一奇迹所依赖的证据可能会构成确凿的证明，但证据的虚妄才真是更离奇荒诞的事。但我们很容易证明这样的让步太大，事实上任何奇迹都绝不可能建立在如此充分的证据之上。

Part II

In the foregoing reasoning we have supposed, that the testimony, upon which a miracle is founded, may possibly amount to an entire proof, and that the falsehood of that testimony would be a real prodigy. But it is easy to shew, that we have been a great deal too liberal in our concession, and that there never was a miraculous event estab-

首先，所有史书中都找不到有任何具有以下特征的奇迹：既得到足够的人支持，这些人又都具备毋庸置疑的理性、教育和学识，足以让我们相信他们的观点不可能出错；他们的正直也不必怀疑，足以让我们相信他们绝不会有任何骗人的企图；他们在人们的眼里都深受信任、德高望重，一旦被揭穿有任何虚妄，将会身败名裂；与此同时，他们必须在世界知名的地方公开地发表证言，任何弄虚作假都将会暴露无遗。要想让我们完全信赖人们的证言，以上这些都是必备条件。

第二，我们可能注意到人性中的一种原则，如果认真检查这原则，就会发现它能极大削弱我们对那些建立在人们证言之上的奇迹的信赖程度。这就是我们平常的推理过程所遵循的原则，包括如下几点：我们没有体验过的事物和我们体验过的事物具有相似性；我们发现的最平常的事物往往具有最大的可能性；如果两种论证相矛盾，我们应该优先考虑有更多的经验支持的一方。虽然从这个原则出发，我们能轻易拒绝任何在常理看来是荒诞不经、难以置信的事物，但进一步讲，我们的思想并不总是遵循这个原则。

lished on so full an evidence.

For first, there is not to be found, in all history, any miracle attested by a sufficient number of men, of such unquestioned good-sense, education, and learning, as to secure us against all delusion in themselves; of such undoubted integrity, as to place them beyond all suspicion of any design to deceive others; of such credit and reputation in the eyes of mankind, as to have a great deal to lose in case of their being detected in any falsehood; and at the same time, attesting facts performed in such a public manner and in so celebrated a part of the world, as to render the detection un-

avoidable; all which circumstances are requisite to give us a full assurance in the testimony of men.

Secondly, we may observe in human nature a principle which, if strictly examined, will be found to diminish extremely the assurance, which we might, from human testimony, have in any kind of prodigy. The maxim, by which we commonly conduct ourselves in our reasoning, is, that the objects, of which we have no experience, resembles those, of which we have; that what we have found to be most usual is always most probable; and that where there is an opposition of arguments, we ought to give

如果遇到被人们断言为荒诞离奇的事物，我们的心灵反倒非常愿意接受这是个事实，理由恰恰是那些本该让我们完全不相信这个奇迹的情节。由奇迹引起的惊讶和神奇是令人愉快的感情，它让我们从情感上更倾向于相信我们感到神奇的事物的确存在。更有甚者，即使那些没能直接体验到神奇之感，或者原本就不相信真有这些神奇的事物的人们，也都乐于间接地分享他人的快乐，并为自己能激起别人的羡慕之情而得意高兴。

the preference to such as are founded on the greatest number of past observations. But though, in proceeding by this rule, we readily reject any fact which is unusual and incredible in an ordinary degree; yet in advancing farther, the mind observes not always the same rule; but when anything is affirmed utterly absurd and miraculous, it rather the more readily admits of such a fact, upon account of that very circumstance, which ought to destroy all its authority. The passion of surprise and wonder, arising from miracles, being an agreeable emotion, gives a sensible tendency towards the belief of those events, from which it is derived. And this goes so far, that even

those who cannot enjoy this pleasure immediately, nor can believe those miraculous events, of which they are informed, yet love to partake of the satisfaction at second-hand or by rebound, and place a pride and delight in exciting the admiration of others.

人们是何等如饥似渴地聆听旅行家们讲述的那些离奇的故事啊！他们描述的那些海上、陆上的怪物，他们所吹嘘的那些精彩的冒险、怪异的人们、原始粗野的生活方式……但是，如果宗教情感和对神奇的热爱掺杂在一起，常识就没有生存的余地了。在这种情况下，人们的证言丧失了所有效力。一个信奉宗教的人可能是个狂热的人，他会想象自己见到了现实中根本不存在的事物。

With what greediness are the miraculous accounts of travellers received, their descriptions of sea and land monsters, their relations of wonderful adventures, strange men, and uncouth manners? But if the spirit of religion join itself to the love of wonder, there is an end of common sense; and human testimony, in these circumstances, loses all pretensions to authority. A

他或许知道自己讲的都是假的，但为了促进如此神圣的事业，他会带着善意的主观意图坚持自己的观点。即便他的虚妄没有被人接受，在强烈的诱惑之下，虚荣心对他的影响也远胜于在任何情景下对其他人的影响，而自我利益的作用和虚荣心一样强大。他的听众可能没有明辨是非的能力，通常事实上也的确没什么明辨是非的能力，因而不能对他的证据进行检查。无论他们还剩下多少判别是非的能力，在遇到这些崇高而神秘的话题时，他们都恪守原则，弃之不用。或者说，即便他们愿意发挥自己的判断力，受心中狂热的激情和想象力的影响，他们的判断力也不能正常发挥。听众的盲目轻信助长了他的厚颜无耻，而他的厚颜无耻又反过来征服了听众，使他们更加轻信。

religionist may be an enthusiast, and imagine he sees what has no reality. He may know his narrative to be false, and yet persevere in it, with the best intentions in the world, for the sake of promoting so holy a cause; or even where this delusion has not place, vanity, excited by so strong a temptation, operates on him more powerfully than on the rest of mankind in any other circumstances; and self-interest with equal force. His auditors may not have, and commonly have not, sufficient judgement to canvass his evidence. What judgement they have, they renounce by principle, in these sublime and mysterious subjects; or if they were ever so willing to employ it, passion and a

heated imagination disturb the regularity of its operations. Their credulity increases his impudence, and his impudence overpowers their credulity.

雄辩发挥到了极致，就不会给理性和思考留下多少余地，而是全靠调动人们的想象和感情来迷惑热情的听众，让他们丧失理智。幸运的是，雄辩很少达到这个程度。但是，一个西塞罗或一个狄摩西尼很少能让一群罗马或雅典听众接受的事情，一名嘉布遣会修士，每一名巡行的或站立不动的教士却可以调动普通人低劣粗俗的情感，让他们更加信以为真。

Eloquence, when at its highest pitch, leaves little room for reason or reflection; but addressing itself entirely to the fancy or the affections, captivates the willing hearers, and subdues their understanding. Happily, this pitch it seldom attains. But what a Tully or a Demosthenes could scarcely effect over a Roman or Athenian audience, every Capuchin, every itinerant or stationary teacher can perform over the generality of mankind, and in a higher degree, by

人们捏造的奇迹、预言和超自然事物不在少数，这些东西要么已经在各个时代被相反的证据所揭穿，要么由于自身的荒谬而不攻自破。这足以证明，人类是多么愿意相信神奇超凡的事物，同时这也应当促使让我们在面对所有类似描述时持一种怀疑的态度。比如在乡里和小镇最容易出现且传播最快的故事莫过于那些和婚姻有关的事情，你常常会听说一对门当户对的青年男女，甚至连第二次面都没见过，就被当地的乡亲们火速撮合在一起。正是因为讲一件趣事、传播这件趣事，成为最先讲述这件趣事的人之一，能给人带来快乐，才使得一件事很快传开来。众所周知，任何理智清醒的人都不会在意这

些传说，除非他发现更有确凿的证据可以证明它们。难道不是这些同样的感情，以及其他更强烈的感情，促使普罗大众热情饱满、信心十足地相信和传播一切宗教奇迹吗？

touching such gross and vulgar passions.

The many instances of forged miracles, and prophecies, and supernatural events, which, in all ages, have either been detected by contrary evidence, or which detect themselves by their absurdity, prove sufficiently the strong propensity of mankind to the extraordinary and the marvellous, and ought reasonably to beget a suspicion against all relations of this kind. This is our natural way of thinking, even with regard to the most common and most credible events. For instance: There is no kind of report which rises so easily, and spreads so quickly, especially in country places and

provincial towns, as those concerning marriages; insomuch that two young persons of equal condition never see each other twice, but the whole neighborhood immediately join them together. The pleasure of telling a piece of news so interesting, of propagating it, and of being the first reporters of it, spreads the intelligence. And this is so well known, that no man of sense gives attention to these reports, till he finds them confirmed by some greater evidence. Do not the same passions, and others still stronger, incline the generality of mankind to believe and report, with the greatest vehemence and assurance, all religious miracles?

第三，反对一切超自然的神奇故事的充分理由是，这些故事主要产生于无知蒙昧的民族，或者说，如果一个开化的民族里也有这种传说，那么他们一定是从其无知蒙昧的先民那里得来，是先民们带着不可冒犯的威信传承下来的，毕竟来自祖先的传说总带有这样的威信。翻开各民族早期的历史，我们很容易想象自己进入了一片新的天地，大自然处于混乱的状态，各种自然因素发挥着迥然不同的作用，那时的大自然和我们今天所见大不一样。战争、革命、瘟疫、饥荒、死亡，都不是我们体验过的自然原因造成的。在少数自然事件中掺杂着各种奇迹、征兆、神谕和审判的描述，使我们难辨这些事件的真相。但是，随着人类迈入开化的时代，这类描述逐渐减少，我们很快发现，其实根本

就没有神秘超凡的东西，一切描述都出于人们喜好奇迹的倾向。尽管这种倾向不时会受到理智和知识的遏制，但我们从来就没有把它从人性里根除。

Thirdly, it forms a strong presumption against all supernatural and miraculous relations, that they are observed chiefly to abound among ignorant and barbarous nations; or if a civilized people has ever given admission to any of them, that people will be found to have received them from ignorant and barbarous ancestors, who transmitted them with that inviolable sanction and authority, which always attend received opinions. When we peruse the first histories of all nations, we are apt to imagine ourselves transported into some new world; where the whole frame of nature is disjointed, and every element performs its operations in a different manner, from what it

does at present. Battles, revolutions, pestilence, famine and death, are never the effect of those natural causes, which we experience. Prodigies, omens, oracles, judgments, quite obscure the few natural events, that are intermingled with them. But as the former grow thinner every page, in proportion as we advance nearer the enlightened ages, we soon learn, that there is nothing mysterious or supernatural in the case, but that all proceeds from the usual propensity of mankind towards the marvellous, and that, though this inclination may at intervals receive a check from sense and learning, it can never be thoroughly extirpated from human nature.

明智的读者在翻阅那些神奇的史学家的书时不禁会感到奇怪，为什么他们描述的种种奇迹在今天都没有发生过。所有时代的人们都会撒谎，我觉得一点都不奇怪。你一定见过许多撒谎的例子，你一定听到过许多这类怪事，因为被所有聪明而审慎的人们所唾弃，最终连普通人也不再相信它。可以肯定那些弥天大谎，虽然传得远，信众多，开始的时候都是一样的，只不过它生存于更加适合的土壤，所以最后得以成为离奇的传说，这传播过程的荒诞程度堪比它们本身所描绘的奇迹。

It is strange, a judicious reader is apt to say, upon the perusal of these wonderful historians, that such prodigious events never happen in our days. But it is nothing strange, I hope, that men should lie in all ages. You must surely have seen instances enough of that frailty. You have yourself heard many such marvellous relations started, which, being treated with scorn by all the wise and judicious, have at last been abandoned even by the vulgar. Be assured, that those renowned lies, which have spread and flourished to such a monstrous height, arose from like beginnings; but being sown in a more proper soil, shot up at last into prodigies almost equal to those which they

relate.

尽管现在人们遗忘了亚历山大这个虚伪的预言家，但当时他却赫赫有名。他将帕夫拉戈尼亚作为其招摇撞骗的起点可谓机关算尽，因为正如卢奇安所说，帕夫拉戈尼亚的人愚昧无知到了极点，哪怕最卑劣的谎言他们也会不假思索地全盘照收。外地的人们信念不够坚定，虽然觉得这个事情值得认真研究，却无从获取更准确的信息。那些谎言通过上百种方式夸大其词地传到他们耳里。傻瓜们不遗余力地向他人传播这些骗人的鬼话；聪明博学之士则常常只对其荒诞不经嗤之以鼻，却没有设法找到具体的事实来批判和驳斥这些谬论。就这样，这个骗子得以从愚昧的帕夫拉戈尼亚人开始，壮大了他的追

It was a wise policy in that false prophet, Alexander, who though now forgotten, was once so famous, to lay the first scene of his impostures in Paphlagonia, where, as Lucian tells us, the people were extremely ignorant and stupid, and ready to swallow even the grossest delusion. People at a distance, who are weak enough to think the matter at all worth enquiry, have no opportunity of receiving better information. The stories come magnified to them by a hundred circumstances. Fools are industrious in propagating the imposture; while the wise and learned are contented, in general,

随者队伍，其中不乏希腊哲学家以及罗马社会中身份显赫的人士，他还甚至引起了圣明的罗马皇帝马可·奥勒利乌斯的注意，竟然使得这位皇帝把一次战争的胜利完全寄托在虚妄的预言之上。

从无知的人群中开始招摇撞骗有极大的便利。即便欺骗的行为太过昭彰，不能让普通大众全盘接受（这种情况虽然少见，却也

时有发生），但是谎言在偏远的乡下更容易让人相信和传播，在崇尚艺术和知识的城市则不然。那些未开化的、最愚昧无知的乡民会把谎言传向四面八方，乡邻中缺少见多识广的人，也没有具有十足的信誉和威望的人来批驳和揭穿这些谎言。在这里，人们喜好奇迹的倾向得到了充分展示。因此，一件荒谬的事，哪怕在其发源地就已经被普通人识破，也必定会传到千里之外。倘若亚历山大住在雅典，这个以学术闻名的城市的哲学家们立刻会把他们对于事态的认识传遍整个罗马帝国。他们的观点具有极大的权威性，并展现出理性和雄辩的巨大影响，一定会开阔人类的眼界。的确，正是卢奇安碰巧路过帕夫拉戈尼亚，才有机会行使这一职责。尽管我们期望这种巧合经常出现，但事实上不

to deride its absurdity, without informing themselves of the particular facts, by which it may be distinctly refuted. And thus the impostor above mentioned was enabled to proceed, from his ignorant Paphlagonians, to the enlisting of votaries, even among the Grecian philosophers, and men of the most eminent rank and distinction in Rome; nay, could engage the attention of that sage emperor Marcus Aurelius; so far as to make him trust the success of a military expedition to his delusive prophecies.

The advantages are so great, of starting an imposture among an ignorant people, that, even though the delusion should be

too gross to impose on the generality of them (which, though seldom, is sometimes the case) it has a much better chance for succeeding in remote countries, than if the first scene had been laid in a city renowned for arts and knowledge. The most ignorant and barbarous of these barbarians carry the report abroad. None of their countrymen have a large correspondence, or sufficient credit and authority to contradict and beat down the delusion. Men's inclination to the marvellous has full opportunity to display itself. And thus a story, which is universally exploded in the place where it was first started, shall pass for certain at a thousand miles' distance. But had Alexander fixed his

是每个亚历山大都会遇到一个时刻准备揭穿其谎言的卢奇安。

residence at Athens, the philosophers of that renowned mart of learning had immediately spread, throughout the whole Roman empire, their sense of the matter; which, being supported by so great authority, and displayed by all the force of reason and eloquence, had entirely opened the eyes of mankind. It is true; Lucian, passing by chance through Paphlagonia, had an opportunity of performing this good office. But, though much to be wished, it does not always happen, that every Alexander meets with a Lucian, ready to expose and detect his impostures.

此外，我还可以提出第四个理由来削弱

I may add as a fourth reason, which di-

奇迹的可信度。即便针对那些尚未被揭穿的奇迹而言，没有任何证据不是同时遭到无数证人的反对的，所以不只是奇迹本身摧毁了这证据的可信度，证据自己也毁灭了自身。为了更好地理解这一点，我们来思考一下，在宗教问题上，既然不同的主张就是对立的主张，那么古罗马的、土耳其的、暹罗的、中国的宗教不可能都建立在坚实的基础上。任何一门宗教所描述的每一种奇迹（这些神迹在各种宗教里比比皆是），其直接目的都是要证明这一宗教体系的合法性，显然它应该同时具有推翻其他宗教的作用，哪怕是间接的作用。在推翻对立的宗教的同时，它同样推翻了这门宗教的合法性赖以存在的各种奇迹；这样看来，不同宗教里的奇迹应该是相互矛盾的事实，而用来支持它们的证据，

minishes the authority of prodigies, that there is no testimony for any, even those which have not been expressly detected, that is not opposed by an infinite number of witnesses; so that not only the miracle destroys the credit of testimony, but the testimony destroys itself. To make this the better understood, let us consider, that, in matters of religion, whatever is different is contrary; and that it is impossible the religions of ancient Rome, of Turkey, of Siam, and of China should, all of them, be established on any solid foundation. Every miracle, therefore, pretended to have been wrought in any of these religions (and all of them abound in miracles), as its direct scope is to establish

无论强弱，都是相互对立的。按照这一思路，如果我们相信默罕默德和他的信徒们施展的任何奇迹，我们肯定可以找到一些野蛮蒙昧的阿拉伯人的证言来支持。另一方面，我们也应该以同样的方式对待蒂托·李维、普鲁塔克、塔西佗的话，总之，我们应该同样看待希腊宗教、中国宗教和罗马天主教里各自为自己的宗教讲述奇迹的作者和证人。我是说，我们应该以同样的方式对待他们的言论，仿佛他们提到了那个默罕默德奇迹，然后明白无误地提出了与之矛盾的观点，其确定程度不亚于他们对自己讲述的奇迹所抱有的信念。这种论证似乎显得过于微妙精密，但是，这难道和现实中法官判案的推理方式有什么两样吗？如果有两个证人控告某人犯了某罪，但是另外两人却向法官保证，案发

the particular system to which it is attributed; so has it the same force, though more indirectly, to overthrow every other system. In destroying a rival system, it likewise destroys the credit of those miracles, on which that system was established; so that all the prodigies of different religions are to be regarded as contrary facts, and the evidences of these prodigies, whether weak or strong, as opposite to each other. According to this method of reasoning, when we believe any miracle of Mahomet or his successors, we have for our warrant the testimony of a few barbarous Arabians; and on the other hand, we are to regard the authority of Titus Livius, Plutarch, Tacitus, and, in short, of

之时此人身处六百英里之外。法官自然认为前两人的证言不足以信。

all the authors and witnesses, Grecian, Chinese, and Roman Catholic, who have related any miracle in their particular religion; I say, we are to regard their testimony in the same light as if they had mentioned that Mahometan miracle, and had in express terms contradicted it, with the same certainty as they have for the miracle they relate. This argument may appear over subtle and refined; but is not in reality different from the reasoning of a judge, who supposes, that the credit of two witnesses, maintaining a crime against any one, is destroyed by the testimony of two others, who affirm him to have been two hundred leagues distant, at the same instant when

世俗史上得到多方证实的奇迹之一，是塔西佗讲述的关于罗马皇帝维斯帕先的奇迹。据塔西佗描述，维斯帕先在亚历山大里亚用唾液让一个盲人重新获得光明，他用脚轻轻触了一下瘸子，便治好了他的瘸腿。这一切都是按照希腊神塞拉皮斯的预示发生的，塞拉皮斯嘱咐那些病人求助于这位罗马皇帝，请求他用这些神奇的方法治愈了他们。读者可以在这位有名的史学家的书里读到这个故事，*根据书中的记载，当时的各种情节都起到了强化证据可信度的作用。如果现在谁还希望来为那个早已被揭穿的、极度宣扬个人崇拜的迷信的增添证据，或许还可以把当初的情节令人信服地再现出来。维

the crime is said to have been committed.

One of the best attested miracles in all profane history, is that which Tacitus reports of Vespasian, who cured a blind man in Alexandria, by means of his spittle, and a lame man by the mere touch of his foot; in obedience to a vision of the god Serapis, who had enjoined them to have recourse to the Emperor, for these miraculous cures. The story maybe seen in that fine historian^{*}; where every circumstance seems to add weight to the testimony, and might be displayed at large with all the force of argument and eloquence, if any one were now concerned to enforce the evidence of that

斯帕先这样英明的皇帝，既严肃诚恳，又德高望重，一生与朋友和臣下亲密无间，从未像亚历山大和德米特里那样，装腔作势，以神自居。记述这个事件的史学家与他们处于同一个时代，以诚实可信著称，甚至可以说是整个古代时期最杰出、最睿智的思想家，不会对任何事物抱轻信的态度。他甚至还因此受到恰恰相反的指责，说他信仰无神论，亵渎神灵。我们完全可以信赖向他转述这个奇迹的人们，都具有明辨是非的能力和诚实的品格，亲眼目睹了奇迹的发生。而且他们在证明这些奇迹的时候，夫拉维家族已经被赶下罗马帝国的皇位，不可能再对任何谣言给予任何奖励。况且，谁都知道，后人更不会给撒谎者任何奖赏。如果再考虑到这些事实都是公开讲述的，那么对于这一虚妄昭彰

exploded and idolatrous superstition. The gravity, solidity, age, and probity of so great an emperor, who, through the whole course of his life, conversed in a familiar manner with his friends and courtiers, and never affected those extraordinary airs of divinity assumed by Alexander and Demetrius. The historian, a contemporary writer, noted for candour and veracity, and withal, the greatest and most penetrating genius, perhaps, of all antiquity; and so free from any tendency to credulity, that he even lies under the contrary imputation, of atheism and profaneness: The persons, from whose authority he related the miracle, of established character for judgement and veracity, as we

的谎言来说，似乎再也不可能找到比这些更有力的证据了。

莱兹主教也讲过一个类似的故事，值得我们注意。莱兹主教是善于权谋的政客，为躲避仇敌的迫害逃到西班牙。他在路过阿拉贡的京城萨拉戈萨时，在当地教堂里见到一

个人。这人已经在教堂里当了七年的看门人，当地凡是到过该教堂做礼拜的人都认知他。此前很长一段时间，人们都看见他只有一条腿。但是，他把圣油涂抹到残肢上，缺了的腿又长出来了。主教向我们保证说他见到这人有两条腿。教堂的全体教士都证明确有这一神奇的事情。主教大人又向萨拉戈萨全体市民求证，结果发现他们都是虔诚的教徒，完全相信这一奇迹的真实性。这里我们再次看到，故事讲述者诉说的就是发生在与他本人同时代的所谓的奇迹，他本人思想开明，不会对事物抱随意轻信的态度，而且具有极高的才能。这件事本身很特别，很难有捏造的可能性，证人很多，而且可以说都是对他们亲眼见过的事提供证明。然而，极大增强证据说服力，并让我们倍感惊奇的是，

may well presume; eye-witnesses of the fact, and confirming their testimony, after the Flavian family was despoiled of the empire, and could no longer give any reward, as the price of a lie. *Utrumque, qui interfuerit, nunc quoque memorant, postquam nullum mendacio pretium*. To which if we add the public nature of the facts, as related, it will appear, that no evidence can well be supposed stronger for so gross and so palpable a falsehood.

There is also a memorable story related by Cardinal de Retz, which may well deserve our consideration. When that intriguing politician fled into Spain, to avoid

the persecution of his enemies, he passed through Saragossa, the capital of Aragon, where he was shewn, in the cathedral, a man, who had served seven years as a door-keeper, and was well known to every body in town, that had ever paid his devotions at that church. He had been seen, for so long a time, wanting a leg; but recovered that limb by the rubbing of holy oil upon the stump; and the cardinal assures us that he saw him with two legs. This miracle was vouched by all the canons of the church; and the whole company in town were appealed to for a confirmation of the fact; whom the cardinal found, by their zealous devotion, to be thorough believers of the miracle. Here the re-

讲述者主教似乎连自己都不相信真有其事，我们自然不会怀疑他参与了这一骗局。他合理地指出，要驳斥这类性质的事情，精确地揭穿各种证据的漏洞，无需从事件产生的欺骗性的、令人轻信的具体情境中追寻证据的错误。他知道，因为发生的事情在时空上离我们都不近，通常完全找不到这样的证据。即使一个人就在现场，要澄清事实真相也是极为困难的，毕竟大部分人都有偏执、无知、狡诈和欺骗的特性。因此，他像公平的推理者一样得出结论说，这类证据是明目张胆的招摇撞骗，任何建立在人类证言基础上的奇迹不过是一种笑料，不值得我们讨论。

later was also contemporary to the supposed prodigy, of an incredulous and libertine character, as well as of great genius; the miracle of so singular a nature as could scarcely admit of a counterfeit, and the witnesses very numerous, and all of them, in a manner, spectators of the fact, to which they gave their testimony. And what adds mightily to the force of the evidence, and may double our surprise on this occasion, is, that the cardinal himself, who relates the story, seems not to give any credit to it, and consequently cannot be suspected of any concurrence in the holy fraud. He considered justly, that it was not requisite, in order to reject a fact of this nature, to be

able accurately to disprove the testimony, and to trace its falsehood, through all the circumstances of knavery and credulity which produced it. He knew, that, as this was commonly altogether impossible at any small distance of time and place; so was it extremely difficult, even where one was immediately present, by reason of the bigotry, ignorance, cunning, and roguery of a great part of mankind. He therefore concluded, like a just reasoner, that such an evidence carried falsehood upon the very face of it, and that a miracle, supported by any human testimony, was more properly a subject of derision than of argument.

围绕个人的奇迹，数量最多的莫过于近来在法国盛传的和巴黎神父的坟墓有关的了。巴黎神父是有名的詹森派信徒，他的圣洁长期以来蒙骗了很多。民间到处流传着这座神圣的坟墓常常可以治病救人，可以让聋子恢复听觉、让盲人重见光明，等等。但是，更神奇的是，种种此等神迹都在现场得到应验，有着绝对诚信的人作为裁判，还有众多有信誉有身份的人作证。而这一切竟然发生在一个文明的时代，发生在当今世界享有盛誉的文明之都。事情还不止于此。其中一个故事还被印制成册，到处传播。耶稣会可谓是一个崇尚学术且受到政府支持的团体，虽然彻底反对制造和拥护这些神迹的种种言论，也无法对其进行有力的驳斥和揭露。[^5]我们还能去哪里寻找众多这样的情

节来确凿证明一件事情的真实性？除了这些子虚乌有的神迹绝不可能发生之外，我们还有什么可以用来反驳如此众多的证人？在所有理性的人们看来，这本身就是对谣言的充分反驳。

There surely never was a greater number of miracles ascribed to one person, than those, which were lately said to have been wrought in France upon the tomb of Abbe Paris, the famous Jansenist, with whose sanctity the people were so long deluded. The curing of the sick, giving hearing to the deaf, and sight to the blind, were every where talked of as the usual effects of that holy sepulchre. But what is more extraordinary; many of the miracles were immediately proved upon the spot, before judges of unquestioned integrity, attested by witnesses of credit and distinction, in a learned age, and on the most eminent theatre that is now in the world. Nor is this

all: a relation of them was published and dispersed everywhere; nor were the Jesuits, though a learned body supported by the civil magistrate, and determined enemies to those opinions, in whose favour the miracles were said to have been wrought, ever able distinctly to refute or detect them.[^5] Where shall we find such a number of circumstances, agreeing to the corroboration of one fact? And what have we to oppose to such a cloud of witnesses, but the absolute impossibility or miraculous nature of the events, which they relate? And this surely, in the eyes of all reasonable people, will alone be regarded as a sufficient refutation.

人类的证言有些时候具备极大的效力和权威，比如前人讲述的腓利比或法萨利亚之战。因此，人类在所有场合的所有证言都该具有同样的效力和权威吗？假设当年凯撒的阵营和庞培的阵营都各自宣称在这些战役中获胜，维护各自一方的史学家们全部都把功劳记在自己一方的名下，那么，经过了遥远的时代之后，今天的人类如何在二者间确定真伪？希罗多德或普鲁塔克笔下的奇迹和马里亚纳、圣徒比得或任何其他僧侣历史学家们讲述的神迹之间，有着同样尖锐的矛盾。

Is the consequence just, because some human testimony has the utmost force and authority in some cases, when it relates the battle of Philippi or Pharsalia for instance; that therefore all kinds of testimony must, in all cases, have equal force and authority? Suppose that the Caesarean and Pompeian factions had, each of them, claimed the victory in these battles, and that the historians of each party had uniformly ascribed the advantage to their own side; how could mankind, at this distance, have been able to determine between them? The contrariety is equally strong between the miracles related by Herodotus or Plutarch, and those delivered by Mariana, Bede, or any monkish

historian.

聪明的人对讲述者为满足激情而报告的故事抱以谨慎怀疑的态度，无论这种故事是为了颂扬他的国家、他的家庭或他本人，还是以任何别的方式凸显讲述者自己的性情和习性。但是，把自己装扮成天国的信使、先知和代表，还有什么别的行当比这更具诱惑呢？谁能不遭遇重重危险和困难就可以把自己变成如此神圣的人物呢？或者说，如果一个人凭借虚荣心和狂热的想象，首先把自己感化，一本正经地相信起谎言来，难道他还有什么顾虑，不会虔诚地利用各种骗术来支持这等神圣崇高的事业？

The wise lend a very academic faith to every report which favours the passion of the reporter; whether it magnifies his country, his family, or himself, or in any other way strikes in with his natural inclinations and propensities. But what greater temptation than to appear a missionary, a prophet, an ambassador from heaven? Who would not encounter many dangers and difficulties, in order to attain so sublime a character? Or if, by the help of vanity and a heated imagination, a man has first made a convert of himself, and entered seriously into the delusion; who ever scruples to

“星星之火可以燃烧成熊熊烈焰，因为永远不缺柴草。”* 普通大众时刻张着探听消息的耳朵，带着渴求的目光，不加任何思索，贪婪地接受一切迎合迷信、助长神奇的事物。

古往今来，有多少这样的故事一开始就被人们发现和揭穿？又有多少这样的故事虽然一开始被人传颂，但不久之后便沉入了历史的硝烟？因此，在这类故事盛传的地方，解决问题的办法非常明确：我们应该将其作

为轻信和欺骗行为加以对付，这样的判断是合乎日常经验和观察的。难道我们不该借助这一自然的解决方式来对付各种神迹，而是任由其公然违背我们早已接受的自然法则？

我无需指出，无论在公开的历史还是私下的记载里，要揭穿一种骗术是很困难的，即便在其发生的现场也是如此，而稍微离开事发地一点点就困难得多了。就算是法庭，虽然拥有权威，法官准确掌握着各种事实，具有正确的判断能力，也常常很难从刚刚发

make use of pious frauds, in support of so holy and meritorious a cause?

The smallest spark may here kindle into the greatest flame, because the materials are always prepared for it. The *avidum genus auricularum*,* the gazing populace, receive greedily, without examination, whatever soothes superstition, and promotes wonder.

How many stories of this nature have, in all ages, been detected and exploded in their infancy? How many more have been celebrated for a time, and have afterwards sunk into neglect and oblivion? Where such

reports, therefore, fly about, the solution of the phenomenon is obvious; and we judge in conformity to regular experience and observation, when we account for it by the known and natural principles of credulity and delusion. And shall we, rather than have a recourse to so natural a solution, allow of a miraculous violation of the most established laws of nature?

I need not mention the difficulty of detecting a falsehood in any private or even public history, at the place, where it is said to happen; much more when the scene is removed to ever so small a distance. Even a court of judicature, with all the authority,

生的事件中判别真伪。如果采用惯常的方法争论不休，听凭流言蜚语到处传播，人们从情感出发各自维护自己的立场，那就永远不会有任何结果。

在新的宗教出现之初，聪明博学之士常常认为这种事情微不足道，不值得关注。等到他们觉得有必要揭穿谎言，还真相于受蒙骗的大众的时候，却早已错过了时机，能够用来澄清事实的相关记载和证人已经消失，无处寻觅了。

到了这个时候，除了从讲述故事的人的证言中寻找证据之外，再没有别的办法可以用来揭穿谎言。虽然在明达之士看来，这样的方法也足够了，但是，对普通人而言，常常就显得十分微妙，难以理解。

总而言之，没有任何用于证明奇迹的证据可以达到可然性的程度，更不用说能作为确凿的证据了。退一步而言，即使这样的证据能够达到确凿的地步，还会遭遇到源于同样事实的反面证据的抗衡。人类证据的效力的唯一来源就是经验，也正是同样的经验向

accuracy, and judgement, which they can employ, find themselves often at a loss to distinguish between truth and falsehood in the most recent actions. But the matter never comes to any issue, if trusted to the common method of altercations and debate and flying rumours; especially when men's passions have taken part on either side.

In the infancy of new religions, the wise and learned commonly esteem the matter too inconsiderable to deserve their attention or regard. And when afterwards they would willingly detect the cheat in order to undeceive the deluded multitude, the season is now past, and the records and wit-

nesses, which might clear up the matter, have perished beyond recovery.

No means of detection remain, but those which must be drawn from the very testimony itself of the reporters; and these, though always sufficient with the judicious and knowing, are commonly too fine to fall under the comprehension of the vulgar.

Upon the whole, then, it appears, that no testimony for any kind of miracle has ever amounted to a probability, much less to a proof; and that, even supposing it amounted to a proof, it would be opposed by another proof; derived from the very

我们明确地呈现自然运行的法则。当两种经验互相矛盾时，我们唯一的办法就是用多的经验减去少的经验，然后按剩余的多少抱着相应的态度支持胜出的一方的观点。然而，按照这一原则来解决所有通俗的宗教问题，两相抵消就什么都不剩了。因此，我们可以提出一项普遍的原理，即没有任何人类证据具有证明奇迹的作用，更不能使其成为任何宗教迷信赖以存在的合理基础。

nature of the fact, which it would endeavour to establish. It is experience only, which gives authority to human testimony; and it is the same experience, which assures us of the laws of nature. When, therefore, these two kinds of experience are contrary, we have nothing to do but subtract the one from the other, and embrace an opinion, either on one side or the other, with that assurance which arises from the remainder. But according to the principle here explained, this subtraction, with regard to all popular religions, amounts to an entire annihilation; and therefore we may establish it as a maxim, that no human testimony can have such force as to prove a miracle, and

make it a just foundation for any such system of religion.

虽然我说我们永远不能证明一种神迹的存在，并以之作为宗教迷信的基础，但是我的说法是有一定局限的。因为我承认，说不定会有别的什么奇迹，或是违背自然规律的事情，也得到人类证言的支持，尽管在一切历史记载中不可能找得到这样的事。假设各种语言中的作者们都记载说，从公元1600年1月1日这天起，整个世界接连8天都处于完全黑暗之中，假设今天的人们依然完全相信这一神奇的事件确实发生过，从国外归来的旅行者们也有同样的描述，没有任何变化，也没有矛盾之处。如果是这样，显然今天的哲学家们就不会对此表示怀疑，而是把它当作

I beg the limitations here made may be remarked, when I say, that a miracle can never be proved, so as to be the foundation of a system of religion. For I own, that otherwise, there may possibly be miracles, or violations of the usual course of nature, of such a kind as to admit of proof from human testimony; though, perhaps, it will be impossible to find any such in all the records of history. Thus, suppose, all authors, in all languages, agree, that, from the first of January, 1600, there was a total darkness over the whole earth for eight days; suppose

确定的事实加以接受，并且去追寻这一神奇事件背后的起因。许多类似的事件表明，自然中出现各种衰败、损毁、分化的现象是可能的，任何可能引起这一灾难的现象，都是可以用人类的证据来证明的，尤其是这样的证据得到普遍一致的认同的时候。

that the tradition of this extraordinary event is still strong and lively among the people; that all travellers, who return from foreign countries, bring us accounts of the same tradition, without the least variation or contradiction. It is evident, that our present philosophers, instead of doubting the fact, ought to receive it as certain, and ought to search for the causes whence it might be derived. The decay, corruption, and dissolution of nature, is an event rendered probable by so many analogies, that any phenomenon, which seems to have a tendency towards that catastrophe, comes within the reach of human testimony, if that testimony be very extensive and uniform.

但是，假设所有撰写英国历史的史学家都记载说，公元1600年1月1日，伊莉莎白女王驾崩了。在她死前和死后都有她的医生和宫廷全体成员守候在身边，因为像她这样地位的人都会如此。王位的继承者得到议会承认并已正式宣布。可是，在被埋葬了一个月之后，伊莉莎白又出现了，重新坐上了王位，又统治了英国三年时间。如果是这样，我必须承认，虽然我对这么多奇怪的巧合感到惊讶，但丝毫也不会相信真有这等神奇的事情发生。我不会怀疑人们宣称她的死亡，以及她死后举行的各种公开活动，我只想断言说，这不过是人们的宣称而已，她的死亡不是真的，也不可能是真的。你可能会枉然反对说，在这样重要的事情上欺骗世人很难办到，几乎是不可能的，伊莉莎白女王具有

But suppose, that all the historians who treat of England, should agree, that, on the first of January, 1600, Queen Elizabeth died; that both before and after her death she was seen by her physicians and the whole court, as is usual with persons of her rank; that her successor was acknowledged and proclaimed by the parliament; and that, after being interred a month, she again appeared, resumed the throne, and governed England for three years. I must confess that I should be surprised at the concurrence of so many odd circumstances, but should not have the least inclination to believe so miraculous an event. I should not doubt of her pretended death, and of those other public

何等智慧和英明，这样笨拙的把戏对她而言没有任何好处。这一切都让我感到惊讶，但是，我依然会说，人们的狡诈和愚蠢实在太常见，我宁愿相信正是狡诈和愚蠢的结合制造了最奇异的事物，也不会承认世间真有这样违背自然法则的事情。

circumstances that followed it. I should only assert it to have been pretended, and that it neither was, nor possibly could be real. You would in vain object to me the difficulty, and almost impossibility of deceiving the world in an affair of such consequence; the wisdom and solid judgement of that renowned queen; with the little or no advantage which she could reap from so poor an artifice; all this might astonish me; but I would still reply, that the knavery and folly of men are such common phenomena, that I should rather believe the most extraordinary events to arise from their concurrence, than admit of so signal a violation of the laws of nature.

但是，如果这一奇迹是由一种新的宗教散播出来，习惯了这类荒谬故事的人们立刻就知道，故事发生的情景本身就是一场骗局的确凿证据，足以让所有具备理性思考能力的人拒绝接受这一事实，而且可以不加任何检查地加以拒绝。即使让奇迹得以发生的神灵就是万能的主，这件事的可然性却不会因此有丝毫增加，因为对我们而言，除了从经验中了解这一神灵在自然中的作品之外，无从知道他所具备的特性和所能施展的行为。这仍然把我们带回过去的观察中，促使我们把人类证据违背真相的情形和以神迹的形式违背自然法则的情形做比较，以判断哪一种情形更有可能出现，可然性更高。由于在宗教奇迹的问题上，人类的证据违背真相的情形比在其他客观事物上显得更为常见，这就

But should this miracle be ascribed to any new system of religion; men, in all ages, have been so much imposed on by ridiculous stories of that kind, that this very circumstance would be a full proof of a cheat, and sufficient, with all men of sense, not only to make them reject the fact, but even reject it without farther examination. Though the Being to whom the miracle is ascribed, be, in this case, Almighty, it does not, upon that account, become a whit more probable; since it is impossible for us to know the attributes or actions of such a Being, otherwise than from the experience which we have of his productions, in the usual course of nature. This still reduces us

大大削弱了用来证明宗教神迹的证据的效力，从而让我们形成一种普遍性的结论，无论这种证据披着多么华美的外衣，都决不能信以为真地加以重视。

培根勋爵似乎也信奉同样的推理原则。

他说：“我们应该把各种魔怪、各种仙人投胎转世或者其他神奇的事件汇集起来，换句话说，把自然中一切新奇、罕见和超凡的现象收集起来。但是，我们必须小心谨慎，以免偏离真相。”最重要的是，必须把一切与宗教有关的叙述都视为是值得怀疑的，就像李维笔下的那些奇迹一样。自然巫术或炼丹术的作者们，还有所有那些有着强烈的欺骗和捏造欲望的作者们，他们所描绘的一切，都是值得怀疑的。^{*}

to past observation, and obliges us to compare the instances of the violation of truth in the testimony of men, with those of the violation of the laws of nature by miracles, in order to judge which of them is most likely and probable. As the violations of truth are more common in the testimony concerning religious miracles, than in that concerning any other matter of fact; this must diminish very much the authority of the former testimony, and make us form a general resolution, never to lend any attention to it, with whatever specious pretence it may be covered.

Lord Bacon seems to have embraced

the same principles of reasoning. "We ought," says he, "to make a collection or particular history of all monsters and prodigious births or productions, and in a word of every thing new, rare, and extraordinary in nature. But this must be done with the most severe scrutiny, lest we depart from truth." Above all, every relation must be considered as suspicious, which depends in any degree upon religion, as the prodigies of Livy; and no less so, everything that is to be found in the writers of natural magic or alchemy, or such authors, who seem, all of them, to have an unconquerable appetite for falsehood and fable.^{*}

我很赞赏这样的推理方法，因为我想它可以挫败基督教那些危险的朋友和伪装的敌人，他们借用人类理性的原则来捍卫基督教。我们最神圣的宗教是建立在信仰之上的，而不是建立在理性的基础上。如果要把它交给一种它完全不能承受的方式来检验，正好可以暴露出它的缺陷来。为了阐明这一点，我们来看看基督教经文里的那些奇迹。再把范围缩小一点，我们来看看摩西五经里的记载。按照这些所谓基督徒的原则，我们将不把经文视为上帝本身的言语或证据，而仅仅是人类作者和史学家的产物。我们首先看到的是，这是一个蒙昧无知的民族为我们提供的一部书。在写这部书的时候，他们还处在更加野蛮的状态，叙述的却是很久以前的事情，没有任何当时的证据可以证明这些

事情，完全就像任何民族对自身起源所做的神话式描述。翻阅这部书，随处可见各种怪事和神迹。它对世界的状态和人性的描述完全和今天的不同，涉及人类的堕落；人活在世上的年龄近千岁；上帝用大洪水毁灭世界；上帝把一个民族挑选出来作为天国的选民；而这个民族正是作者的同胞；这个民族历尽磨难，最终借助神迹获得解放。我恳请每个人把手按在胸前，认真思考一下再发表意见：你是不是认为，这部建立在如此证据之上的虚妄之书本身比书中讲述的各种神迹还要荒诞离奇。然而，按照上文确定的可能性原则，正是因为该书的虚妄胜于其中的神迹，才使得它被人们接受。

I am the better pleased with the method of reasoning here delivered, as I think it may serve to confound those dangerous friends or disguised enemies to the Christian Religion, who have undertaken to defend it by the principles of human reason. Our most holy religion is founded on Faith, not on reason; and it is a sure method of exposing it to put it to such a trial as it is, by no means, fitted to endure. To make this more evident, let us examine those miracles, related in scripture; and not to lose ourselves in too wide a field, let us confine ourselves to such as we find in the Pentateuch, which we shall examine, according to the principles of these pretended

Christians, not as the word or testimony of God himself, but as the production of a mere human writer and historian. Here then we are first to consider a book, presented to us by a barbarous and ignorant people, written in an age when they were still more barbarous, and in all probability long after the facts which it relates, corroborated by no concurring testimony, and resembling those fabulous accounts, which every nation gives of its origin. Upon reading this book, we find it full of prodigies and miracles. It gives an account of a state of the world and of human nature entirely different from the present: of our fall from that state; of the age of man, extended to near a

thousand years; of the destruction of the world by a deluge; of the arbitrary choice of one people, as the favourites of heaven; and that people the countrymen of the author; of their deliverance from bondage by prodigies the most astonishing imaginable. I desire any one to lay his hand upon his heart, and after a serious consideration declare, whether he thinks that the falsehood of such a book, supported by such a testimony, would be more extraordinary and miraculous than all the miracles it relates; which is, however, necessary to make it be received, according to the measures of probability above established.

我们对于奇迹的看法可以丝毫不变地用于各种预言。事实上，所有的预言都是真正的奇迹，而且只有如此，才能作为任何启示的证据。如果无需超越人性的能力就可以预知未来的事件，那么借助预言为神圣使命辩护或者将其作为天国的权威就显得无比荒唐。因此，总体上我们可以得出结论说，基督教不仅一开始就充满了各种神迹，而且直到今天，任何理智的人离开了这些神迹都无法相信基督教。仅凭理性不足以让我们相信基督教的真实性。无论是谁，由于信仰而相信基督教，都会意识到自己身上有一种奇迹，颠覆了自己所有的理解原则，让他坚定不移地相信与人类习惯和经验背道而驰的事物。

What we have said of miracles may be applied, without any variation, to prophecies; and indeed, all prophecies are real miracles, and as such only, can be admitted as proofs of any revelation. If it did not exceed the capacity of human nature to foretell future events, it would be absurd to employ any prophecy as an argument for a divine mission or authority from heaven. So that, upon the whole, we may conclude, that the Christian Religion not only was at first attended with miracles, but even at this day cannot be believed by any reasonable person without one. Mere reason is insufficient to convince us of its veracity; and whoever is moved by Faith to assent to it, is con-

scious of a continued miracle in his own person, which subverts all the principles of his understanding, and gives him a determination to believe what is most contrary to custom and experience.

第十一章 论天意和来世

我最近和一位喜欢怀疑主义论辩的朋友有过一次对话。尽管他在谈话中提出的许多原则我绝不敢苟同，但是这些原则很有意思，而且与我在本书中的系列推理不无关联，我在此将我们的对话尽可能准确地抄录下来，让读者自己来做判断。

对话一开始，我首先对哲学独享的好运表示羡慕。哲学对自由的要求高于它所要求

Section XI Of a Particular Providence and of a Future State

I was lately engaged in a conversation with a friend who loves sceptical paradoxes; where, though he advanced many principles, of which I can by no means approve, yet as they seem to be curious, and to bear some relation to the chain of reasoning carried on throughout this enquiry, I shall here copy them from my memory as accurately as I can, in order to submit them to the judgement of the reader.

Our conversation began with my admiring the singular good fortune of philo-

的其他特权，哲学的繁荣主要有赖于各种意见和观点可以自由地对立和争论，而哲学恰好诞生于一个自由宽容的时代和国度，即便是它提出的最大胆的原则也不曾受到任何信条、任何特许权和任何刑事法规的限制。除了普罗塔哥拉遭到了放逐，苏格拉底被迫害至死（后面这一事件还牵涉到其他动机），在整个古代史上，几乎再也没有过类似的极端的忌恨事件，而在今天的时代却随处可见。伊壁鸠鲁在雅典活到很高的年龄，得以安享其晚年。而伊壁鸠鲁的信徒们*甚至得到祭司的身份，在雅典已确立的宗教中最神圣的仪式上走上祭坛主持典礼。罗马帝国最聪明的皇帝们公开向各派哲学家提供均等的津贴和薪俸以兹鼓励。*^{*}可以想象，在哲学发展的初期，这样的待遇很有必要。再想一

想，即便在今天，这个人们都以为哲学变得更加顽强健壮的时候，她其实仍然在恶劣的天气中艰难承受着不时向她吹来的诽谤和迫害的狂风。

sophy, which, as it requires entire liberty above all other privileges, and chiefly flourishes from the free opposition of sentiments and argumentation, received its first birth in an age and country of freedom and toleration, and was never cramped, even in its most extravagant principles, by any creeds, concessions, or penal statutes. For, except the banishment of Protagoras, and the death of Socrates, which last event proceeded partly from other motives, there are scarcely any instances to be met with, in ancient history, of this bigoted jealousy, with which the present age is so much infested. Epicurus lived at Athens to an advanced age, in peace and tranquillity; Epicureans

were even admitted to receive the sacerdotal character, and to officiate at the altar, in the most sacred rites of the established religion; and the public encouragement of pensions and salaries was afforded equally, by the wisest of all the Roman emperors^{}, to the professors of every sect of philosophy. How requisite such kind of treatment was to philosophy, in her early youth, will easily be conceived, if we reflect, that, even at present, when she may be supposed more hardy and robust, she bears with much difficulty the inclemency of the seasons, and those harsh winds of calumny and persecution, which blow upon her.*

我的朋友说，你所羡慕的哲学的好运气，似乎都是自然而然的结果，都是各时各地不可避免的发展趋势。你所抱怨的那种对哲学顽固不化的偏执态度，对哲学十分有害。这种态度其实就是哲学的子嗣，他和迷信勾结在一起，全然不顾其生母哲学的利益，反而成了她最冥顽不化的敌人和迫害者。在人类社会早期，人们想象不到像今天这样引起激烈争辩的宗教教义。那时候，所有人都目不识丁，理解能力低，只能形成简单的宗教观念。他们的宗教信条常常是一些以传统信仰为目的的传说，而不是什么论述和争辩。因而哲学家们提出的各种新的悖论和原则，一开始让世人感到惊恐。可是惊恐过后，古代的这些哲学家们似乎和当时盛行的宗教迷信相处得非常和谐，并且把人类一

分为二，哲学拥有所有聪明博学的人，而迷信则把庸俗无知的另一半据为己有。

我说，你似乎完全忽略了政治，而且你从来没有想过，一个明智的官吏可能会自然

You admire, says my friend, as the singular good fortune of philosophy, what seems to result from the natural course of things, and to be unavoidable in every age and nation. This pertinacious bigotry, of which you complain, as so fatal to philosophy, is really her offspring, who, after allying with superstition, separates himself entirely from the interest of his parent, and becomes her most inveterate enemy and persecutor. Speculative dogmas of religion, the present occasions of such furious dispute, could not possibly be conceived or admitted in the early ages of the world; when mankind, being wholly illiterate, formed an idea of religion more suitable to their weak

apprehension, and composed their sacred tenets of such tales chiefly as were the objects of traditional belief, more than of argument or disputation. After the first alarm, therefore, was over, which arose from the new paradoxes and principles of the philosophers; these teachers seem ever after, during the ages of antiquity, to have lived in great harmony with the established superstition, and to have made a fair partition of mankind between them; the former claiming all the learned and wise, the latter possessing all the vulgar and illiterate.

It seems then, say I, that you leave politics entirely out of the question, and

而然地防备某些哲学信条，比如伊壁鸠鲁的观点。伊壁鸠鲁的学说否认任何神圣的存在，因而也否认有天意和来世，这似乎在很大程度上削弱了道德的束缚力，因而可能被认作对社会安宁有害。

朋友回答说，我知道，事实上任何时代的迫害现象都不是理性平静思考的结果，也不是因为人们体验到哲学的危害，完全是由人们的情感和偏见所引起的。但是如果再进一步，我可以说，就算伊壁鸠鲁遭到当时那些谗言者们的控告，他完全可以在公众面前

轻松地捍卫自己的观点，证明他的哲学原则和其反对者们的原则一样，都是有益于公众的，尽管他的对手们以极大的热忱一心要置他于公众的仇恨和嫉妒之下。如果我这样说，会有什么结果呢？

我说，既然是这样，但愿你能在这个非凡的话题上施展你的口才，发表一篇拥护伊壁鸠鲁的演说。当然，目的不是要你说服雅典的暴民（如果你认为在雅典这个古老的文明城市里确有暴民存在），而是要你说服那些更有哲学头脑，估计更能够了解伊壁鸠鲁思想的听众。

never suppose, that a wise magistrate can justly be jealous of certain tenets of philosophy, such as those of Epicurus, which, denying a divine existence, and consequently a providence and a future state, seem to loosen, in a great measure the ties of morality, and may be supposed, for that reason, pernicious to the peace of civil society.

I know, replied he, that in fact these persecutions never, in any age, proceeded from calm reason, or from experience of the pernicious consequences of philosophy; but arose entirely from passion and prejudice. But what if I should advance farther, and

assert, that if Epicurus had been accused before the people, by any of the sycophants or informers of those days, he could easily have defended his cause, and proved his principles of philosophy to be as salutary as those of his adversaries, who endeavoured, with such zeal, to expose him to the public hatred and jealousy?

I wish, said I, you would try your eloquence upon so extraordinary a topic, and make a speech for Epicurus, which might satisfy, not the mob of Athens, if you will allow that ancient and polite city to have contained any mob, but the more philosophical part of his audience, such as might be sup-

他回答说，照你这样说，这事并不难。如果你愿意，我暂且把自己当作伊壁鸠鲁，让你来代表雅典公民。现在我就在你面前发表演说，让全体雅典公民都来投我的票，不让我的敌人得到一张支持的票，让他们的恶意得不到一点满足的机会。

很好，但愿一切如你所愿。

雅典的公民们，我到这里来，是要利用

大家集会的机会向诸位说明我的哲学信念，因为我发现我不是在和一些冷静客观的研究者讨论问题，而是遭到一些怒不可遏的反对者的非难和诋毁。诸位本该思考有益于公共利益和大众福利的问题，现在却把心思分散到思辨哲学的研究上了。这些研究的话题固然宏大，但可能没有任何用处，它们占据了诸位更加熟悉、更加实用的工作。但是，我将尽自己所能来防止大家把精力用到错误的地方。我们在这里不去讨论世界的起源和管理的问题，只探询这些问题在多大程度上与公共利益相关。如果我能使诸位相信，这类问题完全不会影响社会的和平安宁和政府的安全稳定，我希望大家能够让我们立刻回到自己的学院，让我们可以自由探索那些最崇高、最具思辨性的哲学问题。

posed capable of comprehending his arguments.

The matter would not be difficult, upon such conditions, replied he, and if you please, I shall suppose myself Epicurus for a moment, and make you stand for the Athenian people, and shall deliver you such a harangue as will fill all the urn with white beans, and leave not a black one to gratify the malice of my adversaries.

Very well, pray proceed upon these suppositions.

I come hither, O ye Athenians, to jus-

tify in your assembly what I maintain in my school, and I find myself impeached by furious antagonists, instead of reasoning with calm and dispassionate enquirers. Your deliberations, which of right should be directed to questions of public good, and the interest of the commonwealth, are diverted to the disquisitions of speculative philosophy; and these magnificent, but perhaps fruitless enquiries, take place of your more familiar but more useful occupations. But so far as in me lies, I will prevent this abuse. We shall not here dispute concerning the origin and government of worlds. We shall only enquire how far such questions concern the public interest. And if I can persuade you,

宗教哲学家们对你们祖先的传统和祭司们的教义并不满意，而这些我都欣然接受。他们鲁莽地纵容自己的好奇心，极力要把宗教建立在理性的原则之上。其结果是，他们不但没有平息人们在勤恳细致地研究哲学问题时产生的种种疑虑，反而激起了人们的疑虑。他们把宇宙的秩序、美丽和精巧描绘得无比壮丽多彩，并进而问道，难道这种壮观

的智慧呈现是由原子的偶然结合而产生的？或者说让最富天才的人们都叹为观止的宇宙难道是偶然的产物？这个观点正确与否，我暂且不在这里讨论。我愿意承认它像我的反对者和诋毁者们所期望的那样坚实可靠。我只想按照他们这种推理来证明，这完全是个哲学思辨问题，而我在哲学的研究中否认天意和来世的存在，不仅不会削弱社会的基础，反而提出了一些原则。如果他们在自己的研究领域进行连贯一致的论证，也不得不承认这些原则是坚实可靠的，是令人满意的。如果我能达到这一目标，那就够了。

that they are entirely indifferent to the peace of society and security of government, I hope that you will presently send us back to our schools, there to examine, at leisure, the question the most sublime, but, at the same time, the most speculative of all philosophy.

The religious philosophers, not satisfied with the tradition of your forefathers, and doctrine of your priests (in which I willingly acquiesce), indulge a rash curiosity, in trying how far they can establish religion upon the principles of reason; and they thereby excite, instead of satisfying, the doubts, which naturally arise from a dili-

gent and scrupulous enquiry. They paint, in the most magnificent colours, the order, beauty, and wise arrangement of the universe; and then ask, if such a glorious display of intelligence could proceed from the fortuitous concourse of atoms, or if chance could produce what the greatest genius can never sufficiently admire. I shall not examine the justness of this argument. I shall allow it to be as solid as my antagonists and accusers can desire. It is sufficient, if I can prove, from this very reasoning, that the question is entirely speculative, and that, when, in my philosophical disquisitions, I deny a providence and a future state, I undermine not the foundations of society, but

你们当中指控我的人已经承认，神圣存在（我对此从未怀疑过）的首要的、唯一的证据来自于自然秩序。自然中呈现的这些智慧和设计，你们认为将其归因于偶然的機會，或者事物盲目、散乱的力量，便太不切实际了。你们承认，这是从结果到原因的论证方法。你们从作品的结构推断出工匠心中一定事先就有设计和筹划。如果你们没法阐明这一点，你们就会承认，你们得出的结论是错误的。你们并不企图得出任何超过自然现象所许可的结论。这些都是你们所认可

的。我请大家看看会有什么后果。

我们从结果推断出原因的时候，必须注意二者间恰当的比例关系，除了足以产生某种结果的那些属性，我们始终不能把其他的属性归于原因。一个十盎司重的物体在天平的一边被举了起来，足以说明天平另一边能将它举起来的法码是不只十盎司重的，但是我们没有任何理由认为，这个法码的重量超

advance principles, which they themselves, upon their own topics, if they argue consistently, must allow to be solid and satisfactory.

You then, who are my accusers, have acknowledged, that the chief or sole argument for a divine existence (which I never questioned) is derived from the order of nature; where there appear such marks of intelligence and design, that you think it extravagant to assign for its cause, either chance, or the blind and unguided force of matter. You allow, that this is an argument drawn from effects to causes. From the order of the work, you infer, that there must

have been project and forethought in the workman. If you cannot make out this point, you allow, that your conclusion fails; and you pretend not to establish the conclusion in a greater latitude than the phenomena of nature will justify. These are your concessions. I desire you to mark the consequences.

When we infer any particular cause from an effect, we must proportion the one to the other, and can never be allowed to ascribe to the cause any qualities, but what are exactly sufficient to produce the effect. A body of ten ounces raised in any scale may serve as a proof, that the counterbalan-

过了一百盎司。如果我们为结果找出的某个原因不足以产生这个结果，我们要么拒绝接受这个原因，要么为这个原因补充适当的属性，使之和结果的比例恰到好处。但是如果我们说还有其他属性，或者断言它还能引起其他结果，那就是胡乱猜测，在没有任何理由和根据的情况下，武断地认定有别的属性和能量存在。

我们确定的原因，无论是无意识的物体还是有智慧的生命，都适用这个同样的原则。如果我们只能从结果中认识某个原因，

那么我们认为，这个原因恰恰具有产生该结果的属性，而不能随意认为它还具备其他属性。同样，按照合理的推断方式，我们不能再由原因往回推，断定该原因除了产生我们熟悉的结果之外，还会引起其他结果。没有任何人只看了宙克西斯的绘画之后，就知道他还是雕塑家和建筑师，就知道他在石工方面的技艺并不逊色于他的绘画艺术。眼前这幅作品中展示的才艺和趣味，我们可以可靠地断定是作者具有的品质。原因要和结果相称，如果我们能准确把握好二者之间的比例关系，我们就不会认定还有其他品质，进一步随意推断别的设计或表现。这些品质已经超出了产生目前我们探讨的结果所要求的范畴。

cing weight exceeds ten ounces; but can never afford a reason that it exceeds a hundred. If the cause, assigned for any effect, be not sufficient to produce it, we must either reject that cause, or add to it such qualities as will give it a just proportion to the effect. But if we ascribe to it farther qualities, or affirm it capable of producing other effects, we can only indulge the licence of conjecture, and arbitrarily suppose the existence of qualities and energies, without reason or authority.

The same rule holds, whether the cause assigned be brute unconscious matter, or a rational intelligent being. If the cause be

known only by the effect, we never ought to ascribe to it any qualities, beyond what are precisely requisite to produce the effect; nor can we, by any rules of just reasoning, return back from the cause, and infer other effects from it, beyond those by which alone it is known to us. No one, merely from the sight of one of Zeuxis's pictures, could know, that he was also a statuary or architect, and was an artist no less skilful in stone and marble than in colours. The talents and taste, displayed in the particular work before us; these we may safely conclude the workman to be possessed of. The cause must be proportioned to the effect; and if we exactly and precisely proportion

因此，就算我们承认各种神灵是宇宙存在和秩序的缔造者，也只能说，这些神灵恰好只具备他们的作品所显示的力量、智慧和仁爱，此外再不能证明有别的品质，除非我们采取夸大其词、巴结奉承的办法来弥补论证和推理的不足。现在，只有有迹象显示这些品质存在，我们才能如此断定。除此之外，认为还有任何别的品质存在都不过是揣测。而如果认为，在某个遥远的地域，或某

个久远的时代，这些品质曾经或者将会壮丽地展现出来，也曾经有过或将会有一种更适合这些想象的德行的宇宙秩序，那就更是毫无根据的主观臆断了。我们绝不能把宇宙的存在这一结果往回推到朱庇特这个原因上，然后再折回来，从这个原因推出新的结果，仿佛现在的结果还配不上我们归于朱庇特神的辉煌品质。既然原因只能从结果中得出来，二者必须是紧密联系的，各自都不能指向任何别的事物，也不能以自身为基础，推出新的事物或得出新的结论。

it, we shall never find in it any qualities, that point farther, or afford an inference concerning any other design or performance. Such qualities must be somewhat beyond what is merely requisite for producing the effect, which we examine.

Allowing, therefore, the gods to be the authors of the existence or order of the universe; it follows, that they possess that precise degree of power, intelligence, and benevolence, which appears in their workmanship; but nothing farther can ever be proved, except we call in the assistance of exaggeration and flattery to supply the defects of argument and reasoning. So far as

the traces of any attributes, at present, appear, so far may we conclude these attributes to exist. The supposition of farther attributes is mere hypothesis; much more the supposition, that, in distant regions of space or periods of time, there has been, or will be, a more magnificent display of these attributes, and a scheme of administration more suitable to such imaginary virtues. We can never be allowed to mount up from the universe, the effect, to Jupiter, the cause; and then descend downwards, to infer any new effect from that cause; as if the present effects alone were not entirely worthy of the glorious attributes, which we ascribe to that deity. The knowledge of the cause being de-

你发现自然界中的某种现象，然后去寻求这一现象的原因或缔造者。你想象自己找到了这一原因或缔造者，此后你對自己大腦的這一產物如此傾心，覺得他的能耐不可能就只有這麼一點點，一定還引起了比眼前的現象更加宏偉、更加完美的事物，因為眼前的這些現象處處都是問題，混亂不堪。你忘了這個具有無上智慧和仁愛的生靈完全是想象的產物，至少沒有任何合理的存在基礎，除了你親眼見到的他在其造物中顯示的品質

之外，你沒有理由認為他還具備其他的任何品質。因此，哲學家們啊，讓你們的神靈合乎自然的現狀，不要用武斷的假設來改變自然的現狀，反過來迎合你們欣然以為你們的神靈所具有的那些品質。

雅典人啊，你們的祭司和詩人們在你們的威望支持下，談論在我們這個充滿邪惡和苦難的時代之前出現的黃金時代和白銀時代，我總是洗耳恭聽。但是，當那些宣稱不顧你們的威信，而要培養理性的哲學家們談

rived solely from the effect, they must be exactly adjusted to each other; and the one can never refer to anything farther, or be the foundation of any new inference and conclusion.

You find certain phenomena in nature. You seek a cause or author. You imagine that you have found him. You afterwards become so enamoured of this offspring of your brain, that you imagine it impossible, but he must produce something greater and more perfect than the present scene of things, which is so full of ill and disorder. You forget, that this superlative intelligence and benevolence are entirely imaginary, or,

at least, without any foundation in reason; and that you have no ground to ascribe to him any qualities, but what you see he has actually exerted and displayed in his productions. Let your gods, therefore, O philosophers, be suited to the present appearances of nature; and presume not to alter these appearances by arbitrary suppositions, in order to suit them to the attributes, which you so fondly ascribe to your deities.

When priests and poets, supported by your authority, O Athenians, talk of a golden or silver age, which preceded the present state of vice and misery, I hear them with attention and with reverence. But

起同样的话题时，我承认自己对他们就没有那么顺从和恭敬了。我要问，谁把他们引入了天界，谁允许他们进入神灵的会堂，谁为他们翻开了命运之书，让他们可以草率地断言，他们的神灵曾经实现了事实上不存在的任何目的，或将要实现这一目的？如果说，他们或是借助逐步推理，或是从结果推导出原因，从而攀上了这个理性的台阶，我仍然要说，他们是凭借想象的翅膀让理性飞升起来。不然他们也就不会改变了推理的方式，从原因中推出结果，荒谬地以为只有一个比眼前的世界更完美的景象才更符合完美的神灵的作为，忘了他们根本没有任何理由把现实世界中不存在的任何完美品质归于这些天国的神灵。

when philosophers, who pretend to neglect authority, and to cultivate reason, hold the same discourse, I pay them not, I own, the same obsequious submission and pious deference. I ask; who carried them into the celestial regions, who admitted them into the councils of the gods, who opened to them the book of fate, that they thus rashly affirm, that their deities have executed, or will execute, any purpose beyond what has actually appeared? If they tell me, that they have mounted on the steps or by the gradual ascent of reason, and by drawing inferences from effects to causes, I still insist, that they have aided the ascent of reason by the wings of imagination; otherwise they could not

thus change their manner of inference, and argue from causes to effects; presuming, that a more perfect production than the present world would be more suitable to such perfect beings as the gods, and forgetting that they have no reason to ascribe to these celestial beings any perfection or any attribute, but what can be found in the present world.

因此，尽管我们必须承认，世界的确充满了邪恶和混乱，但是，一切用这样的方式解释自然的乱象和拯救神灵荣誉的努力都是徒劳的。人们告诉我们，之所以朱庇特的能力和仁慈受到限制，使他把人类和每一种有灵性的动物创造得如此不完美、如此不幸

Hence all the fruitless industry to account for the ill appearances of nature, and save the honour of the gods; while we must acknowledge the reality of that evil and disorder, with which the world so much abounds. The obstinate and intractable

福，唯一的原因是物质固有的不可改变的属性，或者必须遵守的自然法则，或某种类似的缘由。我们似乎事先就想当然地认为朱庇特具有这些最完美的品质。从这个假设出发，我认为这些猜想或许可以为自然中的各种恶劣现象提供言之有理的解决方案。但是我依然要问，为什么我们事先就设定这些品质的存在，或者为什么我们要把结果中没有呈现的品质归到原因的名下呢？为什么要绞尽脑汁，用你们清楚知道完全出于想象、在自然中没有一丝存在痕迹的假设来解释自然的进程呢？

因此，我们只能把宗教假设视为解释宇宙中明显的现象的一种特殊方法，正确运用推理的人都不会在具体情况下用这种方法推出某个具体事实，来改变实际存在的现象，或随意增加内容。如果你们认为，事物的现状证明有这些原因存在，你们可以就这些原因的存在作出自己的推断。对于这些复杂而崇高的话题，人人都有进行推测和论述的自由。但是你们得就此而止。倘若你们又从自己推断出的原因出发，反过来得出结论说，自然界中有过某个事物，或将会出现某个事

qualities of matter, we are told, or the observance of general laws, or some such reason, is the sole cause, which controlled the power and benevolence of Jupiter, and obliged him to create mankind and every sensible creature so imperfect and so unhappy. These attributes then, are, it seems, beforehand, taken for granted, in their greatest latitude. And upon that supposition, I own that such conjectures may, perhaps, be admitted as plausible solutions of the ill phenomena. But still I ask, why take these attributes for granted, or why ascribe to the cause any qualities but what actually appear in the effect? Why torture your brain to justify the course of nature upon suppositions, which, for aught you know, may be entirely imaginary, and of which there are to be found no traces in the course of nature?

The religious hypothesis, therefore, must be considered only as a particular method of accounting for the visible phenomena of the universe; but no just reasoner will ever presume to infer from it any single fact, and alter or add to the phenomena, in any single particular. If you think, that the appearances of things prove such causes, it is allowable for you to draw an inference concerning the existence of these causes. In such complicated and sub-

物，并以之证明这是某些品质的更充分的呈现，那我得警告你们说，你们已经背离目前的话题所需要的正确的推理方法，随意增加了原因的属性，增加了结果中并未显示的属性，否则只要你们能明事理、知分寸，就绝不会把结果夸大，以便它更能展示原因的完美。

lime subjects, every one should be indulged in the liberty of conjecture and argument. But here you ought to rest. If you come backward, and arguing from your inferred causes, conclude, that any other fact has existed, or will exist, in the course of nature, which may serve as a fuller display of particular attributes; I must admonish you, that you have departed from the method of reasoning, attached to the present subject, and have certainly added something to the attributes of the cause, beyond what appears in the effect; otherwise you could never, with tolerable sense or propriety, add anything to the effect, in order to render it more worthy of the cause.

那么，我在自己学院中所传授的学说，或者说我在自己花园中研究的学说，究竟有什么令人憎恶的呢？或者说，在这个丝毫不损于良好的道德和社会的安宁和秩序的问题上，你们究竟发现了什么危害呢？

Where, then, is the odiousness of that doctrine, which I teach in my school, or rather, which I examine in my gardens? Or what do you find in this whole question, wherein the security of good morals, or the peace and order of society, is in the least concerned?

你们说，我否认神灵的存在，否认有一个至高无上的世界的管理者在背后引领着万事万物，在自然的进程中惩恶扬善，让邪恶的人臭名昭著、永远失意，让具有美德的人功成名就、载誉而归。但是，我显然并不否定事物本身的进程，这是人人可以自由探索和考察的。我承认，就事物的现状来看，美德比罪恶更能让人心得到安宁，更受世人

I deny a providence, you say, and supreme governor of the world, who guides the course of events, and punishes the vicious with infamy and disappointment, and rewards the virtuous with honour and success, in all their undertakings. But surely, I deny not the course itself of events, which lies open to every one's inquiry and examin-

欢迎。我能感受到，就人类过去的经验说来看，友谊是人生最大的快乐，而节制乃是宁静和幸福人生的唯一源泉。我从没有把善良的人生和罪恶的人生看作是平等的，而是清楚地知道，从心态安宁的角度来看，善良的人生具有各种优势。如果你们的所有假设和推论都得到认可，你们还有什么可以说的呢？你们告诉我说，实际上，事物的这种安排源自智慧和设计。但是无论源自什么地方，我们的幸福和苦难所依赖的这种安排是没有改变的，我们人生的行为举止所依赖的这种安排是相同的。我和你们一样，仍然可以用我过去的经验来规范我的行为。如果你们肯定地说，我们承认有神圣的上帝，承认宇宙中有一种至高无上的正义分配给万事万物，我就能期待在事物寻常的秩序之外，好

人能得到相应的奖赏，恶人也会得到应有的惩罚。那么，这里又出现了我先前努力所揭露的那种谬误。你们坚持自己的想象：我们如果承认你们热切主张的神灵确实存在，你们就可以安全地以之为起点进行推断，凭借你们赋予神灵的各种品质，把新的事物添加到我们所体验到的自然秩序之上。你们似乎不记得，你们在此话题上的所有推理都只能从结果推断出原因，而从原因到结果的任何论证都必然是彻底的诡辩。因为对于原因的了解，除了事先从结果中发现的，其他内容根本不可能仅凭臆断就能知道。

ation. I acknowledge, that, in the present order of things, virtue is attended with more peace of mind than vice, and meets with a more favourable reception from the world. I am sensible, that, according to the past experience of mankind, friendship is the chief joy of human life, and moderation the only source of tranquillity and happiness. I never balance between the virtuous and the vicious course of life; but am sensible, that, to a well-disposed mind, every advantage is on the side of the former. And what can you say more, allowing all your suppositions and reasonings? You tell me, indeed, that this disposition of things proceeds from intelligence and design. But whatever it pro-

ceeds from, the disposition itself, on which depends our happiness or misery, and consequently our conduct and deportment in life is still the same. It is still open for me, as well as you, to regulate my behaviour, by my experience of past events. And if you affirm, that, while a divine providence is allowed and a supreme distributive justice in the universe, I ought to expect some more particular reward of the good, and punishment of the bad, beyond the ordinary course of events; I here find the same fallacy, which I have before endeavoured to detect. You persist in imagining, that, if we grant that divine existence, for which you so earnestly contend, you may safely infer con-

sequences from it, and add something to the experienced order of nature, by arguing from the attributes which you ascribe to your gods. You seem not to remember, that all your reasonings on this subject can only be drawn from effects to causes; and that every argument, deducted from causes to effects, must of necessity be a gross sophism; since it is impossible for you to know anything of the cause, but what you have antecedently, not inferred, but discovered to the full, in the effect.

但是，一个哲学家会怎么看那些枉费心机的推理者呢？他们不把事物的现状作为思索的唯一目标，相反，他们完全背离自然的

But what must a philosopher think of those vain reasoners, who instead of regarding the present scene of things as the sole

进程，认为此生不过是通往更遥远世界的通道，是引领我们通向更雄伟的、截然不同的建筑物的一道走廊，是一篇序言，目的是向我们介绍真正的鸿篇巨制，为之增色、为之捧场。你们觉得这些哲学家们从哪里得来了他们关于神灵的观念？显然这是来源于他们的自负和想象。因为如果他们的观念来源于眼前的现象，断然就不会把人们引向任何更遥远的事物，而是必须和现实相符的。那位神灵或许拥有我们从未见过的品质，或许受到我们无从发现的行为原则的限制，这一切我们都可以承认。但是，这也只是一种可能性，一种猜测。我们绝没有任何理由推断出它具有我们未曾见过他们施展、实现的任何品质和行为原则。

object of their contemplation, so far reverse the whole course of nature, as to render this life merely a passage to something farther; a porch, which leads to a greater, and vastly different building; a prologue, which serves only to introduce the piece, and give it more grace and propriety? Whence, do you think, can such philosophers derive their idea of the gods? From their own conceit and imagination surely. For if they derived it from the present phenomena, it would never point to anything farther, but must be exactly adjusted to them. That the divinity may possibly be endowed with attributes, which we have never seen exerted; may be governed by principles of action, which we

cannot discover to be satisfied; all this will freely be allowed. But still this is mere possibility and hypothesis. We never can have reason to infer any attributes, or any principles of action in him, but so far as we know them to have been exerted and satisfied.

有任何迹象表明世界上存在着一种可以公平分配的正义么？如果说有，那我会说，既然正义在这里显现出来，它就得以实现。如果说没有，我会说你们没有理由把我们所理解的正义归于神灵。如果你们既不肯定又不否定，说神灵的正义目前只得到部分施行，没有完全地发挥出来，我要说，除了亲眼所见，你们没有理由为正义设定一

Are there any marks of a distributive justice in the world? If you answer in the affirmative, I conclude, that, since justice here exerts itself, it is satisfied. If you reply in the negative, I conclude, that you have then no reason to ascribe justice, in our sense of it, to the gods. If you hold a medium between affirmation and negation, by saying, that

个具体的程度。

the justice of the gods, at present, exerts itself in part, but not in its full extent; I answer, that you have no reason to give it any particular extent, but only so far as you see it, at present, exert itself.

雅典人啊，让我把我和反对者之间的争议简短地了结了吧。自然的进程是我可以自由思考的，也是他们可以自由探索的。我们过去所经历过的事是我们规范自己行为的大标准，除此之外，无论是在田间地头还是在议会大厅，都不能诉诸别的东西；无论是在学校，还是在私人的秘密房间里，都不该听到别的内容。这样的界限对于我们喜欢的想象力而言实在是狭窄，但是，如果我们有限的理解要试图打破这些边界，则是徒劳之

Thus I bring the dispute, O Athenians, to a short issue with my antagonists. The course of nature lies open to my contemplation as well as to theirs. The experienced train of events is the great standard, by which we all regulate our conduct. Nothing else can be appealed to in the field, or in the senate. Nothing else ought ever to be heard of in the school, or in the closet. In vain would our limited understanding break

举。如果我们从自然的进程出发，推测出某种智慧的原因从一开始就赋予并一直在维护着宇宙的秩序，我们就选择了一种既不确定也无用处的法则。之所以不确定，是因为它完全处于人类的经验之外；而之所以说它毫无用处，则是因为我们关于原因的知识完全源于自然进程之中，根据正确的推理方法，我们绝不可能又从原因出发，推导出新的结论，或者对我们共同的、有经验的自然作任意增加，确定任何新的行为举止的原则。

在发现我的朋友完成了他的长篇大论之后，我说，我注意到你善于运用古代演说家们的把戏。你先让我来代表雅典人民，然后你又表达了你知道我素来所捍卫的原则，因而逐渐赢得了我的欢心。但是，纵然我承认你把经验作为我们在这一问题以及其他一切关于客观事实的问题上进行判断的唯一标准（事实上我也认为你应该这样做），我仍然相信，我们可以用你所求助的经验来反驳你借伊壁鸠鲁的口说出的这种推理。例如，你看见一在建了一半的建筑，周围堆着砖块、石头、灰浆和泥水匠所用的各种工具，难道你不能由眼前的结果推测说，这是一项有设计、有计划的工程么？难道你不能从这个推

through those boundaries, which are too narrow for our fond imagination. While we argue from the course of nature, and infer a particular intelligent cause, which first bestowed, and still preserves order in the universe, we embrace a principle, which is both uncertain and useless. It is uncertain; because the subject lies entirely beyond the reach of human experience. It is useless; because our knowledge of this cause being derived entirely from the course of nature, we can never, according to the rules of just reasoning, return back from the cause with any new inference, or making additions to the common and experienced course of nature, establish any new principles of conduct and behaviour.

I observe (said I, finding he had finished his harangue) that you neglect not the artifice of the demagogues of old; and as you were pleased to make me stand for the people, you insinuate yourself into my favour by embracing those principles, to which, you know, I have always expressed a particular attachment. But allowing you to make experience (as indeed I think you ought) the only standard of our judgement concerning this, and all other questions of fact; I doubt not but, from the very same experience, to which you appeal, it may be possible to refute this reasoning, which you

测的原因再返回来，推测出眼前的结果会有所增加，即建筑很快会完成，并将得到建筑艺术所能给予的一切完善吗？如果你在海滨见到了人留下的一只脚印，你会推断出有人从那里走过，而且他一定也留下了另一只脚的脚印，尽管那个脚印已经被流沙和海水抹去了痕迹。既然如此，你为什么又拒绝在自然秩序中运用相似的推理方法呢？如果把世界和现在的人生当着一栋没有完成的建筑，我们就可以由此推断出背后有一个至高无上的智慧。既然至高无上的智慧不可能留下任何不完美的事物，那么，你为什么不能从这一至高无上的智慧出发，推测出一种更加完整的设计和计划，可能将在更为遥远的时空得以完善呢？这两种推论方法不是很相似吗？你有什么理由要采用一种方法，却又排

have put into the mouth of Epicurus. If you saw, for instance, a half-finished building, surrounded with heaps of brick and stone and mortar, and all the instruments of masonry; could you not infer from the effect, that it was a work of design and contrivance? And could you not return again, from this inferred cause, to infer new additions to the effect, and conclude, that the building would soon be finished, and receive all the further improvements, which art could bestow upon it? If you saw upon the seashore the print of one human foot, you would conclude, that a man had passed that way, and that he had also left the traces of the other foot, though effaced by the rolling of the

斥另一种方法呢？

sands or inundation of the waters. Why then do you refuse to admit the same method of reasoning with regard to the order of nature? Consider the world and the present life only as an imperfect building, from which you can infer a superior intelligence; and arguing from that superior intelligence, which can leave nothing imperfect; why may you not infer a more finished scheme or plan, which will receive its completion in some distant point of space or time? Are not these methods of reasoning exactly similar? And under what pretence can you embrace the one, while you reject the other?

他回答说，由这里涉及的话题有无穷的差异，足以让我得出不同的结论。在人类艺术和设计作品中，可以从结果推测出原因，再从原因出发，推出关于结果的新的结论，并检查从中出现的变化，或者有可能还会出现的变化。这种推理方法的基础是什么呢？简单地说是这样的：人是我们通过经验知晓的生物，我们熟悉其动机和目的，根据自然为管理这一生灵确立的法则，人的行为和性情倾向之间有一定联系，是前后连贯的。因此，当我们见到由人的技艺和勤劳得来的作品时，由于了解人这一生物的本性，我们可以对其可能的结果作上百种推测，而这些推测都是建立在过去的经验和观察之上的。但是，如果我们只是从我们所见的单个作品或产物中了解人，我们就不可能用这样的方式

The infinite difference of the subjects, replied he, is a sufficient foundation for this difference in my conclusions. In works of human art and contrivance, it is allowable to advance from the effect to the cause, and returning back from the cause, to form new inferences concerning the effect, and examine the alterations, which it has probably undergone, or may still undergo. But what is the foundation of this method of reasoning? Plainly this, that man is a being, whom we know by experience, whose motives and designs we are acquainted with, and whose projects and inclinations have a certain connexion and coherence, according to the laws which nature has established for the gov-

做进一步的推论，因为既然我们关于人的所有品质的知识都来源于他的产物，这些品质就不可能再指向任何其他的事物，或者成为我们做出新的推测的基础。沙地上留下的一只脚印，孤立地看，只能证明它是由某个与之相符的形体产生的；但是如果是人留下的一只脚印，从我们的经验看，就同样证明或许还有另一只脚也留下了脚印，尽管时光或其他偶然的因素已经抹去了它的痕迹。这里我们由结果上升到原因，又从原因往下推，得出结果中可能出现的变化。但是这可不是一连串简单推理的继续。在这种情形下，它涉及我们对于人这一动物平常的形象和肢体的上百种经验和观察，没有这些经验和观察，这种推理方法一定是错误的，一定是诡辩。

ernment of such a creature. When, therefore, we find, that any work has proceeded from the skill and industry of man; as we are otherwise acquainted with the nature of the animal, we can draw a hundred inferences concerning what may be expected from him; and these inferences will all be founded in experience and observation. But did we know man only from the single work or production which we examine, it were impossible for us to argue in this manner; because our knowledge of all the qualities, which we ascribe to him, being in that case derived from the production, it is impossible they could point to anything farther, or be the foundation of any new in-

ference. The print of a foot in the sand can only prove, when considered alone, that there was some figure adapted to it, by which it was produced; but the print of a human foot proves likewise, from our other experience, that there was probably another foot, which also left its impression, though effaced by time or other accidents. Here we mount from the effect to the cause; and descending again from the cause, infer alterations in the effect; but this is not a continuation of the same simple chain of reasoning. We comprehend in this case a hundred other experiences and observations, concerning the usual figure and members of that species of animal, without which this

method of argument must be considered as fallacious and sophistical.

这个情形和我们针对自然中的事物的推理不一样。我们只能通过上帝的造物来认识他的特性，由于他是宇宙间唯一的存在，不能被纳入任何物种和类别中去理解，不然我们可以通过类比，从这些物种和类别的特性或品质中推测他所具有的属性或品质。宇宙呈现了智慧和善良，我们则推测上帝具有智慧和善良的属性。宇宙在一定程度上呈现了这些完美属性，我们也就推测出与我们考察的结果完全相符的完美属性。至于其他的属性或更大程度的同一属性，我们没有任何权利运用正确的推理方法作出推断和假设。既然没有任意假设的权利，我们就不可能从原

The case is not the same with our reasonings from the works of nature. The Deity is known to us only by his productions, and is a single being in the universe, not comprehended under any species or genus, from whose experienced attributes or qualities, we can, by analogy, infer any attribute or quality in him. As the universe shews wisdom and goodness, we infer wisdom and goodness. As it shews a particular degree of these perfections, we infer a particular degree of them, precisely adapted to the effect which we examine. But farther attributes or

因出发进行论证，或者对结果作超越我们直接感知的改变。这一神圣的生灵产生的善行越大，那就证明他具备越大程度的善心，他的奖惩愈加公正合理，也就证明他愈加看重正义和公道。我们任意增加自然界作品的属性，就意味着我们同样增加了自然的创造者之属性。因此，如果没有得到理性和论证的支持，我们所增加的属性只能是凭空假设和凭空推测的结果^{*}。

farther degrees of the same attributes, we can never be authorised to infer or suppose, by any rules of just reasoning. Now, without some such licence of supposition, it is impossible for us to argue from the cause, or infer any alteration in the effect, beyond what has immediately fallen under our observation. Greater good produced by this Being must still prove a greater degree of goodness; a more impartial distribution of rewards and punishments must proceed from a greater regard to justice and equity. Every supposed addition to the works of nature makes an addition to the attributes of the Author of nature; and consequently, being entirely unsupported by any reason or

argument, can never be admitted but as mere conjecture and hypothesis^{*}.

我们在这个话题上之所以会犯错误，会不受约束地恣意猜想，其根源在于我们默许自己具有至高无上的神灵的地位，并且断言，这一神灵在各种情况下都会遵照同样的行为原则，正如我们处在他的位置，也会认为这一原则乃是合理的、正确的选择。但是，日常的自然现象让我们相信，几乎各种事物所遵循的法则和原理都和我们所遵循的大不一样，除此之外，我要说的是，以人类的意向和计划为基础，推及与人类截然不同，并高于人类万分的神灵也有同样的意向和计划，这显然违背了一切类比推理的原则。从我们的经验看来，人性中存在设计规

The great source of our mistake in this subject, and of the unbounded licence of conjecture, which we indulge, is, that we tacitly consider ourselves, as in the place of the Supreme Being, and conclude, that he will, on every occasion, observe the same conduct, which we ourselves, in his situation, would have embraced as reasonable and eligible. But, besides that the ordinary course of nature may convince us, that almost everything is regulated by principles and maxims very different from ours; besides this, I say, it must evidently appear

划和心向性情之间的连贯性，所以我们一旦从某个事情中发现某人的一种意图，依据经验我们往往可以合理地推测出他的另一种意图，并且能对他过去和未来的行为得出一长串结论。但是，对于如此遥远、如此不可理解的神灵，这种推理方法就完全不适用。这样的神灵和宇宙中其他事物间的差异之大，胜于太阳和蜡烛之间的差异；他只留下了些许痕迹和踪影，除此之外，我们没有任何依据认为他还具备其他的属性或美德。我们想象的无上的美德说不定真的是一项缺陷。如果真是一种至高无上的美德，但是如果我们在崇高的神灵尚未在其作品里充分显示这一美德的时候，就认定这是他所具有的美德，这与其说是正确的推理和健全的哲学判断，毋宁说是巴结谄媚和阿谀奉承之举。因此，

contrary to all rules of analogy to reason, from the intentions and projects of men, to those of a Being so different, and so much superior. In human nature, there is a certain experienced coherence of designs and inclinations; so that when, from any fact, we have discovered one intention of any man, it may often be reasonable, from experience, to infer another, and draw a long chain of conclusions concerning his past or future conduct. But this method of reasoning can never have place with regard to a Being, so remote and incomprehensible, who bears much less analogy to any other being in the universe than the sun to a waxen taper, and who discovers himself

世界上一切哲学和一切宗教（其实也只是一种哲学），都不能使我们超越寻常的经验，也不能为我们提供有别于我们从日常生活的反思中得来的行为规范。除了我们从实践和观察所得之外，我们不能依据宗教假设来推测任何新的事实，也不能预见或预言任何别的事件，更不能期待获得某种额外的奖赏，或畏惧遭受某种额外的惩罚。我替伊壁鸠鲁所作的辩护似乎仍然是有理由的，是让人满意的；社会的政治利益和涉及形上学和宗教的哲学论争之间没有任何联系。

only by some faint traces or outlines, beyond which we have no authority to ascribe to him any attribute or perfection. What we imagine to be a superior perfection, may really be a defect. Or were it ever so much a perfection, the ascribing of it to the Supreme Being, where it appears not to have been really exerted, to the full, in his works, savours more of flattery and panegyric, than of just reasoning and sound philosophy. All the philosophy, therefore, in the world, and all the religion, which is nothing but a species of philosophy, will never be able to carry us beyond the usual course of experience, or give us measures of conduct and behaviour different from those which are

furnished by reflections on common life. No new fact can ever be inferred from the religious hypothesis; no event foreseen or foretold; no reward or punishment expected or dreaded, beyond what is already known by practice and observation. So that my apology for Epicurus will still appear solid and satisfactory; nor have the political interests of society any connexion with the philosophical disputes concerning metaphysics and religion.

我对他说，你似乎还忽略了另一种情况。虽然我承认你的前提是合理的，但是我必须拒绝你得出的结论。你的结论是，宗教学说和推理方式对生活没有影响，因为它们

There is still one circumstance, replied I, which you seem to have overlooked. Though I should allow your premises, I must deny your conclusion. You conclude,

本来就不该产生影响。可是你从来没有考虑到，人们不是用你的方式来思考问题的，他们是从神圣存在的信念中推测出许多结果，认为至上的神灵会在日常的自然表象之外，对邪恶实施惩罚，对美德给予奖赏。他们的这种思考方式正确与否，其实并不重要。但是这对他们的生活和行为的影响必然还是一样的。有些人尽量让自己免于这类偏见，我认为他们是用正确的方式来思考的，但是我并不认为他们就是好的公民，或者好的政治家。因为他们让人们摆脱掉了激情的羁绊，在某一方面让他们更容易、更安全地干违法乱纪的事情。

that religious doctrines and reasonings can have no influence on life, because they ought to have no influence; never considering, that men reason not in the same manner you do, but draw many consequences from the belief of a divine Existence, and suppose that the Deity will inflict punishments on vice, and bestow rewards on virtue, beyond what appear in the ordinary course of nature. Whether this reasoning of theirs be just or not, is no matter. Its influence on their life and conduct must still be the same. And those, who attempt to disabuse them of such prejudices, may, for aught I know, be good reasoners, but I cannot allow them to be good citizens and politi-

cians; since they free men from one restraint upon their passions, and make the infringement of the laws of society, in one respect, more easy and secure.

我可能很赞同你拥护自由的总的结论，但是我赞同的依据和你得出这个结论的依据并不一样。我认为国家应该对每一种哲学原则持宽容的态度，没有哪一个政府因为持这样的宽容态度而损害了它的政治利益。哲学家们不是热情高涨的人，他们的学说对于普通人并无太大的吸引力，我们不能限制他们的推理方式，除非他们的推理方式慢慢地在一般人十分关心的领域铺上残害和压迫的道路，从而对科学，甚或对国家造成危害。

After all, I may, perhaps, agree to your general conclusion in favour of liberty, though upon different premises from those, on which you endeavour to found it. I think, that the state ought to tolerate every principle of philosophy; nor is there an instance, that any government has suffered in its political interests by such indulgence. There is no enthusiasm among philosophers; their doctrines are not very alluring to the people; and no restraint can be put upon

their reasonings, but what must be of dangerous consequence to the sciences, and even to the state, by paving the way for persecution and oppression in points, where the generality of mankind are more deeply interested and concerned.

我接着说，你谈论的主题让我想到了一种困难。我现在只把这种困难向你提出来，不作深入探究，以免陷入过于细致精深的推理过程。一句话，我非常怀疑我们是否能只通过结果来认识一个原因，像你一直假设的，或者是否存在非常独特、十分特殊的原因，和我们见过的其他任何原因任何事物都不一样，没有相似之处。只有我们见到两事物恒常地同时出现，我们才能从一事物推

But there occurs to me (continued I) with regard to your main topic, a difficulty, which I shall just propose to you without insisting on it; lest it lead into reasonings of too nice and delicate a nature. In a word, I much doubt whether it be possible for a cause to be known only by its effect (as you have all along supposed) or to be of so singular and particular a nature as to have no

测出另一事物。假如某种结果是完全特殊的，不能在我们已知的事物中得到理解，我认为我们就无法对造成该结果的原因做出任何猜想或推测。如果在进行这类推测时，我们所能合理遵循的惟一向导只有经验、观察和类比，那么结果和原因就一定得同我们已知的结果和原因之间存在相似性，因为我们从许多例证中发现这样的结果总是和这样的原因伴随在一块的。请你自己通过思考来追寻这个原则的结果。我只想指出，既然伊壁鸠鲁的反对者们总是假设宇宙这个独特的前所未有的结果正好证明了神圣神灵这个同样独特、同样前所未有的原因的存在，从这个假设来看，你的推论至少是值得我们注意的。我承认，我们如何从原因反过来推出结果，如何能从原因的观念出发，推测出结果中的变化，或者增加结果的内容，这是有一定难度的。

parallel and no similarity with any other cause or object, that has ever fallen under our observation. It is only when two species of objects are found to be constantly conjoined, that we can infer the one from the other; and were an effect presented, which was entirely singular, and could not be comprehended under any known species, I do not see, that we could form any conjecture or inference at all concerning its cause. If experience and observation and analogy be, indeed, the only guides which we can reasonably follow in inferences of this nature; both the effect and cause must bear a similarity and resemblance to other effects and causes, which we know, and which we have found, in many instances, to be conjoined with each other. I leave it to your own reflection to pursue the consequences of this principle. I shall just observe, that, as the antagonists of Epicurus always suppose the universe, an effect quite singular and unparalleled, to be the proof of a Deity, a cause no less singular and unparalleled; your reasonings, upon that supposition, seem, at least, to merit our attention. There is, I own, some difficulty, how we can ever return from the cause to the effect, and, reasoning from our ideas of the former, infer any alteration on the latter, or any, addition to it.

第十二章 论怀疑哲学

Section XII Of the Academical or
Sceptical Philosophy

第一节

Part I

证明无上的神灵的存在，批驳无神论的谬误，围绕这些话题产生的哲学论争数量之多，胜于任何其他题目。然而，即便是最富于宗教性的哲学家也还在争论，世上是否有人盲目至极，竟成为一个善于思辨的无神论者。我们如何能调和这其中的矛盾呢？四处巡游的骑士们一心要把世上的蛟龙和巨人消灭干净，他们对于这些妖魔的存在，从未有过丝毫的怀疑。

There is not a greater number of philosophical reasonings, displayed upon any subject, than those, which prove the existence of a Deity, and refute the fallacies of Atheists; and yet the most religious philosophers still dispute whether any man can be so blinded as to be a speculative atheist. How shall we reconcile these contradictions? The knights errant, who wandered about to clear the world of dragons and giants, never entertained the least doubt with

regard to the existence of these monsters.

怀疑论者是宗教的另一个敌人，他自然而然地激起一切神学家和更严肃的哲学家的愤怒。如果一个人有任何有关行动或思辨的话题上都没有自己的见解和原则，一定荒唐至极。不过可以确定地说，这样的人谁也没有见过，不曾与之交流过。这就让我们不禁要问：怀疑论者指的是什么样的人？我们可以把怀疑论哲学原则向前推进到什么地步？

The Sceptic is another enemy of religion, who naturally provokes the indignation of all divines and graver philosophers; though it is certain, that no man ever met with any such absurd creature, or conversed with a man, who had no opinion or principle concerning any subject, either of action or speculation. This begets a very natural question; What is meant by a sceptic? And how far it is possible to push these philosophical principles of doubt and uncertainty?

有一种先于一切研究和哲学的怀疑主

There is a species of scepticism, ante-

义，是笛卡尔和他人反复倡导的，认为它是防止人们犯错误和作出轻率判断的灵丹妙药。该怀疑论提倡对事物采取普遍的怀疑态度，我们不仅要怀疑我们先前的一切意见和原则，还要怀疑我们自己的各种官能。他们说，我们必须根据一种没有任何错误、不带任何欺骗性的初始原则进行环环相扣的推论，才能保证我们的意见和原则是正确的，我们的官能是良好的。但是，世间根本没有这样一种高于其他原则的初始原则，既不言自明，又具说服力。即使真有这样的原则，我们要往前超越一步，也只能借助我们本该持怀疑态度的那些官能。因此，笛卡尔式的怀疑论显然是不可能实现的，就算真的有人能达到，那也完全是不可救药的，因为没有任何推论可以让我们在任何话题上达到确信的

的状态。

然而，我们必须承认，适当地持有这一种怀疑论是可以理解的，也是哲学研究必要的准备，因为它让我们能够更加公正地判断是非，帮助我们摆脱我们从教育和草率的见解中得来的各种偏见。从清楚明白的原则出发，踏着谨慎而稳健的步履前行，不时检查我们的结论，仔细考察它们引起的一切后果，我们虽然只能凭借这些方法推动我们的

cedent to all study and philosophy, which is much inculcated by Des Cartes and others, as a sovereign preservative against error and precipitate judgement. It recommends an universal doubt, not only of all our former opinions and principles, but also of our very faculties; of whose veracity, say they, we must assure ourselves, by a chain of reasoning, deduced from some original principle, which cannot possibly be fallacious or deceitful. But neither is there any such original principle, which has a prerogative above others, that are self-evident and convincing; or if there were, could we advance a step beyond it, but by the use of those very faculties, of which we are sup-

posed to be already diffident. The Cartesian doubt, therefore, were it ever possible to be attained by any human creature (as it plainly is not) would be entirely incurable; and no reasoning could ever bring us to a state of assurance and conviction upon any subject.

It must, however, be confessed, that this species of scepticism, when more moderate, may be understood in a very reasonable sense, and is a necessary preparative to the study of philosophy, by preserving a proper impartiality in our judgements, and weaning our mind from all those prejudices, which we may have imbibed from education

哲学研究缓慢前行，但是这却是我们希望达到真理，在我们的研究中寻求稳定和确定的结果的唯一方法。

还有一种怀疑主义是伴随科学和研究而来的，人们从科学和研究中要么发现他们的大脑官能是绝对错误的，要么发现他们的大脑官能在其寻常的思辨研究中不能得出任何明确的结论。有一类哲学家甚至对我们的感

官本身提出了怀疑，日常生活中的原则和形而上学及神学中最玄奥的原理或结论一样，都受到了同样的怀疑。因为有些哲学家宣扬这些似是而非的教条（如果称得上教条的话），而另一些哲学家却批驳这些教条，这就自然引起了我们的好奇，要去探究它们赖以建立的观点。

各个时代的怀疑论者们使用过许多陈腐

or rash opinion. To begin with clear and self-evident principles, to advance by timorous and sure steps, to review frequently our conclusions, and examine accurately all their consequences; though by these means we shall make both a slow and a short progress in our systems; are the only methods, by which we can ever hope to reach truth, and attain a proper stability and certainty in our determinations.

There is another species of scepticism, consequent to science and enquiry, when men are supposed to have discovered, either the absolute fallaciousness of their mental faculties, or their unfitness to reach

any fixed determination in all those curious subjects of speculation, about which they are commonly employed. Even our very senses are brought into dispute, by a certain species of philosophers; and the maxims of common life are subjected to the same doubt as the most profound principles or conclusions of metaphysics and theology. As these paradoxical tenets (if they may be called tenets) are to be met with in some philosophers, and the refutation of them in several, they naturally excite our curiosity, and make us enquire into the arguments, on which they may be founded.

I need not insist upon the more trite

老套的话题来反驳感官的证据，诸如由我们的器官缺失和谬误在许多场合所引起的问题；例如桨在水中显得弯曲的样子；例如离我们远近不等的物体呈现的不同形状；又如挤压一只眼睛所产生的重影，以及许多类似的现象，等等。在此我无需对这些话题作深入探究。事实上，这些怀疑论话题仅仅能够证明，我们不能全靠感官来认识事物，而应当通过理性和思考来修正感官的证据，要考虑媒介的性质、物体的远近、器官的特性，使它们在各自的范围内成为辨别真伪的适当标准。当然，还有别的反对感官证据的论述，要深入得多，是不能这样简单对待的。

topics, employed by the sceptics in all ages, against the evidence of sense; such as those which are derived from the imperfection and fallaciousness of our organs, on numberless occasions; the crooked appearance of an oar in water; the various aspects of objects, according to their different distances; the double images which arise from the pressing one eye; with many other appearances of a like nature. These sceptical topics, indeed, are only sufficient to prove, that the senses alone are not implicitly to be depended on; but that we must correct their evidence by reason, and by considerations, derived from the nature of the medium, the distance of the object, and the disposition of

似乎很明确的是，人类出于本能或先入之见，信任他们的感官；我们往往无需任何推理，甚至无需动用理性，就能设定有一个外在的宇宙，其存在不依赖我们的知觉，纵然没有人类及一切有理智情感的生灵，或是我们和一切有理智情感的生灵都被消灭殆尽了，它依然会存在。就是动物界也受这种观点支配，在其思想、计划和行动中，都保持着这种对外界事物的信念。

the organ, in order to render them, within their sphere, the proper criteria of truth and falsehood. There are other more profound arguments against the senses, which admit not of so easy a solution.

It seems evident, that men are carried, by a natural instinct or prepossession, to repose faith in their senses; and that, without any reasoning, or even almost before the use of reason, we always suppose an external universe, which depends not on our perception, but would exist, though we and every sensible creature were absent or annihilated. Even the animal creation are governed by a like opinion, and preserve this

同样显而易见的是，人类在追随这种盲目却强大的本能之时，总是认定感官显现的形象就是外界事物本身，从未怀疑一者只是另一者影像的再现而已。我们眼中的这张白色的桌子，摸上去很结实，我们认为它独立于我们的感官而存在，乃是我们心理之外的物体，我们不过是感知到它而已。桌子不因我们在场而存在，不因我们不在场而消失。其自身一致且完整地存在着，不因任何感知和思索其存在的智慧生灵的境况而改变。

但是，人类这一普遍的基本信念很快就被最浅显的哲学摧毁了。哲学告诉我们，呈现到我们心中的不过是事物的印象或我们对于事物的知觉，我们的各种感官只是一些通道，事物的印象藉此传入，感官本身并不使我们的的心灵和外界事物进行直接的交流。我们眼前的这张桌子，在我们往后退时，似乎就变小了。而真实的桌子不以我们的意识为转移，本身并没有发生什么变化。可见呈现于我们心中的只是桌子的影像而已。这显然是理性在指引我们。任何人只要用心思考都不会怀疑，我们说“这间房子”、“那棵树”，

belief of external objects, in all their thoughts, designs, and actions.

It seems also evident, that, when men follow this blind and powerful instinct of nature, they always suppose the very images, presented by the senses, to be the external objects, and never entertain any suspicion, that the one are nothing but representations of the other. This very table, which we see white, and which we feel hard, is believed to exist, independent of our perception, and to be something external to our mind, which perceives it. Our presence bestows not being on it; our absence does not annihilate it. It preserves its existence

uniform and entire, independent of the situation of intelligent beings, who perceive or contemplate it.

But this universal and primary opinion of all men is soon destroyed by the slightest philosophy, which teaches us, that nothing can ever be present to the mind but an image or perception, and that the senses are only the inlets, through which these images are conveyed, without being able to produce any immediate intercourse between the mind and the object. The table, which we see, seems to diminish, as we remove farther from it; but the real table, which exists independent of us, suffers no alteration;

所指的存在不过是心中的知觉，不过是别的独立存在的事物在我们心中留下的飘忽不定的摹本或影像。

由此看来，我们有必要通过理性来反驳或抛弃自然的原始本能，来接纳一种关于感官证据的新的体系。但是，哲学如果要为这个新的体系正名，并排除怀疑论者的指责和反对，就会发现自己陷于十分窘迫的境地。哲学不能再为那种准确无误的、不可抗拒的

自然本能申辩，因为那将把我们引入一个完全不同的体系，一个被认为是缺陷的，甚至是错误的体系。然而，要借助一连串清楚有力的论证，或者貌似论证，为这个所谓的哲学体系正名，又超出了人类的能力所限。

我们凭借什么论证可以证明，心中的知觉一定是由外界事物引起，尽管它们和外界事物相似（如果可能的话），实际上却是和外界事物全然不同的呢？凭什么可以证明这些知觉既不能由心灵的力量自发引起，也不

it was, therefore, nothing but its image, which was present to the mind. These are the obvious dictates of reason; and no man, who reflects, ever doubted, that the existences, which we consider, when we say, this house and that tree, are nothing but perceptions in the mind, and fleeting copies or representations of other existences, which remain uniform and independent.

So far, then, are we necessitated by reasoning to contradict or depart from the primary instincts of nature, and to embrace a new system with regard to the evidence of our senses. But here philosophy finds herself extremely embarrassed, when she

would justify this new system, and obviate the cavils and objections of the sceptics. She can no longer plead the infallible and irresistible instinct of nature, for that led us to a quite different system, which is acknowledged fallible and even erroneous. And to justify this pretended philosophical system, by a chain of clear and convincing argument, or even any appearance of argument, exceeds the power of all human capacity.

By what argument can it be proved, that the perceptions of the mind must be caused by external objects, entirely different from them, though resembling them (if that be possible) and could not arise either from

能由某种无形的、不可知的精神暗示所产生，更不是由我们全然不知的缘由所导致的呢？我们承认，事实上这类知觉许多并不是由外界事物引起的，比如人们在做梦，处于疯狂状态或有其他疾病时。令人最难解释的是物体作用于心灵的方式，二者本是截然不同，甚至完全相反的事物，物体何以能将自身的影像传达给心灵呢？

一个实际问题是，感官中的知觉是否是由与之相似的外界事物所引起的。这个问题该如何来解决呢？当然是借助经验，和其他

性质类似的问题一样。但是在这个问题上，经验完全是沉默不语的，也必须是沉默不语的。呈现在我们心中的除了知觉，别无他物，我们的心灵不可能自己获得知觉与事物之间有联系的经验。因此，我们只是假设有一种联系，而这种推论实则没有任何依据的。

借助无上神灵的真实确凿，来证明我们感官的真实确凿，显然是出乎意料地绕了一个圈。如果他的真实的确与此事有关，我们的感官就不会出现任何错误，因为他是不可能欺骗人的。更不用说，如果连外在的世界也受到怀疑，我们将不知道从哪里去寻找证

the energy of the mind itself, or from the suggestion of some invisible and unknown spirit, or from some other causes still more unknown to us? It is acknowledged, that, in fact, many of these perceptions arise not from anything external, as in dreams, madness, and other diseases. And nothing can be more inexplicable than the manner, in which body should so operate upon mind as ever to convey an image of itself to a substance, supposed of so different, and even contrary a nature.

It is a question of fact, whether the perceptions of the senses be produced by external objects, resembling them. How shall

this question be determined? By experience surely; as all other questions of a like nature. But here experience is, and must be entirely silent. The mind has never anything present to it but the perceptions, and cannot possibly reach any experience of their connexion with objects. The supposition of such a connexion is, therefore, without any foundation in reasoning.

To have recourse to the veracity of the supreme Being, in order to prove the veracity of our senses, is surely making a very unexpected circuit. If his veracity were at all concerned in this matter, our senses would be entirely infallible; because it is not pos-

据，来证明那个至高无上的神灵确实存在，或者证明他确实具有某些属性。

因此，在这个论题上，那些比较深刻的、更富哲学意识的怀疑论者总是会占上风，他们努力把普遍怀疑观引入人类知识和研究的各个领域。他们会问，你是按照自然的本能和天性来相信感官的真实吗？如果是这样，你会相信你的知觉或你所感知的影像就是外界事物本身。你会抛弃这个原则，接受另一个更合理的观点，认为各种知觉只不过外界事物在心中的一种表现吗？这样的

话，你既背离了自己的自然天性和明显的情感，又无法满足你的理性，因为理性不能从经验中找出有力的证据，来证明知觉和外界事物之间是有联系的。

还有一个类似的怀疑论话题，是从最玄奥的哲学衍生而来的。如果我们必须深入研究，以发现那些其实并无任何严肃用途的论证和推理，那么这就是一个值得我们关注的

sible that he can ever deceive. Not to mention, that, if the external world be once called in question, we shall be at a loss to find arguments, by which we may prove the existence of that Being or any of his attributes.

This is a topic, therefore, in which the profounder and more philosophical sceptics will always triumph, when they endeavour to introduce an universal doubt into all subjects of human knowledge and enquiry. Do you follow the instincts and propensities of nature, may they say, in assenting to the veracity of sense? But these lead you to believe that the very perception or sensible

image is the external object. Do you disclaim this principle, in order to embrace a more rational opinion, that the perceptions are only representations of something external? You here depart from your natural propensities and more obvious sentiments; and yet are not able to satisfy your reason, which can never find any convincing argument from experience to prove, that the perceptions are connected with any external objects.

There is another sceptical topic of a like nature, derived from the most profound philosophy; which might merit our attention, were it requisite to dive so deep, in or-

话题。现代的研究者们普遍承认，事物可感知的一切属性，诸如物体的软硬、冷热、黑白等等，都是事物次要的属性，本身并不存在于事物之中，而是我们心里的知觉，不代表任何外在的原型或模式。如果我们承认事物的次要属性确实如此，那么，关于事物广延性和实在性的基本属性也不例外，况且后者并不比前者更有权利获得“基本属性”这个称谓。事物广延性的观念完全来自视觉和触觉，如果感官感知的一切属性都只在心中，而不在事物本身，那么这个结论必须同样适用于广延性的观念，因为它完全建立在我们感知的观念或事物次要属性的观念之上。我们得出这个结论是不可避免的，除非我们断言事物的基本属性是通过抽象推理得来的。只要我们仔细考察，就会发现这个观点是难

der to discover arguments and reasonings, which can so little serve to any serious purpose. It is universally allowed by modern enquirers, that all the sensible qualities of objects, such as hard, soft, hot, cold, white, black, &c. are merely secondary, and exist not in the objects themselves, but are perceptions of the mind, without any external archetype or model, which they represent. If this be allowed, with regard to secondary qualities, it must also follow, with regard to the supposed primary qualities of extension and solidity; nor can the latter be any more entitled to that denomination than the former. The idea of extension is entirely acquired from the senses of sight and feeling;

以理解的，甚至是荒谬的。既看不见又摸不着的广延性无法想象，看得见或摸得着的广延性，既不硬又不软，既非黑也非白，同样超出了人类想象的范围。让任何人来构想一个三角形，既不等腰又不等边，各边无确定的长度和比例，他立刻就会明白，就抽象思维和概括的思想而言，经院哲学的一切观念有多么荒谬。^{*}

and if all the qualities, perceived by the senses, be in the mind, not in the object, the same conclusion must reach the idea of extension, which is wholly dependent on the sensible ideas or the ideas of secondary qualities. Nothing can save us from this conclusion, but the asserting, that the ideas of those primary qualities are attained by Abstraction, an opinion, which, if we examine it accurately, we shall find to be unintelligible, and even absurd. An extension, that is neither tangible nor visible, cannot possibly be conceived; and a tangible or visible extension, which is neither hard nor soft, black nor white, is equally beyond the reach of human conception. Let any man try to

conceive a triangle in general, which is neither Isosceles nor Scalenum, nor has any particular length or proportion of sides; and he will soon perceive the absurdity of all the scholastic notions with regard to abstraction and general ideas.*

因此，对于感官的证据，或对于外界事物存在的观点，从哲学的角度看，第一种反对意见就是：如果这个观点建立在自然本能上，它就违反了理性，如果涉及到理性，则又违背了人类的自然本能，并且没有任何合理的证据来说服公正的探究者。第二层反驳就更进一步，认为这个观点违背理性，至少可以说，如果它是理性的原则，那么我们感知的一切属性都只在心中，而不在事物本

Thus the first philosophical objection to the evidence of sense or to the opinion of external existence consists in this, that such an opinion, if rested on natural instinct, is contrary to reason, and if referred to reason, is contrary to natural instinct, and at the same time carries no rational evidence with it, to convince an impartial enquirer. The second objection goes farther,

身。如果把事物的一切可认知的属性，包括基本属性和次要属性，都给剥夺了，你无异于把事物给消灭了，只留下一种无从认知、难以理喻的东西作为引起我们知觉的原因。这个观念漏洞百出，没有哪个怀疑论者会认为值得一驳。

and represents this opinion as contrary to reason; at least, if it be a principle of reason, that all sensible qualities are in the mind, not in the object. Bereave matter of all its intelligible qualities, both primary and secondary, you in a manner annihilate it, and leave only a certain unknown, inexplicable something, as the cause of our perceptions; a notion so imperfect, that no sceptic will think it worth while to contend against it.

第二节

Part II

怀疑论者借助论证和推理来消灭理性，似乎显得很狂妄，然而这的确是他们研究和争论的宏大目标。他们试图寻找一些证据来

It may seem a very extravagant attempt of the sceptics to destroy reason by argument and ratiocination; yet is this the grand

反驳我们的抽象推理，以及我们关于客观事实和存在的推论。

反对一切抽象推理的主要理由来自空间和时间的观念。在日常生活中，乍一看，这些观念是非常明白清楚的，但是在深奥科学（它们正是这些科学的主要对象）的研究之下，它们为我们提供的却是一些充满了荒谬和矛盾的原则。人们为驯服和压制人类的反叛理性提出过许多震撼常识的宗教信条，然而最震撼常识的，莫过于事物广延性的无限分割说，及其各种结果。所有几何学家和玄学家都堂而皇之、得意忘形地展示过这个学说。一个真实的数量，永远小于任何特定的

量，同时又包含比自身小的无限数量，可以无限往下推。这栋庞大的建筑实在太张扬，太怪异，没有哪种演示方法可以承受它的重量，因为它震撼了人类理性最明白最自然的原则。^{*}然而更不可思议的是，这些似乎荒谬的观点却是建立在一连串最清楚、最自然的推论之上的。而且，我们只要承认了前提，就不可能不承认其结论。最具说服力、最令人满意的莫过于涉及圆形和三角形属性的结论。但是我们一旦接受了这些结论，我们就无法否认，圆和切线间的接触角无限小于任何直线角；随着圆的直径无限增大，这个接触角就无限缩小；其他曲线和其切线间的接触角无限小于圆形和其切线间的接触角，如此等等，可以无限往下推。这些原则可以演示得无懈可击，就像证明三角形三内

scope of all their enquiries and disputes. They endeavour to find objections, both to our abstract reasonings, and to those which regard matter of fact and existence.

The chief objection against all abstract reasonings is derived from the ideas of space and time; ideas, which, in common life and to a careless view, are very clear and intelligible, but when they pass through the scrutiny of the profound sciences (and they are the chief object of these sciences) afford principles, which seem full of absurdity and contradiction. No priestly dogmas, invented on purpose to tame and subdue the rebellious reason of mankind, ever shocked com-

mon sense more than the doctrine of the infinite divisibility of extension, with its consequences; as they are pompously displayed by all geometricians and metaphysicians, with a kind of triumph and exultation. A real quantity, infinitely less than any finite quantity, containing quantities infinitely less than itself, and so on in infinitum; this is an edifice so bold and prodigious, that it is too weighty for any pretended demonstration to support, because it shocks the clearest and most natural principles of human reason^{*}. But what renders the matter more extraordinary, is, that these seemingly absurd opinions are supported by a chain of reasoning, the clearest and most natural;

角之和等于两个直角之和一样。不同的是，后面这个观点很自然，很容易证明，而前者则矛盾重重、荒谬至极。在这里理性似乎被抛入一种惊诧和犹疑中，如果没有怀疑论者的指引，理性就会怀疑自己，怀疑她所行走的土地。它看见一片绚丽的光芒照亮了某些地方，但是亮光却和最幽深的黑暗交接在一起。理性身处光明和黑暗之间，既感到晕眩，又感到迷惑，对任何事物都没有确定和实在的把握。

nor is it possible for us to allow the premises without admitting the consequences. Nothing can be more convincing and satisfactory than all the conclusions concerning the properties of circles and triangles; and yet, when these are once received, how can we deny, that the angle of contact between a circle and its tangent is infinitely less than any rectilineal angle, that as you may increase the diameter of the circle in infinitum, this angle of contact becomes still less, even in infinitum, and that the angle of contact between other curves and their tangents may be infinitely less than those between any circle and its tangent, and so on, in infinitum? The demon-

stration of these principles seems as unexceptionable as that which proves the three angles of a triangle to be equal to two right ones, though the latter opinion be natural and easy, and the former big with contradiction and absurdity. Reason here seems to be thrown into a kind of amazement and suspence, which, without the suggestions of any sceptic, gives her a diffidence of herself, and of the ground on which she treads. She sees a full light, which illuminates certain places; but that light borders upon the most profound darkness. And between these she is so dazzled and confounded, that she scarcely can pronounce with certainty and assurance concerning any one object.

抽象科学中这些狂妄结论的荒谬之处，在时间上比在广延性方面可能显得更为突出。时间被分为无数真实的组成部分，前后相连，逐一消逝耗尽，分明矛盾至极。我们认为，任何人只要其判断没有被这些科学所毁损（更不用说得到改善），都不会接受这样的观点。

然而，理性仍然躁动不安，即便被这些看似荒谬和矛盾的事物驱赶到怀疑主义的边缘，也是如此。一个清楚明白的观念包含同其自身相矛盾，或与另一个清楚明白的观念

相矛盾的东西，这简直无法理解，其荒谬程度已经达到了我们想象的极限。可见，最具怀疑色彩、最令人犹疑不定的莫过于从几何学或数量科学似是而非的结论中衍生而来的怀疑主义本身。^{*}

针对道德证据，或针对事实本身的推论，有两种怀疑主义的反对意见：一为通俗层面的，一为哲学层面的。通俗层面的反对意见来自如下各种因素：人类理解中固有的弱点；不同时代、不同民族的人所持有的相

The absurdity of these bold determinations of the abstract sciences seems to become, if possible, still more palpable with regard to time than extension. An infinite number of real parts of time, passing in succession, and exhausted one after another, appears so evident a contradiction, that no man, one should think, whose judgement is not corrupted, instead of being improved, by the sciences, would ever be able to admit of it.

Yet still reason must remain restless, and unquiet, even with regard to that scepticism, to which she is driven by these seeming absurdities and contradictions.

How any clear, distinct idea can contain circumstances, contradictory to itself, or to any other clear, distinct idea, is absolutely incomprehensible; and is, perhaps, as absurd as any proposition, which can be formed. So that nothing can be more sceptical, or more full of doubt and hesitation, than this scepticism itself, which arises from some of the paradoxical conclusions of geometry or the science of quantity.^{*}

The sceptical objections to moral evidence, or to the reasonings concerning matter of fact, are either popular or philosophical. The popular objections are derived from the natural weakness of human under-

互矛盾的观点；人在健康状态和生病状态、青年时期和老年时期、顺境和逆境中等不同情形下所具备判断能力的变化；每个个体观念和情感中永远存在的矛盾，以及其他许多诸如此类的问题。在这里无需一一列举。这些反驳都没有说服力。因为在日常生活中，我们时刻都在进行与事实和存在相关的推理，而实际上离开了这类持续存在的推理，我们就无法生存下去。但是，从中衍生出来的通俗的反对意见却不足以消灭关于事实的证据。皮浪主义学说或过分的怀疑主义原则的伟大颠覆者，乃是行动，是事务，是日常生活中的种种消遣。这些原则可以在经院中得以兴盛，因为要在经院中要批驳这些原则虽说不是不可能，但也是很困难的。可是一旦离开了庇护它们的树荫，在触动我们激情

和感觉的真实事物面前，它们就会和我们天性中更强有力的原则对立起来，并会立刻烟消云散，使得最坚定的怀疑论者也会陷入同其他凡夫俗子一样的境地。

由此看来，怀疑论者最好把自己控制在适当的范围内，并从更加深入的研究中提出

standing; the contradictory opinions, which have been entertained in different ages and nations; the variations of our judgement in sickness and health, youth and old age, prosperity and adversity; the perpetual contradiction of each particular man's opinions and sentiments; with many other topics of that kind. It is needless to insist farther on this head. These objections are but weak. For as, in common life, we reason every moment concerning fact and existence, and cannot possibly subsist, without continually employing this species of argument, any popular objections, derived from thence, must be insufficient to destroy that evidence. The great subverter of Pyrrhonism or

the excessive principles of scepticism is action, and employment, and the occupations of common life. These principles may flourish and triumph in the schools; where it is, indeed, difficult, if not impossible, to refute them. But as soon as they leave the shade, and by the presence of the real objects, which actuate our passions and sentiments, are put in opposition to the more powerful principles of our nature, they vanish like smoke, and leave the most determined sceptic in the same condition as other mortals.

The sceptic, therefore, had better keep within his proper sphere, and display those

富有哲学性的反对意见。这样他似乎会有充分的胜算，因为他合理地坚持如下观点：我们关于任何客观事实的证据——存在于感官和记忆之外——完全来自因果关系；但是我们除了对两种经常结伴出现的事物有所了解之外，对于因果关系并更多的了解；我们没有充分的证据说服自己这样一种事实：在我们过去的经验中恒常结伴出现的事物，在其他场合也会以同样的方式结伴出现；致使我们得出这个推论的不过是习惯和某种自然的本能，我们很难拒绝这种本能，但是它像其他本能一样，可能是错误和带有欺骗性的。假如怀疑论者紧紧围绕这些话题展开论证，就能展示他的说服力，或者确切地说，是他的不足之处，也是我们的弱点所在。这一论证，恍惚一看，至少暂时消灭了一切的确证

和信念。这些论证若是真的可以为社会带来经久的好处和利益，我们不妨可以充分地展开。

因为在这里我们可以提出对过分的怀疑主义最重要、最猛烈的反驳，那就是，尽管这种怀疑主义显得强大而且充满活力，但是它不能为社会带来经久的利益。我们只需要问一问这样的怀疑论者：他所传达的意义何

philosophical objections, which arise from more profound researches. Here he seems to have ample matter of triumph; while he justly insists, that all our evidence for any matter of fact, which lies beyond the testimony of sense or memory, is derived entirely from the relation of cause and effect; that we have no other idea of this relation than that of two objects, which have been frequently conjoined together; that we have no argument to convince us, that objects, which have, in our experience, been frequently conjoined, will likewise, in other instances, be conjoined in the same manner; and that nothing leads us to this inference but custom or a certain instinct of our

nature; which it is indeed difficult to resist, but which, like other instincts, may be fallacious and deceitful. While the sceptic insists upon these topics, he shows his force, or rather, indeed, his own and our weakness; and seems, for the time at least, to destroy all assurance and conviction. These arguments might be displayed at greater length, if any durable good or benefit to society could ever be expected to result from them.

For here is the chief and most confounding objection to excessive scepticism, that no durable good can ever result from it; while it remains in its full force and vigour. We need only ask such a sceptic: What his

在？他想通过这些好奇的研究提出什么观点？他立刻就会不知所措，无言以对。哥白尼的追随者或信奉托勒密学说的人，都各自捍卫自己所支持的天文学原理，可能希望提出某种能让自己的读者和听众始终如一确信的东西。一个斯多葛学派学者或伊壁鸠鲁学派的信徒提出的原则或许并不持久，但却能影响人们的行为举止。但是，一个皮浪主义怀疑论者却不能指望他的哲学能对人心产生任何持续性的影响，或者即便有影响，他也不能指望这一影响会有益于社会。相反，如果他有什么要承认的，他就必须承认，他的原则若是得以恒久、普遍地盛行，一切人类生活都会消失殆尽。所有的话语、所有的行动都会立刻终止，人们会完全处于昏聩的状态，直至自然的需要得不到满足，从而彻底

meaning is? And what he proposes by all these curious researches? He is immediately at a loss, and knows not what to answer. A Copernican or Ptolemaic, who supports each his different system of astronomy, may hope to produce a conviction, which will remain constant and durable, with his audience. A Stoic or Epicurean displays principles, which may not be durable, but which have an effect on conduct and behaviour. But a Pyrrhonian cannot expect, that his philosophy will have any constant influence on the mind; or if it had, that its influence would be beneficial to society. On the contrary, he must acknowledge, if he will acknowledge anything, that all human

结束他们痛苦的生存。诚然，我们无须恐惧会出现这样可怕的事情。自然总是很强大，不是什么原则可以左右的。尽管皮浪主义怀疑论者可以通过玄奥的推论把自己或他人置于短暂的诧异和纷乱之中，但是生活中最基本、最琐碎的现实会驱散他的一切疑虑和顾忌，让他和其他派别的哲学家们一样行动和思考，甚至和那些从未进行哲学研究的人们没有任何区别。怀疑论者一旦从自己的睡梦中醒来，一定会是第一个嘲笑自己的人，并且会承认他所有的反驳不过是搞笑而已，除了展示人类怪诞的生存状态，别无其他目的。人类虽然不能靠自己最勤勉的探索找到令自己满意的行动、思考和信仰的基础，也不能消除别人针对他们提出的各种反对的观点，但是他们依然要行动、要思考、要有自

life must perish, were his principles universally and steadily to prevail. All discourse, all action would immediately cease; and men remain in a total lethargy, till the necessities of nature, unsatisfied, put an end to their miserable existence. It is true; so fatal an event is very little to be dreaded. Nature is always too strong for principle. And though a Pyrrhonian may throw himself or others into a momentary amazement and confusion by his profound reasonings; the first and most trivial event in life will put to flight all his doubts and scruples, and leave him the same, in every point of action and speculation, with the philosophers of every other sect, or with those who never

己的信念。

concerned themselves in any philosophical researches. When he awakes from his dream, he will be the first to join in the laugh against himself, and to confess, that all his objections are mere amusement, and can have no other tendency than to show the whimsical condition of mankind, who must act and reason and believe; though they are not able, by their most diligent enquiry, to satisfy themselves concerning the foundation of these operations, or to remove the objections, which may be raised against them.

第三节

Part III

事实上，有一种更为温和的怀疑主义或学院派哲学，既可以经得起时间的考验，也有实际用处。这可以说是皮浪主义或“过度”的怀疑主义的产物，不过其普遍怀疑观在一定程度上会受到常识和反思的矫正。大部分人都会武断和固执地坚持自己的观点。他们往往看到了事物的一面，并不了解相反的看法，就会匆忙地投身于自己所偏爱的原则，而且对持相反意见的人没有一点宽容。他们是不能犹豫不决、迟疑不断的，这样会让们感到茫然不解，会束缚他们的情感，阻止他们的行动。因此，他们急不可耐地要逃脱这种让他们感到不自在的状态，而且他们认为，他们要借助强烈的肯定和执着的信念，离这种状态越远越好。但是，倘若这些教条的推理者能够意识到，即使在最完美的状态

There is, indeed, a more mitigated scepticism or academical philosophy, which may be both durable and useful, and which may, in part, be the result of this Pyrrhonism, or excessive scepticism, when its undistinguished doubts are, in some measure, corrected by common sense and reflection. The greater part of mankind are naturally apt to be affirmative and dogmatical in their opinions; and while they see objects only on one side, and have no idea of any counterpoising argument, they throw themselves precipitately into the principles, to which they are inclined; nor have they any indulgence for those who entertain opposite sentiments. To hesitate or balance perplexes

下，即使在其得出最精确、最谨慎的结论的时候，人类的理解也是非常脆弱的，那么这种反省自然会让他们更谦逊、更矜持，让他们少一些孤芳自赏，少一些对其对手的偏见。目不识丁的人要思考博学之士的性情，博学之士们虽然从研究和思索中受益颇多，在作结论时却也常常犹豫不定，疑虑重重。另一方面，如有博学的人天性高傲固执，那么适当了解一些皮浪主义则能减少他们的傲慢，因为皮浪主义怀疑精神可以让他们明白，他们与别人相比所占的那点点优势，和人性中固有的、广泛的迷惑和纷乱之感比起来，实在是微不足道。总之，一个合理的推理者在进行一切考察和决断之时，都应该具备一定程度的怀疑、谨慎和谦恭的态度。

their understanding, checks their passion, and suspends their action. They are, therefore, impatient till they escape from a state, which to them is so uneasy; and they think, that they could never remove themselves far enough from it, by the violence of their affirmations and obstinacy of their belief. But could such dogmatical reasoners become sensible of the strange infirmities of human understanding, even in its most perfect state, and when most accurate and cautious in its determinations; such a reflection would naturally inspire them with more modesty and reserve, and diminish their fond opinion of themselves, and their prejudice against antagonists. The illiterate may

reflect on the disposition of the learned, who, amidst all the advantages of study and reflection, are commonly still diffident in their determinations; and if any of the learned be inclined, from their natural temper, to haughtiness and obstinacy, a small tincture of Pyrrhonism might abate their pride, by showing them, that the few advantages, which they may have attained over their fellows, are but inconsiderable, if compared with the universal perplexity and confusion, which is inherent in human nature. In general, there is a degree of doubt, and caution, and modesty, which, in all kinds of scrutiny and decision, ought for ever to accompany a just reasoner.

另外一种温和的怀疑主义或许有益于人类，同样可能是皮浪主义的犹疑和顾虑的自然产物。这种怀疑主义认为，我们应该限制研究的话题，只选择最适合人类理解相对有限的能力的那些领域。人的想象自然是高远的，人们乐于想象一切悠远奇特的事物，他们的想象会无拘无束地遨游到遥远的时空，以逃避因为习惯而天天接触，因而显得平淡无奇的事物。正确的判断恰恰需要遵循相反的方法，要避免一切好高骛远的探索，把研究的范围限于日常生活中，选择属于我们日常实践和经验范围内的话题。至于更为高远的论题，就让诗人和演说家去装点，或留给祭司和政治家们去施展才艺。要得出这样有益的结论，最有效的方法莫过于完全相信皮浪主义怀疑论的力量，并且相信，除了自然

Another species of mitigated scepticism which may be of advantage to mankind, and which may be the natural result of the Pyrrhonian doubts and scruples, is the limitation of our enquiries to such subjects as are best adapted to the narrow capacity of human understanding. The imagination of man is naturally sublime, delighted with whatever is remote and extraordinary, and running, without control, into the most distant parts of space and time in order to avoid the objects, which custom has rendered too familiar to it. A correct Judgment observes a contrary method, and avoiding all distant and high enquiries, confines itself to common life, and to such sub-

固来所具有的强大力量，没有任何事物能够让我们摆脱这种怀疑的影响。喜欢进行哲学思考的人们仍然会继续从事他们的研究。因为在他们看来，除了那些直接从哲学研究中得来的快乐，哲学的结论不过是对日常生活所作的系统化的、正确的反省。但是，只要他们意识到自己所运用的官能并不完善，其范围的有限性，其实际作用的不精确性，他们就不会受到诱导，要选择超越日常生活之外的话题来研究。既然我们拿不出一个令人满意的理由，来解释我们为什么在经过上千次实验以后，就相信石头总是要往下落，火总会燃烧，那么在关于世界的起源和自然在永恒中的状态这些高深的论题上，我们还能得出让自己满意的结论吗？

jects as fall under daily practice and experience; leaving the more sublime topics to the embellishment of poets and orators, or to the arts of priests and politicians. To bring us to so salutary a determination, nothing can be more serviceable, than to be once thoroughly convinced of the force of the Pyrrhonian doubt, and of the impossibility, that anything, but the strong power of natural instinct, could free us from it. Those who have a propensity to philosophy, will still continue their researches; because they reflect, that, besides the immediate pleasure, attending such an occupation, philosophical decisions are nothing but the reflections of common life, methodized and

corrected. But they will never be tempted to go beyond common life, so long as they consider the imperfection of those faculties which they employ, their narrow reach, and their inaccurate operations. While we cannot give a satisfactory reason, why we believe, after a thousand experiments, that a stone will fall, or fire burn; can we ever satisfy ourselves concerning any determination, which we may form, with regard to the origin of worlds, and the situation of nature, from, and to eternity?

This narrow limitation, indeed, of our enquiries, is, in every respect, so reasonable, that it suffices to make the slightest

从各方面来看，我们对研究话题的限制都如此合理，以至于只要我们对人的心智的自然能力稍加考察，并把这些能力和与之相

应的事物进行对比，就会明白这一点。因此，我们接下来将会探索哪些是适合科学和研究的话题。

examination into the natural powers of the human mind and to compare them with their objects, in order to recommend it to us. We shall then find what are the proper subjects of science and enquiry.

我认为，抽象科学或演算科学的唯一对象是量和数，一切要把这类更完备的知识扩充到量和数的界限之外的企图都不过是诡辩和幻想。由于量和数的组成部分完全相似，各组成部分间的关系显得错综复杂。因而，最有意思也最有用的莫过于借用各种手段，通过它们呈现出来的不同外表，来确定它们到底是相同还是相异。但是，其他的观念都是清晰可辨且各不相同的，即使我们凭借多么深入细致的研究，也只能观察到各自的差

It seems to me, that the only objects of the abstract science or of demonstration are quantity and number, and that all attempts to extend this more perfect species of knowledge beyond these bounds are mere sophistry and illusion. As the component parts of quantity and number are entirely similar, their relations become intricate and involved; and nothing can be more curious, as well as useful, than to trace, by a variety of

异，并通过明白的反省来指出此物非彼物，仅此而已。如果我们在做出这些判断时面临困难，那都是由于词义的不确定性引起的，可以通过更准确的定义来对此进行纠正。拿“直角三角形斜边的平方等于其余两边平方之和”这一定理来说，即使其中涉及的术语都有精确的定义，如果不通过一连串推理和演算，我们也不能理解该定理。但是，要让我们接受“没有财产，就没有不义之行为”这个命题，我们只须明确定义这些名词，并解释不义之行为就是对他人财产的侵犯。其实这个命题也不过是一种较不完全的定义。除了数量科学以外，各种科学中那些三段论式的演绎推理都是一样的。所以，我想我可以断言，只有关于数和量的科学才配称得上是知识和演算的适当对象。

人类所进行的其他一切研究只涉及事实问题和存在，这些显然是无法验证的。任何“存在”也可以“不存在”。否定一个事实不会

mediums, their equality or inequality, through their different appearances. But as all other ideas are clearly distinct and different from each other, we can never advance farther, by our utmost scrutiny, than to observe this diversity, and, by an obvious reflection, pronounce one thing not to be another. Or if there be any difficulty in these decisions, it proceeds entirely from the undeterminate meaning of words, which is corrected by juster definitions. That the square of the hypotenuse is equal to the squares of the other two sides, cannot be known, let the terms be ever so exactly defined, without a train of reasoning and enquiry. But to convince us of this proposi-

tion, that where there is no property, there can be no injustice, it is only necessary to define the terms, and explain injustice to be a violation of property. This proposition is, indeed, nothing but a more imperfect definition. It is the same case with all those pretended syllogistical reasonings, which may be found in every other branch of learning, except the sciences of quantity and number; and these may safely, I think, be pronounced the only proper objects of knowledge and demonstration.

All other enquiries of men regard only matter of fact and existence; and these are evidently incapable of demonstration.

引发矛盾。任何事物之“不存在”都毫无例外地和其“存在”一样，都是清楚明白的观念。断言其“不存在”的命题，无论多么荒谬，肯定也和其“存在”的命题一样，是我们可以想象和理解的。而若涉及真正的科学，情况就不一样了。在真正的科学里，任何不真实的命题都会令人困惑并莫名其妙。比如“64的立方根等于10的一半”就是错误的命题，这一点我们永远无法清晰地理解。但是，如果我们说凯撒或天使加百列，或其他任何人物，不曾存在过，这也许是错误的命题，但这却是完全可以想象的，并不暗含什么矛盾之处。

Whatever is may *not* be. No negation of a fact can involve a contradiction. The non-existence of any being, without exception, is as clear and distinct an idea as its existence. The proposition, which affirms it not to be, however false, is no less conceivable and intelligible, than that which affirms it to be. The case is different with the sciences, properly so called. Every proposition, which is not true, is there confused and unintelligible. That the cube root of 64 is equal to the half of 10, is a false proposition, and can never be distinctly conceived. But that Caesar, or the angel Gabriel, or any being never existed, may be a false proposition, but still is perfectly conceivable, and implies

no contradiction.

因此，任何事物的存在，只能由其原因或其结果来加以证明，而这些论证是完全建立在经验的基础之上的。我们如果进行先觉的推理，任何事物似乎都能产生任何别的事物。比如，一个石子落下可能会消灭太阳；人的意愿可以控制住在轨道上运转的行星。只有经验才能教会我们认识因果关系的本质和适用范围，使我们具备从一种事物的存在推断出另一事物的存在的能力。^{*}这便是进行道德推理的基础，它构成了人类的大部分知识，是一切人类行为的源泉。

The existence, therefore, of any being can only be proved by arguments from its cause or its effect; and these arguments are founded entirely on experience. If we reason *a priori*, anything may appear able to produce anything. The falling of a pebble may, for aught we know, extinguish the sun; or the wish of a man control the planets in their orbits. It is only experience, which teaches us the nature and bounds of cause and effect, and enables us to infer the existence of one object from that of another^{*}. Such is the foundation of moral reasoning, which forms the greater part of human

道德推理所依据的，要么是具体的事实，要么是普遍的事实。关于人生的思考都涉及具体事实；历史学、年代学、地理学和天文学的一切研究也是一样的。 以普遍的事实为对象的科学包括政治学、自然哲学、物理学、化学等等，在这些领域中，人们研究的是一切事物的性质和因果关系。 神学或神性，都旨在证明神的存在和灵	knowledge, and is the source of all human action and behaviour. Moral reasonings are either concerning particular or general facts. All deliberations in life regard the former; as also all disquisitions in history, chronology, geography, and astronomy. The sciences, which treat of general facts, are politics, natural philosophy, physic, chemistry, &c. where the qualities, causes and effects of a whole species of objects are enquired into. Divinity or Theology, as it proves the
魂的不朽，其推理论证既涉及具体事实，也关乎普遍的事实。在其可以用经验证明的范围内，神学有一定的理性基础。但是，神学最佳和最坚实的基础是建立在信仰和神圣启示之上的。 与其说道德和批评是人类理解的适当对象，毋宁说是它们人类趣味和情感的表达。美，无论是道德的美还是自然的美，更多地是被人所感觉，而不是为人所认知。我们若要针对美作相关推论，并努力确定美的标准，那么我们所考虑的就是一种新的事实，即人类一般的趣味，或者说是一种可供我们推论和研究的这类事实。	existence of a Deity, and the immortality of souls, is composed partly of reasonings concerning particular, partly concerning general facts. It has a foundation in reason, so far as it is supported by experience. But its best and most solid foundation is faith and divine revelation. Morals and criticism are not so properly objects of the understanding as of taste and sentiment. Beauty, whether moral or natural, is felt, more properly than perceived. Or if we reason concerning it, and endeavour to fix its standard, we regard a new fact, to wit, the general tastes of mankind, or some such fact, which may be the

假如我们相信了这些原则，那么在翻查各个图书馆的藏书时，我们该销毁什么样的图书呢？如果随手拿起一本书，比如与神学或经院哲学相关的图书，我们可以这样发问：这本书涉及数和量方面的抽象推论吗？没有。它涉及任何针对事实和存在的推论吗？没有。那么我们就可以付之一炬，因为它所讲的不过都是些诡辩和幻想。

object of reasoning and enquiry.

When we run over libraries, persuaded of these principles, what havoc must we make? If we take in our hand any volume; of divinity or school metaphysics, for instance; let us ask: Does it contain any abstract reasoning concerning quantity or number? No. Does it contain any experimental reasoning concerning matter of fact and existence? No. Commit it then to the flames, for it can contain nothing but sophistry and illusion.

完结，希望给你带来思索感动！